

Knights of the Grail

TM

A Guide to Bretonnia

Design and Writing: David Chart

Development: Robert J. Schwalb Editing: Kara Hamilton

Graphic Design & Art Direction: Hal Mangold

Cover Art: Mark Gibbons WFRP Logo: Darius Hinks

Interior Art: James Brady, Vincent Dutrait, Wayne England,

Mike Franchina, Carl Frank, Dave Gallagher, Karl Kopinski, Jim Pavalec,

Scott Purdy, Adrian Smith, Christophe Swal, Chris Trevas

Cartography: Shawn Brown and Andy Law

WFRP Development Manager: Kate Flack

Head of Black Industries: Marc Gascoigne

Special Thanks: Simon Butler and Ewan Lamont Workshop logo, Warhammer, Warhammer Fantasy

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Introduction

Welcome to Bretonnia, land of knights and chivalry, Chapter IV: Law and Justice explains the Bretonnian legal home of the servants of the Lady of the Lake. It's a land system, which is very different for nobles and peasants.

where the ideals of knightly heroism are still admired, if not upheld, and a land of perilous adventure. Chapter V: Religion and Custom is largely concerned with the cult of the Lady of the Lake—the state religion of This book contains all the information you need to set your Bretonnia—but also covers holidays and the worship of the

WFRP campaign in Bretonnia, a land very different from the standard Gods of the Old World. Empire, or to bring Imperial characters on a visit. It sets a new stage for your stories. Chapter VI: A Tour of Bretonnia is by far the longest chapter. Each of the fourteen dukedoms is described, with

Just like Sigmar's Heirs, this book is a toolkit. Use what you like details of the land, people, notable sites, and current tensions and ignore what you don't. All the sections have been written and opportunities for adventure. Each section also considers

with an eye to material reasons for an adventurer to immediately useful in play, leave that particular dukedom but nothing is set in stone for for the wider world. your campaign. Women in Bretonnia Chapter VII: Characters and

What's Women in Bretonnia are second-class citizens, and Careers covers the creation of many Careers are only open to them if they pretend Bretonnian characters. New to be men. This is not a feature of Bretonnian society Racial Characteristics are Inside? of which the author or Games Workshop approves, given, both for Bretonnian but women pretending to be men make interesting Humans in general and for The nine chapters following characters in a roleplaying game. If the sexism of people from each dukedom.

this introduction provide Bretonnia makes you or your players uncomfortable, There are also numerous new

extensive information on feel free to ignore it. careers, from the Carcassonne Bretonnia, broken up by The author and Black Industries also do not approve Shepherd to the noble Grail

topic. of the arbitrary execution of peasants, fighting local Knight.

Chapter I: Land and People wars over an insult, or worshipping the Ruinous Chapter VIII: Knighthood

describes the general lay of Powers, all activities depicted herein. Just so we're sets out the ideals and powers

the land of Bretonnia and the clear. of Bretonnian chivalry. The culture of its people. Blessings of the Lady, Virtues

Chapter II: History is an of Knighthood, and steeds of account of Bretonnia from the Bretonnian knights are all before its founding to the present day. Most important are covered.

the battles of Gilles the Unifier, events that still resonate with Finally, Chapter IX: Ill Tidings is an adventure designed Bretonnians today. to introduce a group of adventurers to Bretonnia. There are

Chapter III: Politics covers the general structure of two sets of statistics, one for novice Bretonnian adventurers

Bretonnian politics: the feudal system, merchant organisations, and one for more experienced adventurers just arrived from and the informal politics of peasant villages. elsewhere.

A Turn for the Better

Sir Gilbert urged his weary mount into the dreary looking village. The roads here were terrible, and he had a hard time believing this was the route to the Chapel of Shields Burning. But the lord he had stayed with the previous night had been quite emphatic.

At last, he reached what looked like an inn. Crude emblems were painted on the door. Typical peasant superstition, thought Gilbert. The knight banged his gauntleted fist on the door, but no one answered. Gilbert kept pounding, but something about this was horribly familiar. He lowered his right hand to his sword and looked around cautiously.

At last, a voice came from inside. "Go away!" "You will open this door this instant," the Bretonnian said, lacking any measure of optimism. "I am Sir Gilbert de Arnaud, Knight Errant..." He got no further, as the door flew open. "My most humble apologies, lord knight. I had not realised." The innkeeper was literally grovelling in the mud. "The finest room is, of course, at your disposal." Sir Gilbert sighed contentedly. It was good to be home.

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Chapter I: The Land and Its People

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The Land and Chapter
its People

I

"Bretonnia is fair and peaceful because everyone knows their place. Yours is with the truffle

hounds.”

- Lord Thederic of Maronz,
to a captured outlaw.

Short-term visitors to Bretonnia see a land of fertile farms, It does, however, conceal problems. The mountains are home rolling hills, starkly beautiful mountains, and airy forests. to Greenskins, the forests to foul creatures. Many peasants are The population consists of noble and courteous knights, fair starving, and knights who use courtesy to cloak brutality are ladies, and contented and deferential peasants. Bretonnian found throughout the land. Even the superb flavours of the food chefs are famous for their culinary skill, and the wine produced often mask rotten ingredients. The cynical say Bretonnia wears in the vineyards of the country is renowned throughout the a fair mask over deep corruption; the more generous lament Old World. This is the image Bretonnians want to project, and the gap often found between its ideals and reality. No one who it is not entirely false. knows the country at all can ignore the contrast, however.

— The Land —

Anyone travelling through Bretonnia, outside the blighted Peasants work the fields almost constantly. In fine weather, land of Mousillon, sees a country that looks fair and this adds to the charm of the scene, and most peasants seem prosperous. The forbidding forests and frowning mountains cheerful. In bad weather, they hunch over against the wind of the Empire are nowhere to be seen. This does not mean and rain and can almost vanish as they are covered with mud, Bretonnia is completely safe, however. Behind the facade, peril making them the same colour as the fields. At such times, there lurks. are few to see them.

Bretonnia’s landscape can be divided into six main types: Most of Bretonnia’s hills are devoted to pastoral farming, whilst arable land, where crops are grown; pastoral land, where the plains and valleys are arable. The grazing animals keep animals are grazed; forests; mountains; the coast; and the the grass short, and the view of green hills dotted with white great rivers. This section discusses the types in general sheep or typically Bretonnian russet cattle is a common one. terms, as specific areas are covered in Chapter V: A Tour of The flocks and herds are tended by shepherds and herdsmen. Bretonnia. The exceptions are the great rivers, which form Shepherdesses are common in the south of Bretonnia, where the borders between Duchies and thus are treated individually it is the only occupation that allows women to travel by

here. themselves. In the north, the idea of letting women go into the hills alone is frowned upon. The dominant arable crop in Bretonnia is wheat, though oats, barley, and green vegetables are also grown. Fields are very large and divided into strips. Peasant families are responsible for one strip each, and differences in treatment mean many fields look somewhat stripy. Fruit Orchards and vineyards are common in particular, have a reputation the hills, on land that is too steep for easy farming. Sheep are as tough and dangerous fighters and generally cannot find often grazed under fruit trees. husbands. Most of them do not particularly care. Many

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shepherds carry the Bretonnian Crook, a spear with a hook at the end of the handle, and are skilled in its use. The outer edges of Bretonnia's forests are thoroughly exploited by the people. Pigs forage in the leaf litter, trees are felled for building, and others are coppiced or pollarded. These are techniques that ensure a tree produces a lot of long, thin branches, useful for wattle and daub or for firewood. It involves cutting the branches right back every year, almost to the ground in the case of a coppice, or further up the trunk for a pollard. In Bretonnia, pollards are more common, so that pigs and sheep cannot eat the shoots of new branches. As a result, the trees in these areas are spaced out for easy access, and there is little undergrowth.

Further in, however, the forests become as dark and tangled as anything in the Empire. There are no Elves in the forests of Arden or Châlons (Athel-Loren is outside Bretonnia proper), and no Humans live beyond the tamed borders. As a result, they are a haven for Beastmen and similar foul creatures, or for cultists of the Ruinous Powers. Human outlaws often lair near the edge of forests, and provide an important defence for local communities, keeping worse creatures back in the depths of the woods. There are stories of whole cities of Beastmen in the depths of the Arden, and whilst there is no evidence for this implausible idea, it is not impossible; no one knows enough about the forest interior to say the cities are not there.

The mountains surrounding Bretonnia, and the Massif Orcal in its heart, are notable for their spectacular scenery. Soaring cliffs and thundering waterfalls mark the outer edges of mountain ranges, and on clear days, the peaks seem to shine from the snow on them. Farming and mining communities dot

the edges of the mountain ranges, renowned for the extremely steep roofs of their houses, designed to shed snowfall quickly. Some of these communities are cut off from the rest of Bretonnia for months at a time in winter and have developed their own customs, in some cases involving the worship of the Dark Ones. Further in, Orc and Goblin tribes make their homes. When the snows melt in spring, at least one mountain community is found reduced to charred rubble. It has, however, been many years since these Orcs dared to raid outside their mountain strongholds; some fear they have been building their strength.

Bretonnia's coasts are marked by many cliffs and broad beaches of golden sand at their base. Around the great river deltas, the approach is gentler, and there are a number of safe harbours. Small islands dot the waters off much of Bretonnia. A few of these are home to villages or even small towns. A number of coastal villages are built up the sides of cliffs and other rugged coastal areas, with staircases or even ladders connecting streets running parallel to the slope of the land. These villages typically rely on fishing for their official income.

However, the waters around Bretonnia are notoriously difficult to navigate. Currents, winds, and tides shift rapidly, and many sea monsters live in caves in the more rugged areas of the coast. As a result, there are many shipwrecks. This situation is exacerbated by the inhabitants of certain villages who lure ships onto rocks and then pillage the wreckage. The form of the land also makes

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it all but impossible to moor a ship anywhere but a major port, The main fault of the Grismerie is that it reaches the sea in the and tolls and duties at those ports are very high. Smugglers are swarms of Mousillon. The slow current means that it is easy also found along most of the coast, avoiding the tolls at the major for things to swim up the river, and attacks by waterlogged ports by carrying goods in small boats they know how and where Undead are not unusual. All boats try to make an inn by to beach. nightfall, and the innkeepers hire guards to drive off any The River Sannez is the swiftest of Bretonnia's great rivers, attacks that might come. This makes the river inns unusual in a narrow and deep for much of its length and renowned for the second respect: they are more designed to drive off attacks from purity of its water. It flows through Couronne, the capital, to the river than from the land.

reach the coast at L'Anguille, the greatest port, and as a result The Gilleau, which reaches the sea at Bordeleaux, is most famous
sees a lot of trade. The fast current means upstream trading as the site of the first of the Great Battles of Gilles the Unifier.
is much harder than down, and the traders on the river use Indeed, it takes its name from that event. It is famous for the
“upstream” to refer to any difficult task, particularly if there Gillites—boatmen who live on their boats and refuse to set foot
is an easier way of doing something. In the latter sense, it has on land. Their boats are brightly painted, and they make excellent
entered normal Bretonnian, so “That’s a bit upstream” means tradesmen, so they have a near-monopoly on river trade.
“You’re doing that the hard way.” The river has its source in the Massif Orcal, a tributary
The current of the Sannez makes it hard to control a boat from the heart of the Forest of Châlons, and flows along the
and very difficult to swim to safety if you land in the water. borders of that forest for most of its length. As a result, it is
Carnivorous fish take advantage of this, having learned plagued by Greenskins and Beastmen, and another reason for
that a Human in water is basically helpless. In many places, the monopoly of the Gillites is their skill in driving off such
someone who falls into the Sannez is literally eaten alive. The attacks. They also seem to be attacked less often than other
carnivorous fish are very tasty, however, and some regular users of the river, leading some to whisper that they are in
boatmen make a show of catching them by trailing a hand league with the monsters.
in the water and grabbing the fish that bites. Two-fingered The Brienne is the southernmost of the great rivers, and the
Gothric (previously known as Three-fingered Gothric) is the fact that its source rises in the Forest of Loren leads many
acknowledged master of this lunatic fishing method. Bretonnians to regard it as sacred. The water is notable for a
The Grismerie is the largest of the rivers, broad and slow for distinct blue tint, and for the fact that it can be safely drunk at
much of its length. It begins near Parravon, where it is still a any point along its length, even where it flows through the city
young and energetic stream, but by the time it reaches Montfort of Brionne. Most Bretonnians attribute this to the influence of
it has settled down. The Grismerie sees more traffic than any the Fay of Loren.
other river, and the riverside inns are famous throughout the Traffic on the Brienne is lighter than might be expected,
country. They particularly compete on cuisine, and The Braided because boats sailing on it sometimes simply vanish without a
Fish, near Montfort, is famous for both the house speciality of trace. Neither the boats, the passengers, nor even splinters are
grilled trout and the spectacular view of the mountains from the ever seen again. This isn’t an everyday occurrence, happening
rooftop dining area. The Duke of Montfort has stayed there, and no more often than once per

month, but it is far too common
rumours suggest that the King is considering a visit. to be chance. These events have remained
inexplicable.

— The Bretonnians —

Unlike the Empire, Bretonnia is populated almost entirely A Bretonnian peasant concentrates on
getting through today,
by Humans. Dwarfs come from the mountains to trade, rather than storing up worries about
tomorrow.
and the Sea Elves have an enclave at L'Anguille, but you can Bretonnians do not worry about the
consequences of their
spend days travelling through the heart of Bretonnia without actions. When those consequences
come, they deal with them
meeting either. Halflings are even rarer, and those that are there in the same spirit; few
Bretonnians waste time whining about
have come from the Empire. the unfairness of life. Indeed, most Bretonnians look down on
Whilst Bretonnians, like all Humans, vary a great deal among those who make provision for the
future. No one knows what
themselves, there is one feature shared by so many that it is the future will bring, so failing to do
the best you can now in
regarded as the national character. Bretonnians live for the order to have reserves for a future
that might never come is
moment and pride themselves on this fact. little more than an excuse for shirking.

This does not mean all Bretonnians are wild hedonists, partying This does not mean that
Bretonnians eat the entire harvest
constantly, though some members of the nobility do fit this over the course of a month; they are
neither suicidal nor idiots.
image. Rather, it means that, for a Bretonnian, what matters is On the other hand, they might eat
well on a holiday and then
what you do now, not what you may or may not be able to do poorly thereafter because the
stocks have been reduced. Very
in the future. A dedicated Bretonnian craftsman might labour few Bretonnians would reduce
their intake before the holiday,
long into the night to make the shoes he is working on now so as to have enough in reserve for a
feast.
as good as they possibly can be. Bretonnian knights choose More generally, Bretonnians tend
not to invest for the future.
their actions to ensure that they are always acting honourably. Large buildings are constructed
for immediate display, not

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to increase the wealth of their owners. Similarly, programs of from their imperial neighbours and
vice versa, but Breton
social reform are unpopular because their benefits are entirely has evolved in different fashion,

making communication in the future and distract from doing good now. A Bretonnian between these people challenging. This has led to bigotry, and would rather feed the starving than campaign to remove the exaggerated parodies of the Imperial speech are often used causes of starvation. when being rude about merchants. This attitude has been blamed, particularly by Imperial citizens, Whilst communication between speakers of Bretonnian and for Bretonnia's relative backwardness. Whilst the Imperial armies speakers of Reikspiel is generally possible, there are a number fight with musketeers and cannons, the Bretonnians still rely on of potential pitfalls. Two in particular stand out. mounted knights and trebuchets. Similarly, printing has taken First, the Bretonnian vocabulary for food and drink is the Empire by storm, but most books in Bretonnia are still much richer than in Reikspiel and different even when they written by hand. On the other hand, it cannot be denied that the overlap. There are a number of Bretonnian dishes that do individual products of Bretonnian craftsmen tend to be superior not even have names in Reikspiel. This makes ordering a to those produced in the Empire. A Bretonnian swordsmith lives meal difficult and finding out what you have been served to make the best swords he can, not to make as much money as even harder. A number of Imperial travellers make it a rule possible. Adventurers are almost the epitome of the Bretonnian not to eat anything that the chef cannot name in Reikspiel. mindset, and Bretonnian adventurers are therefore much more (And sometimes not even then; see Material Culture on the common than one might expect. following page.) There are exceptions, particularly among the merchants of Second, in spoken Bretonnian there is a very strong tendency Bretonnia. Indeed, many Bretonnians with an inclination to to use the future tense for talking about the past. This is rather plan for the future find themselves drawn into trade almost casual and a bit lower class, but members of the nobility also against their will, as they find they have a surplus to sell at a do it among friends. Scholars tend to avoid it, and writing in time when other people are desperate. As a result, merchants in this form is a sign of ignorance. Thus, a Bretonnian talking general are poorly regarded by most Bretonnians, but are far, about an accident the previous day might say: far richer than their compatriots. "Well, the ostler, right, he'll tell the horse to stop, but the Bretonnian Language horse, he won't listen, and he'll charge straight out of the gate. What do you think? The maid'll be just coming out Though Breton is similar in some ways to Reikspiel, suggesting of the door, and the horse will go and hit her. She'll break some common, albeit ancient, heritage, it is wholly a distinct her arm in three places, and she

won't be back at work
language. Certainly, the Bretons have borrowed words for months. What'll I do?"

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Of course, the last two occurrences of the future tense are line would die out immediately. Such additional ennobling has actually future, but they don't sound any different. This habit never happened, and all of Bretonnia's noble lines can trace often leaves foreigners utterly confused. (It is also fairly easy to pedigrees back to the foundation of the kingdom. No records roleplay.) are kept from before the time of Gilles the Uniter. All male nobles are expected to become knights, and the Social Structure overwhelming majority do so. (Knighthood is treated in detail in Chapter VIII: Knighthood.) Female nobles are not allowed Bretonnian society is divided between nobles and peasants. The to become knights and are expected to keep house for their division is enshrined in law, and the laws governing the two husbands, being a fine ornament to his household. classes are very different (see Chapter IV: Law and Justice). The divide between men and women is the second major The notion that all people are basically equal seems laughable divide in Bretonnian society, for the two sexes are far from to most Bretonnians. equal. Men are required to be polite to women at all times. Every Bretonnian is born into one class or the other, and it Insulting a woman is a terrible breach of etiquette, and men is almost impossible to change. A noble is someone who can who violently attack women are punished particularly severely. show that all his (or her) ancestors for five generations were Men should stand when a woman enters the room and should nobles. As the names and pedigrees of all members of the always let her go first, unless climbing stairs, in which case the nobility are recorded in the Registers of the Peerage, this is man should go first. Women are served first at meals and given merely a matter of showing all your ancestors are in those the more comfortable rooms in inns. registers. Everyone else is a peasant. Thus, in particular, the Of course, these requirements only apply within a class. Noble children of a noble and a peasant are peasants. Since a peasant men are not required to show this level of courtesy to peasant cannot inherit a noble fief, landed nobles never marry peasants. women, though some do and are well regarded for it, as long as There are two groups of exceptions. First, foreigners are not it doesn't get out of hand. Bretonnian and are thus neither noble nor peasant. This also On the other hand, women are not allowed to own property, to applies to the Dwarfs, Elves, and Halflings in the kingdom. travel without a male escort, or to undertake most trades and

Such characters are treated with the respect that seems to be professions. Despite the trappings of courtesy, men are firmly due, which in practice means that they are treated according in charge. The Grail Damsels are the most obvious exception to their clothes. Second, the Grail Damsels (see Chapter VI: to this. Religion and Custom) stand completely outside the system, Most women live with the constraints, and a significant number even believe that they are right. Some, however, decide

The relations between nobles and peasants influence all aspects they want to fight or own a shop. In order to do this, they of Bretonnian society and so are treated repeatedly in this must disguise themselves as men. No one knows how many book. The basic relationship, however, is simple. Peasants disguised women there are in Bretonnia at any one time, but live to serve their lords. The nobles, in return, should protect solely among the nobility, a Knight is found on his death in the peasants and provide justice. Lords do, however, have battle to be a woman at least once per year.

other duties than to their peasants, most notably to their own Female Bretonnian player characters must pretend to be men lords, and these other duties are generally regarded as more in order to start their careers. This pretence is automatically important. successful and requires no Tests of any sort. Unless the woman Almost all nobles regard all peasants as their inferiors. Exceptions reveals her true sex, no one notices. Of course, if they leave are incredibly rare; player characters are likely candidates, Bretonnia, they can drop the disguise.

but otherwise a character might meet one in a lifetime. Even Female adventurers and merchants from foreign countries are then, the noble is likely to recognise no more than a handful likely to become impatient with their treatment. They benefit of peasants as equals. Many peasants regard the nobility as from the courtesy, but no one takes them seriously, assuming their superiors, but exceptions are much more common in this the men in the party must be in charge. Some women who direction. Peasants who regard all nobles as useless parasites on visit Bretonnia frequently pretend to be men whilst they are society are found across the kingdom. there in order to avoid the hassle.

Nobles can be stripped of their title by order of the King or the Fay Enchantress. This equally affects all of their descendants, so Material Culture this is not done lightly. The King and Fay Enchantress can also raise a peasant to the nobility, but in this case, they must both “Material culture” refers to the things that a people use in their agree. In theory, the Lady of the Lake could raise anyone she daily life: food and drink, clothes, housing, and so on. It can be wanted to any position she wanted, but she never has. contrasted with “high culture,” the stories and songs they listen

In the whole of Bretonnian history, only three peasants have to and the art they produce. Material culture is, in general, been raised to the nobility. The children of an ennobled peasant more important than people realise. are not themselves nobles, as their grandparents, on at least In Bretonnia, the most important element of material culture one side, are peasants. Thus, unless they were also ennobled, is wine. Uniquely, there are no laws governing who may drink by the agreement of the King and Fay Enchantress, the noble

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Chapter I: The Land and Its People

it, and “like a bottle of bad wine” is a Bretonnian saying women, on being told that the peasants have no bread, suggest meaning “extremely rare and unexpected (and somewhat that they should eat cake, instead. unpleasant).” As a result, almost all Bretonnians drink wine The Bretonnians are also notorious for eating things other with every meal and often between meals as well. It is normal nations find repulsive. Truffles, large, smelly fungi with a to add quite a lot of water to wine before drinking it, partly very strong taste, are eaten raw as a fine delicacy. Frogs are to make it go further and partly to avoid going about your boiled alive at the table, eviscerated, and eaten whole, bones daily life permanently tipsy. Only nobles and drunkards drink and all. Snails are fried with garlic and eaten from the shell. wine straight. Finally, the eyeballs of sheep or cattle are added to thick soups. Whilst bad wine is very hard to find, there are still clear The eyes tend to rise to the top and become visible once the distinctions between the merely good and the excellent. soup is disturbed, often by the diner beginning to eat. Many Carcassonne Special Reserve is the most famous wine in the Bretonnians take delight in serving these delicacies to their country, and a single bottle costs over a hundred Gold Crowns. honoured foreign guests. True connoisseurs tend to believe it is not actually the best, but they fail to agree as to what is. No one doubts that it is very Clothing good indeed. Brandy, made by distilling wine, is more rarely drunk as it Bretonnian costume is basically the same no matter what the is far more expensive. Adding water to brandy is a sign that social class, though the details vary widely, and some fabrics, you are an uncultured nouveau-riche or a poverty-stricken colours, and styles of clothing are reserved to nobles by law provincial knight with no taste. Some snobbish merchants and (see Chapter IV: Law and Justice). Men wear shoes or boots, nobles use this as a test. Almost everyone agrees that the finest breeches (trousers), a tunic, and a cloak over the top.

brandy is Parravon Crown Reserve. Rumour has it that less than a dozen bottles reach the required standard in a year. The cloak is normally hooded, but the hood is only raised if the weather is inclement and is often used as a pocket otherwise.

It is certainly true that the whole extent of the feudal obligation is that knights wear a cloak over their armour, and this cloak gets of the Marrennes, the noble family who hold the fief where it was damaged in the heat of battle. Wearing a battle-damaged cloak is produced, is two bottles per year, given to the King. There in normal circumstances is a claim to respect for your knightly is also a waiting list for those wishing to buy, and the price is prowess, and thus only those knights who think they deserve rarely just cash. respect do so. It is currently fashionable for other nobles to Bretonnian beer, on the other hand, is a byword for wear cloaks with deliberately cut slits. These slits are often lined undrinkable swill throughout the Old World. Asking an with fur or another material, to make it clear that they are Imperial landlord if his brewer is Bretonnian is a good way to deliberate; faking battle damage is frowned upon. The length of start a fight. the cloak is variable, according to personal taste.

Peasants almost always wear long cloaks, and the cloak is Food typically the finest item of clothing they own. As it covers the poorer tunic and breeches, most Bretonnian peasants look The cuisine of Bretonnia is justly famous. The land produces better dressed than they are. a number of strongly flavoured herbs, which, used in Tunics are normally long, and breeches slightly loose and moderation, produce delicious dishes. Used more liberally, they ankle-length, like normal trousers. However, noble fashion can even make rotten vegetables palatable, and many peasants includes very short tunics, reaching only to the waist, and skin-use them for this purpose. Whilst a Bretonnian meal might tight breeches called "hose." give you food poisoning, it is unlikely to taste foul. Women wear long dresses and no breeches, with a cloak

Diet does differ between the nobility and the peasants. Peasants over the top. The main difference between a dress and a eat very little meat, whilst a noble meal is almost always tunic is that a long tunic is often slit to make walking easier, dominated by the meat course. Farmed meats, such as pork, whilst a dress is not. Recent noble fashion is for a very short beef, and mutton, can be eaten by peasants; game meats, cloak, little more than a scarf, and for dresses that leave the most notably venison, are restricted to the nobility by law. A shoulders and arms bare. Peasant women wear long cloaks, peasant who knowingly eats venison is liable to face severe like the men. punishment; in the darker fiefs, he is fed to the lord's hunting Bretonnian women always cover their head hair and are dogs. As a result, serving venison to noble guests is a sign of deeply embarrassed if anyone sees it. This is so ingrained that

respect. Serving nothing but bread and vegetables is positively a Bretonnian woman caught naked holding a towel would use insulting. it to cover her head. Most peasant women cut their hair short Bretonnian bread comes in several varieties. The whiter and and cover it with a cloth hood of some sort, but noblewomen lighter it is, the more expensive and the more suitable to the often use their hair as the foundation for elaborate, bejewelled nobility. The coarsest peasant fare is almost as hard a rock and headgear. Noblewomen also tend to pluck their eyebrows, as often contains small stones. The finest noble fare is so light that they are hair on the head, but peasants rarely bother. Grail you can cut it with your finger. A slightly cheaper and firmer Damsels often ignore this restriction, setting themselves apart bread, known as cake, is also popular with the nobility, though from society. the finest product is known simply as bread. Many noble

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The Bretonnian Truffle Hound

Bretonnian truffles grow underground, on or near tree-roots, and leave no obvious sign at the surface. Finding them would be impossible, were it not for the uncanny senses of the male Bretonnian Truffle Hound. These dogs can smell a buried truffle from over a hundred feet away, and, if possible, they immediately rush to the spot, dig the fungus up, and devour it.

This is bad for two reasons. First, the dog has eaten the truffle. Second, a Truffle Hound who has eaten a truffle becomes extremely paranoid about possible male rivals for the affection of Truffle Hound females, disregarding species entirely, and takes direct action to deal with the most immediate threat. A number of truffle hunters can explain, in fine soprano voices, exactly what happens, though most other men would rather not listen.

To avoid such accidents, wealthy and experienced truffle hunters have two dogs, each on a sturdy chain with a barbed spike on the end. When the dogs scent a truffle, the hunter rams one spike into the ground to hold one dog in place, and then drags the other off to one side, before fixing it in place. Both dogs strain to reach the truffle, so the hunter knows to dig at the point where their lines of sight cross.

Poor or beginning truffle hunters have a single dog and wait until he has begun to dig. They then drag him back from the spot, spike the chain to the ground, and dig the truffle up. This puts the dog very close to the truffle, and accidents do happen. Such truffle hunters rely on strength, speed, prayers to the Lady, and a solid steel codpiece, preferably with spikes. The truffle must be stored in alcohol, normally cheap brandy, so that the dogs can no longer

smell it, and all the tools that touched it must be washed in the same liquid. If something smells of truffles, Truffle Hounds become extremely affectionate towards it and are very insistent in pressing their attentions. They don't become dangerously violent unless they actually eat the fungus, however. Some lords like to smear criminals in truffle and throw them to the Truffle Hounds. There are two ways to do this. One involves simply rubbing the truffle lightly on the skin; the results of this are painful and deeply embarrassing but rarely fatal. The other involves actually crushing truffle onto the skin and is much more serious. Truffle Hounds are notoriously ugly dogs with faces that look as though they have been dropped and put back together by a clumsy five-year-old. Only peasants with a license from a noble are allowed to own them, and they must be kept under close control at all times to stop them running into the forest and eating all the truffles. Truffle Hounds use the statistics for War Dogs given on WFRP page 233. When they have eaten truffles, any Body Critical Effect of 7+ against a male character is a unique effect, not listed on the tables.

Adventure Event

An agent of dark powers throws truffles to the village's truffle hounds and then opens the door of the kennels. So, how many of the adventurers are only pretending to be men?

Architecture Daub is a mixture of mud, straw, and animal dung, smoothed over the wattle to keep out wind and rain. The daub used Buildings also clearly reflect the social divide. Only the nobility in Bretonnia dries to a warm, rich orange, the colour of may use stone in their constructions, and very few nobles sandstone, so even peasant houses look solid, but it's an would condescend to live in a structure that wasn't at least illusion. mainly stone. Grail Chapels (see Chapter V: Religion and Wealthy peasants have recently started to use brick extensively, Custom) built by the nobility may use stone. as it is not stone and thus permitted. They also use fine woods, Peasant huts are made from wattle and daub. Wattle is a woven and the richest merchants gild the outside of their houses. The network of thin branches, neither strong nor waterproof. structures are legal but far gaudier than any noble residence.

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Chapter II: History of Bretonnia

History of Chapter

Bretonnia

II

“All of Bretonnian history is prefigured and illuminated by the tales of the battles of Gilles the Unifier. What more need we know?”

- Laurent de Parravon,
History scholar

Brettonnia starts its calendar from the foundation of the (770), the lands of the Bretonni were divided into sixteen areas, nation by Gilles le Breton, the Unifier, in the year 979 each controlled by a major tribe, led by its Duke. These areas

of the Imperial Calendar, year one of the Bretonnian. In the form the basis for the current Dukedoms, though two, Cuileux

following chapter, dates are given by the Bretonnian Calendar and Glanborielle, have been absorbed into other regions.

first, followed by the Imperial date in brackets. The current Cuileux was the first to fall, in –48 (930). A massive horde of

year is 1544 (2522 by the Imperial Calendar). Orcs, led by the warlord Gragabad, poured out of the Massif

Orcal and overran their lands. The horsemen of Cuileux rode

Before the Kingdom out in a last, desperate battle, and though the Greenskins fell like wheat before the scythe, there were too many, and the

Brettonnia’s story begins three and a half thousand years ago, knights of Cuileux perished to the last man.

when the Bretonni, brave and warlike horsemen, crossed the In the wake of this disaster, the armies of Quenelles and

Grey Mountains and settled in the lands that would become Brionne rode forth and routed the weakened Orcs. The two

Brettonnia. These tribes faced centuries of constant warfare with Bretonni armies faced each other but had no stomach for war

the Greenskins who overran the land, but the tribes slowly over the lands of Cuileux. Instead, the two Dukes chose to

established themselves, driving the Orcs and Goblins back. duel, the winner taking Cuileux as part of his dukedom. The

Attempts to penetrate the Forest of Loren were less successful, lord of Brionne was cut down, and Quenelles was expanded.

leaving only a handful of survivors, all driven mad by the Fay

magic of the place. Within a few hundred years, the Forest of Prelude to Unity

Loren was believed to be a place of power outside the realm of

men. The destruction of Cuileux marks the beginning of the wars

When Sigmar Heldenhammer was unifying the tribes of the that culminated in the unification of the kingdom. In –46

Empire, he called upon the Bretonni to join his alliance. The (932) Balduin, the young Duke of Brionne, led his armies

leaders of the twenty tribes refused, however, disdaining to to victory, defeating the hordes of Gragabad and slaying the

bow to a foreigner. Sigmar fought the Greenskins without the warlord in single combat. In the battle, Gragabad's great axe Bretonni and forged his Empire. The Bretonni were to remain became lodged fast in Balduin's shield, and the lord fought feuding tribes for almost another thousand years. the entire battle with the axe in place. Afterwards, the axe was The number of Bretonni tribes fell over time, as the stronger adopted as the symbol of Brionne in memory of this event. took over the lands of weaker, and isolated tribes fell to the This victory did not stop the Orcs, however, and around predations of Orcs, Chaos, and Undead. In the year –208 –30 (948) the northern lands were overrun by Greenskins,

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Beastmen pouring from the Forest of Arden and Norse raiders withdrew a little way into the woods, camping in the peace striking from the sea. The northern tribes were driven back beside a small lake to plan their battle. into their strongholds, reduced to defending their castles whilst As they took counsel, the scene was suddenly bathed in a enemies roamed across their lands at will. bright light, and the air filled with the scent of summer In –26 (952) Gilles of Bastonne, heir of the Duke, slew the red meadows. A beautiful maiden, clothed in shining white and wyrm Smearghus, deep in the forest of Châlons. Though sorely bearing a golden cup from which light spilled like water, rose wounded, he managed to drag the beast's severed head back to from the waters of the lake and walked across them to the Castle Bastonne, where it still hangs above Gilles Gate, named knight, though the surface was not marred by a single ripple in his honour. Gilles took to wearing the dragon's skin as a and the Lady's clothes were perfectly dry. cloak and adopted the beast as his personal heraldry. On reaching the shore, she stood before Gilles and his In –4 (974) Orcs poured from the mountains and forests in companions. numbers never seen before or since. The Bretonni were unable "Rise and drink, Gilles le Breton, first King of Bretonnia. Drink to come to each other's aid, and the Dukedom of Glanborielle of honour and chivalry and of strength." Gilles stood and drank was utterly destroyed, its lands later taken by Carcassonne. In the from the offered Grail. As the shining liquid touched his lips, following year, the Duke of Bastonne was killed repelling the attack weariness fell from his bones and his eyes began to glow with a on his lands and was succeeded by Gilles le Breton, the Unifier. faint light. The Lady spoke to him again.

“Go forth in my name, Gilles le Breton. Go forth and in this
 Unification sign conquer.” So saying, she touched his banner, and where
 before the image of Smearghus had writhed, now the Lady’s
 Gilles gathered his armies and led them towards Bordeleaux, fair likeness gazed forth. The Lady
 then turned to Gilles’s
 aiming to stop the hordes of Greenskins from joining up and companions.
 forming a single army that could sweep Humankind into the “Rise and drink also, Landuin and
 Thierulf, Companions of the
 ocean. Thierulf of Lyonesse, a friend since childhood, and Lord Grail. Drink that you may follow
 your lord.” The knights drank
 Landuin of Mousillon, the finest knight in history, joined him; also and light suffused their bodies,
 whilst their weapons
 their lands were also under intense pressure, and they hoped, at seemed to burn with inner fire.
 least, to die gloriously at Gilles’s side. The three, the first Grail Knights, rode out of the forest to
 rally
 The knights camped under the eaves of the Forest of their troops to meet the dawn and the
 horde before them.
 Châlons, whilst before them the campfires of the Orc horde
 outnumbered the stars of the sky. Gilles and his companions

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The Twelve The Second Battle

Great Battles

As the Companions rode south to the relief of Brionne, they
 Gilles le Breton and his companions fought Twelve Great found their way blocked by the army of
 the bloated Orc
 Battles against the horde of enemies that threatened to destroy warlord Brogtar. Lord
 Fredemund summoned a great flock of
 the Bretonni. The battles took place over the course of two falcons, which struck the flying
 beasts of the Orcs from the sky,
 years, –1 to 0 (977 to 978) and over the whole of Bretonnia. and the Companions fought their way
 to the heart of the army,
 Each is the subject of more epic poems than a scholar could where Landuin struck the warlord
 down.
 read in a Human lifetime.

The Third Battle

The First Battle

The Companions came to Brionne to find the castle besieged,
 The morning after his encounter with the Lady of the Lake, wrapped around with countless
 Greenskins. The knights drove
 Gilles le Breton led his army against the Orcs besieging through the besiegers from behind,
 scattering them like chaff,
 Bordeleaux. The three Grail Companions did as much Lord Balduin of Brionne sallied forth with
 his knights, and
 slaughter as the rest of their army combined, and the they met Gilles in the midst of the Orc

armies. As they clasped
Greenskins were driven into the ocean. Lord Marcus of forearm as brothers, the Lady of the
Lake was suddenly beside
Bordeleaux and Lord Fredemund of Aquitaine joined Gilles them, and Balduin drank from the
Grail as Orcs screamed and
with their armies. died around them. Although the knights were outnumbered
three hundred to one, the Orcs could not stand and were
After the victory feast, the Lady of the Lake appeared in the driven from the field.
private chamber where the lords were gathered, and Marcus
and Fredemund both drank from the Grail. Marcus turned The Fourth Battle
that chamber within his castle into the first Grail Chapel, a site
still of unparalleled sanctity today. Urged on by visions of the Lady, the army crossed the River
Brienne and rode east through Carcasonne, towards Quenelles.
As they rode, Lord Lambard of Carcasonne rallied to their
banner, but he was not yet a Grail Companion. As the army

Tombs of the Horselords

The primitive Bretonni buried their lords in underground chambers, accessed through a deep
vertical shaft and marked with a few tall
standing stones, placed close together. These lords were buried with some of their finest
treasures, and the tombs defended with traps
and magic. Over the millennia, most of their locations have been forgotten, but the tombs
survive.

Scions of Cuileux

The knights of Cuileux all died in their last battle, but some had children at home, and the arrival
of the armies of Brionne
and Quenelles meant that the Orcs had no chance to wipe them out. Thus, descendants of the
Cuileux army still live in
Bretonnia. It is possible that a village has maintained a tradition of marrying only among the
descendants of those knights,
and since Bretonnian kings through the ages have paid tribute to the sacrifice of the noble
knights of Cuileux, that means that
those peasants are all, legally, nobles. A player character from the village might have an interest
in proving this to the courts of
Bretonnia.

The Head of the Wyrn

Residents of Bastonne start to dream that the head of Smearghus is talking to them,
encouraging them to do terrible things. Some
start to hear its voice even when they are awake, and a wave of dreadful crimes starts to sweep
the town. The player characters are
on the spot and called in to solve the problem. And then one of them starts to dream.

The Lake

The lake where Gilles and his companions met the Lady of the Lake would be the most sacred site in the whole of Bretonnia, if only people knew where it was. The legend is clear it is near the western end of the Forest of Châlons, and knights have scoured that area repeatedly over the last millennium and a half, without success. Most people believe the Lady hides the lake from those who are not worthy, and anyone allowed to find the lake would have a destiny on a par with that of Gilles himself. The few people who think that the failure to find the lake proves that the legend is just that either keep their thoughts to themselves or leave Bretonnia.

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The Perilous Dart

The bolt that struck Gilles down, and which he then used to kill the wyvern, is said to still exist. An item of great power, it drives events around its bearer to a crisis, where he can, by his own efforts, either gain a great victory or suffer a great loss. The bolt does not care about the goals of its holder, and those at a great disadvantage in a struggle for which they care deeply sometimes seek it out, trusting to the crisis to give them a victory otherwise unattainable.

The Blood Marshes

The mire formed by the blood of the Greenskins still exists in Couronne. In the recent past, it was quite small, but as the Storm of Chaos approached, it grew, year by year, swallowing a few small villages. Ghosts and similar Undead are common within its confines, but rumours speak of still darker things. All agree that there is no drinkable water to be found there. Now that the Storm of Chaos has been broken, some people are turning their thoughts to reversing the growth of the mire.

entered Quenelles, they saw that the borders of the Forest of the newest of their number. Whilst they watched, a fair Loren were aflame, assaulted by the Orcs. Some of the knights maiden appeared in the room and bathed Gilles's forehead were afraid to venture there, wary of the wrath of the Fay, but with liquid taken from a Grail she bore. She then bade the Gilles urged them on, declaring that the Fay would look kindly attendant lords drink from the cup, and thus they became on those coming to their aid. true Grail Knights. His words seemed true, as weariness fell from the knights When the lords returned their gaze to

Gilles, his eyes were
like a cloak, and in the heat of battle the very trees rose up to open, his breathing normal, and
with a great roar he pulled the
aid them, whilst the Fay themselves flitted in and out of the bolt from his own chest, sprang to
his feet, and led his army
shadows, appearing briefly to strike down a hundred, nay, a back onto the field of battle. As soon
as he passed the gates,
thousand Orcs before vanishing once more. he was assailed by three Wyverns, which he slew
before taking
Under the shadow of the trees, they met with the army of another step, one dying with the fell
bolt lodged in its eye.
Rademund the Pure, Lord of Quenelles, and as the last Orcs Taking heart from their leader, the
besieged struck out once
fled, the Lady of the Lake granted all the defenders peaceful more, but such was the number of
their foes that it still took
sleep. When they awoke, their wounds and fatigue were gone, a week to lift the siege and drive
the Goblins back into the
and both Rademund and Lambard shone like the other mountains.
Companions. The Lady, they said, had come to them in their
dreams, and none could gainsay them.

The Fifth Battle

Riding north to Parravon, the Companions found the
beautiful city in ruins, as Giants rained boulders on it from
above. Lord Agilgar of Parravon, mounted upon Glorfinial,
his faithful Pegasus, took to battle to the skies, whilst Goblins
of the Severed Hand laid waste to the city streets. The charge
of Gilles's army swept the Goblins before them, leaving the
city clean and clear.

The Sixth Battle

The Companions, now joined by Agilgar, rode north
to Montfort, where they found that fortress besieged.
Lord Martrud's army fought heroically, but they were
greatly outnumbered. With a war cry that shook the very
mountains, Gilles led his forces in a charge, but was struck
down by a cowardly bolt through the chest, launched by one
of the Goblins' dishonourable machines. His Companions
rallied about him and fought their way through to Montfort,
where they were welcomed by Martrud.
Gilles lay in a fever-dream, and the Companions feared
for his life, taking turns to watch over him. At length, the
privilege was granted to the Lords Agilgar and Martrud,

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The Ninth Battle

The army continued west into the lands of Mousillon. Once the fairest of all, they became wasted and burning as bands of Greenskins roamed at will. Landuin's heart was deeply grieved, for his land and people had been brought to ruin, and at the city of Mousillon the army was met by Folgar of Artois, who brought news of an approaching horde of Beastmen and the walking dead. The defence of Mousillon was divided between the Companions, and all fought with surpassing valour.

Gilles himself hewed the head from a drake-beast, whilst Agilgar, mounted on Glorfinial, took the battle to the bat-winged beasts that filled the sky. Thierulf wrestled with and defeated a two-headed Giant. The battle ended when Landuin himself struck down the sorcerer who had raised the dead, and half of the opposing army fell to the earth. The Beastmen fled towards the forest, pursued by the Companions. Beren and Folgar returned, shining, and telling of meeting a maiden with a Grail just inside the forest's borders.

The Seventh Battle The Tenth Battle

Gilles was not content that his enemy should flee, and The victorious lords turned north, riding through the forest gathering his army, he took the battle to the lightless passages of Arden, where no foul creatures dared to trouble the mighty beneath the earth. Those foul caverns were illuminated by host, to the Elf-built port of L'Anguille. The great city was the light that shone from the Grail Knights, and the armies besieged by Norses, attacking from both land and sea. Lord fought their way to the halls of the Goblin kings, slaying them Corduin of L'Anguille cut a path through the besiegers, joining and breaking the unity of the Goblin tribes for good. Turning forces with the Companions, but still the battle raged, as night about, they fought their way back to the surface, emerging followed day, with no sight of victory. covered in the black blood of their enemies. At length, Lord Marcus of Bordeleaux challenged the leader of the Northmen, Svengar of the Skaelings, to single combat, with The Eighth Battle the condition that the loser's forces would withdraw. Too proud to refuse, the giant warrior met Lord Marcus atop the great Now with ten of the Bretonni lords following his banner, Gilles lighthouse, and they fought in view of all Bretonnia. Throughout turned west to face the Greenskins despoiling Gisoreux. Joining the night, the elements seemed to aid Svengar's twin hammers, forces with Beren, the lord of that land, Gilles faced a horde but as dawn broke, Lord Marcus

found renewed strength and
containing many of the Orcs' finest shamans, who turned their drove the Northman back. With a
final blow, Marcus cut the
foul magic against the Bretonni. It was to no avail, as the power Giant in two, and his body fell to
the rocks below.
of the Lady protected her knights, and the Companions drove At the death of their leader, the
Norses returned to their ships
the enemy from the field with great slaughter. and sailed away.

The Battles The Eleventh Battle

The Great Battles form the material of the national epic of After but a single night's rest, the
Companions rode eastward
Bretonnia, and many knights try to visit each of the battlefields to Couronne, where Lord
Caerleond joined the army. Together
at least once during their period of errantry. Once a knight they fought an Orc horde at the River
Sannez, and defeated
sets out on the quest for the Lady of the Lake, it is not unusual them, the waters of the river
running black with blood.
for him to find that the events of his quest somehow mirror Turning from the light surrounding the
Grail Companions, the
the events of the Great Battles, his meeting with the Lady Greenskins were cut down in such
numbers that the earth was
occurring on the eve of his last and greatest struggle. turned to mire by their blood.

The Twelfth Battle

The Companions gathered at Couronne, where news came
to them of a host of Beastmen, Trolls, and nameless creatures
of Chaos pouring from the Forest of Arden. As they girded
to meet this threat, another messenger brought word of tribe

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upon tribe of Greenskins descending from the Pale Sisters. Finding Gilles
And as the army massed before the walls of Couronne, foul
rats that walked as men erupted from within the city, stalking A legend has circulated among
Grail Knights for centuries,
the streets and hemming the Bretonni in on all sides. saying that Gilles is gathering an army to
aid him when he
As the Lords took counsel before the fight, the Lady of returns. Only knights with a record of
glorious deeds can join
the Lake joined their number. She had Lords Corduin the army, but those who do are restored to
their full vigour
and Caerleond drink from the Grail, and at last, the Grail and then placed in a magical sleep until
they are needed. Grail

Companions reached their full number of fourteen. Then she Knights feeling the effects of old age often set out on a quest to blessed the army and bade them fight in her name. find their first King and join him, and many need protection, as Emboldened, the knights took the field, sure that none could their days of glory are in the past, and aged limbs can no longer ultimately stand against them. The battle raged for week upon wield a lance with vigour. week, as foul creatures continued to pour from their lairs like a storm tide and break upon the armies of the Bretonni as In 23 (1001), Louis returned to the court, riding a purebred against a cliff. charger and shining with light. None could deny he had drunk When at last the sounds of battle fell silent, the plains of from the Grail, and he was welcomed as King.

Couronne were covered with the bodies of the slain to the Louis drew up the Decrees of Chivalry, formalising the code height of a horse's shoulder. When the bodies of the enemy by which all the Companions had lived, and his own quest were burned, the smoke from the pyres darkened the day was the pattern for the Questing Knights of the future. Those whilst the flames brightened the night, so that for months no who succeeded became Grail Knights, who, as the Grail one could tell the difference between the two. Companions died one by one, became the elite of the country.

Thus were the Bretonni united and the enemy driven from the lands. In presence of the whole army, the Lady of the Errantry Wars Lake crowned Gilles as the first King of Bretonnia, and the acclamation shook the very mountains. Young Bretonnian knights spend a period as Knights Errant, seeking out dangers in which to prove themselves. Only those Louis the Rash who succeed can become Knights of the Realm. The King of Bretonnia can channel this custom by declaring an Errantry In the year 17 (995) Gilles le Breton was struck down by War, a grand campaign that qualifies all knightly participants a cowardly bolt hurled against him as he challenged the for the higher status.

Orc warlords of the Grey Mountains, near the edge of the Forest of Loren. As he died, he had a vision and told his Companions to bear him to the shores of a nearby lake. There, a boat decked out for a funeral awaited him, and his knights placed their King on the bier and watched as the boat, apparently without crew, carried him into the mists and out of the world. It is believed that his lasts words were a promise:

“In the time of Bretonnia's greatest need, when it seems that all hope is gone, I shall return to aid you.”

The death of Gilles left the country in need of a new king but without established rules for choosing one. Some favoured Louis, Gilles's only son, born under mysterious circumstances and whispered to be the son of the Lady herself. Others,

however, argued that Louis was young, and that the crown should pass to one of the Grail Companions: Landuin, Thierulf, and Marcus were all mooted as candidates. The Great Council agreed only one who had drunk from the Grail could become King of Bretonnia, which seemed to spell the end of Louis's hopes. Instead, he immediately rose up and declared he would seek the Grail and drink from it, to prove his right to be king. He asked the Lords Landuin, Thierulf, and Marcus to serve as regents until he returned, and when they agreed the Council was at an end. Louis's bold declaration earned him the name Louis the Rash, and tales of his exploits came from all parts of the kingdom.

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Chapter II: History of Bretonnia

The first such war was declared in 471 (1449), against the Death Pass, said to have been slain by the Black Orc warlord Arabyans who had invaded Estalia. The invaders were driven Morglum Necksnapper. The King then declared the Errantry back, and a second army, which heard of the victory en route, Wars at an end. turned aside to clear Greenskins from the lands that became the Border Princes. From the time of this war, relations The Fall of Mousillon between Bretonnia and the Dwarfs have been good, though not nearly as close as those between Dwarfs and the Empire. Landuin was the greatest and purest of the Companions, but his The Errantry War declared in 1223 (2201) had the aim of successors were not in the same mould, and Mousillon gained a driving all Orcs from Bretonnia. Whilst this goal was always reputation as a cursed land, plagued by the walking dead. impossible, such was the ardour of Bretonnia's knights that In 835 (1813) the Red Pox ravaged Bretonnia, and Skaven the borders of the Dukedoms grew to encompass many laid siege to Brionne and Quenelles. Duke Merovech of mountain ranges that had previously been the domain of the Mousillon and his knights were unaffected by the plague and Greenskins. rode forth to relieve the sieges and cast the Skaven back into In an attempt to emulate his predecessor, King Charlen the lairs. At the victory feast, hosted in Mousillon, the other declared an Errantry War in 1442 (2420) that aimed to rid lords were repulsed by the spitted and impaled criminals the entire world of Greenskins. So many knights left on the displayed within the hall itself, leading Merovech to claim war that Bretonnia itself was left vulnerable to Orc raids. his hospitality was being dishonoured. The King spoke out In 1510 (2488), a mighty host of knights vanished in the against the Duke's cruelty, and the Duke, in turn, accused

the King of trying to unseat him, challenging him to single The False Grail combat. The King accepted, and Merovech defeated him, tearing out The cup borne by Maldred's consort was not the Grail, his throat with his bare hands, and then drinking the King's but it was an artefact of considerable power. It was lost blood from a goblet. Horrified, the other lords raised their when Maldred, his consort, and much of the population of armies, and most of the lands of Mousillon were annexed by Mousillon died in the Red Pox of 1322 (2300). If it were Lyonesse. to fall into the hands of someone unscrupulous, such as the In 1319 (2297), Duke Maldred of Mousillon claimed to have Black Knight currently claiming to be the rightful Duke of taken the Lady of the Lake as his wife. He and his consort Mousillon, it would be very dangerous. appeared with a shining cup, which they said was the grail, and many knights who felt unfairly treated flocked to their banner. As the Duke rode to Gisoreux to claim the crown, he was met by the army of the King. Maldred held aloft the grail, asking who dared to stand against its bearer. Whilst the opposing army stood silent, the Green Knight emerged from the forest, and turned to challenge the Duke. At that moment, all saw the Lady of the Lake standing beside the King, the true Grail in her hand. The fake was revealed for the tawdry thing it was, and Maldred's followers deserted him en masse. The Duke fled back to his castle, but the King deprived him of both title and noble status. Since that time, there has been no Duke of Mousillon.

The Undead

Brettonnia has always been plagued by the Undead. Most recently, in 1513 (2491), the abbey of La Maisontaal was sacked by the Necromancer Heinrich Kemmler and his army, and the attackers were only repelled by the efforts of Tancred, Duke of Quenelles, and his knights. However, the walking dead are a constant threat. The most notable Undead menace was the Red Duke. In 476 (1454), this creature terrorised Aquitaine before being slain by the King at the Battle of Ceren Field. In 954 (1932), it rose from its grave, slaying the Duke of Aquitaine in battle. The knights were victorious, but the Red Duke was not slain, merely driven into the Forest of Châlons, where he may exist to this day.

Politics Chapter
& Foreign
Relations III

“We have political systems like this in the Empire. We call them ‘protection rackets’.”

- Matthias von Pfeildorf, former Imperial Envoy to Couronne.

Mention Bretonnian politics to most Old Worlders and However, that exclusion does not mean peasants actually stay they think of knights swearing oaths of fealty, feuds completely out of politics—not by a long shot. The invisible between noble families stretching back generations, and the politics of Bretonnia, the web of relations and responsibilities pomp and circumstance of the royal court. These are certainly between Lord and peasant, are as important, tumultuous, important features of the realm, and it is true that peasants are and vicious as the showy relations between members of the excluded from all formal power. nobility.

— The Feudal System —

Noble politics take place within the feudal system, an of fealty. A lesser noble makes a vow to a greater, promising archaic political system that was found across the Old military service in return for sustenance. World several centuries ago. Now, Bretonnia is the only land where it remains. The feudal system is based on oaths of Nobles fall into five main classes, which are roughly equivalent to loyalty between individuals and has no abstract conception ranks. Many nobles fall into more than one of the classes; Louen of the state. Whilst Bretonnians do think of themselves as a Leoncoeur, for example, is both King of Bretonnia and Duke of nation on a par with the Empire, there is no legal substance to Couronne, and his rank is determined by his higher title.

“Bretonnia” beyond “all people who ultimately owe loyalty to King the King of Bretonnia and the lands that they hold.”

At the top is the King. The King is sovereign, which means he is not bound by the law. He can make laws as he wishes, T K ' VPeasants form the foundation of the feudal system and are and anything he does is legal, required to serve and obey the nobility. They do not swear because he does it. If the oaths, as peasants are not King were corrupt, Bretonnia

thought to have the honour to would face serious problems.
keep them. Instead, they are However, Louen is a shining
told their duties and forced he night s ow example of chivalry, as were
most of his predecessors, and
to fulfil them, by violence if I pledge my service and my loyalty, body and soul, to
necessary. my Lord. When the clarion call is sounded, I will ride

Nobility out and fight in the name of liege and Lady. Whilst I so the King's power serves as a
draw breath, the lands bequeathed unto me will remain check on abuses by the lesser

The nobility are bound untainted by evil. Honour is all. Chivalry is all. This I nobility, even when
those
together by vows: the oaths swear on my blood and my breath. abuses abide by the letter of
the law.

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Dukes in which it is found. There are not many barons in Bretonnia.
(Note that nobles who hold land from Louen in his capacity as
Duke of Couronne are not Barons; only those who hold land
Below the King are the Dukes. A Bretonnian Duke has royal from him in his capacity of King of
Bretonnia have that status.)
power within his dukedom, but he is still subject to the King.
That means a Duke acting within his own dukedom cannot
break the law, unless he disobeys a direct order from the King Lords

himself. Unlike royal power, the power of the Dukes has been Below the Barons are the lords,
nobles who hold land from a
abused, most notably in Mousillon. There is no current Duke lord other than the King. They are
subject to royal law, the ducal
of Mousillon to avoid having someone hold such authority in law of the dukedom where they
hold land, and the laws of their
such a corrupt area. All Dukes hold their land directly from immediate lord. Even the vassals of
Barons are subject to ducal
the King. Louen also holds the Dukedom of Couronne from law; the baronial immunity is not
passed down. The lords form
the King, and thus holds it from himself. Legally, he is two the overwhelming majority of the
landed nobility of Bretonnia.
different people.

Knights

In theory, the King can create as many Dukes as he wants,
though the title is meaningless without land. In practice,
only the fourteen great fiefs descended from Gilles and his The bottom rank of the nobility are
the knights. Knights hold
Companions are held to be worthy of this status. no land and often serve nobles in return for
food and lodging.

It is important to note that all nobles are also knights; it is only those knights who hold Barons no other title who are at the

Barons are nobles who hold The Peasant's Duty bottom of the scale. land directly from the King but are not Dukes. They are Son of the soil, thou art born to labour and to serve, Titles of subject to royal law and royal protected by thy betters. Thou shalt give unto thy Honour command but not to the laws glorious liege the taxes that he requires. Thou shalt or commands of any other labour all but feast days, and no more than a tenth-share Titles of honour carry legal noble, including the Dukes. shalt thou keep for kith and kin. Rejoice! For a knight rights of less importance than Thus, a barony is legally of Bretonnia provides your shield. those attaching to the titles of independent of the dukedom power.

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A House Divided Against Itself

Two noble families who had feuded for decades arranged a marriage between the heirs of the two lines, hoping for peace. The marriage soon became famous for the tempestuous fights between the husband and wife, but it produced a son. The son is a truly noble knight, and when his parents die he will inherit both titles. Someone, possibly the heir himself, who may even be a player character, discovers the feud has its origins in a supernatural curse. The two lords cannot live at peace with one another, which is why the marriage was so violent. If one person becomes the lord of both fiefs, he will surely be driven insane. Can the player characters lift the curse in time?

Baronial Adventures

Barons who hold lands far from the King often become corrupt, as there is no one in the area with legal authority over them—just the sort of people for a brave group of adventurers to deal with. On the other side of the coin, truly famous adventurers of noble birth might be made Barons of some particularly dangerous area. This allows player characters to join the nobility without having to give up much of their freedom of action. They do have a superior who can give them orders, but the King has too much to do to interfere with them much, if at all.

Subinfeudation

One of the Dukes of Bretonnia holds a small fief from a minor noble, who in turn owes fealty to a

Baron. As the liege lord of a Duke, that noble has a number of privileges at court, and the new noble has started throwing his weight around. The Duke (or one of his courtiers, if the Duke is above any corruption) tries to frame the noble for consorting with the Ruinous Powers, so he can legally deprive the lord of the fief, which would then revert to the Baron. The player characters come upon the evidence but realise that it is faked. Clever player characters discover that the Baron is in service to Slaanesh and has been subtly pushing his vassal to cause trouble for the Duke.

Earl Families and Inheritance

Earls are rich and powerful nobles. This title grants no extra Family is very important to the nobility. First, unless all your powers, but it is a sign of recognition by the King. Many earls ancestors are noble, you are not a noble. This means the are also Barons, but not all. nobility are careful about whom they marry. Second, fiefs are inherited. Most lords cannot simply deprive one of his vassals Marquis of his fief or refuse to accept a deceased vassal's son. The Dukes and King can do this, but very rarely do; it is one of the few A marquis is a noble responsible for a fief in an area subject things capable of uniting all a Duke's vassals against him. to attack, often on the borders of the kingdom. A marquis A dead noble's property all goes to his eldest son. The noble is allowed to gather forces and build fortifications without cannot leave it to anyone else, and he cannot give away fiefs seeking permission from his superiors. before he dies. As a result, the other children of the nobility must struggle to find their place in the world. Daughters try to marry Castellan heirs, whilst younger sons might try to carve out their own fiefs by strength of arms or even marry rich peasants, trading the A castellan is a noble with responsibility for a major castle, nobility of their children for the comfort of riches. The younger which is usually held by his feudal superior. He has full children of the nobility thus make good player characters. authority over the castle and its lands unless his lord is present. Noble women cannot become knights (unless they pretend to be men; see Chapter I). The eldest daughter of a noble with Justiciar no sons does, however, inherit his fiefs. She is the lord of those fiefs, but she cannot enforce the lord's rights herself. Instead, Justiciars are experts in the law. He has the power to enforce her husband must do this on her behalf. When the lady dies, the laws of the noble who made him a justiciar; the King's her titles pass to her eldest son, as do her husband's on his justiciars travel the realm enforcing royal law. death. If the husband dies first, which is not uncommon, the eldest son takes on the husband's role as defender of his

Paladin mother's rights, but he does not actually become the lord until his mother dies.

Paladins are renowned warriors and war-leaders. This title is a pure matter of honour, though many paladins are given dangerous lands and made marquises to put their talents to good use.

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Heiresses are by far the most popular noble brides, as they with ignoring the court, as they are secure in their fiefs, but substantially strengthen a family. They are also rare and many still find it useful to be aware of their lord's plans and sometimes have their own ideas about whom they would like personality. Second, there are the household knights of the to marry. Marriages to noble daughters with no inheritance are lord. The knights have a definite function, and if they are good equally political, expressing alliances between two families. In at it, they are unlikely to be dismissed on the basis of rumour. those cases, the eldest daughter is most valuable: If her brothers On the other hand, their positions are not secure, and many of die before her father, and her father dies before she does, she them spend a lot of time manoeuvring to be granted a fief. becomes the heir. Nobles who are relying on such an event may Finally, there are the younger siblings of nobles associated with try to help it along. the court, generally its leader and his vassals. These courtiers Marriages normally take place between equals. However, nobles have no position beyond the simple favour of the lord, and it may also grant a part of their fiefs to other nobles, in return for is here that the politics get most vicious, extending as far as those knights' services. This is subinfeudation, and it is central assassination. The courts of a corrupt lord are as dangerous as to the system; in theory, the King subinfeudates the whole an Orc-hold, and even a paragon of virtue can find his court country. A noble may also increase his power by petitioning twisted by evil, but subtle, advisers. Adventurers can easily find a lord to grant him a fief. As a lord cannot simply claim a fief themselves caught up in the schemes of such people. back once he has granted it, such grants are rare. There is no law that says that a noble may only have one The Royal Court lord. Some have several. The extreme is Baron Marsaq, who holds land from the King, the Dukes of Aquitaine, Bastonne, The court of King Louen Leoncoeur sits in Couronne in the Bordeleaux, and Quenelles, and three other lesser nobles. winter months. In the summer, the nobles disperse to their fiefs He is a greater noble than the final three, despite being their or to wage war. By long custom, the

King speaks only to nobles
vassal for some lands. Such situations are difficult if conflicts and rarely to nobles of less than
baronial rank. All of the King's
arise between a noble's lords, and the Barons Marsaq have a personal servants are Barons,
powerful due to their constant
reputation as diplomats that has been built up over several access to the King. The only time the
King speaks to a peasant
generations. is when raising one to the ranks of the nobility.
King Louen is devoted to his country, and has declared he is
Courts willing to hear of abuses and injustices committed by any of
his subjects, no matter how powerful. Peasants who can find
A court centres around a noble lord. The aim of the courtiers a noble, no matter how lowly, to
plead their case can appeal
is to convince the lord to favour them with wealth, power, directly to the King. Still, the King has
limited time, and
or lands. A few courtiers have entirely altruistic aims, but there are more abuses than he could
hear, much less rectify.
those are rare exceptions. Most of the truly noble knights of Convincing the courtiers that a
particular petition should be
Bretonnia stay out of court as much as they can, relying on heard would be a worthy adventure.
Happily, if the King hears
their fiefs to support their acts of chivalry. a case, he always judges justly. Some say the Lady of
the Lake
All members of a court are of lower rank than the central inspires him directly with wisdom.
noble, which means courts are larger the more powerful the
noble is himself. Anyone petitioning the lord for a favour Army
becomes part of the court, so at lower levels the court
includes peasants. However, peasants never become courtiers, Bretonnia does not have an
army. That is, there are no soldiers
individuals who spend their lives in the court, fighting for the serving a career as paid warriors in
the service of the state.
lord's favour. Instead, it relies on the feudal service of its knights.
Courtiers fall into three main classes. First, there are the landed When a lord must take the field
against an enemy, he summons
vassals of the lord in question. These nobles can often get away his vassals to provide their
military service. They, in turn,
summon their vassals, and most lords bring peasant men-

Farabus, Footman of the Stool

The Footman of the Stool is responsible for attending the King whilst he answers the call of
nature and emptying the chamber pot
afterwards. As a result, this position is always held by a Baron the King trusts implicitly, and as it
guarantees access to the King
several times per day the Footman of the Stool is a powerful courtier.
Farabus was a brave Grail Knight, until his left leg was crushed by a Daemon that died under his
sword. The King granted him his
current position as compensation, and Farabus serves loyally. The Baron fully appreciates the

importance of his job, but recently the jokes that always circulate around the court have begun to grate on him. He does not want to leave his job, but he does want to teach the jokers a lesson.

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at-arms and bowmen to the fight. These armies do not train together and normally do not even have a central chain of command, but Bretonnian military tactics are sufficiently simple and uniform that they can work together well enough nevertheless.

The feudal levy's main weakness comes in long campaigns. Lords and knights must return to their fiefs to serve as rulers or to defend their own homes, and most lords can only hold the levy together for 40 days. Of course, things are different if it's the lord's own lands under attack in the first place.

When an important place, such as a mountain pass or the route to a Goblin stronghold, needs defending, the King or a Duke grants a fief in that place to a powerful warrior and makes him a Marquis. The lord is then responsible for constructing fortifications, raising troops, and dealing with the menace. This works well for the first generation, but the first Marquis's heir is not always up to the job. Some even resort to calling on base-born adventurers for help.

Finally, the King, and only the King, can declare an Errantry War, which summons most knights to fight and prove their virtue. Errantry Wars are dealt with at more length in Chapter Eight: Knighthood.

Civil Strife Merchants and Trade

Bretonnia is not an entirely peaceful land, quite apart from the Merchants occupy an anomalous place in Bretonnian society.

assaults launched by the Orcs of the mountains and the beasts Almost all of them are peasants, as very few nobles deign to

of the forests. Battles between nobles also disturb the land. sully their hands with trade.

Successful merchants are often far

Nobles who wish to do so may settle certain kinds of dispute wealthier than the nobles they serve, however. Trade is vital to

by force of arms rather than in court of law. They may not Bretonnia, both moving goods around within the country and

resort to war against their feudal superiors or against anyone drawing in foreign goods, primarily in return for Bretonnian

with legal authority over them, but such opponents are wine. So, concerted action by the merchant classes could cause

generally too strong to fight anyway. serious problems for the nobility.

There are three recognised justifications for war. The first is As peasants, merchants are bound by the same laws as other

the recovery of lands stolen by the other noble. The second is peasants. In theory, they would be forced to hand most of their

the destruction of a notorious traitor; whilst the traitor's lord income over to their lords. In practice, the way that Bretonnian

is expected to take action, any noble is allowed to do so. The law defines income was defined with agriculture in mind, and

final justification is an injury done to the honour of the noble's whilst it catches much of what craftsmen produce, almost all of

family. a merchant's profits are invisible because a merchant does not

Serving Chaos or allying with Greenskins is regarded as actually make anything. Bretonnian conservatism and subtle,

treason, and such accusations have served as an excuse for but intense, mercantile lobbying has kept things this way.

many assaults. Theft of land has no time limit attached, and Some of the cleverer nobles have worked out that they actually

if an attack is successful, the victim can always claim that the get more in bribes than they would from the taxes, as the taxes

land taken was stolen, and counterattack after gathering allies. imposed on most peasants would destroy almost any trading

The final justification, injury to the family's honour, allows a venture.

noble to declare war over being seated in the wrong place at All merchants recognise the need to keep the nobility sweet,

a feast, and this has actually happened. Sometimes such wars leading to a constant stream of gifts. These gifts are presented

degenerate into feuds lasting generations, with the acts of each as humble acknowledgements of the noble's great superiority

side providing the other with all the excuses it needs for war. and are always lavish, high-quality items, such as gold plates

The best of Bretonnian nobles only use this right to move or fur-lined, embroidered robes. If the noble is poor and more

against lords who are clearly traitors, and gathering the in need of bread, meat, and firewood, the merchant arranges

evidence to convince them is often a job for adventurers. Less to buy the gift back for cash. This purchase, of course, takes

scrupulous lords can also create work for adventurers when place without any fanfare. A merchant living in the Dukedom

an innocent noble needs help defending himself from an overbearing neighbour.

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of Quenelles is reputed to have given the lord of his village the their favour. Thus, there are many clubs of merchants, most

same golden chalice every festival for the last ten years, buying functioning as guilds in all but name.

it back the following day and sustaining the lord despite the A typical club requires its members to trade with each other

general poverty of the village in question. In return, the lord on favourable terms and with outsiders on terms that make it

allows the merchant to operate as he wishes. all but impossible for them to turn a profit. Many try to get

Most merchants rely entirely on gifts, but all but the poorest a monopoly on trade within a town, city, or dukedom; others

have to hire guards to protect their shipments and warehouses. try to corner the market in a particular kind of goods. It's

The guards of the richest merchants form private armies, which cutthroat trade practice in its purest form.

can be turned against nobles who threaten them with violence. Because the guilds have no legal standing, they cannot use the

Of course, the merchants have to ensure other nobles stay out law to make other merchants obey their rules. As a result, they

of the fight, as they could not win a battle against the whole of use violence and intimidation.

The nobility care very little, on

Brettonnia. Such conflicts are rare, but the combination of gifts the whole, about violence directed at peasants, as long as it

and guns means that the wealthiest merchants are effectively does not get completely out of hand.

above the law, so long as they do not threaten to upset the The distinction between these clubs and organised crime

social order. is often subtle, but it is there. The merchants are primarily

Most merchants respect those limits, knowing social anarchy concerned with legal trade and use thuggery to dissuade

would be bad for trade. Some do seek to better their position competitors, whilst criminals use thuggery to get money out

within society through closer alliances with the nobility. The of just about anyone. Still, groups can cross the line in both

younger children of poorer nobles are sometimes willing to directions.

marry into a wealthy merchant family, trading social position In addition, there is no law to say which club has jurisdiction

for wealth. The merchant family is then expected to support in a particular area. This leads to battles for control, fought

their noble relatives financially, whilst the nobles provide legal through intimidation, bribery of judges, sabotage, arson,

and political support for the merchants. and murder. The town of Dalron in Lyonesse was a thriving

port until the trade war between the Golden Feathers and

Merchant Clubs the Three Tuns reduced all important businesses to ash. Now,

the population has turned to crime for a living, under the

There are no formal merchant guilds in Brettonnia. The law leadership of the Three Feathers syndicate.

does not recognise such gatherings of peasants as having any Important merchant clubs

include the following.

legal weight at all. The law does not, however, stop merchants getting together and attempting to organise trade to work in

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Brethren of the Lighthouse Marrying Trade

One of the oldest clubs in the country, with over three A baronial family and a merchant family have been

centuries of verifiable history, this group has a monopoly intermarrying for several generations, the baronial line drawing

on trade within the city of L'Anguille. Bretonnia's wealthiest its noble consorts from among the Baron's vassals. The two

merchant family, the Fitzgodrics, are members of this club, inbred families now have absolute control of the barony, at all

as are three of the next five wealthiest. The Brethren watched levels, and terrible rumours have started to circulate.

events in Marienburg with great interest and are looking for an A very wealthy merchant family has married into many noble

opportunity to make a similar move. families over the last five generations. Indeed, the current head

of the family only has five ancestors who are not noble, as each

The Rooster and Kettle merchant in the male line married a noblewoman. Now he

would like posthumous declarations of nobility for all of them,

Originally a gathering of petty peddlers, this group organised making him and all his descendants noble, and creating a noble

trading rights for its members in most cities of the kingdom, merchant. Many nobles are opposed to such a change, but the

in return for minor payments. Recently, the group has taken to merchant is prepared to use all his resources to achieve this.

importing firearms, primarily from the Empire but with some The player characters get to know the wife of a minor noble.

items of Dwarf-make. Its wealth and influence is growing, even She is the daughter of a wealthy merchant house and badly

though the nobility refuse to use firearms, branding them "un- treated by her husband, who is an arrogant snob. Whilst the

chivalrous." Members of the group are thus finding themselves noble had five elder brothers when he married, four of them

with a near-monopoly on the use of firearms and have recently have now died in battle, making him a possible heir. He cannot

started trying to enforce that. Some nobles have noticed and inherit whilst married to a peasant, as his children would not

are becoming worried. be noble, and he can only remarry if his wife dies. She begins to fear for her life.

Inequitable Life

walking in a ring in front of the noble, so that no one is at
Active in the western Duchies, particularly near the coast, this the front, or finding a naive
outsider, such as a good-hearted
group traffics in illicit substances and slaves. Dark rumours adventurer, to serve as a lightning
rod. The techniques are
circulate about the nature of its leadership, but those spreading never completely effective, as a
lord determined to hang
such rumours tend to turn up dead. Those traders who work someone to restore order can just
choose at random.
for it have front identities as pharmacists or as hiring agencies As a result, peasants try to avoid
involving the nobility in
for temporary labour and do both jobs extremely well. That is disputes as much as possible. This
might seem difficult, but
fortunate, as their monopoly is brutally enforced. problems for peasants are only rarely caused
by the lord
personally coming to the village and beating people up. Most
Blue Bloods often, the problems result from conflicts with other villages,
abuses by bailiffs, or excessive taxes being demanded on a poor
In order to join this group, you must have at least one noble harvest.
ancestor in the last two generations, and status is determined Conflicts between villages arise
over many matters, but
by a combination of wealth and how much noble blood you rights to use common resources,
such as grazing land, rivers,
have. The Blue Bloods allow dual membership with other or forests are by far the most common.
Each village in the
clubs, as the group's aim is simply to get merchants into the dispute chooses an ambassador
who meets the ambassadors
nobility. Many merchants believe that this is futile and thus from the other side at a neutral
location, often a deserted area
stay away, even if they have the necessary ancestry. half way between the villages, to work out a
compromise. The
ambassadors then have to convince their village to agree.
Peasant Politics When the sides cannot agree, it is traditional to resolve matters
with a formal combat. The two villages agree on what victory
If merchants are officially excluded from politics, run-of-the- will mean for each side and then
agree on a place and time for
mill peasants are even more so. They cannot afford to offer the combat. The number of
combatants, weapons allowed, and
expensive gifts to the nobility, nor do they have private armies. the conditions for victory are also
decided at this point. Fights
In most cases, a peasant's primary concern is growing enough to the death are rare, as the
deaths might have to be explained
food to feed his family. to the lord. Most villages respect the results of such combats
This does not mean peasants have no involvement with politics because the alternative is
getting the nobility involved.
at all. Peasants oppressed by their lord or his bailiff are not Corrupt bailiffs are more of a
problem because only the lord
uncommon in Bretonnia, and they sometimes try to appeal can remove them. Villagers may

negotiate directly with the
for help in their plight. An individual peasant would never
be heard by a nobleman, so these appeals are conducted as a
group, ideally representing the whole village. Some lords treat
these groups as attempted rebellion and hang the ringleaders.
The peasants thus try to organise themselves to avoid picking
anyone out as a ringleader. This might involve reciting their
grievance in perfect unison (after hours of practice), slowly

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bailiff if that seems likely to succeed, but that is unusual.
Normally, they try to make the bailiff seem corrupt. This
involves hiding goods from him when he does the tax
assessment and then planting the “excess tax” in the bailiff’s
house. Particularly bold peasants may appear before their lord
to thank him for the protection leading to the large harvest,
which will make him wonder why the taxes are so low.

Of course, most bailiffs are aware of this strategy, so the
manoeuvring between the bailiff and villagers can get very
elaborate. Many bailiffs choose to reach an accommodation
with the villagers, defrauding the lord and splitting the profits
whilst presenting a united front. This can get very messy if the
lord finds out.

Excessive taxes present the most problems. Even if the bailiff is
on the side of the villagers, they simply cannot hand over that
much without starving. If an appeal to the good nature of the
lord is out of the question, the villagers resort to having the
taxes “stolen by outlaws” as they make their way to the lord.
Most lords pursue the outlaws, rather than demanding that the
village make up the difference.

One result of these practices, and of the existence of village
courts (see Chapter IV), is that many lords believe there are no
problems among their peasants, and that they truly live idyllic
lives, without the sorts of troubles that afflict the nobility.
Thus, even those nobles who are inclined to help the peasants
rarely feel that there is any need.

Peasant Uprisings

From time to time, the peasants rise in revolt. These uprisings
almost always surprise the nobility because the peasants have
hidden the problems until they became unbearable. Thus,
most nobles believe the revolts are inspired by greed or base
ingratitude, and even the virtuous ones have no hesitation in
using force to put them down. No peasant uprising has ever

succeeded because all the nobles help to put it down. They cannot countenance such a threat to their authority. By far the most common cause of an uprising is insupportable taxes. If the taxes demanded by a lord condemn the peasants to starvation, they have nothing to lose by rising in revolt. Indeed, given the Bretonnian attitude, dying in battle is better than dying of starvation, so even if they lose, their condition improves. These uprisings are brutally suppressed; many of the surviving peasants are executed. As a result, the food stores are often sufficient to support the survivors. The next most common cause is manipulation by other nobles. Peasant revolts never succeed, but they do distract a noble and draw his forces away, making an attack by another noble more likely to succeed. Some nobles simply promise better conditions once they have taken over; a small number even keep that promise. Others rely on manipulating their enemy into demanding excessive taxes or sabotage the harvest to make normal taxes unbearable, so that the peasants rise on their own account. Foreign agitators and revolutionary sentiment are often blamed for uprisings, but in truth, they are hardly ever responsible. Foreign powers that wish to weaken Bretonnia have more

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Chapter III: Politics & Foreign Relations

effective means available than stirring up the peasantry, and hordes. The returning knights have enthusiastically joined in political agitators are just rare. stamping these out, and the few pockets of corruption that By far the most dangerous uprisings are those inspired by remain are small and isolated. the Ruinous Powers. Peasants with mutations—or worse, In normal times, the Ruinous Powers often find the subjects supported by Beastmen—can pose a serious threat even to the of brutal nobles to be the most receptive to the lures of Chaos. knights of Bretonnia. Such uprisings were briefly common This can cause problems for adventurers who have taken up the during the Storm of Chaos, whilst much of the flower of cause of oppressed peasants, only to learn that they are allied Bretonnian chivalry was in the Empire fighting Archaon's with the forces of Chaos.

— Bretonnians Abroad —

Bretonnia has borders with most nations of the Old World, Bretonnia's border with the Estalian kingdom of Bilbali is a meaning it must find some way to live with them. mere river. The consequence is that there is almost as much traffic with Estalia as with the Empire, despite the Empire's far Border Princes greater size. Relations with Bilbali are good, and Bretonnian nobles recognise Bilbalian nobles as peers. As a result, relations

My father's father's father was a Knight Errant of with Magritta are generally bad, and most Bretonnians regard Bretonnia. Our family upholds the honour of true the southern kingdom as composed entirely of peasants. nobility, unlike some here. Bretonnian knights and Estalian duellists have very little understanding of one another's fighting styles, and this —Lord Bastond of Rushwater, Border Prince incomprehension is responsible for much of the tension Many of the Border Princes are descended from Bretonnian between the nations. knights who fought in King Charlen's Errantry War against the Greenskins, a war that lasted 68 years and ended only 34 years Tilea ago. These knights did not leave in disgrace, and some still owe fealty to nobles back in Bretonnia, though given the barrier of Puffed up snobs relying purely on the achievements of The Vaults, this is almost purely notional. their fathers! What have they done? Nothing! And they The Bretonnian Border Princes tend to see themselves as call me a peasant! Bretonnian and as maintaining honour, as opposed to the opportunists who make up the other petty princedoms. This —Ricardo of Trantio, merchant has made Bretonnians in general unpopular with all the other The Tileans have remarkably few dealings with Bretonnia. inhabitants of the region. Bretonnians never hire mercenaries (officially), and merchants have such low status in the country that Tileans prefer to The Empire trade with the Bretonnians who come to them. As a result, stereotypes and prejudice are rife. To the Tileans, Bretonnians They eat live frogs, make beer that tastes as if it's been are either stupid nobles who need to be told which end of their drunk once already, and ponce about on horses rather horse to face, or they're peasants so blighted as to be barely than using guns. Still, the wine is good. Human. To the Bretonnians, Tileans are all either thieves posing as merchants or murderers selling their services to the —Thomas of Helmgart, mercenary highest bidder whilst claiming to be warriors. Bretonnia's relations with the Empire are the most important and currently better than they have been for decades. King The Wasteland Louen Leoncoeur declared an Errantry War to assist the Empire against the hordes of Archaon, and the Emperor is still Why swap an Emperor for a King? grateful. —Marienburger saying However, the two nations have very different personalities, and the Empire's greater age leads it to look down on Bretonnia. In The Bretonnians would like to incorporate The Wasteland into return, the Bretonnians can see little nobility in the Empire, their kingdom, as long as they can do so without offending the even among those who claim to be noble. Empire. The boundary between the Marches of Couronne and the Wasteland is ill defined, and Adalbert, Marquis of Couronne, Estalia would dearly like to add Marienburg to his realm and petition for the status of a Dukedom. Dukes Folcard of Montfort and Look down on their lack of technique if you must, but Hagen of Gisoreux also cast acquisitive eyes northwards, though

a lance of Bretonnian knights is still a formidable force the Grey Mountains make any conquest harder for them.

on the field of battle. Their matters of honour do get The Marienburgers are aware of these ambitions and normally

out of hand, though. play the Empire and Bretonnia against one another. The

weakened state of the Empire has led them to strengthen their

—Diego Cortez y Maranda, Diestro own forces, mainly by hiring Tilean mercenaries.

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Chapter IV: Law and Justice

Law and Chapter

Justice

IV

“There’s one law for the nobles,
another for the rich, and another
for the poor. We don’t bother
learning the last because the poor
cannot pay us.”

- Louis Chamignon (nee Louise),

L’Anguille lawyer

Bretonnia is a land with many laws. The laws of chivalry alien to the Bretonnian mind as the notion that they should

bind the nobility whilst the laws of earth bind the peasants. be equal in any other way. Laws, courts, and punishments all

The notion that all people should be equal before the law is as reflect these differences.

— Laws of Chivalry —

The nobles of Bretonnia are, for the most part, subject to convening lord sits as a judge, and seven other nobles of rank

the laws of chivalry—also known as “royal laws” because at least equal to the accused sit as a jury.

they are declared by the authority of the King. Peasants are not The accused must appear before the court in person or

subject to these laws, and there are some activities forbidden to provide a good excuse. The judge decides whether to admit

nobles that are permitted to peasants. an excuse; if he does, he dissolves the court and sets a date for

In most cases, an action is only an offence under the laws of it to reconvene. If he does not, the case proceeds without the

chivalry if the victim is a noble or foreigner. Peasants area accused. The accused makes arguments in his defence, and the

different matter. A noble has a legal duty to protect, guide, and accusers make their case. The judge then sleeps on the case,

judge the peasants under his rule, but quite a lot is permitted and the court gathers the next

morning to hear the verdict. The
 under the guise of “instilling proper respect for the nobility,” judge decides on guilt or innocence
 and then passes sentencing
 and very few nobles bother to investigate reports of abuses. A to the jury. A jury that disagrees
 with a guilty verdict may
 noble who acts against another lord’s peasants is committing a impose a light sentence, but it
 has no authority to overturn an
 crime against that noble but not against the peasants who are acquittal.
 the actual victims. Most sentences are symbolic; nobles are never subjected to
 The royal laws forbid all standard crimes, such as theft, assault, imprisonment or corporal
 punishment. Fines are possible, but
 and murder. Violence within the context of a legitimate very rare, and mostly take the form of
 compensation. A noble
 grievance is permitted, however. The laws also forbid actions who killed five of another noble’s
 servants in a drunken rage
 unbecoming to a noble, such as engaging in a trade. might be required to pay the costs of
 training replacements,
 The courts of chivalry are elaborate events, closely defined by for example. Common sentences
 include public apologies,
 law. A court must be convened by the liege lord of the accused specific services to the victim,
 particular limits on behaviour,
 or by someone higher in the direct chain of fealty. The King, or imposed quests of valour. In
 extreme cases, a court may
 therefore, can convene a court to try any noble. The court must petition the King to strip the
 noble in question of his fiefs, or
 be publicly proclaimed three times on separate days, no more even of his nobility. Louen
 Leoncoeur insists on hearing such
 than two weeks before and no later than the day before. The cases again in person, though
 earlier kings often imposed the
 punishment on the say-so of the lower courts.

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Chapter IV: Law and Justice

It is clear that the system relies almost entirely on the integrity
 of the judge. A noble with a corrupt, or corruptible, lord can get
 away with almost any atrocity. Similarly, corrupt lords can use
 the courts to hound vassals who do not show proper respect. The
 jury does place some limits on this; lords who abuse the courts
 in this way find that the jury imposes penalties such as ‘say sorry
 right now’.

On the other hand, juries can impose fantastically dangerous
 quests of valour with conditions attached that make it all but
 certain that the accused will die in the process. At a lesser
 level, quests to distant lands that will take years to fulfil are
 effectively sentences of exile.

A noble who refuses to honour the judgement of the court

becomes an outlaw. He remains a noble, but he is not protected by the law, even against his own peasants. It is no crime to kill him. As he remains a noble, his children and descendants remain nobles; there are few noble families without an outlaw somewhere in their family tree.

Noble women are also subject to the courts of chivalry and may be assigned the same penalties as men. A quest of valour assigned to a woman is a death sentence; a few noble women have become outlaws as a result. Noble women caught pretending to be men are generally assigned a quest of valour. As these women have weapons and training, they occasionally succeed but face repeated court cases until they start behaving like proper women.

Sample Noble Sentences

“Appear before the Baron of Fellone wearing nothing but sackcloth, and apologise three times whilst lying face-down on the ground.”

“Ride in a carriage when travelling for the next three months.” (Riding in a carriage of some sort is a common penalty, so Bretonnian nobles never do so voluntarily.)

“Travel to the Vaults, and kill the Orc warlord Baldagran, wearing no armour and carrying no weapon but a fruit knife.” (An effective death sentence.)

— Peasant Law —

Peasant law falls into two categories. First there are formal

laws enacted by the nobility. These require peasants to obey the nobility, hand over large amounts of taxes, and refrain from behaviour that might damage the interests of the nobility. Theft from other peasants is not necessarily illegal nor is a certain amount of brawling.

Formal courts for peasants are very simple. The peasant is brought before his lord, who hears the circumstances of the case. He may allow the peasant to speak in his defence, or he may not. He then pronounces judgement and sentence. Sentences are normally corporal punishment of some sort: exposure in the stocks, flogging, torture, mutilation (the loss of a body part, such as an ear, eye, hand, or leg), or death. Imprisonment costs the lord money and thus is avoided, whilst most peasants have no money to pay fines. Lords may impose any penalty they choose for any crime. A lord might

decide on a light flogging for murdering another peasant whilst can be replaced. Most have trained judges, normally working imposing torture and death by starvation in a gibbet for being in panels of three or five for serious cases. Juries are rare, as that insufficiently polite to a noble. would make the courts look too much like a noble court. Obviously, formal justice for peasants is entirely dependent on People appearing before these courts generally hire lawyers to the good will of the lord. In those fiefs where the lord is both help them. The merchant courts are very attentive to the letter of wise and well intentioned, the system works well. In others, it the rules, so a skilled lawyer is a great help. In some towns, it is is a mere instrument of oppression. possible to hire the judges to serve as your lawyers, which is very

Because of these inadequacies, most peasants try to deal with expensive but almost always effective. This is not regarded as a crimes without involving their lords. The wealthy merchants, corrupt practice, because the judge must still find a way to justify in particular, want to keep the nobility out of their dealings your behaviour under the law. Many lawyers are very inventive in as far as possible. The merchants have convinced many nobles this respect and become more inventive the more they are paid. that any lord looking into mercantile dealings in any detail is clearly planning to become a merchant himself and thus in Sample Merchant Sentences breach of the laws of chivalry. That propaganda, backed up by gifts that make the nobles happy with the current situation, has “Pay a fine of 100 gc, compensating the club for lost kept most nobles out of mercantile law. revenues due to your trading practices.”

The clubs of merchants (see Chapter III) make their own rules, “Hand over your business to your accuser as compensation often setting minimum standards for goods, the treatment of for running him out of business through unfair means.” apprentices, and basic trade practice. They also have very strict “Close your shop every day one hour before sunset.” (The laws against theft. Merchants who break these rules are fined or competition gains an advantage, but not a decisive one.) thrown out of the club. Other townsfolk are hunted down and “Wear a large, fake green nose at all times.” (This makes the then beaten up or killed in a “spontaneous brawl” of the sort merchant look ridiculous and will hinder his business.) that the nobility generally ignore. In a town, the nobility do “Cease trading in this town, or you will suffer a serious not normally worry about the deaths of a few townsfolk as it is accident.” to be expected. In villages, things are more restrained. The lord is more likely Merchant courts vary in their practices. Most provide a to notice attempts to enforce laws without telling him, so reasonable semblance of justice to discourage people from things are kept quieter. In most cases, a small number of village bringing things to the attention of the nobility. A few rely on elders, rarely more than three, have

responsibility for all cases.

the wisdom and justice of a particular merchant, which works They hear the two sides and then assign a penalty. The penalty

better than doing the same with a noble because the merchant generally provides some sort of compensation for the victim, as

that is easier to hide from the lord than hurting the criminal.

In serious cases, however, “accidents” are arranged to impose mutilation or the death penalty. Peasants who slip whilst carrying a scythe and accidentally stab themselves twelve times in the stomach have contributed to the nobility’s belief that peasants are supernaturally clumsy and incompetent.

Sample Peasant Sentences

“Give your pig’s next three litters to the person whose pig you stole.”

“Never enter the house of Galbad again, on pain of having your feet cut off.” (Sentences of this sort are often used on adulterers.)

“Give your next child to the family of Martan to be raised to replace the child who died.” (In a case of accidental death.)

“Explain to the lord why he must reduce the taxes on the village.” (Usually a death sentence, but if the peasant can succeed he will have almost any crime forgiven.)

Peasants can flee justice, becoming outlaws. Indeed, if your lord is after you, this is often the best choice. Nevertheless, few outlaws last more than a week or so in the wilderness. Some even return to have their hands cut off by the village court, rather than die in the forests.

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Chapter IV: Law and Justice

— Sumptuary Laws —

Brettonia’s sumptuary laws forbid the peasants from wearing peasant woman’s dress must run from her neck to her ankles

certain things or using certain items. They are central and may not be gathered at the waist. Only nobles may wear

to maintaining the difference between nobles and peasants, slashed cloaks, as they are associated with knighthood (thus

and few nobles would wear something that was permitted peasants have to be very careful about repairing their cloaks).

to peasants if they had the choice. In addition, women are Many nobles choose to emphasise their status by wearing

forbidden to wear men’s clothing. Men could wear dresses, but clothes that would be highly

illegal for peasants. Possibly the they do not. most absurd manifestation of this are the popular shoes, with Peasants are not permitted to wear armour at all, unless serving extended toes reaching several feet from the heel. These are nobles in a feudal host. Heavy plate armour is forbidden often curved back and tied to the wearer's leg around the knee to peasants under all circumstances, as are the weapons of to keep them out of the way. Apart from this, embroidered chivalry: the lance and the sword. Gunpowder weapons are not breeches are very common, as are short tunics with enormous covered by the sumptuary laws, as they are a recent invention. sleeves. All noble clothing includes some red, white, or blue, As mentioned in Chapter I, stone, as a building material, is and much is trimmed with fox, ermine, or squirrel fur. limited to the nobility. In addition, only the nobility may use Noble women often wear low-cut dresses pulled very tight at eating utensils made of silver. Wealthy merchants thus use the waist. Short skirts are unheard of, as anything worn under gold and glass, which are even more expensive but legal. Very a skirt would count as breeches and, thus, men's clothing. few nobles eat off gold because it has become associated with Very long skirts which trail on the ground behind the lady are mercantile activities. popular.

The traditional Bretonnian floor was packed earth, covered Lords may issue peasants under their authority with specific by rushes and reeds of various kinds. A few centuries ago, exemptions from the sumptuary laws. This may be as minor as the sumptuary laws fixed that the best reeds and herbs for allowing a woman to have a red ribbon at the neck of her dress this could only be used by the nobility. Since then, wealthier or as major as exempting a merchant from all restrictions on peasants have discovered floorboards and carpets, which are not tunics. By long-standing custom, however, the laws are most covered, but most nobles still scatter the prescribed reeds and honoured in the breeches, and no exemptions to those rules are herbs. In many cases, this is now purely symbolic, a handful of ever granted. leaves being scattered on top of a carpet. Wealthy peasants without exemptions often run as close to The main target of the sumptuary laws is clothing. White, the rules as they can. Merchants, for example, wear boots that red, and blue cloth or thread are limited to the nobility, as are reach their knees, a tunic embroidered in yellow, green, and the fur of the fox, ermine, and squirrel. The foot of a peasant's black that reaches the top of the boots, and lots of jewellery. shoe must be no more than twelve inches long (peasants with If they have an exception, they take as much advantage of it big feet must wear sandals), and his breeches must reach from as they can, which occasionally

results in tasteless merchants

waist to ankle, be of un-dyed cloth, and carry no embroidery. dressing in solid crimson. Indeed, some nobles grant

A peasant's tunic must reach his knees, be close about the exemptions that they know will make someone embarrass

neck, and the sleeves can be no more than six inches across. A himself.

— Local Laws —

All nobles have the power to make laws for their peasants as Finally, many local laws reflect the eccentricities of the lords.

long as they do not conflict with royal law. Likewise, Dukes Lord Deslisle, ruler of lands in

Bastonne, requires all peasants

make laws that apply to all nobles, apart from Barons, in their to press their faces to the ground when he passes. Lord Laurent,

dukedom, again as long as they do not conflict with royal law. in Artois, requires all newly married couples to spend their

Some of these laws are practical responses to local conditions. first night in his bedchamber. To the surprise of his peasants,

The Dukedom of Bordeleaux, for example, requires that the the Lord himself always spends that night sleeping outside the

dead be cremated and the ashes scattered on water before the door to the chamber, ensuring that the couple is not disturbed.

first nightfall after death. In an area plagued by the Undead, The Duke of Lyonesse has, for many years, required all nobles

these are merely sensible precautions. in the Dukedom to provide a feast for twelve peasants once

Others were practical once, but have long since lost their per year. Most nobles invite wealthy merchants and the like,

original point. In the city of Gisoreux, there must be a torch though a few of the truly noble feed the utterly impoverished.

outside every house, to be lit when the Nightravens come. These local laws are under the control of the noble who declares

The Nightravens were monsters that attacked people in flocks, them. However, if the law is particularly extreme, the King

picking their bones clean, but they fled from light. However, can pass a royal law that conflicts with it, making it illegal. It

the last flock was destroyed by Sir Thopas over five hundred is believed that this is the origin of the royal law stating that all

years ago, so Gisoreux is full of torches that are never lit. peasant boys between thirteen and fifteen years of age must stand

Chapter IV: Law and Justice

under the open sky and shout "Griffon claws!" once, on nights All turnips must be carved with an Orc's face before being

when Mannanslieb is full. At least, no one can think of any other eaten, to express contempt for

that pathetic race.

reason for it, though most scholars are equally puzzled as to the All houses must keep a bale of reeds for re-thatching

nature of the law it was to over-rule. (This law is rarely enforced.) the roof. (Most effective if enforced in a town where

almost all houses are now tiled.)

Sample Local Laws Any boat landing in the port must pay a tax of its keel or its captain, unless a resident of the town owns it.

Peasants must remain indoors between sunset and sunrise. All men's clothing must expose the left-hand side of the

All pigs must swear before a Grail Damsel that they are chest at all times. (Instituted after trouble with a Chaos

not servants of Chaos. cult that branded its members there. Chaos cults are

Peasants must wear hats, the height of the hat indicating too stupid to think of moving the brand, after all.)

the amount of taxes they paid last year.

— Outlaws —

Bretonnia has a long tradition of outlaws. These are people

who are outside the law; no matter what you do to them, it outlaws flee into the wilderness where they can establish a

is not illegal. There are a number of ways to become an outlaw, secret stronghold and support themselves by preying on the

and the different routes produce rather different people. surrounding country.

Such groups find themselves in violent competition with

On the run all other outlaws in the area, as defeating such a threat wins

pardon for almost any crime. These outlaws are also the most

First, any peasant who flees his rightful lord automatically depraved, killing people for the fun of it and targeting nobles

becomes an outlaw. These outlaws are simply trying to survive and peasants indifferently. but don't feel that they owe anything to Bretonnian society.

They hunt illegally and steal food from villages. They rarely Herrimaults

steal money, as they have no opportunities to spend it, and on

the whole, they try to avoid killing their victims. Foreigners The final group of outlaws is the Herrimaults.

often have quite a bit of sympathy for these outlaws, an Herrimaults are outside the law, but they fight for justice,

attitude shared by Bretonnian townsfolk. Nobles regard them robbing the rich to feed the poor and overthrowing oppressive

as despicable criminals for fleeing their rightful place, and nobles condoned by their peers. They are a popular subject

because villagers suffer the effects of their thefts and may be of peasant tales, and over the years, these stories have come

punished for the outlaw's hunting, they also regard them as to be attributed to a single group, led by The Faceless, which

criminals. acts all over Bretonnia. The Herrimault is a style of hooded

On the other hand, no one particularly hates these kinds of cloak popular a few centuries ago, worn by the characters in

outlaws, and most people overlook their dubious pasts if they these stories. The name has come to be applied to the men perform some sort of great service, such as saving a village from themselves, who are also called Hoods, Hoodies, Wood Hoods, a band of Beastmen. Woodies, and Herrings. The Faceless prefer that but are also called Crownless Lords, Nameless Men, Him Out Back, and Criminal Intent Cod. The fish names are not particularly respectful, but even so, using them distinguishes the Herrimaults from common. The second group is made up of violent criminals who have outlaws, so almost no nobles do so. fled justice. These outlaws do kill their victims and generally Herrimaults have diverse backgrounds. Many are peasants who have the contacts necessary to fence stolen goods. Most of served in their lord's army and saw enough of the world to them target nobles and merchants because peasants have want to help the unfortunate. Other peasants started by trying nothing to steal, but they have no desire to help peasants. The to right a local injustice, were condemned to outlawry in the victims of these outlaws hire bounty hunters or dispatch troops process, and joined the Herrimaults to continue their quest. to deal with them. Even ordinary peasants have no sympathy Some groups form in response to a particularly evil noble, for them, though it is rare for a village to be roused to any sort drawing mainly from his lands. Many women who are caught of positive action. passing as men flee justice to become outlaws, and most of The third group is the most loathed. Corrupt and powerful them join the Herrimaults. Ironically, they must still conceal nobles or significant Chaos cults are declared outlawed when their sex, even among outlaws, because the sexist attitudes of discovered, along with all their associates. This grants anyone Bretonnia persist. Finally, some Herrimaults were noble-born permission to try to defeat them, and knights and peasants but made outlaws because they tried to right an injustice alike take advantage of it. An outlawed noble may be able committed by a more powerful noble who was able to turn to hold on to his castle for some time, but ultimately the the courts against them. These individuals expect to become rest of the Bretonnian nobility turns against him. Most such leaders, and their military training means they are often suited to the role.

Chapter IV: Law and Justice

Herrimaults live by a code of honour that is clearly set out in the tales of the Faceless (as described in the corresponding sidebar). The order of the injunctions is roughly their order of importance. Groups of outlaws who harm innocents

(generally defined as women, children, and the aged) lose any claim to be Herrimaults, even if the harm was caused in the pursuit of justice.

Loyalty to one another is, of course, vital among outlaws, as is the prohibition on asking about a member's past.

Peasants and even nobles who wish to leave some traumatic event behind often join the Herrimaults, concentrating on their new goals.

Joining the Outlaws

Becoming a Merry Man (a member of the Herrimaults) is protect villages from Beastmen and Greenskins, and attempt

simple; become an outlaw, and declare yourself to be one. If the overthrow of particularly oppressive nobles.

you uphold the Code, others will recognise you as such, and They are also very protective of their reputations. Anyone not a

you gain the benefits of their good reputation. member of a band of Herrimaults who claims to be risks being

However, lone outlaws do not survive for very long, so most executed as a warning to others (such liars are not innocent).

aspiring Herrimaults look to join an established group. Similarly, bands of outlaws who claim the name but do not live

Traditionally, as described in the story cycle, applicants walk up to the Code are the first targets of genuine Herrimaults in

through the forest where the group hides, loudly declaring the area.

their intent to join. An applicant who survives doing this is Most nobles regard the Herrimaults as criminals and

clearly competent enough to join; the chances of avoiding revolutionaries, to be put down as quickly and brutally as

being attacked by beasts, Beastmen, or Orcs are very slim. possible. Many merchants share this opinion. The most just

The applicant is confronted by the Herrimaults and required nobles, however, find that they have few problems with the

to swear to the Code. These probationary members are watched Herrimaults personally and generally admire their aims.

carefully for some time until The Faceless judges them to have Some even help them secretly without giving up their noble

proved their loyalty. Infiltration by spies is a constant problem positions, and a few Faceless sleep in a castle most nights.

for bands of Herrimaults, so wise Herrimaulted Men organise

their bands so that they can survive any single member turning

out to be a spy. The normal method is to split the gang into

groups with separate hideouts and never tell anyone in advance

when they plan to gather the whole band.

Bands of outlaws that hold to the Code of the Herrimaults are

very popular among the peasants, who call on them to right

perceived injustices. It is common for Herrimaults to steal

shipments of heavy taxes and return the food and goods to the peasants who paid them. Groups that have survived for some time know how to do this without arousing the suspicions of the lord. Herrimaults also rescue peasants sentenced to hang,

The Code of the Herrimaults

Do not harm the innocent. You cannot fight for justice by unjust means.
Uphold justice where law has failed.

Take the excess from the wealthy to feed the starving. It is no harm to lose money that you do not need.

Be true to your fellows. Betrayal is a foul deed, worthy of Greenskins and Beastmen.

Ask no questions of your fellows' pasts. Every Herrimault has his reasons for fighting and should be judged on his actions now.

Reject the Ruinous Powers, and fight against them even alongside tyrants.

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Chapter V: Religion and Custom

Religion and Chapter

Custom

V

"Favored by the Lady, I am. She took all my children, and now I'm too old to work. Spare a copper?"
- anonymous L'Anguillen beggar

Much as the Empire is shaped by the cult of Sigmar The most prominent difference between the Cult of the Lady and

Heldenhammer, Bretonnia is shaped by the Cult of the other religious orders of the Old World is that the Lady has no

the Lady of the Lake, who is often simply called the Lady. Priests or Initiates. Instead, she is served by the Grail Knights—the

Within Bretonnia, no one else could possibly be meant. flower of Bretonnian chivalry—and the Grail Damsels, women

There are, however, deep differences between the two Cults. taken from their families as children and raised by the Fay

Most notably, whilst the Cult of Sigmar claims the allegiance Enchantress to serve the Lady with mysterious powers.

of all in the Empire, the Cult of the Lady is almost entirely

restricted to the nobility. Further, the agents of the Lady take Symbol

all children who show magical talent before they reach the

age of three, and these thefts have left profound scars on the The Lady has two symbols. The

first is the Grail, the magical national psyche. cup from which her Grail Knights drink and from which Grail Damsels and Prophetesses are believed to draw their power. It The Lady of the Lake is depicted as a golden goblet with a wide base, narrow stem, and flaring cup.

Goddess of Bretonnia The Grail is often shown decorated with the Lady's other symbol, the fleur-de-lis, though those who have seen it insist Revered throughout Bretonnia but barely known beyond, the that it bears no ornament other than its superb shape. The Lady of the Lake is a truly regional goddess. She stands for fleur-de-lis, a stylised lily, primarily symbolises purity and only purity, nobility, and courage in the face of danger. She is the secondarily the Lady. ideal lady, everything a knight should love and strive to serve. Finally, it is common for the Lady to be depicted directly—on In the minds of many knights, the Lady is Bretonnia, in a banners, after the manner of the one she gave to Gilles le mystical sense. Breton, or in stained glass. Over time, stained glass depictions Unlike virtually all other Gods of the Old World, the Lady have become extremely popular, as the light shining through is encountered by her mortal worshippers in this world. All them recalls the light that is supposed to surround the Lady. Grail Knights met her at the climax of their quest, and the Most Grail Chapels have such a window.

Grail Damsels are also said to be initiated by the Lady herself, though they speak very little of it. As a result, when the Lady Area of Worship is portrayed, she is portrayed consistently: a young woman of great and somewhat unworldly beauty, clothed in white, with The Lady is worshipped within Bretonnia, primarily by the a narrow golden fillet holding a white veil on her head. In one nobility. Both knights and their ladies worship her, and hand, she holds the Grail. Bretonnians outside their own country normally maintain their

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faith. Strong Bretonnian influence among the Border Princes means that there are a number of Grail Chapels to be found there, though the Grail Damsels normally seem to treat that area as outside their sphere of influence.

Temperament

The Lady is concerned with protecting Bretonnia, working through its knights to do so. Their courage and martial skill protect the land from external foes, whilst their nobility and chivalry ensure that the land enjoys internal peace and justice. She seems not to concern herself directly with peasants in any way.

Strictures

The strictures of the Lady are the strictures of chivalry. As these apply to men, they are described in Chapter Eight, but the rules for women are different.

- Preserve your modesty and innocence.
- Serve and obey your father before marriage, your

husband after.

- Succour those who are weak and helpless through no

fault of their own.

- Show favour only to the bravest and most noble knights

who seek your blessing.

Grail Chapels

The Lady's temples and shrines are called Grail Chapels and are only built on sites where the Lady herself has appeared to one of her worshippers. This is most often the site where a Questing Knight was allowed to drink from the Grail, becoming a Grail Knight.

As Grail Chapels are almost invariably built by the nobility, most are of stone and built in a soaring style dominated by pointed arches and large windows. Each Chapel is a single hall with a high ceiling, a door at one end, windows in the side walls, and a large window in the end opposite the door. Stained glass, depicting the Lady, her servants, and great deeds of chivalry, is the dominant form of decoration. All Grail Chapels face the Forest of Loren, home of the Fay Enchantress and the place where, most believe, the Grail Damsels are trained. In much of Bretonnia, then, they face southeast, which also means that a lot of sunlight falls on that side.

The main window is almost always a depiction of the Lady, but in particularly small or poor chapels it may depict the Grail or a fleur-de-lis. The windows are decorated in order, moving back along the Chapel from the main window. The window over the door is often in the shape of the fleur-de-lis and almost never glazed with stained glass.

Every Grail Chapel is supposed to be attended by a Grail Knight, who guards it, maintains it, and exemplifies the values of the Lady. In practice, many Grail Knights found Grail Chapels on the site where they themselves encounter the Lady, and thus there are far more Grail Chapels than Grail Knights. In addition, most Grail Knights spend their lives wandering

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the land and fighting evil or serving their lords. Only a few, the Chapels to fall into ruin, as stone buildings are durable and

Hermit Knights, choose to spend their lives watching over a normally only fall apart completely when building materials

Grail Chapel. are stolen from them. In Bretonnia, only nobles are allowed

At an attended Chapel, the Grail Knight gives a short sermon to build in stone, and no nobles would risk getting caught

every Ladyday (the name for Holiday in Bretonnia), and those stealing building material from a Grail Chapel.

who live nearby are expected to attend. Grail Knights are not The holiest Grail Chapel in

Bretonnia is the First Chapel, in

selected for their oratorical abilities, but many feel that they the castle of Bordeleaux. Founded by Marcus of Bordeleaux,

ought to make an effort, and thus long, rambling, pointless one of the Grail Companions, in the great hall where he was

sermons are extremely common. For the rest of the time, the visited by the Lady, it set the architectural pattern for all future

Chapel is open to those who wish to pray or meditate, but the Chapels, but is unusual in facing west; the hall already existed.

Knight prevents any lesser use of the building. This Chapel is attended by a Grail Prophetess, at least three

Some Chapels are attended by Grail and Battle Pilgrims (see Grail Damsels, and at least two Grail Knights at all times. All

pages 97 and 95 respectively), often venerating the reliquary of the greatest nobles of Bretonnia pay towards its upkeep, but

of the Grail Knight who founded the Chapel. These operate in the Duke of Bordeleaux willingly pays the largest share.

much the same way as those attended by Grail Knights, except

that the sermons tend to be better; the leaders of Grail Pilgrims Pilgrimages are chosen on the basis of oratorical ability.

A few Chapels are maintained by nobles who are not Grail Followers of the Lady are encouraged to make pilgrimages,

Knights. These Chapels were generally founded by an ancestor journeys to distant sites of religious significance. The target of

of the nobles in question, and in some cases, the maintenance of a pilgrimage is almost always a Grail Chapel and must be at

a Chapel is one of the duties attached to a fief. A bare handful some distance from the pilgrim's place of residence. The First

are attended by Grail Damsels and Prophetesses. These are the Chapel in Bordeleaux is a very popular destination, but not for

holiest of the Chapels and popular destinations for pilgrimage. those who live in the city itself; for them, it is too close.

Many Grail Chapels, however, are unattended and uncared for. People, both noble and peasant, often go on pilgrimages to

These buildings may fall into ruin or be used as storage areas mark major life events. Marriages are solemnised at distant by peasants. As stone buildings, they are normally the sturdiest Chapels, whilst after a funeral, the bereaved family make a structure in a village. Grail Knights frown on most such uses, pilgrimage on behalf of the deceased soul. Illness and injury with one exception. Peasants who take refuge from attackers are also occasions for pilgrimage; it is common to promise to in the Chapel are believed to be putting themselves under the go on a pilgrimage if you recover. Some people also mark the protection of the Lady, an act of piety. It is rare for even these anniversaries of major events with a pilgrimage.

This is not pure piety. Peasants need the permission of their lords to travel, and most lords are very reluctant to give this out. Even the meanest lord, however, can hardly refuse permission for a wedding pilgrimage. Thus, for many peasants, pilgrimages are basically holidays.

The destination of a pilgrimage is most often a Grail Chapel attended by a living Grail Knight, with the hope of gaining the Knight's blessing. Those few Chapels attended by Grail Damsels are popular with the nobility, but peasants tend to stay away. There are also a few Chapels that have become popular destinations and now provide many services for the pilgrims that flock there, including taverns, inns, theatres, and other entertainments. The Chapel of the Thrice-Sundered Lance, in the mountains near Parravon, is the most famous of such locations, drawing pilgrims from across Bretonnia.

Grail Damsels

Grail Damsels, also known as The Damsels of the Lady, are wrapped in mystery. Born in Bretonnia, they were taken by the Fay Enchantress as young girls and raised by her, some say in the Forest of Loren, others say in another world entirely. They wield supernatural power, generally over nature, and tell the Bretonnia's nobles of the Lady's will.

Grail Damsels are completely outside the laws of Bretonnia and equally outside its social customs. No one would dare to criticise one, even behind her back. They are all beautiful,

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Damsels in Play

Damsels and Prophetesses of the Lady are not suitable as player characters because they

should always be surrounded by an air of mystery. Player characters cannot be mysterious to the players. In game terms, treat their powers as those of Wizards, except that many of them can cast spells from more than one Lore. Damsels start with access to either Beasts or Life and then gain access to the other. Advancement to Prophetess is marked by gaining access to the Lore of the Heavens. Damsels work best in three roles. First, as they operate completely outside the social structures of Bretonnia, they make good contacts for non-noble player characters. A knight fraternising with peasants would be looked at suspiciously, but no one would question a Damsel. Second, they can be *dei ex machina*, appearing to save the player characters when all seems lost. You should avoid using them like this at the climax of an adventure, because characters should feel as though they have won or lost by their own efforts. Third, they are good sources of adventures. A Damsel might carry a message from the Lady, or a Prophetess might have a vision that involves the player characters. Damsels never apologise and never explain. They never seem surprised by the outcome of events, and they often know things it seems that they could not have learned by mundane means. Player characters should feel respect tinged with fear for these figures. Genuine Damsels are never corrupt, but there are servants of the Dark Powers who pretend to be Damsels. Such figures make good antagonists.

appearing young for many years before suddenly withdrawing takes a few minutes (at least 12 combat rounds) to pray to the Forest of Loren, where most assume that they die. Many Lady, asking for a boon. He then spends a Fortune Point and go about with their hair uncovered, and not a few are notorious chooses the blessing he wants. Sometimes, the Lady grants for their promiscuity, though no tales of a Grail Damsel giving a different blessing if it would benefit the knight. Thus, if birth are known. Few claim to understand their behaviour, the knight is facing non-magical opponents with poisoned but the arcane support they give to Bretonnia's armies is much weapons, she might grant protection from poison, even though appreciated. the knight asked for protection from magic. Experienced Grail Damsels are called Prophetesses of the Lady, A knight can only benefit from one Gift at a time. The effect or Grail Prophetesses. These Damsels have the power to foretell of the Gift lasts until a combat ends or until the knight runs the future and provide counsel to the highest nobles. Some away, whichever comes first. If the knight runs, gathers his Prophetesses travel Bretonnia, giving counsel to many different courage, and returns, the effects of the Gift do not return; he

people, as they see fit. has shamed his station and must pay the price.
The highest of the Lady's servants is the Fay Enchantress. The Fay Enchantress spends much of her time in Bretonnia and can Grail Draught be found at the Royal Court for all major events. Her authority is greater even than the King's, for with a single word she could The knight gains a +20% bonus to all tests to resist poison.
deprive any King of his crown. Her personal supernatural power is also immense, far greater than even the Grail Lady's Mantle Prophetesses'. The Fay Enchantress is apparently immortal, as the same person has apparently filled the role since the The knight gains +1 Armour Point on all locations. This adds foundation of Bretonnia. Some believe she is actually an avatar to the value of any armour actually worn, to a maximum of 6 of the Lady herself, but the Fay Enchantress has always denied APs per location. this when asked.

Might of Purity

Gifts of the Lady

The knight rolls two dice when dealing damage and chooses The Lady of the Lake grants benefits to those who truly serve the better result. her. She is most renowned for granting protection, but her powers are broader than that. Stout Heart
The Gifts of the Lady can only be received by characters with at least one Knightly Virtue Talent (see Chapter Eight: The knight gains a +20% bonus to all tests to resist fear, Knighthood for details). Before going into combat, the knight whether mundane or magical.

Ward of Light

The knight seems slightly brighter than his surroundings and gains a +10% bonus to all tests to resist harmful magic.

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Grail Pilgrims Grail Pilgrims. Most try to be of service to their knight, whether cleaning his gear, preparing his food, or even serving Whilst worship of the Lady is centred on the nobility, the as guards whilst he sleeps. peasants do not ignore her. It is true that most peasants give In return for this, the Pilgrims gather items that the knight their primary devotion to other deities, and these practices are casts off and wear them as relics of a living saint. Anything discussed below. A few peasants, however, are as devoted to the will do; a typical Grail Pilgrim wears a number of old buttons, Lady of the Lake as any Grail Knight. socks, armour rivets, and pieces of leather strapping. The more As these peasants cannot become Grail Knights or Damsels fortunate might wear a broken campstool as a hat or have a

themselves, they try to be as close as possible to those who strip of cloak wound over the heart. If the knight is killed in have. Damsels of the Lady are more feared than loved by most combat, most Grail Pilgrims immediately strip the corpse of peasants, and most would drive off any peasants who started suitable relics. If the Grail Knight hasn't quite died in combat, following them around, so the vast majority of these peasants this treatment is often enough to finish him off. join the entourage of a Grail Knight. Such people are known as Novice Grail Pilgrims run and hide when the knight goes into Grail Pilgrims. combat, but over time, they learn to provide some military A Grail Pilgrim, as long as he follows his Grail Knight, accepting support. The more experienced become Battle Pilgrims, as the hardships of life on the road, is deemed to be on pilgrimage competent in a fight as any knight of the Realm. A Grail and thus cannot be seized by his lord. Few join purely for this Knight with a group of Battle Pilgrims is a truly formidable independence, however, as Grail Knights seek out dangerous enemy. places, and the life expectancy of Grail Pilgrims is not long. When a Grail Knight dies, his body is often made into a Most Grail Knights believe their Pilgrims are especially under Reliquae by his Pilgrims, who then carry it into battle. The their protection, but they do not speak to them, even to give corpse is dressed in armour, placed on a skeletal horse, and orders. The Grail Knights are, after all, far above the Pilgrims carried on the shoulders of Grail Pilgrims. The Battle Pilgrims in station. This does not bother the Pilgrims, who share the themselves draw strength from the presence of their saint. knight's opinion and are delighted to be allowed to stay close These groups can last for decades and tend to contain more to him. Peasants who do not share this opinion do not become Battle Pilgrims than most groups that follow a living knight. It is not uncommon for a lord to ask them to join his army.

— Peasant Religion —

As noted, the Cult of the Lady is aimed mainly at the themselves as hunters rather than criminals. There are few nobility. Most of the peasants give their primary villages without at least a shrine to these Gods. reverence to the standard Gods of the Old World. Ulric However, by far the most important God for most peasants is has very few worshippers in Bretonnia and fewer shrines. Shallya. The life of a Bretonnian peasant is extremely hard, and Myrmidia is growing in popularity among the peasant the relief brought by Shallyans is very welcome. No village is bowmen and men-at-arms summoned in to the armies of the more than a day's walk from a substantial temple, and Shallyan lords, but her perceived relationship with mercenaries reduces priests are as sacrosanct as

Damsels of the Lady. No peasant her appeal. Manann is worshipped by Bretonnian sailors family would choose to live more than a few minutes' walk just as he is anywhere else in the Old World, whilst Verena from a Shallyan shrine, and one sits at the centre of most appeals to the few scholars in Bretonnian society, and many villages. The nobility have recently taken to endowing small village elders also like to be seen to honour her. Verena is also shrines of Shallya near Grail Chapels, a custom that it rapidly the patron of a few Merry Men, those who are particularly growing in popularity. interested in fighting for justice. Sigmar, of course, is not The Old World's main temple of Shallya is in Couronne. worshipped. Because of the presence of the Cult of the Lady, it has almost The recurrent problems with the restless dead have made the no political influence, which suits most Shallyans very well. worship of Morr quite important, and Gardens of Morr are Being apart from politics, they can concentrate on bringing normally fortified with a wall that is able to defend against healing and succour to the needy. attacks from within the garden as well as from without. Even A common heresy among the peasants is the belief that the nobility entrust their mortal remains to Morr's priests. the Lady of the Lake is a servant of Shallya, who guides Ranald is also perennially popular, mostly in towns and cities. the nobility to protect the peasantry. The indisputable fact Merchants, in particular, tend to look to him as a patron. In that Grail Knights treat peasants better than almost any Bretonnia, Ranald is more associated with merchants than with other noble lends some weight to this belief. The Grail rogues, but then most Bretonnians see little difference between Knights and Damsels, however, are ruthless in suppressing a merchant and a thief anyway. it whenever it rears its head. Vigorous investigation has Taal and Rhya are important to both farmers and hunters, failed to uncover a network of believers, despite the constant and their stone circles stand in Bretonnia as well as in the reappearance of the heresy; it appears to be a natural Empire. Many outlaws also look to Taal as their patron, seeing weakness of the common folk.

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Holidays Bretonnian Holidays

The great holidays of Bretonnia all derive from the foundation Month Day Occasion legend of the country. The holy days of the Gods of the Old World are also celebrated in Bretonnia, but the holidays – Witching Night New Year associated with the Lady are far more important. After-Witching Spring Equinox Summer Solstice

Witching Night Year-Turn Autumn Equinox

– Lily Day Winter Solstice

Under the light of both full moons, Bretonnians celebrate the (Imperial Start Growth) power of the Lady to defend against evil magic, as exemplified in the Eighth Battle of Gilles the Uniter, and her blessing of good Plough-Tide magic, as wielded by the Damsels. For the day of the festival, Lady's Month women are in charge, in a sign of respect for the Damsels. Great (Imperial Sigmar-Tide) bonfires are built, and effigies representing (male) Wizards set Summer-Tide upon them to be burned. Some areas try to obtain a real Wizard instead, but this is difficult. The fires are always lit by women. – Peace-Tide (Imperial Sun Still)

Lily Day

Fore-Mystery

Lily Day celebrates purity and new growth. It is a very popular – Day of Mystery day for weddings, and the young brides are decked in white flowers. Most villages choose a Lady of Lilies, traditionally the After-Mystery most beautiful maiden, to preside over festivities. Harvest-Tide

Peace Tide – Grail Day

(Imperial Less Growth)

Gilles's final victory is celebrated with re-enacted battles, pledges of loyalty, and lots of eating and drinking. All quarrels within Brew-Month a community are supposed to be resolved by this day, though Chill Month quarrels with other communities need not be. Some villages force Gilles-Tide people who are still quarrelling to accept some resolution before (Imperial Ulric-Tide) dawn of this day, even if that resolution is a fight to the death.

– King's Sleep

Day of Mystery (Imperial World Still)

The Day of Mystery commemorates the Lady's first appearance Fore-Witching to Gilles and is the holiest day of the year. The barriers between the normal world and the Lady's realm are thought Note: Sacred days with no Month entry do not fall in the to be thinner, and most people gather in Grail Chapels to months, but rather between them. contemplate the Lady's works.

The children are normally taken as babies, before they have learned Grail Day to talk. The Fay may strike at any time, but no one ever sees them come or go. Sometimes that child is taken from the bed she shares In origin, this festival honoured the Grail. It is now an occasion with her mother; other children vanish from the crib whilst the for sampling as much wine as possible. Traditionally, wine is mother has her back turned. No matter how much they try to drunk undiluted on this day, which makes many celebrations steel themselves, this is a devastating blow for the parents. extremely raucous. Children are not named until they can talk, to avoid naming someone who will be taken from them. In most areas, the King's Sleep parents wait until the child has named both of them (that is, said both "mama" and "papa"), but in some a child is not named

In the depths of winter, the people remember that Gilles before speaking a sentence. The first custom occasionally results

le Breton, like the trees, is not dead, but merely sleeping.

Plays depicting his departure and return are a common Bretonnian Characters and Magic entertainment.

Most Bretonnians with the potential to learn arcane magic

The Stolen Children (Hedge Magic and the Wizard careers) are taken by the Fay.

Normal Bretonnian characters can never learn arcane magic. A

The Fay Enchantress takes all Bretonnian children with magical character who was hidden and raised in the wilderness may, as

talent. The girls may return as Damsels of the Lady, but the may one who was raised abroad, or who had their doll stolen in

boys are never seen again. This practice has a profound effect their youth (see Protecting Children, below).

on Bretonnian society.

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The Stolen Dolls poor families in the other country. The adoptive parents are

paid to raise the child well, whilst the Bretonnians raise the

In recent years, some children's dolls, have been taken (see borrowed baby as their own child.

The true child is often taken

Protecting Children, below). These thefts have occurred on as an apprentice, mysteriously favoured, whilst the decoy

throughout Bretonnia. Despite thorough investigations, no child finds his parents strangely cold.

mundane thieves have been discovered, so it is believed that the Centuries ago, some parents started making dolls to resemble

Fay took them. The biggest question is why? The first of the their children, in the hope that the Fay would take the doll by

children are now reaching adulthood, and a remarkably large mistake. The custom spread, and now every Bretonnian has a

number of them are showing a desire for adventure. "Fay doll." These dolls range from simple rag dolls to elaborate

constructions of painted wood that look a great deal like the

in babies being taken after they are named, but most parents baby. The families of stolen

children often give the doll a seat at

want to give their children a name by that point. feasts and important gatherings and may buy it small birthday

presents. People who were not taken keep their own Fay dolls,

Protecting Children which are thought to bring good luck.

A darker custom is infanticide. Peasant families that cannot

Some parents, desperate to keep their children, try to hide them feed another mouth may take a new baby into the wilderness

from the Fay. This is highly illegal. If the ruse is discovered, the and abandon it, claiming that the child was taken by the Fay.

child is presented to the Damsels. If it has power, it is taken. If it Few parents can actually bring

themselves to kill their own
does not, it is executed before the eyes of its parents. Some of the children, and some of these
children are found and raised by
crueller fiefs require the parents to do it themselves, on pain of groups of outlaws. Since there is
no reason to suppose that the
dying after seeing their child die. The more practical lords have child was not taken by the Fay,
these cases are almost never
noticed that this results in a lot of dead peasants. investigated.
However, it works often enough that parents still try it. The Because there are no male Wizards in
Bretonnia, any who visit
Fay are not omniscient, and claiming the baby was taken, or the country are treated with great
suspicion. Visiting around
still-born, followed by hiding it in the wilderness, has been Witching Night is particularly
dangerous, unless you want
known to work. Such children often become outlaws because to play a central role in the
celebrations. Most Bretonnians
they were not born into a Bretonnian community. have too much common sense to risk angering
a master of
Wealthier parents, particularly merchants with connections in the mystic arts, but few will trust
a Wizard, and he will be a
other countries, arrange to swap babies, often with relatively prime suspect in any mysterious
events that coincide with his
visit. Even more so than in the Empire, Wizards should feel
extremely unwelcome.

The Fay

The Fay of Bretonnia are actually the Wood Elves of Athel
Loren. Bretonnians do know about Elves; some Sea Elves trade
with the country, particularly through L'Anguille where they
have a substantial enclave. Wood Elves from the Empire also
occasionally pass through. However, most people do not make
any connection to the Fay of the forest, the servants of the Lady.
Non-Bretonnian characters who encounter the Fay are quite
likely to realise they are Elves, and Bretonnian characters
with substantial personal experience of Elves may also make
the connection. However, most Bretonnians with personal
experience of Elves live in L'Anguille, at the opposite end of the
country from the Forest of Loren.

The Fay Enchantress is also an Elf, and characters have the
same chance to notice. Elven characters, of course, realise
automatically whenever they meet "the Fay."

Perceptive players might notice that the Fay and the Fay
Enchantress are all Elves, that the Damsels of the Lady are
Wizards, and that there are no Priests of the Lady. This might lead
them to ask questions about the nature of the Lady of the Lake.
There are some questions, however, to which the answers
should remain mysterious.

Chapter VI: A Tour of Bretonnia

A Tour of Chapter

Bretonnia

VI

“The character of every Dukedom is captured in its wines. I have laid in stock, and propose to tour the Kingdom this very night. Would you care to join me?”

- a Merchant of Bordelaux

Bretonnia is a land rich in tradition and scenic landscapes. which is found in the city of Couronne. This applies at lower From the emerald green fields to the imposing forests, it levels, too. The Lord of Temmerais, in Quenelles, rules the is a place of beauty and glory. But beneath the veneer of the fief of Temmerais from Castle Temmerais, which overlooks splendour, Bretonnia, like the rest of the Old World hides its the village of Temmerais. Empire folk suggest that this is own corruption, its own dark secrets. This chapter provides all because Bretonnians cannot remember more than one name. the details needed to explore this storied nation. Bretonnians, on the other hand, insinuate that Imperial Before setting out to describe the various duchies, it's nobles like to have lots of titles because they have little power. important to clarify how names work here. Place names and Bretonnian nobles may, in fact, have multiple titles, but using titles in Bretonnia are very simple. Consider, as an example, more than one at once is frowned upon; they use whichever is Couronne. The Dukedom of Couronne is ruled by the most relevant. Dukes almost invariably use their ducal title, the Duke of Couronne, who has his seat in Castle Couronne, main exception being the King.

— L'Anguille —

Most of L'Anguille consists of arable land, though the Forest Inland L'Anguille is almost entirely arable, dotted with the of Arden covers its southernmost reaches. castles of the nobility. The soil is fertile and the Despite the fame of the port at the city of L'Anguille, weather normally mild as if the storms spend all the coastline of the dukedom is actually rather short their fury on the sea-cliffs, and few monsters lurk and famed for being particularly rugged. For most in the fields. The villages of L'Anguille maintain

of its length, cliffs plunge straight into the sea, and long, narrow strips of woodland, no more than rocks rise from the water off shore. The currents a hundred feet across and often narrower. These are even more treacherous than normal; even with bands separate the land of one village from the a skilled pilot, tests to get a boat to a safe landing next, offer a source of timber, provide forage for point are Hard (-20%). The sea monsters known as Theralind's Brood (see sidebar, page 44) that infest the pigs, and cannot hide bandits or monsters. area make things even more hazardous. Apart from the great city of L'Anguille, there are no As a result, there are very few settlements along the coast of real towns in the dukedom. The cities of L'Anguille and L'Anguille, with the notable exception of the city of L'Anguille Couronne are so positioned that no area of L'Anguille is very itself. Those who do live there generally want to keep to far from them, and they have proved impossible to compete themselves; hermits, smugglers, pirates, and cultists have all with. On the other hand, it seems as though every village has a been found clinging to the coast. weekly market, as no peasant wants to go as far as the cities for daily necessities.

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Chapter VI: A Tour of Bretonnia

Theralind's Brood opportunity to enjoy life as much as possible. They claim the country-folk spend so much time worrying about next year's Theralind was the beloved of Corduin of L'Anguille, first Duke crop that they forget to live. People leave the city to settle down and Grail Companion. Legend has it she was transformed (unlikely for player characters) or because they want to face into a hideous sea-monster by a jealous hag, but her natural challenges that can be defeated, rather than merely survived. virtue triumphed and she now guards the port. The fierce, Those from the country are farmers. They are solid and unpredictable storms that lash the coast are said to be the result reliable, and the main threats are from bandits and, especially, of her grief, and it is true they almost never strike L'Anguille Beastmen. They claim the city folk are gamblers who cannot itself nor the shipping channel leading to the port. be trusted to do an honest day's work. People leave the country The monsters referred to as Theralind's Brood are certainly to see something more exciting than a turnip harvest or to take hideous, but they seem to have no natural virtue. They are the fight to the Beastmen. serpent-like, though their heads are best described as like The tension between the two groups

is the main factor in the
scaly horses with fangs. They have two clawed arms but no internal politics of the dukedom.
Duke Taubert's avoidance of
apparent hind limbs. The brood seem to revel in the most the sea exacerbated this; not only
does he never visit the city,
dangerous currents and show no hesitation in attacking boats but he also avoids thinking about
it as much as possible. He
or even ships. They can leap from the water to reach the deck has appointed several stewards,
but previous ones all failed to
of a vessel (scholars report that they can survive for up to impose order. The current steward,
Godemar Fitzgodric, is the
half an hour on land) and fight just as viciously there. Some wealthiest merchant in Bretonnia,
head of the Brethren of the
think that they are the adult form of the carnivorous fish in Lighthouse, and fully effective in
making sure that the city's
the Sannez. At any rate, they have never been seen outside the taxes are paid on time.
Gulf of L'Anguille. Godemar and the Brethren, however, want independence
and rulership. Godemar, as a peasant, is a very lowly
Theralind's Brood Statistics servant of the Duke—a fact the Duke's court rubs his
nose in every time he goes to pay the taxes. However, his
Main Profile position has allowed him to bring the city almost entirely
under the control of the Brethren. The Council of the
WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel Brethren are currently debating their next move: should
0% they seek independence from the dukedom of L'Anguille,
40% 0% 43% 45% 50% 10% 32% or independence from Bretonnia with the lands of the
FP dukedom dependent on them? Whilst this debate continues,
Secondary Profile 0 they are interested mainly in political stability.
Duke Taubert's absence means he is unknown to most people
A W SB TB M Mag IP in the city. There are some who are considering appealing to
him about the abuses of the Brethren, and among them, he
3 22 4 4 3 0 0 has an almost messianic reputation. Most citizens, particularly
merchants, regard him as distant and ineffectual, and that's the
Skills: Concealment, Perception +20%, Silent Move, Swim way they like it.
+20% Among the peasantry of the countryside, things are very
different. To them, the Duke is a hero, riding personally
Talents: Frightening, Keen Senses, Natural Weapons, Scales (2) against the Beastmen. He has
set up a chain of signal towers
Special Rules: along the edges of the forest which relay an alarm to Grasgar
Castle if raiding bands are sighted. Armed bands are sent out
Aquatic: Those of Theralind's Brood can breathe underwater. in response, often led by the Duke
in person. More than a few
They also have a Movement of 8 in water. villages have been saved from utter destruction by the
timely
arrival of the Duke's men, and there are some people who have
Armour: None had their lives saved by him personally; this often has a major
Armour Points: Head 2, Arms 2, Body 2, Legs (none) impact on their opinions of their Duke.
Weapons: Claws and Fangs The Beastmen have become more cunning over the years,
and the more brutish have simply turned their attentions to

The southern stretch of the dukedom is within the Forest of Lyonesse, Artois, and Couronne. This is the cause of some Arden, and Beastmen and fouler things often make their way tension with the neighbouring dukedoms, and some of the out of the woods to raid the lands. For some reason, stag- other nobles mutter that Duke Taubert should try to defeat headed Beastmen are particularly common in this dukedom. the Beastmen properly rather than just driving them into other lords' lands. The fact remains, however, that Duke Taubert is People acting more heroically than are most other lords in the area, and this keeps criticism muted whilst making it more likely The people of L'Anguille fall into two groups: those from the city and those from the country. They differ radically, and rivalries between them are as strong as rivalries with other dukedoms. Those from the city are sailors, fishermen, and traders. They live from the sea and are proud of it. True courage is to be found in the face of the elements, whilst life on land is an

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that he will be opposed on Castellan would complain to other issues. the Duke, but any response “The salt gets into your brain, you know. That’s why the would come through the Duke Taubert city folk think about nothing but money.” steward: Godemar Fitzgodric,

of L'Anguille — L'Anguille peasant head of the Brethren.

Duke Taubert was a sailor in “If you see the same few people every day for years, you Grasgar Castle his youth, but has neither set stop believing that anyone else exists, and you really foot on a ship nor lived within think that the size of your cow is a measure of your Grasgar Castle is the current sight of the sea for over fifteen importance.” home of Duke Taubert and years, ever since returning the newest large castle in from his last voyage. He has — L'Anguille burgher Bretonnia. Fifteen years ago, not spoken of his reasons to it was a modest hunting anyone. “They want to be more Marienburg than we are. I hear lodge, defended by a moat that some of the merchants even want to dam the Sannez and wooden palisade. Now so they can have their own swamp.”

Since his return, Duke — Marienburg sailor there is a grand keep, over Taubert based himself at one hundred feet to the top Grasgar Castle on the edge Sayings of L'Anguille of its towers, surrounded by of the Forest of Arden. a moat and curtain wall, and The Dukes have used this “An arm and a leg”: A very small amount of money. construction work

continues

castle as a hunting lodge The gate tolls charge for each arm and each leg, so on a second, even larger,

for generations, but Duke curtain wall. This castle is

Taubert has been expanding being built as a secure base for it and using it as a base for an army.

expeditions deep into the this is half a small amount of money. Even now, there are typically forest. He says his aim is to “Lighthouse fuel”: Large amounts of money. A reference fifty knights and several

defeat the Beastmen, but both to the cost of keeping up the lighthouse and the hundred men-at-arms

many think he just wants money needed to join the Brethren. present, but the barracks

to be as far from the sea as “Night fishing”: suicidally dangerous, with little laid out, though not yet

possible. chance for profit. begun, could house twenty

“Port and Pasture”: two things that are very different times that number. However,

Significant and don’t get along. Duke Taubert does not

Places “There’s no harbour in a cliff”: Don’t go looking for have a thousand knights

new things; be happy with what you have. who owe him fealty and

L’Anguille would have trouble raising

ten thousand men-at-arms.

The Duke refuses to talk

The city of L’Anguille is one about the purpose of the

of the wonders of the Old

World. It was built by the Elves as a great trading port, and castle, but as he continues

his actions against the Beastmen, most people think that

much of the original structure has survived the millennia. they can guess. King Louen Leoncoeur is keeping a close eye

Most spectacular is the lighthouse, over three hundred feet

tall and with walls so smooth that, at first glance, look like on developments, but has not yet felt the need to stop work

on the fortress. Duke Taubert certainly shows no signs of

a single piece of stone. The walls of the city extend from the disloyalty.

lighthouse, rise sixty feet above the streets, and are broad

enough to ride ten abreast along the top. Elves on their first

visit invariably climb to the top of the lighthouse, and none

of the lighthouse keepers would dare to stop them.

The buildings within the walls, however, are all Human-

made and much more recent. The oldest is the castle,

built on an island in the middle of the harbour and

commanding the whole channel with its siege engines. It is

somewhat rundown, as the Duke has not visited in years,

but the defences are kept up. However, the Brethren of the

Lighthouse have taken advantage of the Duke’s absence to

build four of their own watchtowers. These watchtowers are

small castles, armed with cannons, and designed to give the

guns the best field of fire possible. The Brethren have also installed gunnery platforms on the ends of the walls. The

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Marperic D'Abenne The Dragon's Maw

Race: Human The Dragon's Maw is an area of the L'Anguille coast a day's

Career: Merchant (ex-Tradesman) travel from the border with Lyonesse. Dozens of sharp rocks rise

from the water, and the tides and currents raise a constant spray

Main Profile from them, so that they look like teeth wreathed in smoke.

This is also the area most often hit by storms, with at least one

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel major storm striking every week. Sailors believe entering the area is certain death, but they have no superstitions: the natural

29% 26% 27% 40% 36% 44% 44% 38% features are quite dangerous enough.

However, traders have noticed that people travelling by land

Secondary Profile within a few miles of the area also disappear. Indeed, no one

reliable has seen the area at all for over three years, and those

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP who have gone to look have not come back. The Duke will do

nothing, as it is on the coast, and the local lord is (now) a ten-

1 13 2 4 4 0 0 year-old boy. He will offer almost anything to adventurers who can bring his father back.

Skills: Animal Care, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Drive,

Evaluate +10%, Gossip, Haggle +10%, Perception, Read/ Example L'Anguillen

Write, Secret Language (Guild Tongue), Speak Language

(Breton), Trade (Merchant, Vintner) Marperic D'Abenne

Talents: Dealmaker, Savvy Marperic D'Abenne is an up-and-coming merchant in the city

Special Rules: of L'Anguille. Until very recently he kept a shop selling wine

and brandy and oversaw the production of some wine himself.

Marperic gets a +10% on all Common Knowledge His shop sold only high-quality drinks for consumption in the

(Bretonnia) Tests that deal with his home dukedom of homes of his customers, and Marperic is very insistent that he

L'Anguille. never ran a tavern.

Marperic's clients tended to be wealthy, and a few years ago,

Armour: None he started selling other goods he thought they might find

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0, Body 0, Legs 0

Weapons: Hand weapon (short sword) 46

Trappings: Town House, Warehouse, 2,000 gc in trade goods,

500 gc in coin.

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interesting. This side of his business did well, and he started to is noticeable it does not hinder him, and he normally forgets eye the wealth and privileges of the Brethren of the Lighthouse. the fact. Within the last month, he sold his shop and invested the proceeds in trade goods, which he hopes to sell at a substantial Adventure Seeds profit.

As he is barely started as a merchant, Marperic does not have Free L'Anguille! many contacts yet and is looking to hire talented individuals to protect his goods, report on distant markets, and maybe find A group of agitators takes up the merchants' cause and starts him rare items. At the moment, he has no interest in illegal rousing the people of both city and countryside with talk of goods, though that could change if business otherwise goes a free nation where all honest men have a say in government.

poorly. The nobility take a very dim view of this, hanging any agitators

At present, Marperic is something very rare: a potential they catch. The merchants are no happier: they want a free

patron for adventurers who is exactly what he seems. country with them in charge, not a bunch of smelly peasants

However, his ambition is likely to change that. He desperately running the show. Are the agitators simply mad idealists, or are

wants to join the Brethren of the Lighthouse, and if this they the puppets of more sinister forces? looks unlikely to happen legitimately, he would be willing to

try anything. If his business continues to grow, he is invited The Recruiters

to join in the normal way and becomes caught up in the

push for L'Anguillian independence. If his business suffers The player characters do something that is not really legal.

setbacks, he gets caught up in the tentacles of a Chaos cult. (Almost any adventure counts.) To their surprise, they find

The characters might have to help him get out, or they'll have themselves surrounded by a dozen knights (backed up with

to deal with learning that their patron has become a cultist twice as many Men-at-Arms) and marched to Grasgar Castle,

whilst they weren't looking. where the Duke very publicly condemns them to hang. That

Marperic is in his late twenties and is thin for a merchant; night, in their cell, the Duke comes to visit them and offers

he has been ploughing his profits back into the business. them a deal. They will be allowed to "escape" into the forest

He dresses well and is quite good-looking, but walks with a with all their equipment if they agree to serve as scouts against

slight limp as the result of a childhood accident. Whilst this the Beastmen. Otherwise, they hang.

Of course, the Duke could have got the characters' service by simply paying them. What is he really up to?

— Aquitaine —

Aquitaine lies south of the Gilleau and the Forest of Châlons, or possessing extra money extends

his castle, and his heirs
 and consists almost entirely of arable land. There are a few abandoned the parts that are no longer
 necessary to avoid the
 hills, but nothing so steep as to make pastoral farming the only expense of upkeep.
 option. The coastline is the gentlest in Bretonnia, with many These abandoned buildings are
 often taken over by Dereliches
 beaches, few high cliffs, and numerous safe coves. However, (see below), which discourages
 people from raiding them
 there are no suitable locations for a major port, so the largest
 settlements are fishing (and smuggling) villages. for building materials and from trying to live in a
 Inland, there are no major rivers, no obvious building surrounded by abandoned structures.
 crossing points through the low hills, and no
 particularly defensible locations. As a result, no The People
 settlements have grown particularly large. Even the
 town of Aquitaine is no bigger than medium-size, The people of Aquitaine do not have to fight
 and that is due entirely to the influence of the ducal their land, so they fight each other.
 Aquitainians
 court. themselves prefer to say that they have honour and
 Indeed, noble influence is the main factor in town size the courage of their convictions, but the
 result is
 throughout the dukedom. Noblemen encourage urban the same. Aquitainians have a reputation
 for being
 development around their castles so that they can tax the stubborn and for resorting to violence
 to solve their
 trade and become wealthier. So far, these developments have problems. As a result, their
 knights are among the most
 never taken root: when the noble loses interest, the towns shrink renowned in Bretonnia, and the
 dukedom is constantly in the
 again. Thus, there are a lot of towns with abandoned areas as grip of several small wars,
 revolutions, and feuds.
 large as the inhabited. The hovels there quickly collapse, but the People often leave Aquitaine as
 a result of a serious
 more substantial buildings slowly moulder away. disagreement with someone more powerful
 than they are.
 A similar effect can be seen in Aquitaine's castles. As there are Others, particularly nobles, leave
 to prove their mettle against
 no naturally defensible locations, the lords of Aquitaine rely monsters, of which Aquitaine has
 remarkably few. Some, of
 on construction to protect their homes. A noble facing attack course, leave because they are
 sick of the constant feuding and
 want to live somewhere people just get along. These folk tend
 to keep moving.

Dereliches are evil beings that inhabit abandoned buildings or parts of buildings. They try to lure people into their clutches by making the building appear inhabited and welcoming and, once the poor victim is within their grasp, then kill them. Somehow the deaths of their victims provides sustenance to the Derelich.

There is never more than a single Derelich in a small building, though wings of a large building may accommodate one each.

Even then, each Derelich keeps to its own area, and they seem to ignore one another. However, a Derelich can manifest in a large number of spirits, up to 24 in most cases, each of which can take the form of any living creature, playing a role in the charade of the building and playing a role in the attack. These fragments can leave the building, but they cannot go very far; no more than one yard from the edge of the building's plot for every Wound that they have.

The Derelich can also change the appearance of its building, inside and out, making it appear as it was at its height. This makes holes in floors invisible but doesn't actually repair dangerously damaged buildings.

Whilst Dereliches are spirits, they do not appear to be Undead nor do they seem to be Chaos Daemons. Their natures are something of a mystery, and in most of the Old World, they are hardly ever seen. They are, however, quite common in Aquitaine.

Derelich Statistics

Main Profile

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

35% 0% 30% 30% 40% 22% 20% 41%

Secondary Profile

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

1* 24* 3 3 5 0 0 0

Skills: Charm +20%, Perception +20%, Speak Language (Breton)

Talents: Ethereal, M Natural Weapons, Night Vision

Special Rules:

Show of life: The Derelich can create illusions, making its home appear to be inhabited and actively cared for.

*We are legion: A single Derelich can produce many "bodies," apparently separate spirits. Each

spirit has some of the Derelich's

Wounds, so that the total number of Wounds is split between all spirits. Each spirit has 1 Attack. All spirits are part of the same Derelich and thus can coordinate their attacks perfectly. Wounds lost by each spirit are lost by the whole Derelich.

Armour: None

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0, Body 0, Legs 0

Weapons: Claws

The internal politics of Aquitaine are in constant flux as old started over the soiling of the daughter of one house by the son of feuds die down and new ones flare up. The new Duke has, if the other, but no one now knows which was which (both houses anything, made things even worse, despite his best intentions. claim that it was their daughter, of course). This feud has become Whenever he intervenes personally to suppress a revolt or force so formalised that the locations of the battles are set in advance, reconciliation in a feud, he succeeds. However, if he cannot and people come to watch. The feud is still real, though, so the intervene personally, he tends to do nothing, which means that battles are to the death, which attracts even more people. many other feuds are allowed to develop. A more recent feud is that between the Earls of Desroches, in There are a few famous, ancient feuds which Duke Armand has the west of the dukedom, and Fluvia, in the north. The two men not been able to resolve (although in these cases, none of his used to be inseparable friends, spending much time at the courts predecessors could, either). The feud between the D'Elbiq and of the land. A little over ten years ago, something happened, Du Maisne families has continued for several centuries. It was and the two have been implacable foes ever since. Both are

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intelligent, fine tacticians unsafe structures and future and strategists, and superb consequences, but the tower warriors in their own right. Sayings of Aquitaine has stood for over a century. Most of the time they keep No one has been allowed to their feud low-key, but as no "The lights are on, but nobody's home": The situation is enter it for over fifty years, one knows the cause, no one much more dangerous than it appears. A reference to a however, and leaning on it knows what might cause it house occupied by a Derelich. is punished with ten lashes,

to flare up into full-blown "Like a Beastman at court": Someone who is what he seems even if

you are the Duke's
war. Between them, the two daughter (much to her
lords command the fealty to be, surrounded by people just like him but pretending dismayed
astonishment).
to be otherwise. Not used within hearing of the nobility.
of over a third of the nobles
of Aquitaine; war between "Off building castles": Doing something that's a complete The town of
Aquitaine is
them would devastate the waste of time, but that he thinks will be useful. to the west of the
castle
dukedom. and fairly small. It used to
be entirely to the east, but
Relations between Aquitaine over the years it drifted, and
and other dukedoms are generally neutral. Disputes within now the eastern side is entirely
abandoned. The Duke sponsors
Aquitaine stay there, and other nobles have more sense than to expeditions to clear out
unsavoury inhabitants and encourages
get involved. burghers to settle there, but it isn't working.

Duke Armand of Aquitaine Chateau D'Epee

Duke Armand was a younger "Fairest land in the world. The grain is plentiful, This castle is the
epitome of
brother of the last Duke of travelling is easy, and monsters are rare. Who would Aquitainian
fortification and
Aquitaine and never expected choose to live anywhere else?" is located almost exactly in
to inherit. As a Knight the centre of the dukedom.
Errant, he was famed for — Aquitainian noble The current Lord D'Epee's
both his recklessness and his great-grandfather was a highly
luck, and he refused all offers "Travel through Aquitaine is boring. Dull, dull, dull. successful
adventuring knight,
of a fief until King Louen Field of wheat, village, field of wheat, ridiculously over- involved in many
feuds. He
himself offered a place in built castle, orchard, small town. Best part of my job." used his wealth
to build a
the royal household. Again, nigh-impregnable castle with
Armand distinguished himself — Eldergar of Busreq, Coachman several moats, curtain walls
with feats of valour, most that formed a maze of killing
notably slaying the Bestigor "Almost no monsters in Aquitaine. Even Beastmen grounds, mighty
gatehouses,
Darmal the Crooked in single from Châlons seem to stay out. Feuding nobles, and three great
keeps, each of
combat. Many expected him gangsters, rebellious peasants, cultists, serial killers, and which
could hold out against a
to be given a barony and protagonists in abundance, though." siege for months.
probably appointed Marquis. The current Lord D'Epee lives
— Marietta, Tilean mercenary

Instead, after only two years, in the outermost gatehouse, he set off to seek the Grail. along with his whole household. He quested in disguise and has not spoken of his activities since No one has reached one of the great keeps and returned alive in his return. A few minstrels are trying to piece his movements ten years; it is fifteen years since anyone came back sane. That was together, but he is not the only Questing Knight to hide his the current Lord D'Epee, and he never speaks of what he saw.

identity. On his return as a Grail Knight, he was made the Standard Bearer of Bretonnia. The position suited him perfectly.

Three years ago, the Duke of Aquitaine died, and by royal command, Armand was declared heir to the position. He is still finding his feet as an administrator; he has a strong desire to solve problems personally and martially.

Significant Places

Aquitaine

The ducal castle is in the southeast of the dukedom, near the border with Quenelles. It is famous for the Lace Tower, a tall spire built with so many windows that it looks as though it is made from stone lace. Dwarfs who see it mutter darkly about

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Carmolax, the Faceless The village has now been free for over six months, and the leaders—particularly Carlomax, the most experienced Race: Human Faceless—are planning to attack other nobles and extend Career: Faceless (ex-Veteran, ex-Herrimault) their power. They calculate that if they can take enough land, they will be able to hold off anything short of a counterattack Main Profile by the King himself. At the same time, the surrounding nobility, particularly the young Lord Recherche, are planning a WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel counterattack that would teach the uppity peasants a lesson. A cultist of Khorne was recently burned in the area; some fear 56% 67% 44% 53% 39% 41% 48% 73% that there may be more lurking.

Secondary Profile Example Acquitanian

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP Carlomax, The Faceless

3 16 4 5 4 0 0 0 Carlomax was just another peasant until the day he saw his brother hanged for smiling at the lord's daughter and

Skills: Academic Knowledge (Strategy/Tactics), Animal Care, his mother beaten until she was crippled for crying at the Charm +10%, Command, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia execution. Two weeks later, more by luck than ability, +20%), Concealment +10%, Consume Alcohol, Dodge Blow Carlomax had kidnapped the lord's daughter and fled into the +10%, Follow Trail, Gamble, Gossip +20%, Intimidate, forests. His initial plan had been to do unspeakable things to Outdoor Survival +10%, Perception +20%, Scale Sheer her in revenge, but when it came to it, he found that he didn't Surface +10%, Secret Language (Battle Tongue), Secret Signs have the heart to deliberately torture another Human. (Ranger, Scout), Silent Move +10%, Speak Language (Breton) He took her to the road, let her go, and disappeared back into the forest. There, he was approached by a Faceless and invited Talents: Coolheaded, Marksman, Mighty Shot, Public to join the Herrimaults; the Faceless said he had already proved Speaking, Rapid Reload, Rover, Seasoned Traveller, Sixth he had the necessary skill and moral character. Carlomax Sense, Specialist Weapon Group (Entangling, Longbow), eagerly agreed, as he had nowhere else to go. Strike Mighty Blow, Strike to Injure, Sure Shot, Unsettling, Carlomax fit in perfectly and quickly proved to be a talented Very Resilient, Very Strong Herrimault. He rose through the ranks and became a Faceless himself. Oppressive nobles were his particular target, and so it Special Rules: was that he became involved in the uprising at Derrevin Libre. Carmolax gets a +10% bonus to Common Knowledge He hoped to be able to kill the nobleman and then escape (Bretonnia) Tests related to Aquitaine. before the counterattack. The delay in the counterattack caught him by surprise, and he formed a grand, wild plan: maybe he Armour: Medium Armour (Full Leather Armour and Mail could liberate the whole of Bretonnia from oppression! Coif— under Mysterious Hood). Carlomax is now a revolutionary idealist with enough experience of guerrilla warfare to be a real problem for the nobility. He is Armour Points: Head 3, Arms 1, Body 1, Legs 1 also only too aware that a concerted attack by the nobility would Weapons: Hand weapon (sword), Longsword, Net crush his fledgling republic, and he is keen to hire agents to keep Trappings: Band of Herrimaults, Free Peasant Republic (one the nobles distracted, ideally fighting each other.

village) Adventure Hooks

He does, however, hire adventurers, asking them to bring him The Duke's Family a particular stuffed stag's head from the closest keep. He offers a significant amount of money and the right to keep any other The old Duke of Aquitaine died in battle whilst intervening in

treasure that they find, as long as they bring the head. Several one of the dukedom's interminable feuds. Four of his sons had groups have gone in, but none have yet returned. died before him: one in battle like his father, one of plague, one of an overdose, and one from an apparent case of warpstone Derrevin Libre poisoning. His youngest son was feeble-minded and kept locked away. However, he also had two daughters, and normally Derrevin Libre is a village in eastern Aquitaine where they would have inherited. The King chose to pass over them peasants hold power. Their previous lord was truly repellent, and grant the dukedom to Armand, his standard-bearer and, and when the peasants rebelled, none of his neighbours cared significantly, a Grail Knight. to help him. As a result, for almost the first time, a peasant The significance of the deaths of the Duke's sons has not gone rebellion succeeded, exposing the lord as a servant of Nurgle unnoticed, and some people think the King also suspected and destroying him and his whole family. Normally, the local lords would immediately have poured in to re-establish the rightful order of things. However, they were distracted by three separate feuds, and none of them dared to move. This gave the peasants time to consolidate, attract several bands of Herrimaults, and prepare for the inevitable counterattack. The loss of over a dozen knights after they charged straight into a pit trap is not spoken of among nobles by anyone who values his life.

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the involvement of the Ruinous Powers. Unfortunately, whilst lord immediately decides that the player characters are the Duke Armand is above suspicion of personal corruption, he ringleaders and offers the peasants clemency if they turn them is utterly unsuited to making subtle enquiries. Some other, over. The peasants don't believe him and will not hand the disposable, agents are needed. People like the adventurers. characters over as long as the revolution is going well. If things turn against them, they will feel they have no choice. Revolution Day Of course, the only competent leaders and warriors in the village are the adventurers. If they aren't to be handed over as The player characters are staying in a village when the ringleaders, they have to become the ringleaders. peasants decide to rise up and overthrow their lord. The

— Artois —

The land of Artois is dominated by the dense and dukedom exists. Those villages sited on a major road might see a

mysterious Forest of Arden. Apart from a small strip of traveller once per week, but those further into the depths of the land in the western reaches, the whole of the dukedom lies woods might not see an outsider in a lifetime. Leaving the village within that dark woodland. The land outside the forest is predominantly arable, and is home to is regarded as suicidal folly. In most places, people most of the dukedom's Human population. hold funerals for those who leave and assume that The forest is not completely devoid of Human those who return are Undead. The nobility travel inhabitants, however. Apart from woodsmen to the ducal court at least once per year and so and charcoal burners, the forest is also home to generally avoid truly extreme isolation.

Residents

a number of village settlements. Each of these of these villages, on the whole, know almost villages is surrounded by a ditch, bank, and wooden nothing of the outside world. stockade. The stone keep of the noble lord granted the Adventurers from the west of Artois generally land typically also serves as the gate to the village. The leave home because it is expected and encouraged. villagers raise animals because, unlike crops, animals can Indeed, western Artois produces more adventurers be brought within the stockade when they are attacked. per head of population than anywhere else in Attacks are common. Wolves and bears are the least of Bretonnia. Adventurers from eastern Artois usually leave the worries; groups of Beastmen are far from uncommon. because they can no longer stand living in the same place, Indeed, a village in the forest can expect to be attacked by hemmed in by the threatening woods. Beastmen at least once a year. The Dukes of Artois have long Western Artois is all ruled by the Earl Larret, the cultured scion made grants of land in the forest to brave younger sons of of a cultured dynasty. He is rumoured to have spent much of Bretonnian nobles because the ones who succeed establish his time of errantry disguised as a minstrel, rather than fighting vital outposts against dark forces. However, most fail, and like a proper knight. He has never dignified the rumour destroyed villages dot the dukedom's eastern regions. with a response, and when he has taken the field, he has Beastmen are the most common monsters in the forest. For acquitted himself honourably. Whatever his background, he some reason, Artois sees particularly large numbers of Brays, is a masterful politician and has made western Artois peaceful which are generally used as cannon fodder by their Gor and loyal to him, rather than the Duke. He is thought to be superiors. That is not to say that there are few Gors; there are planning to petition the King for baronial status. just uncountable Brays. Eastern Artois is made up of independent fiefs too concerned Other creatures touched by Chaos are also common in Artois, with surviving in a hostile forest to get involved with politics.

and some lost villages appear to have been torn apart not by the Duke who is most active here, hunting down Beastmen and outside depredations of Beastmen, but by Mutants arising within occasionally riding to the rescue of a besieged settlement. Even the population. Indeed, the level of mutation leads many to more occasionally, he arrives in time to do more than scare off suspect that there is a potent source of Chaos somewhere within carrion crows. Artois; anyone who could find and destroy it would be a hero. Slanderous rumours suggest there are Chaos cultists among the eastern nobility and even that there are villages where the People inhabitants willingly consort with Beastmen. The knowledgeable dismiss the latter rumours and worry about the former. The peasants and nobles of the western reaches of Artois are the most widely known noble within the forest is Baron much like their neighbours in Lyonesse or L'Anguille. Indeed, Chlodogar, a Grail Knight. He actually requested lands within many of them barely think of themselves as Artois. They like the Forest of Arden, and he personally leads a group of his to emphasise how much they are a part of the wider culture peasants on a trip to the city of L'Anguille every year. He is active of Bretonnia and the Old World, and younger people are in expanding his fief, which now consists of three settlements, encouraged to travel. and the visits to L'Anguille mean the peasants know far more of The residents of the forest also barely think of themselves the world than most peasants anywhere in Bretonnia. Chlodogar as Artois. Indeed, many of them are only dimly aware he has also overseen the construction of a Grail Chapel in each village, fortified and designed to provide a place to fall back to.

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Each Chapel has a bell tower, people do everything they can but the bell is only rung to to avoid taking a case before summon help in the case of Sayings of Artois the Duke, which is the way attack. Chalfrey likes it.

“Half-sister/half-brother”: Sweetheart. Origins

Whilst Duke Chalfrey obscure; either an insult against the eastern folk or basically ignores his something that originated in earnest in a particularly Significant neighbours and rarely attends inbred forest village. Now neutral in meaning, but even the Royal Court unless very confusing for outsiders. Places summoned, Duke Adalhard

of Lyonesse is trying to win “He’s turned forester”: He won’t leave the house or talk Castle Artois the Earl Larret over to his to anyone. Only used in the west.

fealty, thus expanding his “I’d rather climb a tree”: I will absolutely not do that. The seat of the Dukes of

dukedom and confining Eastern origin but used everywhere. (If you are up a Artois is located

within the
Artois entirely to the forest. tree, it is hard to reach the village stockade ahead of Forest of Arden.
As a result,
The Earl is resisting, more out attacking Beastmen.) it is the only ducal seat with
of desire for independence no town outside the walls.
than any loyalty to Artois. The castle itself, however, has
a substantial keep and a very
large courtyard surrounded by a stone curtain wall. There is
Duke Chilfroy of Artois a ditch beyond the wall, but it is filled with sharpened stakes

Duke Chilfroy is a huge man, stronger and tougher than any rather than with water. Duke Chilfroy
is always based here, but
of his knights or nobles. He is also famously grim: he has never he spends about half his time
riding out to hunt Beastmen.
been heard to laugh and
reputedly only smiles when “There’s fine timber to be had from the forest, but never The
courtyard contains
surveying the devastation he go to get it yourself.” accommodation for many
has wrought on his enemies. warriors. The Duke found the
Whilst not a subtle man, he — L’Anguillian merchant. ability to retreat swiftly after a
is a great war leader when successful battle is vital in the
strategies are simple and “I took the route through eastern Artois once. forest, accounting for the
high
his followers need only be Quadruple pay, they offered. Never again. Although number of
mounted yeomen
inspired. they’re up to sextuple now, I hear.” here. The large number of
The Duke spends most of horses means that the castle
his time hunting beasts, — Eldergar of Busreq, Coachman needs even more supplies than
normal; the stream of wagons
is almost constant.
Beastmen, and other monsters “Don’t eat the pork.”
in the depths of the Forest of
Arden. The great hall of Castle — Anonymous Lyonessan Mother The Duke disdains using
mercenaries in battle, but he
Artois is decorated with the does hire expendable outsiders
preserved heads and pelts of his greatest victories. He holds the reputation as opponents of
duc law court there and is notorious for dealing with cases as scouts. Any characters with a
turning up at the castle and
quickly by declaring the higher-ranked party to be in the right, Chaos can find work simply by
handing down brutal punishments to the loser. As a result, asking.

Larret

Larret, the largest town in Artois, is almost a city. It is in
the southwestern part of the dukedom, near the old border
between Mousillon and Lyonesse. Whilst it is distant from
any competing cities, it is too far from major trade routes to
become a major settlement in its own right, something that the

Earl Larret, the town's ruler, recognises.

Larret is a remarkably pleasant place to visit or to live. Many streets are paved, and almost all of the remainder are cobbled. Underground sewers take waste to a river, dumping it some distance from the walls. Most houses are well built and maintained, and the City Watch is active in preventing and investigating crime, no matter who the victim is. The town is also extremely friendly to entertainers and scholars. The Earl tolerates almost anything, and even those who cross the line (by actually inciting violence, for example) get a friendly warning the first time.

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Artois Boars

Artois Boars are Wild Boars that have been touched by Chaos. Whilst they are found throughout the Forest of Arden, they have never been seen beyond it, and most are found within the dukedom of Artois. They are even more bad-tempered than normal Wild Boars and are entirely carnivorous, preferring to eat living prey. Prey that screams and curses whilst it is being eaten is particularly popular. Peasants say if you can stay still and quiet whilst the boar is eating you, it will lose interest. Peasants say a lot of stupid things. Artois Boars are around five feet high at the shoulder, and normally appear fat. They are, however, extremely fast and strong. Many have mutations, but the race is stable overall.

Artois Boar Statistics

Main Profile

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

20% 5%

40% 0% 51% 54% 32% 10%

IP FP

Secondary Profile 0 0

A W SB TB M Mag

2 20 5 5 8 0

Skills: Concealment, Follow Trail, Perception +10%, Silent Move

Talents: Keen Senses, Natural Weapons, Night Vision

Special Rules:

Mutation: An Artois Boar has a 40% chance of having a single Chaos Mutation. Use common sense when applying the mutations to a quadruped.

Thick Skin: Due to their unusually thick skin, Artois Boars reduce the Critical Values of Critical Hits against them by 1.

Tusks: When an Artois Boar makes a charge attack, its tusks count as having the Impact Quality.

Armour: None

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0, Body 0, Legs 0

Weapons: Tusks

This status is maintained by a ruthless policy of deportation. to be distracted by small things like his skin turning blue and

The lazy, incompetent, and persistently criminal are simply horns growing out of his head. He rallied the villagers and led a removed from the town and told never to come back. When the successful defence of their home.

population grows to the point that the town's economy cannot Afterwards, he held a court at which those villagers too insane to

support everyone, the poorest people are rounded up and exiled live with others were tried and executed. He accepted the village

in the same way. Any exile found within three hours' walk of was now completely cut off from Bretonnian society, though that

Larret after sundown is subject to summary execution. Visitors made little practical difference, and decided to try to gather more

do not know about this, and residents try not to think about it. Mutants. A few agents were sent out to spread rumours, and the

best woodsmen scour the surroundings for abandoned children.

The City of Beastmen The village has grown, and there are now about 300 Mutants

living there. Residents have begun looking for a second site. It is

Rumours of a city of Beastmen within the Forest of Arden have not yet a city, but it has the potential to become one.

circulated for years, possibly centuries. Whilst they cannot be

proved to be false, they are extremely unlikely; Beastmen do Example Artois

not have the right mentality to build cities.

Mutants, however, are a different matter. Many retain their The Earl Larret

Human psychology and, after being cast out of their homes,

want to find a new community. The Earl Larret is a very ambitious man. He has also advanced

Five years ago, the fief of Uesin, in the depths of the forest, about as far as he can without forcing major political changes,

was attacked by Skaven. The Ratmen first poisoned the water which makes him very dangerous to people in his way, such as

with warpstone and then attacked as the mutations took hold. the Duke of Artois. Ideally, the Earl would like to see a scandal

Unfortunately for them, the lord, Sir Madregang, was not about

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The Earl Larret minstrel, mainly in Tilea, during his period of errantry. His tolerance of scholars comes from a similar feeling, and whilst

Race: Human he has no tolerance for servants of the Ruinous Powers, he

Career: Politician (ex-Entertainer, ex-Minstrel, ex-Noble, does give scholars the benefit of the doubt, which can be dangerous.

ex-Rogue) In person, the Earl, who is now in his late fifties, balding, and a little overweight, is very pleasant. He listens to what people

Main Profile say before making his decisions and takes no pleasure in other people's suffering. On the other hand, he is absolutely ruthless.

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel He would never order someone tortured to death, but he has no qualms about ordering quick executions. Indeed, he

41% 41% 38% 41% 45% 63% 37% 64% prefers not to mutilate people and often executes them instead.

Crippled criminals do not often make a useful contribution to Secondary Profile society, after all.

He makes an excellent patron for player characters, as he has

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP lots of schemes in which he can use them. There is a risk that he will fall to Chaos, but it is not large. His main weakness

1 14 3 3 4 0 0 0 is for his son, Fredemund, whom he desperately wants to see become a Grail Knight. Characters might be asked to extract

Skills: Academic Knowledge (History, Law), Animal Care, the heir to the earldom from all kinds of scrapes.

Blather, Charm +20%, Command +10%, Common

Knowledge (Bretonnia +20%, Estalia, Tilea +10%), Adventure Hooks

Evaluate, Gossip +20%, Haggle, Perception +10%,

Performer (Actor, Musician +20%, Singer +10%), Read/ The Fall of Duke Chilfroy

Write +10%, Ride, Search, Secret Language (Thieves'

Tongue), Secret Signs (Thief), Sleight of Hand, Speak The Duke spends a lot of time riding into the depths of the

Language (Breton +20%, Eltharin, Tilean) forest. What if he is not fighting the Beastmen, but allying with

them? Certainly, the penalties he hands down in court have

Talents: Dealmaker, Etiquette, Flee!, Lightning Reflexes, Luck, become particularly bloody of late. The Earl Larret would love

Master Orator, Public Speaking, Savvy, Schemer, Sixth to have evidence that the Duke was in league with the Ruinous

Sense, Streetwise, Strong-minded Powers. He won't even mind if the evidence has been, how to put it, improved slightly.

Special Rules:

The Earl Larret gets a +10% to all Common Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests concerned with Artois.

Armour: Light Armour (Best Craftsmanship Leather Jack)
Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0, Body 1, Legs 0
Weapons: Best Craftsmanship Hand Weapon (sword)

bring down the house of Duke Chilfroy, opening the way for The Village
him to become Duke of Artois. From there, he would be in a
position to see his son, Fredemund, become king. The isolated villages in the Forest of Arden are
perfect sites
The Earl is also a genuinely cultured individual. He does for adventures. The player characters
stop there, and the
not consider satirical entertainers as part of a nefarious plot; villagers beg them to help defend
the village against a band of
he tolerates them because he finds them amusing and can't Beastmen. The adventurers lead a
desperate defence and secure
imagine killing a minstrel simply for offending him. The victory. Afterwards, the villagers stage a
wild victory celebration
rumours, incidentally, are true; he did spend some time as a and drag a statue of a
hermaphroditic figure to the centre of
the village, prostrating themselves before it.

— Bastonne —

Bastonne contains a wide variety of the border with Quenelles. Where the Massif
landscapes. It is bounded on its northern meets the Forest of Châlons, the Chasm is over
and eastern sides by the River Grismerie and in two hundred yards wide and so deep it might be
the south by the Gilleau. The western part of bottomless. The Chasm appears to run into the
the dukedom is mainly arable, whilst the eastern forest, but following it in is rendered impossible
regions are pastoral. The mountains of the Massif by undergrowth, and searching for it from
within
Orcal spill over from Quenelles, and to their the forest is always unsuccessful.
west, much of the Forest of Châlons lies within Black fogs often arise from the Chasm, chilling
this dukedom. those caught within them to the point of death,
The most notable geographic feature, however, is even at the height of summer. Fortunately, the
the Black Chasm. This rift in the earth runs along the fogs do not travel far from the Chasm, and
even
northern edge of the Massif Orcal, becoming narrower Bretonnian knights have more sense than
to build
and shallower to the east, and disappearing just before villages right at the rim. The Chasm
Spawn (see below) are

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more of a problem, as they “The heirs of Gilles le Breton will always uphold the The People
can travel further.

The Chasm is not entirely honour of Bretonnia, no matter how far others may Bastonnians like to

think

a bad thing, however, as it fall.” of themselves as the heart stops the Orcs of the Massif of Bretonnia. They are the Orcal from raiding into the — Sir Darrepin the Furious people of Gilles the Unifier, heart of the dukedom. It also and the dukedom is roughly serves to cut off the villages “Biggest pilgrim trap in the country. If Gilles the in the physical centre of in the mountains. They are Unifier really slept in all those places, he wouldn’t have the nation. They have more ruled by a Baron, Lothar the had time to fight any battles.” pride in their nation than Ready, who is also a Marquis. do the people of any other He takes his responsibilities — Eldegar of Busreq, Coachman dukedom, and the worship very seriously, but he does not of the Lady of the Lake is really see himself as part of “Yes, but who’s the king now?” popular with peasants as well Bastonne. as nobles. Bastonnians have — dozens of exasperated Couronner nobles

The Forest of Châlons is almost a strong tendency to believe completely uninhabited by Humans within Bastonne. There that Bretonnians have certain virtues, particularly courage and are a handful of logging villages along the edge, but they rarely honour, that set them apart from all other nations, and that last more than five years, and it is becoming almost impossible Bastonnians display those virtues to the greatest extent. This to find people willing to go. The Forest is the haunt of Undead, often makes them rather pompous and chauvinistic.

Beastmen, and Undead Beastmen, and they frequently raid to It also provides the main motivation for Bastonnian adventurers: the north. they are travelling to prove that Bretonnians are superior to

Chasm Spawn

Chasm Spawn crawl out of the Black Chasm and then wander Bastonne, attacking and trying to eat anything in their path, including Humans, horses, rocks, and trees. They seem to be almost mindless, but they are dangerous all the same.

They look rather like enormous frogs and can leap long distances, though they prefer not to. Each is about ten feet tall at the shoulder, larger than many peasant houses. Their skin is black and tough rather than slimy.

Young Chasm Spawn have never been observed, but the stability of their shape means that most scholars believe they have nothing to do with Chaos. A few scholars would love to sponsor an expedition to the depths of the Chasm to find out more, as long as they don’t have to go along.

Chasm Spawn Statistics

Main Profile

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

28% 5%

40% 0% 60% 56% 23% 5%

IP FP

Secondary Profile 0 0

A W SB TB M Mag

1 32 6 5 4 0

Skills: Perception +20%

Talents: Natural Weapons, Scales (3)

Special Rules:

Leap: Once per combat the Chasm Spawn may leap up to 20 yards, passing over any obstacles in the way. They normally use this to escape.

Armour: None

Armour Points: Head 3, Arms 3, Body 3, Legs 3

Weapons: Bite

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everyone else. In the best cases, “Beastslayer.” He is also famous they strive to demonstrate their for refusing to fight inferior prowess. In the worst cases, they Sayings of Bastonne opponents; even if they attack

spend their time belittling the “He’s listening to the dragon”: He’s a bit mad. him, he merely stuns them so

achievements of other nations, that he can turn his attention

but do little themselves. “... and Grand Admiral of the Bastonnian Navy.”: elsewhere. As his prowess has

Appended to someone’s list of titles if the speaker

Bastonne’s nobles contain feels that they are impressive sounding but grown, the search for worthy

an unusual number of Grail meaningless. foes has taken him to many

Knights, and corrupt nobles “I’ll do it right after I get back from the Black places within Bretonnia and

are far rarer here than in Chasm.”: I’m not going to do it. beyond. He was one of the few other dukedoms. However, Dukes to ride personally to the competent nobles also seem to aid of the Empire against the be rare; most Bastonnian nobles Storm of Chaos.

couldn't organise a fight in a Waaaugh!. And, whilst the knights Whilst Bohemond is a lineal descendant of Gilles le Breton, are noble, their stewards, bailiffs, and justiciars seem to be at best he is absolutely loyal to King Louen and has no desire venal, at worst servants of the Ruinous Powers. The dukedom for the crown. Indeed, he delegates the whole business of is rife with injustice, most of which the nobility would quickly administering his dukedom to his steward and justice to his rectify, if only they knew. justiciar. Alas, he is not a very good judge of character, and Bastonne and Bordeleaux have good relations since the time of finds himself replacing these men with distressing frequency. Gilles the Unifier, but relations with Gisoreux and, particularly,

S PMontfort are strained. Both of the latter dukedoms are short on land that isn't either forest or mountains. Montfort, for ignificant laces

example, has virtually no land outside the Grey Mountains. Castle Bastonne

The border lords are constantly looking at the expanse of Castle Bastonne is located almost exactly in the centre of the Bastonne and plotting ways to expand their holdings. Cross- dukedom. The whole of it and the surrounding town are filled border private wars are a constant feature of life, but so far the with antiquities made sacred by their association with Gilles the Dukes themselves have kept out of it. Unifier. Old buildings, statues, and bones, including the head

Duke Bohemond of Bastonne of Smearghus stand testimony to Gilles's prowess. As well, a few ancient stone structures remain as well as a number of sections of the former castle are carefully preserved. Peasants and foreigners Duke Bohemond of Bastonne is a Grail Knight, particularly renowned for fighting monsters, to the point that he is known as are forbidden to enter these places, and even nobles are expected to treat everything with respect. Things have happened over the past 1,500 years, and not everything lovingly preserved has any link to the Unifier. The largest revered structure is the Water Tower in Castle Bastonne. This was reputedly Gilles'ss personal residence. Most nobles are not allowed to go beyond the entrance lobby, and peasants can be whipped for looking at it too much. Every so often rumours surface about dark acts performed in secret within the tower, but they are quickly suppressed.

The town has the feel of somewhere preserved for the pilgrim trade, and indeed, it is a very popular destination. Peasant pilgrims are guided to the outside of a number of significant locations and to the inside of taverns that pay the guide a cut. Nobles can expect a personal tour, including opportunities to

pray within most places. At a minimum, visiting nobles go to Gilles's personal Grail Chapel, and almost all Grail Knights have visited it at least once.

The Humble Chapel

The Humble Chapel has stood for over a thousand years, by far the oldest Grail Chapel established by and maintained by peasants. It is found a couple of days west of Castle Bastonne, just outside a village that caters almost entirely to visiting pilgrims. Despite its name, the structure is spectacular. Built of decorated brick, carved wooden beams, brilliant stained glass windows, bronze, silver, and even gold statues, and roofed in glass, it looks

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Sir Darrepin the Furious

Race: Human
Career: Knight Errant

Main Profile

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

33% 29% 35% 28% 36% 24% 29% 31%

Secondary Profile

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

1 12 3 2 4 0 0 0

more splendid than almost any other Grail Chapel in the land. Skills: Academic Knowledge (Genealogy/Heraldry), Animal
Over the centuries, almost all the gifts made by peasants to the Care, Animal Training, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia,
Lady have come to this Chapel, and it shows. the Empire), Dodge Blow, Gossip, Outdoor Survival, Ride,
Popular legend claims the Lady of the Lake appeared on this Speak Language (Breton, Reikspiel) spot to a brave, loyal, and obedient peasant named Gademar.
She praised his fine service to his lord and allowed him to Talents: Etiquette, Luck, Seasoned Traveller, Specialist Weapon
touch the foot of the Grail with the very tips of his fingers. Group (Cavalry), Stout-hearted, Strike Mighty Blow
Most nobles reject this story as patent fabrication; the Lady

would never deign to speak to a mere peasant, and she certainly Special Rules:
would not let him so sully the Grail. Only a handful of Grail Sir Darrepin gets a +10% bonus to all
Common Knowledge

Knights have ever visited the Chapel, but from time to time (Bretonnia) Tests concerned with the
dukedom of Bastonne.

Damsels and Prophetesses of the Lady come and speak at the
services, and the contents of these speeches have great import. Armour: Medium Armour (Mail
Shirt, Mail Coif, Leather
Jack, Helmet)

Armour Points: Head 5, Arms 3, Body 3, Legs 3

Weapons: Lance, Hand Weapon (sword)

Trappings: Light Warhorse with Saddle and Harness, Small

Icon of the Lady of the Lake, Boundless Confidence

Example Bastonnian Note: If you want to use Sir Darrepin repeatedly in your
campaign, it is appropriate to give him two Fate Points.

Sir Darrepin the Furious

Adventure Hooks

Sir Darrepin is a very young Knight Errant, barely started on
his career, and he isn't furious at all; he just thinks the name The Frogs of War
makes him sound more impressive. He is the fourth son of a
household knight at the court of a relatively small landholder The Black Chasm suddenly starts
producing more Chasm
in northern Bastonne, quite near the Mousillon border, and he Spawn than anyone can
remember. Whilst the knights of
has no hope of any inheritance beyond the knightly equipment Bastonne easily defeat the
creatures, there seems to be no end
he was given when he came of age. to them. The Duke needs some brave souls to enter the
Black

Partly for that reason, and partly because he wants to show the Chasm, find out what is
happening, and stop it. All the knights
world that the spirit of the Grail Companions is not dead, he of the dukedom are eager to go, but
unfortunately, their duty
set out into the world, determined to show his prowess. He is to protect their fiefs means that
they cannot enter the Chasm
earnest, enthusiastic, energetic, and prone to getting in well from which no one has ever
returned. The adventurers don't
over his head. He also seems possessed of uncanny luck that have a fief, though, do they?
gets him out of trouble again.

Sir Darrepin takes a slightly condescending attitude to The Bailiff and the Faceless
foreigners, being convinced that Bretonnians are superior. He is
astonishingly good at rationalising away evidence to the contrary. The adventurers are hired by a
noble's bailiff to bring a bandit

However, he is not hostile and takes his duty to protect his chief back, dead or alive. As they
investigate, they find the
inferiors as seriously as he takes everything else. bandits are Herrimaults and the bailiff is

extorting excess

Sir Darrepin can be encountered absolutely anywhere, singing money from the peasants. The

Herrimaults also seem very well

the praises of Bretonnia, particularly of Bastonne. He makes informed, and when the

adventurers ride out with the noble

a good ally-cum-plot-hook-cum-comic-interlude, since he is and his bailiff, the Faceless is not

with the group that ambushes

about as stereotypical as a Bretonnian knight can be and gets them. If the characters keep

watch, they can see the noble slip

himself into constant trouble whilst not being incompetent. away into the forest... to join a

Chaos cult. Is the bailiff playing

a double game? Is the noble spying on the cult? Are they both

corrupt, and the Faceless a third party entirely?

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— Bordeleaux —

Bordeleaux is mostly arable land with some pastoral land pay tribute to the sea God, the

Bordelen are particularly

near the coast. The cliffs of Bordeleaux are particularly fervent, and even the nobles pay more than lip service to him.

high and spectacular, but whilst there are some offshore islands, Bordelen nobles tend to think that the domain of the Lady of

there are very few of the concealed rocks and currents that the Lake ends where the water turns salt.

make L'Anguille's coast so hazardous. Whilst the best port is at

the city of Bordeleaux itself, there are over a dozen The maritime traditions of the dukedom have created

other substantial natural harbours and even more a split between the nobles. Those living inland fishing villages, many cut into the towering cliffs. are much like nobles anywhere else in Bretonnia,

The southeast corner of Bordeleaux is covered primarily worshipping the Lady of the Lake and

by the Forest of Châlons. The western end of the drawing their wealth from land. Those on the

Forest is less dangerous than the portion within coast worship Manann before anyone else and

Bastonne, and a number of villages seem to be hold little land, drawing their wealth from the sea,

flourishing within it. Nevertheless, Beastmen raid instead. These nobles are as likely to send their sons

the villages fairly frequently and the inhabitants of

the woods are particularly self-reliant. out on a ship as to send them on an errantry tour.

There is no real hostility between the two groups, but

there is a profound lack of understanding.

In the north, Bordeleaux has a substantial border with Bordeleaux has good relations with Bastonne and

the cursed land of Mousillon. At the mouth of the river, this Aquitaine, but its only relations with

Mousillon are expressed
is a high escarpment where the coastal hills of Bordeleaux abut in knights given fiefs along the river with the responsibility
the low-lying swamp that is Mousillon. As you turn upstream, for keeping monsters where they belong. There is, however, a
however, the Bordeleaux side falls whilst the Mousillon side rises, strong rivalry between Bordeleaux and L'Anguille, born from
so that for over half of the border's length the River Grismerie is commercial competition. L'Anguille is easily the stronger
the only barrier between the dukedoms. It is not very effective as trading port, so the rivalry is felt much more strongly in
such, and things frequently come across. Undead are the most Bordeleaux.
common problem, but bandits, Beastmen, and Chaos Spawn are
also frequent menaces. The river itself is largely abandoned for Duke Alberic of Bordeleaux fear of the things that live in it.
Duke Alberic is renowned for his personal courage and
astounding self-discipline. He is also notorious for expecting
The People all of his household knights to reach the same standard and for
dismissing those who do not. As a result, he has the smallest
In stark contrast to their disciplined Duke, the people of household of any of the Dukes, but the knights there are some
Bordeleaux are renowned for spending their entire lives tipsy, of the greatest in the realm.
if not completely rat-arsed. This is, of course, not universally
true. Bordeleaux is home to many experienced sailors, and The Duke has always wanted to go on the quest for the Grail,
the perpetually drunk do not reach that status. It is true the but his father died when he was still out on his errantry tour,
wine produced along the Bordelen coast is particularly fine, and Alberic has never felt able to hand the responsibilities of
normally abundant, and mostly consumed locally. Bordelens the dukedom on to someone else. His eldest son, Frermund,
even drink unwatered wine with some frequency. Local wine, would be a fine candidate, but he left on his own Grail Quest.
of any quality, is half the normal price in Bordeleaux; wine This and the Duke's advancing age seem to have pushed him to
from other regions is triple the price of the local produce. do more than wish; solid rumour suggests that he is looking for
a reliable steward to run the dukedom in his absence.
A fair number of Bordelen
adventurers do so to get away
from the constant drinking, Sayings of Bordeleaux Significant
brawling, puking, and passing Places
out. Many are thus deeply "Completely wasted": Sober. The idea is that alcohol,
disappointed in their comrades. or an opportunity, has been wasted. Bordeleaux
Others left because they had
the misfortune to be born near
the border of Mousillon and "Drinks like the sea": Drinks a large amount of The city of Bordeleaux
thought that a life of adventure alcohol. is an ancient foundation

sounded like a safer option. “He takes his wine salted”: He is sober quite a lot of and a bustling port. Castle the time. A reference to sailors. Bordeleaux, seat of the Duke, One notable feature of looks out over the whole city Bordelen life is the popularity “Whirlpool in a wine-glass”: An argument, feud, or from a cliff rising over the of Manann along the coast. war due entirely to drunkenness. harbour, and the siege engines

Whilst sailors everywhere on the wall can reach any point

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Dracoleech

The Dracoleech is a horrible Undead monster found almost exclusively in the River Grismerie between Mousillon and Bordeleaux, though some have been known to swim further upstream. The creatures are serpentine in form, between twenty and thirty feet long and about four feet across. Their skin is rubbery, slimy, and rotten, and there are no bones within. For mouths, they have circles of teeth, constantly pulsing, that can swallow a child or Halfling in one gulp. Their preferred mode of attack is to come up under a boat, tipping any passengers and crew into the water where they can be chewed at leisure. They can also jump onto a small boat, smashing it, but they cannot stay out of the water for long.

Dracoleech Statistics

Main Profile

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

5%

35% 0% 60% 38% 40% 10% 28%

FP

Secondary Profile 0

A W SB TB M Mag IP

1 31 6 3 1 0 0

Skills: Dodge Blow +10%

Talents: Frightening, Natural Weapons, Scales (2), Undead

Special Rules:

Capsize: Dracoleeches can capsize boats with a maximum capacity of six Humans or fewer. This takes an attack action

and succeeds if the Dracoleech succeeds at a Strength Test. Dracoleeches can also crash onto larger boats. This requires a successful Agility Test, and if it hits it does SB+2 damage to the boat, and SB damage to the Dracoleech itself. Passengers on the boat can automatically get out of the way of the falling monster, unless they are paralysed with Fear.

Water Creature: A Dracoleech has a Movement of 8 in water.

Armour: None

Armour Points: Head 2, Body 2

Weapons: Bite

in the bay or the city itself. It is said the engineers are good it has survived for many years. Worshippers travel out by boat, enough to sink a moored rowboat without affecting the boats and if possible they are supposed to help row or sail across. to either side. Grail Knights and Damsels and Prophetesses of the Lady are forbidden to set foot on board. Duke Alberic is the first Duke The First Chapel, housed within Castle Bordeleaux, is the of Bordeleaux in generations most sacred Grail Chapel to visit the temple. in Bretonnia. The Dukes willingly pay a large share of its upkeep, because it brings “I spent three years in Duke Alberic’s household. Hated The Silent Isle them a lot of status, and most every single second of it. But you know, no opponent of the Dukes of Bordeleaux scares me now.” A couple of miles off the have been Grail Knights. central coast of Bordeleaux — Sir Thopas, whilst fighting a horde of Beastmen there is an island. A century

However, the most important “I believe it is traditional for Bordelen men to sober ago, it was the seat of a noble temple is that of Manann, up for their birthday, if their age ends in a zero and fief, and fishing and trading which is not exactly in the Mannslieb is full.” vessels departed from its city. Rather, it is housed in an harbour in large numbers. enormous ship, permanently — Gustav von Marksheim, Student and Imperial And then, one day, there moored near the entrance to expatriate, ten-year resident of Bordeleaux were none. Overnight, all the harbour. It is exposed to of the boats and islanders storms, but the priests say “You gets too sober, you sees them and goes mad. Poof!” vanished. What is more, it that Manann protects it, and now seems to be impossible — Extremely earnest Bordeleaux Burgher.

Lord Savaric been known to visit Turris Vigilans, but the purpose of the visits remains a secret. It is widely known that the priests offer
Race: Human advice to those who seek their counsel, and that the advice is
Career: Noble Lord (ex-Mate, ex-Sea Captain, ex-Seaman) very good. Anyone purchasing one of their many books gets an
automatic hearing; others put their names into a lottery, which
Main Profile the clergy draws from every day. The priests sometimes offer
unsolicited advice, as well, particularly advice that recommends
WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel that adventurers should venture into Mousillon.

48% 59% 43% 56% 47% 50% 55% 58% Example Bordelen

Secondary Profile Lord Savaric

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP Lord Savaric is lord of a small fief on the coast of Bordeleaux.
He served his errantry on the waves and never spent a single
3 18 2 3 4 0 0 0 night out of earshot of the ocean. He claims to have visited
every port of the Old World, and whilst that is an exaggeration,
Skills: Academic Knowledge (Strategy/Tactics), Animal Training, he is extremely well travelled.
He only settled down, he claims,
Common Knowledge (the Border Princes, Bretonnia, because of old age.
Dwarfs, Elves, the Empire, Estalia, Kislev, Norsca, Tilea, the He has not, in fact, slowed down at
all by his advancing years,
Wasteland), Consume Alcohol, Dodge Blow +20%, Gamble, and this has started to worry him.
He is past sixty and has the
Gossip, Intimidate, Perception, Row, Sail, Scale Sheer Surface, white hair and wrinkled features
of an old man, but he still has
Speak Language (Breton, Eltharin, Estalian, Kislevian, all the vigour he had in his youth. Whilst
many people would
Norscan, Reikspiel, Tilean), Swim, Trade (Shipwright) think this a blessing, Lord Savaric has seen
too much to be so
complacent: he is sure it is a curse. He was a pirate for some
Talents: Coolheaded, Disarm, Hardy, Resistance to Disease, of his errantry years and committed
deeds quite sufficient to
Seasoned Traveller, Specialist Weapon Group (Fencing), deserve cursing.
Strike Might Blow, Swashbuckler He plans to go on a last quest, to find the source of the curse
and undo it. If the clues he finds lead inland, he hires others to
Special Rules: search for him.
Lord Savaric gets a +10% to Common Knowledge
(Bretonnia) Tests concerned with Bordeleaux. Adventure Hooks

Armour: Light Armour (Full Leather Armour) Sail Away
Armour Points: Head 1, Arms 1, Body 1, Legs 1
Weapons: Rapier, Shortbow. The characters are all on board the temple of Manann at
Bordeleaux when the ship starts to move. The priests are in
to make any noise on the island. A few groups of adventurers something of a panic; the temple
isn't supposed to move, and

have investigated and fell into two groups. Some were spooked isn't really designed to. It soon becomes clear it is sailing quite by the silence within a few hours and came back with little purposefully, which it certainly isn't equipped to manage. The information. Others never returned. priests soon conclude Manann wants those on board to be Since nothing has come off the island to bother the somewhere and start praying for guidance. Player characters Bordelens, most are content to leave it to the peace and quiet it seems to desire. may have other ideas.

Turris Vigilans Silenced

Turris Vigilans is a temple of Verena that stands on an isolated headland in the north of the dukedom. The characters wake up to find it serves as a lighthouse the village they were staying in and has a reputation of one of unnaturally quiet. Indeed, they the most reliable in the world. Its seem to be only living beings left primary purpose, however, is to and even they cannot make any keep a watch on Mousillon. The noise until they leave the village. priests of the temple are rumoured Where have the villagers gone, to use powerful magic, granted and why were the characters by their Goddess, to scry on the left behind? Some adventurers whole of the cursed dukedom. will immediately seek answers. They refuse to say what they are Others will do nothing until it has looking for or what they will do happened three nights on the run. if they find it. The priests are similarly insistent that they must not enter Mousillon personally. Prophetesses of the Lady and the Fay Enchantress herself have

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Lord Savaric's Curse

The exact details of Lord Savaric's curse are not detailed in his description. This is on purpose. These are some possibilities, to spark your imagination.

- Lord Savaric was killed and reanimated whilst attacking a necromancer. He is Undead and has not realised it. (Add the Undead

talent to his profile.)

- It is a blessing from Manann. Until he sleeps out of earshot of the sea, Lord Savaric will not suffer any substantial impairment

from age.

- Lord Savaric was possessed by a Daemon on one of his exploits. For some reason, the

Daemon proved unable to dominate the

man's mind or to leave his body. It thus maintains his vigour, waiting for him to die, at which point it will take over the corpse.

— Brionne —

Brionne is the least threatened of the Bretonnian dukedoms. learned tomes on the subject.

Every year or so, a new disease

Carcassonne stands between it and the mountains, rips through some part of Brionne. It brings suffering and

Quenelles between it and Athel Loren, and Aquitaine between death to hundreds, nobles and peasants alike, and then it

it and the Forest of Châlons. Even the seas off the coast are vanishes as suddenly as it appeared, never to be seen again.

forgiving. Occasionally cultists of Nurgle are found and held responsible,

Most of Brionne is arable land, with some pastoral land in the but sometimes no plausible cause is forthcoming.

east and south. The coast is typical of Bretonnia's cliffs and

beaches, and there is a major natural port at the mouth of the The People

Brienne. The city of Brionne is built here, shining

like a jewel set in silver, as entirely too many The Brionnians say everyone born in their

poets have said. dukedom is born a poet. Residents of other

dukedom say everyone in Brionne is born

Like Brionne itself, the castles and towns thinking he's a poet. Poetry and courtly love are

of Brionne are built for beauty rather than

practicality. Many nobles have built keeps so as important to the Brionnian nobility as prowess

in battle, and even many of the peasants catch the

as to harmonise with the landscape, but in mood.

completely indefensible positions. Brionnian

fortifications often have large windows and seats The classic form of courtly love is laid down in

that are ideal for listening to lays but less useful for such poems as Clovis and Ermengild and

The Horn of

defence. Castle towers are often confections of white Franez. A young Knight Errant falls in love with the

stone that are too small for a bowman, let alone a siege young and beautiful wife of an older noble. The lady at

engine. first refuses to acknowledge him, so the knight performs

great feats of valour to draw her attention. At length they meet

Villages are also designed to be picturesque. This is difficult, in a beautiful tower with a view over a garden, and the lady

as peasants insist on living there and making the place dirty.

It is not uncommon for Brionnian nobles to tear down all declares the knight has won her heart.

The knight, however,

declares he could not betray the noble lord, her husband, and

the houses in a village and have them rebuilt in accordance leaves on a quest for the Grail. The

lady pines, sustained only

with some vision of what a happy village should look like.

This rarely makes any concessions to practicality. Indeed, by the stories of her lover's prowess, until he returns, as a Grail Knight, shortly after the lady's husband dies. They marry in a few lords forbid their peasants from carrying out any activities glorious ending to the story. S B that might dirty the village and require

entering. This makes life impossible, so grows up behind the nearest hill, where the lord cannot see it when he comes to inspect his lands.

them to wash before Whilst some knights are content to just tell these stories, most a shantytown generally want to live them. This is not popular with older husbands of

young and beautiful wives, as these men are generally not interested in conveniently ayings of rionne dying just before the climax of

Plagues, rather than monsters, "He's singing under her window": He's in love with her. the story. Adultery is the least are the curse of Brionne. "Writing with someone else's ink": Having an affair. of the problems arising: feuds, Nobody really understands attempted assassinations, and the reasons, though ducal physicians have written all-out war are common.

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Many Brionnian adventurers have left the dukedom because of alliances, but most are based on the repercussions of courtly problems arising from their pursuit of courtly love. Often, this love. Apart from the obvious feuds between husbands and means her husband found out, but since deeds of prowess are lovers, there are feuds between rival lovers of the same lady, an important part of the process even successful lovers may set ladies who want the same knight, minstrel-knights jealous out. Others, of course, leave Brionne to get away from all that of each other's fame, and between completely untalented nonsense. wannabe minstrel-knights and everyone with a touch of The internal politics of the dukedom are even more personal musical taste. Mundane issues like land and wealth are almost than elsewhere. There are numerous rivalries, feuds, and never an issue.

Plagues of Brionne Duke Theodoric of Brionne

The following examples could be used for new plagues or Duke Theodoric almost seems to be two different people. In for past ones. Each is listed with a cure, the sort of thing battle, he is a terror, wielding his great battleaxe to deadly that adventurers might be sent to get. Discovering the cure effect. He has faced down terrifying enemies, leaving their requires a character to examine several patients and make a corpses on the ground. He always leads from the front and successful Heal Test. This, of course, exposes the character to rarely returns unwounded. Among his knights, it is whispered the disease and may well give him a strong interest in finding that some war spirit comes upon him, for he seems to take the cure. great delight in slaughter.

Away from battle, the Duke is a patron and connoisseur of Flaming Vomit music and song. He is the greatest patron of minstrels in the whole of Bretonnia and listens to their stories of love with

Description: The sufferers have a high fever and produce great attention. He is something of a minstrel himself, and his copious quantities of bright red vomit. It is a brighter red compositions are competent enough. Indeed, almost all artists than blood, though doctors suspect that blood is a major can stand to praise them to the skies without feeling they are constituent. After three days, the sufferers start to feel very utterly sacrificing their integrity. cold, although they still have a fever and demand fires to The Duke is also rumoured to be an enthusiastic practitioner of keep them warm. These fires must be ever larger as the disease the adulterous love praised in the songs of minstrelsy. It is said progresses. that the noblewomen of Brionne hope this rumour is true, and

Duration: 10 days the noblemen fear that it is.

Effects: The character suffers a -20% penalty to all the Characteristics on his Main Profile. Every day he must Significant Places make a Toughness Test, or spend most of the day vomiting helplessly, losing 5% from Toughness. Brionne

Cure: Ice from a mountain glacier. A lump the size of a crown must be placed in the victim's mouth in conjunction with a Brionne is often called the Jewel of Bretonnia . . . by Brionnians.

Heal Test. It genuinely is a remarkably beautiful city, set on a peninsula linked to the mainland by a narrow neck. The peninsula forms Foot Warts a hill, and the city winds up the side, built with the local white stone or, for peasant buildings, white plaster. The sand of the bay

Description: Many warts rise on the soles of the victim's feet. is extremely good for making glass, so virtually every window in After a day, they start to burst, leaking stinking brown fluid. the city is glazed, and they sparkle in the sunlight.

Putting pressure on the warts is intensely painful, and the Castle Brionne is at the centre of the city and the peak of the substance of the feet is gradually consumed in them. People island. It is what other Brionnian castles want to be: the perfect

without feet appear to be completely immune. merging of fanciful form and flawless functionality. The many
Duration: 8 days. small turrets might appear to be haphazard, but they provide
Effects: The character's Movement is reduced to 1 and all excellent fields of fire. Similarly, the tall, slender towers hold
Characteristics on his Main Profile suffer a –30% penalty if watchposts that can be defended by one man against an army
he is standing. The victim must make a Toughness Test every and command much of the area around. The many courtyard
day. This starts at Very Easy (+30%), but worsens by one step gardens can be sealed and turned into killing rooms to dispose of
every day thereafter. If any of the tests fail, the victim loses his invaders.
feet to the disease. The Hall of Minstrels in Brionne is the most important
Cure: The crushed bodies of twenty marsh millipedes, applied centre for those entertainers in the world. It stands on a
as a paste in conjunction with a Challenging (–10%) Heal small prominence in the southern quarter of the city, and is
Test. Cutting the victim's feet off also works. surrounded by a garden. The building itself is circular, built
of white stone, and home to an auditorium with flawless
acoustics. Minstrels can be found performing there at any time
of the day or night.

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Castle Gransette “Your eyes shine like the stars, and a word from your join a household, claiming lips is as the singing of nightingales.” to still be in his period of
A few decades ago, Castle errantry. The nobility look
Gransette was the setting indulgently upon this claim.
He is attractive, if a bit on
for a tragedy worthy of any — Gilles D’Auran, Brionnian poet

song (and now, of course, “Why is it always stars? What’s wrong with pools of the pretty side (but then, he’s
the subject of several). The limpid water? Or jewels? But no, always stars.” a minstrel), and his singing
lady Isolde had accepted voice is a remarkable high
— Mauricio Casale y Gortez, Estalian poet tenor. More than a few ladies
the knight Sir Gaseric as
her lover, but her husband, have lost their hearts to him,
Lord Gransette, was not “Bunch of ineffectual fops? I’ve seen a group of but rumour has it that all have
willing to take the role of Brionnian knights break off from singing songs about been rebuffed.
This endears
the superfluous husband. their ladies, slaughter a band of Beastmen, and then go him to lords and to other

He confined Isolde in the back to the songs whilst cleaning their weapons. Odd, ladies who feel they might certainly, but not ineffectual.” have a chance. highest tower of his castle and challenged Sir Gaseric to a — Marietta, Tilean mercenary Thiemar is very guarded about duel. Sir Gaseric agreed, on eye the condition that the duel his origins for two reasons. took place in the courtyard of First, his parents were simple peasants in a Brionnian village. of Isolde. Castle Gransette, under the Second, he’s a woman. Fortunately, her voice is naturally very

low, but non-Bretonnians realise the truth immediately if they The songs all tell different stories of what happened in the duel succeed at an Average Perception Test. Bretonnians refuse to see because no one knows. At sunset, a horde of zombies descended it; a woman couldn’t possibly do this. on the village of Gransette and was only defeated by the intervention of a group of adventurers. The zombies were soon When she left her village, Thiemar had vague plans to become identified as the castle staff, but there was no sign of the lord, a Herrimault and lead a revolution to overthrow the nobles. lady, or knight. The adventurers resolved to enter the castle and She thought of her work as an entertainer as a way of gathering destroy the source of the evil. They did not come out and neither information. However, she found that she really liked being a did any of the groups who went to investigate afterwards. minstrel and even liked quite a few of the nobles she met. She has moved away from revolution but still feels that something The village and castle are being administered by the Duke until must be done about the oppression of the peasants. She is someone can determine what happened. The castle is still in dangerously open to suggestions as to what.

remarkably good repair, but the village is inhabited only by a handful of hardy souls who refused to leave their ancestral home, even if it was cursed and haunted. There are stories of hauntings and other strange events, but investigators who Thiemar le Bel stayed outside the castle have found nothing, whilst those who entered never had the chance to say what they found. Race: Human Career: Minstrel (ex-Entertainer)

Example Brionnian Main Profile

Thiemar le Bel WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

Thiemar is a minstrel of growing renown within Brionne. He 33% 37% 30% 33% 36% 25% 32% 63% travels from castle to castle and has so far refused any offers to

Secondary Profile

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

1 14 3 3 4 0 0 0

Skills: Animal Care, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia +20%, the Wasteland), Evaluate, Gossip +10%, Perception, Performer (Musician +10%, Singer +20%), Read/Write, Speak Language (Breton +10%), Ventriloquism

Talents: Etiquette, Mimic, Public Speaking, Sturdy
Special Rules:

Thiemar le Bel gets a +10% bonus on all Common Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests concerning Brionne.

Armour: None

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0, Body 0, Legs 0

Weapons: Hand Weapon (sword)

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Adventure Hooks The Kidnapped Lady

Artistic Differences A noble lord hires the adventurers to rescue his wife, who has been kidnapped. He wants them to do it discreetly, but he The adventurers, with their usual luck, stumble across the corpse doesn't care whether the kidnappers survive. It quickly becomes of a murdered minstrel. They are the prime suspects and are clear that the wife is young and beautiful. locked up to face justice. Whilst locked up, another minstrel is The obvious conclusion is that she has run off with her lover. murdered in the same way. Even the Bretonnians can work out But maybe she has been kidnapped by someone who just wants that they have the wrong people and ask the adventurers to help to be her lover. Or by a band of Herrimaults opposing the investigate. The murders continue, and all the dead minstrels lord's oppression. A knight offers his help; is he the lady's lover, were linked to one another. The adventurers discover the hand or just another wannabe? Or a plant? And maybe the lady of a Chaos cult, but is the killer a member, or were the victims? herself organised the kidnapping, before the side effects of her Either way, things are serious; the victims had many connections study of Necromancy became too obvious. with the nobility, and opportunities to spread corruption, whilst Or maybe she just ran off with

her lover.

an active Chaos cult is always a problem.

— Carcassonne —

Carcassonne is the southern border of Bretonnia, covering who reinforce the normal Orc hordes and who are stronger much of the Irrana Mountains and bordering Estalia in even than the Black Orcs. So far, only natives of Carcassonne the west, Tilea in the south, and Athel Loren in the east. The claim to have seen them. Even Tileans, with territory in the land is split into four regions by the three great tributaries of same mountains, have seen nothing. Many people think the River Brienne, and the Brienne itself forms the northern they are just a story to back up Carcassonnian demands for border. reduced taxes.

There are narrow bands of arable land along The People portions of the major rivers, but the overwhelming majority of Carcassonne is pastoral or mountains. Carcassonnian shepherdesses are particularly Carcassonnians are a martial people, believing renowned in the rest of Bretonnia for strength, prowess at arms is their birthright and their courage, and a complete lack of feminine charm. duty. This mentality is reinforced by the constant Greenskin raids, which often reach quite a way The two eastern portions of Carcassonne were once into the dukedom before a sufficient force can be the land of Glanborielle, but that dukedom was utterly swept away in the invasions of Orcs that led to gathered to crush them. Almost all Carcassonnians have some military training—even the peasants. the unification of Bretonnia. The area is now distinguished by the hill-forts that were the strongholds of the Glanborien However, they do not look down on those who are not nobility, now abandoned. Popular legend holds they are all warriors. This is seen best in their attitude to Brionne, a haunted, and in at least some cases, the legends are known to dukedom that spends its time on poetry. The Carcassonnians be justified. like to listen to Brionnian minstrels when they have time, and those who can travel visit Brionne to see the wonders of The main threat facing Carcassonne is the constant raiding the city. The Carcassonnians are proud of these achievements of the Greenskins of the Irrana Mountains and the Vaults. because, they say, they fight to make such things possible. In the east of the dukedom, they occasionally get some help They fight so that they Brionnians do not have to, and they are from the Fay of Athel Loren, proud of this.

but the Carcassonnians
have never had as good “We keep the Orcs from the rest of Bretonnia. It is our Many
Carcassonnian
relations with the Fay as their duty, and we ask no reward but that we be allowed to do
adventurers travel to employ
neighbours to the north in it. We are the men of Carcassonne, and we will fight!” their martial
abilities against
Quenelles. For the most part, threats in other parts of the
they stand alone, trusting to — Duke Huebald (his longest recorded speech) Old World. Others
travel
their military prowess, and because their talents are not
for the most part, that trust “Ah, Carcassonne. I came into Bretonnia over the martial, and they
find it very
is justified. mountains, and my first job was as a “shepherdess.” hard to receive the recognition
Me and the rest of my company. We had a sheep to look they feel they deserve within

In recent years, after. We protected Bessy from half a dozen Orc war- Carcassonne. Brionnian

Carcassonnian knights have bands, and then the stupid animal fell down a cliff. I minstrels are
all very well,

begun talking of the Iron decided to move on.” but a true son of Carcassonne

Orcs of the mountains, — Marietta, Tilean mercenary should be a warrior.
obvious servants of Chaos

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Iron Orcs

Iron Orcs are real enough, though it is unclear why only Carcassonnian natives have so far
encountered them. At first sight they
look like Black Orcs in plate armour but without a helmet, but closer encounters reveal the
armour is set into their skin. They
are faster, stronger, and better armoured than Black Orcs, but Iron Orcs are less intelligent and
more savage. They normally serve
under Black Orc leaders, and some accounts suggest that their
numbers are increasing.
This worries Duke Huebald a great deal.

Iron Orc Characteristics

Main Profile

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel
32% 15%

45% 20% 51% 53% 34% 18%

IP FP

Secondary Profile 0 0

A W SB TB M Mag

2 14 5 5 5 0

Skills: Common Knowledge (Greenskins), Dodge Blow +20%, Intimidate +20%, Outdoor Survival, Perception, Speak Language (Goblin Tongue)

Talents: Frenzy, Menacing, Night Vision, Scales (5), Specialist Weapon Group (Two-handed), Stout-hearted, Strike Mighty Blow, Strike to Injure, Strike to Stun, Sturdy

Special Rules:

Big Choppa: Even larger and more unwieldy than a Choppa, only Iron Orcs have been seen to use these weapons. On the first round of combat they do SB+2, and on later rounds SB+1 damage. In the hands of a non-Orc, they count as Great Weapons.

Armour: None

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 5, Body 5, Legs 5

Weapons: Big Choppa

Two Carcassonnian customs have achieved a degree of fame: shepherdesses are trained warriors, and they are also trained beyond the dukedom. The first is the Birth Sword. All male to operate alone, spying on and harassing Orc bands. On the nobles are presented with a fine sword at their birth: on the other hand, Carcassonnian nobles sometimes hire foreign mercenaries supposed to be the first thing that they grasp. This sword is “shepherds,” often in bands with a skilled leader, and give them then hung above the boy’s bed until he is old enough to train a single sheep to look after. The pay is 50 Pennies per day, but with it. From that point, it rests on a rack beside his bed whilst those nobles are remarkably careless about dropping purses of he sleeps. Most Carcassonnians refuse to fight with any other gold in front of the head shepherd. weapon and do indeed seem to do better whilst holding it. The mercenaries hired in this way find it amusing. Most The second custom is the Carcassonnian “shepherd.” Peasants manage to resist the temptation to eat their sheep for at least cannot, of course, be trusted to fight independently, a week; some adopt it as a and it would greatly mascot.

shame Bretonnians to hire Sayings of Carcassonne Duke Huebald mercenaries. However, the of Carcassonne flocks of sheep in the foothills “Born with a sword in his hand”: Very rich. Completely unconnected to military prowess. of the mountains do need “Carcasses”: Insulting term for Carcassonnians. Only Duke Huebald is a relatively protecting, and so there is no used within the dukedom by those with a death wish. small man, wiry and fast shame in hiring shepherds “He’s looking for his sheep”: He’s after something he rather than powerful. He who can defend themselves. really cares about. speaks only when absolutely On the one hand, necessary, and even then, he Carcassonnian shepherds and uses as few words as possible.

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Birth Sword (Talent) falling back to the Brienne. There is only a single curtain wall, which encloses a large mustering area, and the keep is very
Description: You have a Birth Sword. Whilst wielding this small. The Duke lives in a complex of buildings that are less
weapon you get +5% to Weapon Skill and deal SB+1 damage. defensible but much more comfortable.
You do not gain these bonuses with any other weapon, nor does anyone else gain these bonuses from your Birth Sword. In Dragon Falls addition, whilst you carry the sword, even if you are not using it, you gain a +10% bonus on Fear and Terror Tests. This waterfall on the upper reaches of the Songez probably got
You may normally only take this talent if you were born a male its name from the rock formations and mist, which make it look noble in Carcassonne. Female characters may take it if they rather like a dragon breathing smoke. Some people believe a were raised as boys from the moment of their birth, generally dragon once lived here, and that its treasure remains.
by parents desperate for a son. Characters not of noble It is currently of concern because it is roughly in the centre background may not take it. of an area where many Undead have been encountered. Local lords are worried that a Necromancer has taken up residence at
No one who knows him has ever seen him smile, much less the falls, and the first group of “shepherds” sent to investigate heard him laugh. His wife, Schermilde, was a political match, have not come back. and the fact that the couple have four children, all of whom take after the Duke, is a matter of some wonderment. Summersfall Fort
The Duke is, however, respected by all his men. He is the finest war-leader that the Carcassonnians have had in generations and Summersfall Fort is a medium-size hill fort in east of a brave warrior in person. Unlike many Bretonnian knights, Carcassonne. It is famous for being

definitely haunted. If he is willing to use ambushes and feints to defeat monstrous a small group of people spends the night of the last day of opponents. He argues that the Orcs that pour out of the summer within the walls of the fort, they encounter the mountains to burn villages do not deserve to be fought with Ghost of the Glanborien noble who once lived here. He honour. asks them to perform a task, which always involves fighting against Orcs. If they refuse, his ghostly warriors rise up from Significant Places the ground and attack them. If they accept, they are safe unless they give up, in which case the warriors attack them, Castle Carcassonne wherever they are. The noble's ghost seems to know a lot about where there are Castle Carcassonne stands on an island surrounded by the Orcs, and a few particularly brave "shepherds" have visited River Songez, the westernmost of the tributaries of the River the Fort on more than one occasion. These hardy souls say Brienne that lie wholly within the dukedom. The attached that the tasks get steadily harder, as if the noble is testing the town is small and exists to provide services to the large number volunteers. They suspect that he has some great task in mind, of "shepherd" companies who come to the castle to take jobs but if he has, no one has yet completed enough tests to learn with the Duke. As a result, it is a very rough place. what it is. The castle itself is designed to be defensible but acts primarily as a base camp. The Duke would not fall back here to prepare Example Carcassonian for a siege; rather, he would harry invading armies whilst slowly Gertrude

Gertrude is an experienced shepherdess, active in the south-western region of Carcassonne. She looks the part: a heavily

built, grim woman with short hair and a long bow. In her time, she has led dozens of small Orc war bands into traps and guided parties of knights to larger groups.

She is starting to feel unappreciated. The pay of a shepherd is not great and their social status is not very high. In particular, Gertrude thinks she would like to get married, but no men seem interested. She is thus considering a number of ways to get more money and find a husband. She might ultimately turn to outlawry, but she isn't there yet.

In the meantime, she is willing to act as a guide for groups of adventurers seeking important sites in the mountains. She

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demands money up front and a share of the treasure, and she Gertrude does her job well as long as she thinks she will get paid. If there are any attractive men among the adventurers, they become the Race: Human subject of her amorous attentions. She does not take insulting Career: Scout (ex-Carcassonne Shepherd) rejections well.

Adventure Hooks Main Profile

Army of Ghosts WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

Stories of hauntings at Glanborien hill forts become much 40% 54% 32% 24% 51% 46% 32% 32%

more common and are soon confirmed by reliable witnesses.

The Ghosts of the nobles and warriors seem to be gathering Secondary Profile in their forts, taking counsel, and preparing their war gear.

Peasants start fleeing the area in fear, and whilst most nobles A W SB TB M Mag IP FP are reluctant to run away, they want to know what is going on. One noble hires the adventurers to try talking to the 2 14 3 2 5 0 0 0 Ghosts.

The Ghosts are willing to talk, eventually. They might be Skills: Animal Care, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia +10%, assembling to enact vengeance on the Orcs or have been Greenskins), Concealment +10%, Dodge Blow, Gossip, compelled by a powerful Necromancer. They might even Navigation, Perception +10%, Scale Sheer Surface, Secret Signs be planning to cast the Carcassonnian invaders out of their (Scout), Set Trap, Silent Move +10%, Speak Language (Breton) lands.

Talents: Flee!, Fleet-footed, Orientation, Rover, Sharpshooter, Sixth Border Problems Sense, Specialist Weapon Group (Longbow), Warrior Born

The Tileans have decided they want to claim more of the Special Rules:

Irrana Mountains for their own. Raids against Bretonnian Gertrude gets a +10% bonus to all Common Knowledge

villages have started, with Tileans moving in quickly to settle (Bretonnia) Tests concerned with the dukedom of

afterwards. There is even some evidence that Orcs have been Carcassonne.

channelled towards Bretonnian settlements, and that some of

the Tilean shepherds might be spies. Armour: Medium Armour (Mail Shirt and Leather Jack)

The lords of Carcassonne cannot afford to fire all the Tileans, Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 3, Body 3, Legs 0

nor do they want war with Tilea. On the other hand, they Weapons: Hand Weapon (axe), Longbow with 20 Arrows.

must take action whilst a foreign power controls their land. They turn to the adventurers to solve the problem quietly, Feed My Sheep without provoking a diplomatic incident. The adventurers are approached by a noble looking to hire some shepherds. When they talk to him, he makes it clear he really does want them to look after the sheep; they are a rare breed and extremely valuable. He fears some people will deliberately try to steal them. The adventurers find themselves dealing with Orcs, sheep rustlers, and idiotic sheep that have trouble noticing that they have wandered up a cliff.

— Couronne —

Couronne is one of the larger dukedoms and unique The Marches of Couronne include the northernmost in possessing a significant internal division. reaches of the Grey Mountains and wide expanses of Couronne proper sits north of the Sannez, around a cape projecting into the Sea of Chaos. plains that are too dry for most crops. As a result, The Marches of Couronne extend to the east, the people of the Marches have become the reaching around the Grey Mountains until they greatest horse-breeders in Bretonnia, which end at the ill-defined border of the Wasteland. is no mean feat given the quality achieved Couronne proper is mostly arable land with elsewhere. pastoral land in the south and east where The Marches are plagued by Greenskins from it approaches the Pale Sisters and the Grey the Grey Mountains who also raid into the Mountains. Its coast is rugged and ill suited to south-eastern portions of Couronne proper. trade, and it's constantly lashed by storms coming in off the Sea of Chaos. It is also subject to These Orcs ride strange carnivorous horses frequent raids by Norscans, both servants of Chaos which seem to be able to gallop up mountains and simple bloodthirsty barbarians. Coastal villages as well as across plains. The Couronnians do not are always protected by a stockade at the very least; know where the creatures have come from, and those without even basic defences do not last a single all attempts to capture, break, and breed them have raiding season. failed dismally.

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The People “What is a knight without his steed? But what is the steed Couronnians start to feel that without the knight? Knight and steed, noble and peasant; using a horse simply to get Despite rumours to the on such relationships is Bretonnia built.” between home and market contrary, Couronnians are is something of an insult,

not born in the saddle. A and thus leave to become
— King Louen Leoncoeur adventurers. Knights Errant,
few women have tried, but of course, want to show off
it is apparently physically “They can’t bear the thought of something that looks their
horsemanship.
impossible. They are, however, even vaguely like a horse that they can’t ride.” However, many
Couronnian
introduced to riding before adventurers hate horses, or
they can walk and continue — Marietta, Tilean mercenary are even allergic to them.
to practise their whole lives. Completely unable to fit in at
Couronnians are without “Their horses are superb. But still not as good as they home, they head
out to meet
question the finest horsemen think; buy in L’Anguille, where they’ll charge you a people who are
not completely
in Bretonnia. reasonable amount.” horse-mad.

— Wolfgang von Ilsbach, Imperial merchant

What is more, almost all of The Couronnian obsession makes horse breeding and
them are deeply knowledgeable about and interested in equine horse racing very important
elements of their culture, and
creatures. For many Couronnians, their best friend is a horse. even their politics. Plots to
undermine a rival’s horses are
It is said a Brionnian would fight you to the death over his wife commonplace and feuds arising
from them a major feature.
but cheerfully lend you his horse, whilst Couronnians are the The summer cycle of major
horseraces gives structure to
other way around. (This is not true. Brionnian knights do not the courtly calendar, and even the
King attends most races.
lend their horses to anyone.) Unlike many Couronnians, however, King Louen feels that

Couronnians hate to walk anywhere when they could his duties as a ruler are more important
than watching a
ride. This even extends to peasants: horse breeding means
most peasants have the use of a horse, even if they do not dozen horses run very quickly.
technically own it. Most Couronnians want the best horse
possible, and it is not at all unusual to see a dainty noble lady Politics within Couronne are
mostly concerned with petty
riding a destrier. They claim being on such a big horse makes feuding about horses. The main
exception concerns the March
them feel safe, and they might occasionally need to ride on a of Couronne. Earl Adalbert, lord of
the March, is a vassal of
battlefield. However, they normally just ride them to market the Duke. He would much rather be
a direct vassal of the King.
and back, even when the market is at the castle gates. Some As the two men are currently the
same person, he feels that
now is an excellent time to press his case. The King, however,
is wary of giving such a powerful lord the independence of a

Duke.

The Earl's political manoeuvrings are proceeding on two fronts. First, he tries to portray all the other non-ducal Barons of the realm in the best possible light. If they can be seen to be righting wrongs committed by a Duke, so much the better. Second, he aims to perform acts so glorious that the King will have little choice but to accept his fealty as the King. In the service of both goals, he has great need of adventurers who are willing to do a lot of work for none of the glory.

The Earl is also pressing for glorious military adventures against the Wasteland. If he could capture Marienburg, he is sure that he would be made a Baron. The Storm of Chaos has drawn a lot of Marienburg's guards to the north and east, so he has recently stepped up cross-border raiding. The Wastelanders have complained, but so far, their emissaries have been largely ignored.

Louen Leoncoeur

King of Bretonnia and Duke of Couronne

The current King of Bretonnia, Louen Leoncoeur, is also the Duke of Couronne. He is a Grail Knight, as is required of all Kings of Bretonnia, and many are saying he is the greatest King the land has had in centuries; flatterers even say the greatest since Gilles le Breton himself.

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Hagranyms

The Orcs of the Grey Mountains call their special mounts Hagranyms. The Hagranyms are not animals; many are more intelligent than the Orcs riding them. This is one reason why all attempts by Bretonnians to tame them have failed; the Hagranyms refuse to cooperate and are clever enough to cause all kinds of problems. The other reason is that all Hagranyms are bloodthirsty killers, delighting in slaughter for its own sake as well as for food. They have chosen to ally with the Orcs because it increases their chances for slaughtering something other than Orcs. Most Orcs think that they have tamed the Hagranym by their superior strength. Only a few of the most intelligent trainers have found that the creatures choose to cooperate. The Orcs know that the Hagranym are individually stronger, and it is only their belief

in their intellectual superiority that sustains the relationship. If the Orcs find out that they are being manipulated, it will be war.

—Hagranym Characteristics—

Main Profile

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

5%

43% 0% 54% 52% 37% 30% 33%

FP

Secondary Profile 0

A W SB TB M Mag IP

2 20 5 5 8 0 0

Skills: Common Knowledge (Greenskins), Dodge Blow, Perception +20%, Scale Sheer Surface +20%

Talents: Acute Hearing, Keen Senses, Natural Weapons, Strike Mighty Blow

Special Rules:

Natural Climbers: Despite having no hands, the Hagranyms can make full use of the Scale Sheer Surface skill.

Armour: None

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0, Body 0, Legs 0

Weapons: Razor Hooves (SB+1), Fangs

King Louen frequently takes the field with his troops, and Significant Places when he does so, he rides a hippogriff, striking fear into his enemies. His prowess in battle is such that even those who meet him dismounted are prone to running away, and the King's presence on the battlefield seems to grant Bretonnians Couronne

greater courage. Next to the Smooth Field is the Lion Ring, the largest and finest horseracing stadium in the Old World. It is a large oval built Away from war, he is renowned as a just monarch. He will not entirely in stone with ranked tiers of seating. There has been a allow the letter of the law to stadium here since before the cloak abuses of its spirit, and even the lowliest noble can unification of Bretonnia, and seek a personal audience. The some say the foundations are King has issued a decree that Sayings of Couronne Elven. (Some say the whole none are to suffer for what they structure is Elven, but they're

say during such an audience, “Like barding on a palfrey”: Something valuable definitely wrong.)
Until very
and he enforces it. Whenever wasted on someone who can’t use it. (A palfrey is a recently it was
clearly a more
small riding horse, suitable for ladies.) spectacular structure than Castle

the King gets involved, justice “Full tack and harness”: Best outfit Couronne, and recent building
is done. “He can’t tell an Orc from a horseshoe”: He’s very, work has only managed to make
The only regret most very drunk or stupid (or both). it debatable.
Bretonnians have is that their The other main feature of
King is still only one man.
Couronne is the Temple of

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Shallya. This is the premier temple of Shallya in the Old World, gateway set in the side. Light
never seems to penetrate far, and
seat of the matriarch and goal of pilgrimages from every nation. a chilling cold always radiates
from it.
However, it has very little influence on local politics, as the Lady Every few years, though the
precise time seems to be random,
of the Lake is far more important to the nobility of Bretonnia. an army of skeletons and zombies
marches out of the barrow.
The supreme leaders of most religions would find this irksome, They follow the same route every
time and completely ignore
but it seems to suit the matriarch of Shallya perfectly. anyone who leaves them alone. As there
are 4,373 of them
(they ignored one scholar so much he was able to make an
Landrel Barrow accurate count), most nobles are willing to ignore them.
The few who are not meet bad ends, unless their friends can
Landrel Barrow is a large earth mound the size of a small hill restrain them.
in the March of Couronne. It is artificial and has a large stone Many groups of adventurers have
investigated the barrow. Most
have come back, reporting finding nothing but a few cold
Ronsard and empty stone tunnels under the hill. One group found an
undisturbed burial chamber, lost one man to the Wight lairing
Race: Human there, and emerged with some treasure. Some groups, however,
Career: Highwayman (ex-Outlaw) have simply failed to emerge.

Main Profile Tancred Castle

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel Tancred Castle is the current seat of Earl Adalbert. The Earl
moves his seat every few years, leaving the previous castle in the
42% 54% 33% 31% 67% 33% 26% 47% hands of a trusted steward. His father did this before
him, and
father and son aim to build a network of strong points across

Secondary Profile their territory.

Tancred Castle, only recently completed, is a good example

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP of this. It sits on a low but steep hill, and the outer wall is studded with towers. The high inner wall allows defenders to

2 16 3 3 4 0 0 0 turn the region between the walls into a killing zone, whilst the final round keep also has a tall signal and watchtower.

Skills: Animal Care, Animal Training, Charm, Common The castle has a good well and large stores of food. Fully

Knowledge (Bretonnia +10%), Concealment, Dodge Blow, manned, it could survive a siege for over three months. The

Gossip +10%, Perception, Ride +20%, Scale Sheer Surface, surrounding land is not particularly fertile, and it is unlikely

Silent Move, Speak Language (Breton), Swim that a living army could last that long.

The Earl is thinking of moving on again and is looking for a

Talents: Ambidextrous, Etiquette, Master Gunner, Mighty reliable castellan. The castle still suffers from occasional Orc

Shot, Rover, Sharpshooter, Specialist Weapon Group raids and is close enough to the border with the Wasteland to

(Fencing, Gunpowder), Streetwise, Strike to Stun, be the target of reprisals from them, as well.

Swashbuckler, Trick Riding

Example Couronnean

Special Rules:

Ronsard gets a +10% bonus on Common Knowledge Ronsard (Bretonnia) Tests relating to the dukedom of Couronne.

Ronsard is a Highwayman, and one of the most famous

Armour: None in Bretonnia. He has only been active for a few years, but

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0, Body 0, Legs 0 tales of his exploits are popular throughout Couronne and

Weapons: Two Pistols, Rapier are starting to spread beyond. He is famed for his unfailing courtesy, for taking only some of his victims' money and possessions, and for a few occasions in which he helped drive off attacking Orcs or bandits and then accepted a little money "for his trouble."

A few foolish people have even been known to deliberately take roads he has targeted, in the hopes of meeting him.

Ronsard was born an ordinary peasant who fled into outlawry after a disagreement over his taxes. His first years as an Outlaw involved simple robbery with violence; he had no pretensions to be a Herrimault. By pure chance, on one occasion he decided to mock a victim by being excessively

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polite. The next day, in the tavern, he heard the victim The adventurers find that their trail is dogged by mysterious

telling the tale of the gentlemanly robber. Ronsard enjoyed killings at the hand of some beast.

They may wonder whether the experience and experimented with it again. It was a one of them is a lycanthrope of some sort. If they do not resounding success, and soon he found himself riding the track things back to the Hagranyms, it betrays them at an path of the Highwayman. extremely inopportune moment, finally unable to endure not Ronsard is utterly in love with his image. He still lives simply feasting on their flesh. to avoid arousing suspicion, but he spends a lot of time Of course, if any character looks in the creature's mouth, the thinking of new ways to augment the legend of Ronsard, game is up. But who would do that to a gift horse? Gentleman Highwayman. Anyone poaching on his territory would be severely dealt with. Simple Theft

Adventure Hooks Less honest characters are hired to steal a particular horse and bring it to a certain castle. The horse is well guarded, but the The Gift Horse job is within their capabilities. When they get to the castle, no one knows anything about them, but the war party coming One of the Hagranyms decides a little spying is in order. He over the horizon is unlikely to believe that. The characters need attacks an isolated rider, then strips the tack off his mount to do a lot of fast-talking or fast running (probably both) to get and hides its body. When the adventurers pass, they find a out of their initial predicament. dead man with his wounded-but-living horse still standing And then there's the little matter of who hired them and by, protecting the body. If the adventurers don't take the why? What happens back at the victim's castle whilst he is out Hagranyms, it tags along. chasing his horse?

— Gisoreux —

The dukedom of Gisoreux is divided into four geographical of forest without a really good reason, and those who do rarely areas. The first, the Plains of Gisoreux, is actually mostly come back. pastoral country and very hilly. This area includes the city of Gisoreux itself and lies between the River North of the river, where the forest runs up to Grismerie, the Forest of Arden, The Pale Sisters, the Pale Sisters, things are very different. No and the Grey Mountains. Just over half of the village founded here has ever survived more than population of the dukedom lives in this small a year. Recently, Bretonnian lords have even area. given up trying. The Human inhabitants are all nomadic, and there are no roads larger than The second area is North Gisoreux. This land, a trail. The trees in this region are particularly between the Sannez and the Pale Sisters, is also old, large, and fine, which prompts nobles to mostly pastoral but has substantial arable portions send occasional logging forays. These sometimes along the course of the Sannez. The land here used succeed in bringing out a tree or two; more often, to be part of the Forest of Arden but was cleared, the loggers simply vanish. over the course of a thousand years, by the family of

the current ruler, Earl Baldhelm of Harran. The process The final region of the dukedom is covered by diversity grants us mountains, split between the continues in the southwest of Pale Sisters in the west and the region. North Gisoreux the Grey Mountains in the is home to about a quarter of east. The two ranges are very the population. “We all are Gisoren, and our very distinct. The Pale Sisters are strength.”

The third region is the Forest — Duke Hagen, in a speech to the North Gisoren in of white rock and tend to of Arden. The areas south and rounded peaks, steep cliffs, which he encouraged them to abandon the uncivilised

east of the river are relatively practice of mock marriages on Lily Day. and lots of high valleys. Access

civilised. The roads between “So many differences, so easy for Chaos to hide. These to the valleys is limited, the villages are patrolled by people have much to learn.” however, and often involves the local nobility or at least climbing a cliff. The Grey by their men-at-arms, and — Ermnegard of Krungenheim, Witch Hunter Mountains are of dark grey

travel on the roads is no more “Great place to work. The inns actually make you stone and are characterised by dangerous than travel on most welcome, rather than treat you as a porter who just very sharp terrain. Their peaks other roads of the Old World. happened to bring customers. If most of the routes there and ridges are narrow, as are The villages do have stockades didn’t also go through the forest, I’d work there all the the are their many passes. As a but, in a good year, suffer no time.” result, more people live in the attacks. On the other hand, Pale Sisters than in the Grey no one leaves the cleared areas — Eldegar of Busreq, Coachman Mountains.

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The People Sayings of Gisoreux The nomads of the forest make a living as hunters and Just as the land of Gisoreux trappers and trade regularly is divided, so are the people. with the villages bordering The Plains of Gisoreux are “He’s crossed the river”: He’s made an irrevocable on their areas. Most of them the heart of the dukedom, decision. Most of the rivers in Gisoreux form make a trip to the city of important borders. Gisoreux at least once every

and these are the people most “He’s got a red horse and a black pig”: He’s dirt poor. This few years, since they have outsiders think of when they is from a folk tale that was very popular two centuries occasional contact with the think of Gisoreux. Gisorens ago. These days, only scholars know the whole story. isolated villages of Artois and are friendly people; they “Winter visitor”: A completely unexpected event, do not want to become like greet even complete strangers originally from the Pale Sisters. them. They also keep an eye politely, and many people on the Beastmen and other offer casual acquaintances a meal. There are, however, monsters and send runners to warn villages at risk of attack. strict limits to this generosity. As a result, they are accepted After a single meal and one night’s accommodation, visitors are expected to earn any further friendliness by reciprocating. without prejudice by virtually all other Gisorens. Clever and mobile rogues manage to sponge off the Gisorens’ largesse for years, but far more are recognised and find In the valleys of the Pale Sisters, the people cluster together themselves shunned. in small communities. Given the labyrinthine quality of this region accompanied by terrible winters, few people These customs even extend to the more civilised parts of the have the means or the interest to leave their small stone homes. Few have little knowledge of others who dwell in and Forest of Arden, but there, new arrivals are expected to begin beyond these mountains. As a result of their isolation, each their visit with a bath, in which they are supervised constantly community has its own strange customs and habits, though by armed villagers. The bath is, of course, a courtesy, and the threat of Orcs and Chaos force all villages to concentrate the guards are for the guests’ protection, and the fact that it is impossible to hide most mutations whilst naked is pure on defence. coincidence. Attractive female visitors may find many, many men are eager to protect them. Women pretending to be men There are Human inhabitants of the Grey Mountains, but in find that people in this region are generally good at overlooking Gisoreux this range is too rugged and plagued by monsters to such things. support any real communities. Most of those who live here are nomadic loners, though there are some family groups. They live by hunting and by guiding travellers through the mountains. A few nobles have lands in the Plains of Gisoreux and strongholds in the mountains, with the responsibility of defending them against monsters. In many places they can do little more than keep their fortress secure and supplied, but the nobles along the Gisoreux Gap pride themselves on keeping it as safe for traffic as any road anywhere.

The internal politics of the dukedom have recently been upset. For centuries, North Gisoreux was basically cut off from the Duke in the south, allowing the Earls of Harran to go about things in their own way. They grew accustomed to this nominal independence, and it was a shock when Duke Hagen moved to Couronne for most of the time. Now, the Duke can easily deal with North Gisoreux, and it is in the Plains where he must rely on his steward. Duke Hagen's high standards of personal virtue do not help matters; he keeps coming across practices he deems unacceptable, but which the people of North Gisoreux have maintained for generations.

Gisoreux, in common with all the dukedoms bordering on that cursed place, would like to see Mousillon invaded and cleansed. However, relations with Bastonne are also strained. Nobles in the Plains of Gisoreux have repeatedly feuded with Bastonnian lords in an effort to extend their holdings across the river. Since Duke Hagen moved north, these lords have become more willing to swear fealty to the Duke of Bastonne for lands in the latter dukedom. As a result, there are now a number of Gisoren lords with some holdings in Bastonne

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as well, which makes relations between the dukedoms even more complex.

Duke Hagen of Gisoreux

Duke Hagen is a Grail Knight and a close companion of The city is dominated by Castle Gisoreux, an enormous, King Louen. The Duke is utterly committed to the ideals of sprawling complex that runs along a ridge in the east of the knighthood, even more so than most Grail Knights, and the city. There is only a single curtain wall, but it is over a mile King knows that he can rely on him for advice on the chivalric long and encloses two large keeps as well as many other thing to do. Duke Hagen's decisions are unclouded by concern buildings. Since the Duke began spending most of his time for consequences, so the King does not always take his advice; in Couronne, most of Castle Gisoreux has been closed down. King Louen is mindful that it is sometimes better to act Lord Hincmar, the Duke's steward, lives in one of the keeps, unchivalrously and avoid throwing away hundreds of lives. but the other is now deserted. The Duke sometimes has trouble with these decisions. He is The area of the city nearest the

castle is reserved for the
aware that the King has wider responsibilities and still trusts his town houses of the nobility.
There is quite a lot of empty
friend's commitment to the ideals of chivalry. Still, every time space here, as the city has never
attracted nobles in the
King Louen compromises those principles for the greater good, numbers one would expect.
Gisoren lords seem to prefer the
the Duke worries about the possibility of corruption. countryside.
Duke Hagen hardly ever leaves the King's side. The King likes
to have the Duke's advice readily available, and the Duke, Valle Florida
though he would scarcely admit it even to himself, wants to
keep an eye on the King. Valle Florida is a large valley in the Pale Sisters. It is unusually
inaccessible (even for the mountains) with high cliffs rising
Significant Places above it on three sides and a steep drop to the south. Entering
or leaving the valley requires at least a day spent climbing
Castle Desfleuve mountains. Its orientation, however, makes its climate
unusually warm: it traps sunlight. Snow only settles there in
Castle Desfleuve stands at the centre of the Gisoreux Gap. In the depths of winter, and in
summer it is filled with flowers.
is the seat of the Marquis Desfleuve, a young man charged The vineyards, in particular, flourish.
with coordinating the defence of the whole pass. He is the Floridan wine is an acquired taste, but
aficionados praise it
only child of his parents: his mother died in childbirth and above all others. Getting genuine
Floridan wine is extremely
his father died less than a year ago. So far, Frederic, the difficult, and both wealthy individuals
and wine dealers often
current Marquis, is living up to his illustrious ancestors' hire adventurers to deliver it.
deeds. A Knight of the Realm, he has already spoken about The people of the valley have
developed something of a
finding a reliable steward so that he can go on the Quest for reputation, in no small part to a
suspicious Witch Hunter who
the Grail. sought to expose the townspeople of being hidden cultists. He
Frederic Desfleuve has a secret problem: he's a woman. He claimed that the locals placed
Warpstone in their wine. But
father couldn't bear the thought of remarrying, so he raised his an investigation revealed he had
tainted some wine himself.
only child to be his heir. In all respects but one, this proved He was to be drowned in his own
tainted barrel, but as he
to be an excellent decision. The only other living person who developed gills within moments of
being ducked, the people
knows the Marquis's secret is his (her?) old nurse, but Frederic had to settle for burning him
instead. Ever since, the folk fawn
is desperate to find someone to trust, who can help her with on their guests but have little
interest in accommodating those
the problem of how on earth she is going to produce a true heir who desire an extended stay.
to the lordship.

Gisoreux

The city of Gisoreux is a busy place filled with traders and travellers stopping on their way along the Grismerie. There are more Imperial merchants in Gisoreux than in any other city in Bretonnia, and it may be the only place in the world where people do not immediately think of sailors when they think of Marienburg: a number of land traders come from the Wasteland through the Gisoreux Gap. The city has fine merchant houses pressed right up against decaying slums, many of which used to be fine merchant houses. For some reason, merchant families in Gisoreux rarely maintain their prosperity for more than one generation.

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Rhodegang the Black in his ancestry, though living person has done so within Rhodegang's hearing.

Race: Human Rhodegang's father raised him with an intense hatred of

Career: Scout (ex-Hunter) Beastmen. One of his earliest memories is of being taken to see what Beastmen had done to a village that wasn't warned

Main Profile in time, and the images still haunt him. Rhodegang started as a hunter, but dedication soon turned him into one of the

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel nomads' foremost experts on the movements of Beastmen. As such information is vital both to the nomads and to settled

31% 62% 29% 36% 55% 52% 36% 32% villages, Rhodegang has earned a great deal of respect.

He is highly focused (the less charitable say obsessed), but he

Secondary Profile treats all non-mutated people politely. If they are interested in fighting against Beastmen, he becomes quite enthusiastic.

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP Characters hunting Beastmen in the eastern Arden are very likely to be referred to Rhodegang if they look for a guide, and

2 17 2 3 4 0 0 0 they will find him very useful in that role. In melee combat, however, he knows his limits and hangs back.

Skills: Animal Care, Common Knowledge (Beastmen, Bretonnia +10%), Concealment +10%, Follow Trail +10%, Adventure Hooks Gossip, Navigation, Outdoor Survival +10%, Perception +10%, Search, Secret Signs (Ranger, Scout), Set Trap, Silent Frontier Life Move +10%, Speak Language (Breton)

The fourth son of a minor Gisoreux noble gets very lucky on

Talents: Excellent Vision, Hardy, Lightning Reflexes, an adventure and acquires a vast amount of money. He decides

Marksman, Mighty Shot, Orientation, Rapid Reload, Rover, he will establish a settlement in the Forest of Arden beyond

Sure Shot, Specialist Weapon (Longbow) the river. Most people decide that he is a lunatic, but surely

the adventurers would be interested in good pay to ensure the

Special Rules: survival of the settlement?

Rhodegang gets a +10% to all Common Knowledge
(Bretonnia) Tests concerned with Gisoreux.

Armour: Medium Armour (Mail Shirt and Leather Jack)
Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 1, Body 3, Legs 0
Weapons: Hand Weapon (Sword), Shield, Longbow and 20

Arrows.

Example Gisoren The Beastmen don't want them there, the nomads really aren't sure, and the noble is remarkably cagey on the details of his Rhodegang the Black lucky adventure. There's plenty for adventurers to do.

Rhodegang was born and raised a nomad in the Forest of Snowbound Arden. His nickname comes from his hair, which is jet black, thick, and all over his body. Even his beard grows quickly. A The characters are resting in one of the valleys of the Pale Sisters few people have speculated on the possibility of a Beastman after an adventure when an unseasonable snowfall traps them there. The villagers assure them it will melt in a few days, but then villagers start to disappear. Search parties are sent out in groups of at least six, but no one blames the adventurers. Why not?

— Lyonesse —

Lyonesse is one of the largest Bretonnian dukedoms, than a hundred feet high, with almost level tops and very steep sprawling along the north-western coast of the country. The sides. Openings in the top lead into a complex of caves that coast is rugged and has many small islands. The offshore currents invariably reaches a drinkable underground river. As many are tricky for newcomers but predictable enough for natives to handle easily, and the islands have better people have noted, they could have been designed harbours than the mainland coast. As a result, as a place to put a castle, but they appear to be most of the coastal villages of Lyonesse are actually entirely natural. These days, every motte has a offshore, scattered throughout the islands. castle or the ruins of a castle on top of it. Inland, the dukedom splits in two, though both The southern area largely lacks mottes, but the areas consist mainly of arable land. In the north land is crossed by dozens of small rivers which are the original lands of Lyonesse, the domain of frequently enlarge into small lakes. Many of these Thierulf, first of Gilles le Breton's Companions. In the lakes have islands of a suitable size for building a south are lands that used to be part of Mousillon. castle. Most are now fortified, and the natural moat The northern area is dotted with the hills that locals call also provides drinking water. Towards the border with mottes. These landforms are roughly circular, normally less Mousillon, these lakes spread out

even more, and the
land becomes marshy in a few areas. However, the true

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Lakemen

Lakemen are a variety of Beastmen found primarily in the Lyonen region of the Forest of Arden, though they swim out to plague the rest of southern Lyonesse with depressing frequency. They all have a vaguely amphibian appearance, often with faces resembling frogs, pincers in place of hands, and gills allowing them to breathe underwater. However, they are more variable than normal Beastmen, and all Lakemen have at least one other mutation. Lakemen prefer to attack from the water, as this gives them the advantage of surprise in most cases, but they are no more adept in water than any other skilled swimmer. Whilst they are as violent and bloodthirsty as Beastmen, the two groups have never been observed to cooperate and have even been known to fight each other for no readily apparent reason.

Lakemen Characteristics

Main Profile

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

30% 20%

45% 15% 46% 42% 30% 27%

IP FP

Secondary Profile 0 0

A W SB TB M Mag

1 13 4 4 4 0

Skills: Concealment +10%, Intimidation, Outdoor Survival, Perception +10%, Silent Move +10%, Speak Language (Dark Tongue), Swim +20%

Talents: Keen Senses, Natural Weapons, Rover
Special Rules:

Chaos Mutations: Bestial Appearance, Gills, Pincer Hand (both). One additional mutation; roll on the table on page 79 of the Old World Bestiary if you have that book, otherwise use the table on page 229 of WFRP.

There is a 50% chance of a further mutation. If another mutation is gained, there is a 50% chance of yet another mutation. Keep going until the creature gets no new mutation or becomes too ridiculous to live.

Like Flowing Water: Lakemen get +20% to Concealment and Silent Move Tests when in water.

Armour: None

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0, Body 0, Legs 0

Weapons: Pincers (SB damage, Precise)

marshes are not reached until one is actually within the cursed much murkier. Nobles who couldn't hope to win militarily dukedom. turned to political plots, hoping to isolate their rivals or stir A tongue of the Forest of Arden protrudes into the southern up other enemies against them. Those who found themselves region of Lyonesse, but the rivers and lakes continue within. beset by these schemes turned to trade and economics, hoping The islands in these lakes often hold small villages as Humans to bolster themselves whilst starving their rivals of essential try to hold their own against the Beastmen. supplies. To respond to that, some lords even recruited peasants as agents in their schemes. The People Things have now reached the point where virtually every Lyonen noble spends his entire life reacting to developments in various Lyonens are renowned for their feuds and schemes. People schemes established by his ancestors. Few fully understand the blame the unusual geography, particularly the prevalence of schemes they are involved in, and many are completely lost excellent sites for fortifications. It is very difficult to utter beyond day-to-day reactions to crises. Indeed, there is a (possibly defeat a Lyonen noble, so rivalries, once started, tend to fake) story of a lord who arranged his wife's assassination and continue for decades, if not centuries. then his own assassination in revenge, without realising. Whilst the complex tangle of Lyonen politics may have started About the only way to get out of the tangle is to simply leave with simple feuds between noble families, it has since become Lyonesse, and a lot of adventurers have taken that option.

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Others found that they had "I defend my honour and patrimony against all-comers. butchering his peasants to no choice but to leave, having That is the duty of a knight." keep the fiend happy. The

been caught out when a neighbouring lords drove
scheme went badly wrong. him out, and the Garlonds
Some, however, leave as part — Sir Leobas, Lyonen Knight put a steward in place. The
of their schemes, hoping steward betrayed his lords to
to return in a far stronger “Always fighting each other, these Lyonens. Sometimes their deaths a
few years later
position. their schemes get so elaborate that they’re actually fighting but was himself killed in
the
themselves. Plenty of work if you have wits and discretion.”

The only broad divide in — Marietta, Tilean mercenary ensuing battles.

Lyonen politics is that between “If their Duke cared to unify them, they would be This time, no
one wanted the
the north and the south. unstoppable. I cannot decide whether that would be good place, so it
was abandoned.
Whilst the southern nobles or bad.” Over the following years

were happy to be liberated — Sir Gaston, Artoin lord bandits, Necromancers, and
from the rule of the mad Chaos cults have all taken up
and bloodthirsty Dukes of residence there. They have
Mousillon, they were less happy when the liberators claimed been driven out, but anyone who
takes possession of the place
many prime fiefs and proceeded to keep the “Old Mousillese” seems to fall to evil. Most people
now believe it to be cursed.
out of the corridors of power. Any attempts to work as a bloc are

undermined by the feuds that exist between the Old Mousillese, Lyonesse
but they do believe that they should work together to claim their
rightful place. The ducal seat is on an island off the northwest coast of Lyonesse.
The walls of the castle, built centuries ago, are washed by the sea at
high tide, and small boats can sail right in to the outer courtyard.
Duke Adalhard of Lyonesse The inner courtyard is higher up and always completely dry, whilst

Duke Adalhard appears to be a simple man. He excels on the the Great Keep stands on the very
peak of the island, commanding
battlefield and, whilst off it, enjoys feasting, gambling, and a fine view of the bay. Duke
Adlahard’s feasts can be heard across
the other entertainments of warriors. Some observers of his the whole island.

style have suggested that his true loyalty is to Ulric, not the When the tide falls, the top of the
island can be seen to resemble a
Lady of the Lake, and blame it on the Norscan blood found in motte. What is more, a causeway
leads down from the main gate,
northern Lyonesse. disappearing into the sea. Legend states Lyonesse was originally set

The Duke keeps himself aloof from the politics of his dukedom on a hill in the middle of the finest
city in the Old World, but the

as far as possible. If a conflict spreads to the point that he can't sins of the city's inhabitants drew the wrath of Mannan, and the ignore it, he typically takes his forces in, crushes all parties, whole area was sunk beneath the waves. Only the Duke's citadel seizes their lands, and declares a resolution. This has been was spared, because only the Duke had remained virtuous. effective every time he has done it, so the nobility now try to Some adventurers have worked out ways to explore the seabed keep their scheming from drawing the attention of their lord. and claim that there are ruins down there, but that they are protected by strange creatures. A few golden items have been Significant Places brought back; not enough to make an expedition worthwhile, but enough to keep people trying.

Barley Motte Sigmarsheim

S

LLBlRbwbwo'orauAearilrdrsnidnlensegrg,oeYadudwwdueMioVfsalhelwerPeooand.nottetCetTwu deodtwhreoiewbrsoeprsyiisencntna,rhaeanaonttgtdtnihetohruedopneruonl.iwfoepfioTtesiwrtthf oteah.hehfdgytoohtmoFietLWyoasnteHsseep“,hHecorlemcoeksepentootiowfvetstahhaweenyh Ddbaoit'wanrhYdeevle'glsleidwnsofiioTnoHrgm”f:eHdSA.iERGnd'smyeoqnarur.omsifHtaeineftlie lmyyexycusieessapseartdesiloiaotngtfloae,lloayuBtpreotsotnonfitahnbfFawierhsreihKeoeEfp.en unfemnHodgaigrshspheehatiiesnrntcttelrthEaasetiiehnrnbmumreduatrenEhntsbdeemwatda mFtcipltkosethaiiodrrtdweeEecsehsiueawttimtnshsotiudtofafhhrpnmiiiemynhsnidss He was driven mad by the people who are some sort of threat to the speaker. of freedom copied from the spirits of the D'ayvles, and another group of adventurers “My grandfather's business”: Something I would rather charters of various Imperial defeated the Undead. Once not do, but about which I have no choice. cities. The village is built around a temple of Sigmar, and again, the Bretonnian knight the lord's keep stands watch at among them was rewarded “Motte and donjon”: Someone who has thoroughly the edge of the island. with the fief. A few years later, capitalised on natural advantages to get a strong The young people of the the knight was revealed to be position. village have a tradition trafficking with a Dark God,

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of going to the Empire for a year or so when they reach Liudver of Barfleur adulthood and of bringing back a spouse. As a result, the language of the village is Reikspiel, and the whole place feels Race: Human like it could have been picked up from the Great Forest and Career: Village Elder (ex-Mediator, ex-Herrimault, ex-Scout,

put down in Bretonnia. Indeed, gullible visitors are told exactly that. ex-Vampire Hunter)

Example Lyonen Main Profile

Liudver of Barfleur WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

Liudver is the Village Elder of Barfleur, a small settlement 53% 53% 36% 52% 45% 52% 51% 59% in northern Lyonesse. Whilst he appears old, white-haired, and frail, he is a lot tougher than he looks, a trait which Secondary Profile becomes apparent when he hands down his decisions.

Liudver's judgements are highly respected, and people from A W SB TB M Mag IP FP other villages bring particularly difficult cases to him. He is known for caring about right and wrong and for devising 2 18 3 5 4 0 0 0

punishments that compensate the victim whilst making the

criminal suffer. Skills: Academic Knowledge (Necromancy), Animal Care,

Like almost everyone in Lyonesse, Liudver has schemes within Charm +10%, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia +20%, the

schemes. In his past, he has been a Vampire Hunter, and he Empire), Concealment +20%, Dodge Blow +20%, Evaluate,

still maintains a lookout for any Undead in the area. Criminals Follow Trail +10%, Gossip +10%, Haggle, Intimidate,

may be required to clear out weaker specimens, whilst Navigation, Outdoor Survival, Perception +20%, Ride, Scale

adventurers, brought before him on trumped-up charges, may Sheer Surface, Search, Secret Language (Ranger Tongue),

be sent to deal with stronger infestations. Secret Signs (Scout), Silent Move, Speak Language (Breton,

Liudver also aims to bring the neighbouring villages properly Classical, Reikspiel)

under his control. Having them bring difficult cases before him

is merely the first step. Next, he wants to discredit their elders, Talents: Dealmaker, Marksman, Mighty Shot, Orientation,

so that he will be the only remaining option. Adventurers Public Speaking, Rapid Reload, Rover, Schemer, Seasoned

would be good for that, as well, especially ones who trust him Traveller, Specialist Weapon (Crossbow), Stout-hearted,

after he advised them on the destruction of some Undead. Strike Mighty Blow, Strike to Injure, Strong-minded, Suave,

Sure Shot, Tunnel Rat

Adventure Hooks

Special Rules:

A Lady from the Lake Liudver gets a +10% bonus on all Common Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests concerning Lyonesse.

The adventurers are engaged in a hard battle by the side of one

of the lakes in southern Lyonesse. A female Lakeman emerges Armour: None

from the water and makes short work of some of the characters' Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0, Body 0, Legs 0

enemies, allowing them to win the battle. She then vanishes Weapons: Hand Weapon (stout

walking stick)

back into the water. The same thing happens again some days later and again after that.

The Lakewoman is clearly a creature of Chaos, so why is she helping the adventurers? How much trouble will the adventurers get into if someone sees them being helped?

House Divided

A Lyonen noble has just discovered that the people plotting to kidnap his sister were working for him, aiming to kidnap the mistress of a rival knight. However, the way he found out suggests to him that the spy he placed at that knight's court was, in fact, his sister. He is not at all happy at the implications of all this, and he would like the adventurers to disentangle all his plots.

However, he does not want them interrupted, nor does he want the plotters to find out that he is behind them. Thus, he wants the characters to do it very, very subtly.

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— Montfort —

The dukedom of Montfort lies almost entirely within the Grey extremely hard and playing even harder when they have the Mountains, running from just south of the Gisoreux Gap chance. They live in isolated communities, which has two to just south of Axe Bite Pass. To the north and west of the Grey possible results. Either the community becomes extremely Mountains, the border of the dukedom and of Bretonnia runs close, or it disintegrates under the pressure of internal along the edge of the mountain range, whilst within Bretonnia a rivalries and hatreds. Obviously, the communities that are narrow strip of pastoral land forms part of the dukedom. still there are mainly of the first type.

There is little farmland within Montfort, and even that is not Few Montfortians are suspicious of Human-looking outsiders, particularly fertile. The dukedom is barely self-sufficient in however. Every community has been rescued by knights food in a good year and must import if there is any problem sent from one of the mountain castles, and every mountain with the harvest. In a dukedom plagued by Goblins and Orcs, community relies on food brought by outside traders. Non-problems with the harvest are common. Human outsiders, including Dwarfs, Elves, and Halflings, are likely to get a hostile reception, as the residents assume they are Fortunately, the dukedom has two other source of income. The some kind of Orc.

first is the tolls on Axe Bite Pass. This is the main trade route between the Empire and Bretonnia, as merchant Some Montfortians leave because they get tired

caravans come over from the Reikland and then of looking at the same rocks every day, others take ship on the River Grismerie to Gisoreux. because they do not get on with their neighbours. A considerable number of adventurers leave

The pass lives up to its name. For most of its because they are among the few survivors of an length, the road runs along the bottom of attack on their village.

a steep, narrow V-shaped valley, with only a narrow strip of sky visible overhead. The road is Greenskin attacks are a fact of life in Montfort. wide enough for two merchant caravans to pass Almost everyone has some experience of fighting easily, but there is very little space off the road. It the Orcs and Goblins, and villages are built to be normally takes several days to pass through, so there able to withstand an assault long enough for help are inns placed along the route where the lie of the to arrive. Axe Bite Pass is the only route wide enough land permits. This has created “Ludwig’s Run” near the to allow an army to enter Bretonnia, and so it is heavily middle of the pass, where the gap between two inns is more guarded. Montfort itself guards the Bretonnian end, whilst than a day’s travel. If a caravan really pushes hard, it can make fiefs have been established along its length. Most of these it, and most try to. Almost unique among isolated inns, those nobles have encouraged inns in the protection of their castles two (“Ludwig’s Nose” and “Ludwig’s Toes”) open the gates and derive their income mainly from taxes and tolls. A few after dark if convinced that an arriving group is genuine. have built castles overlooking the main routes into the pass from the mountains. Each of these nobles normally controls a

The second is mining. The Grey Mountains in Montfort mine, which serves as the main source of income. contain a number of rich veins of iron ore, as well as other metals. There is even a single gold mine, the location of which The nobles of the foothills are constantly seeking to expand is kept secret. their holdings, across the Grismerie and into Bastonne and Quenelles. None are willing

The mountains in Montfort “Gilles the Unifier and his Companions may have to foreswear their Duke, are as sharp as the Grey fought here on horseback, but we cannot match their however, so those who Mountains in Gisoreux, achievements. We must fight as we can, against the same succeed are eventually driven but whilst the Gisorens do foes, with the same courage.” back. When challenged by the not try to live in them, the other Dukes, Duke Folcard Montfortians have no choice. — Duke Folcard of Montfort promises to do something Flat land is for crops and about it when the Greenskins

livestock, not houses, so all “High tolls? Yes, I used to think so. Then half a dozen give him some time. Of mountain homes, including knights with men-at-arms came to rescue us from an course, they never do.

castles, are built on steep, Orc raiding party. Now I pay happily.” Relations with the Empire rocky slopes.

— Siegfried of Bogenhafen, Imperial Merchant, at are excellent. A large part

The People Ludwig’s Nose of the Duke’s income relies on traders using Axe Bite

Montfortians live in a “There’s more than one secret mine in Montfort. And Pass, so he is ruthless with

hostile environment, and most of them aren’t digging for something as mundane nobles who might think

it shows. They live for the as gold.” that taking land from the moment even more than Empire is a good idea.

most Bretonnians, working — Common rumour in taverns in Parravon, Gisoreux, Nobles do occasionally push and Montfort itself.

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into the Wasteland, but the land there is not worth much, and Marienburg is more worried about Couronne. As long as Duke Folcard maintains official disapproval and does not allow it to get out of hand, the Marienburgers are willing to overlook small incursions.

Duke Folcard of Montfort

Duke Folcard is something of an anomaly among the Dukes of Bretonnia. He is a fearsome warrior, but he hardly ever fights on horseback. The mountains that cover his dukedom severely limit mounted combatants, and the Duke accepts no limits in his pursuit of the Greenskins that infest his lands.

Duke Folcard is possibly the Bretonnian Duke most loved by his people. He genuinely seems to care about peasant villages and tries to relieve them when they are attacked by Goblinoids. He has set up a network of signal beacons across the mountains—which means relief forces arrive more often than not—and the Duke goes in person if he can. Once he has relieved a village, he establishes an impromptu court to hear any complaints of unjust treatment and sets things to rights.

The Duke is a tall man with dark hair cropped very close and an intense, fierce glare. Many Montfortian peasant girls dream

about their Duke, as do most of the noble women.

Significant Places thus run all the way around. There is a well within the keep, which stories say is over a thousand feet deep. The water is Garban Hold certainly a long way down.

Garban Hold is an Orc warren, and the Duke of Montfort Double walls run from the lowest tier of the castle, closing the whole pass. They are anchored by a small castle at the would love to know exactly where it is. Captured Orcs and Goblins have mentioned it under torture, and recent raids do far end and a large gatehouse in the centre. This is the only seem to have been more coordinated. It is probably somewhere way to enter or leave the pass, and the place where tolls are in the centre of Montfort, and there is likely to be an Orc charged.

Warlord in control. Beyond that, the Duke knows nothing, As a result, the town of Montfort is split in two. The town and he has offered substantial rewards for anyone who can within the pass buys iron from mining caravans and forges provide reliable information. it into useful goods before shipping them on, as the tolls are

Montfort then a lower portion of the price. The town outside the pass provides services to merchants and is generally a more pleasant The castle and town of place to stay. The craftsmen Montfort sit at the Bretonnian of Inner Montfort are the end of Axe Bite Pass, an finest in Bretonnia, and their important line of defence Sayings of Montfort weapons and armour are against possible invasion by highly respected. The inns of Greenskins or the Empire. The “Digging for Greenskins”: Putting a lot of effort into Outer Montfort are renowned castle is the most impressive something that will happen anyway. for providing absolutely any

Human-built fortification “He’s walking in Ludwig’s shoes”: He’s riding in a cart. sort of lodging you could in the Old World. The main Normally critical, suggesting laziness. desire, as long as you can find body of the castle is on the “Sure as stone”: Very reliable. the right one. There is very north side of the pass, with little contact between the walls rising over sixty feet two towns, as even residents from the rock in five tiers, “When Ludwig burns his nose”: It will never happen. must pay to pass through the each independently defensible. Ludwig’s Nose, in Axe Bite Pass, gets direct sunlight gate. It is said that a resident The lower three tiers stop for no more than an hour a day, and it is normally of Inner Montfort is more against the rock of a cliff-face, cloudy anyway. Getting sunburn there is virtually likely to have visited Altdorf but the top two tiers and the impossible. than Outer Montfort; this

keep are on a smaller peak and may actually be true, as

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Knockers

Knockers are the Undead revenants of miners killed in accidents, particularly accidents caused by carelessness or greed. They are all but mindless and utterly hostile to those who have survived where they perished. Usual Knocker tactics are to try to get between working miners and the surface, and then strike at the wooden supports to collapse the tunnel whilst driving back those miners who try to escape. Single Knockers are usually destroyed before they can collapse the tunnel, but large accidents produce groups.

Knockers look like rotting corpses that have been crushed under tons of rock and then got up again. They normally carry mining tools and wear badly damaged miners' overalls. It is sometimes possible to recognise them, but normally the body is too badly damaged.

Whilst Knockers seem to arise spontaneously, some people worry that there are Necromancers using them to disrupt mining and take the resources for themselves.

Knocker Characteristics

Main Profile

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

40% 5%

20% 0% 50% 35% 10% 10%

IP FP

Secondary Profile 0 0

A W SB TB M Mag

1 18 5 3 3 0

Skills: Concealment +20%, Silent Move +20%

Talents: Frightening, Night Vision, Undead

Special Rules:

Pit Breaker: A Knocker given three rounds to work uninterrupted can collapse any normal tunnel. Dwarf-work takes six rounds.

Armour: None

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0, Body 0, Legs 0

Weapons: Hand Weapon (pick or hammer)

Inner Montfort is home to one of Bretonnia's largest Imperial expatriate communities and the largest temple of Sigmar on Bretonnian soil.

Tharravil

Tharravil is a mountain village sitting on top of the richest goldmine in the world. The peasants' houses are roofed in gold, and all their domestic utensils are made of the metal. The village itself is built up the side of a shining white mountain, and a stream falls through the centre in a series of picturesque waterfalls. A series of ledges are covered with highly fertile soil, so the villagers rarely need to trade, and when they do send out a caravan of gold, they do so in great secrecy and hand it over directly to the Duke.

Or so the stories go. Most people don't believe Tharravil actually exists, but a few scouts and explorers swear that they have been there. One even had what appeared to be a solid gold roof-tile, but he was found dead with the tile missing a couple of days later.

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Example Monfortian Heinrich Jakersdorf

Heinrich Jakersdorf Race: Human

Career: Sergeant (ex-Man-at-Arms, ex-Yeoman)

Heinrich was born in Inner Montfort, the son of two Imperial expatriates. However, he has never been to the Empire, and Main Profile his Reikspiel is limited to swear words (although in that particular respect it seems to have very few limits). When he was fifteen, the Duke chose him to become a Man-at-Arms. At first Heinrich was surly because he had always planned to be a merchant with two large houses; one in Inner Montfort and one in Altdorf. This changed in his first battle. Secondary Profile There were dozens of Orcs, and they had finally broken through the village's stockade just before Heinrich arrived. The first thing he saw was the most beautiful girl he had ever laid eyes on. The next thing he saw was an Orc sticking a spear in her. He charged with the rest of the men and fought as fiercely

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel
64% 48% 46% 45% 46% 39% 36%
27%
The A W SB TB M Mag IP FP
2 19 3 3 4 0 0 0

and bravely as he knew how. The girl was still alive, barely, and Skills: Animal Care, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia +10%), Heinrich paid for her to be nursed back to health. They have Concealment, Consume Alcohol, Dodge Blow +10%, been married for five years, remarkably happily. Gamble, Gossip, Intimidate, Outdoor Survival, Perception Heinrich resolved to keep fighting to save others who would +10%, Ride, Secret Language (Battle Tongue), Silent Move, otherwise be killed by Greenskins, and he advanced rapidly. He Speak Language (Breton) has just been promoted to Sergeant, giving him command of one of the groups sent out to relieve villages under assault. Heinrich Talents: Hardy, Rover, Specialist Weapon Group (Crossbow, is very proud of his new role and resolved to do his best. Two-handed), Street Fighting, Strike Mighty Blow, Strike to Injure, Strike to Stun, Very Resilient, Very Strong

Adventure Hooks

Special Rules:

Inn of Death Heinrich Jakersdorf gets a +10% bonus to Common Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests concerned with Montfort.

The adventurers are travelling through Axe Bite Pass and arrive at an inn just as darkness falls. The place is very quiet, and the Armour: Medium Armour (Full Mail Armour) adventurers soon discover why: everyone within is dead, cut Armour Points: Head 3, Arms 3, Body 3, Legs 3 down. Whilst there is blood everywhere, there are few other Weapons: Halberd, Hand Weapon (sword), Crossbow with 10 signs of a struggle and no sign of whoever might be responsible.

Leaving the inn at night is very dangerous, but is staying even bolts, Shield. more so? Then the characters notice that there are still signs of life (or movement, at least) in the lord's keep above the inn. not familiar to the miners, but then they wouldn't be even if they were standard Bretonnian. The miners who opened the Lost Tunnels tunnels up have all vanished, as have all miners who have gone into the tunnels for more than a couple of minutes.

A mine breaks into a series of tunnels. They are obviously The lord ordered the opening blocked; it was interfering with artificial and very well made. The decorations on the walls are mining. The miners have made it look like the opening is sealed, but secretly they are trying to find adventurers who will investigate for them. They offer 10% of any treasure found but insist that the lord doesn't find out. Shortly afterwards, they are approached by the lord, with a similar offer.

— Mousillon —

Mousillon is the smallest, poorest, and most of the Forest of Arden. The whole of Mousillon is cursed of the dukedoms of Bretonnia. plagued by extreme weather. When the air is still,

Much of its land was taken by Lyonesse in 836 thick fogs gather. If there is wind, it is always (1814), after the corruption of Duke Merovech strong and almost always accompanied by rain was revealed. The Duke of Mousillon slew the or hail. Thunderstorms are common, as are fires King of Bretonnia and drank his blood before the started by lightning strikes. Fortunately, these assembled nobles. War was the only solution. fires do not spread very far.

The remaining land falls into two areas. In the The hills are rocky and treacherous, and most west, the coastal areas are dominated by swamp vegetation consists of scrubby thorn bushes. The

with isolated areas of higher and firmer ground. In Mousillon Rose also grows in the hills. This bush

the north and east there are rugged hills and the edges has luxuriant evergreen leaves and vivid purple flowers

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that bloom most of the year. the Forest of Arden, but

It looks out of place in the living Beastmen seem to

hills, but it fits right in. The “Landuin was the purest and finest of the Grail avoid the area. The exception

stems are coated with vicious, Companions. He drew all the virtue of his land into his is tales of man-sized rats and

barbed thorns (contact inflicts person and left the country the waste it is now.” Ratmen; such creatures are

1 Wound unless the victim — Sir Emmerin, Knight of Lyonesse, often encountered in the

succeeds on a Toughness shortly before his execution for heresy. swamps.

Test), and the pollen is “Never been there, never want to go. Do I look like an The People a deadly poison. Anyone idiot?”

breathing the pollen must

make a Very Easy (+30%) — Eldegar of Busreq, Coachman

The people of Mousillon

Toughness Test or lose 1 are generally Human,

Wound for every degree of “If you don’t behave, I’ll send you to Mousillon.”

failure. This Test must be though you would not

made every round that the — Threat employed by exasperated always know it to look at mothers across Bretonnia them. Most peasants are

character is within ten feet of “If you don’t behave, I’ll lock you out when the horribly deformed and suffer

a blooming Mousillon Rose.

Eating the pollen makes the monsters come.” constantly from foul diseases.

Test Very Hard (–30%).

What is more, it grows where — Punishment employed by exasperated The residents of Mousillon

mothers in Mousillon. are there because they cannot leave: many deformities that a Human corpse has been left are normal in the dukedom to rot. The sites of old battles turn into thickets of the deadly would get someone burned as a Mutant anywhere else. plant. Indeed, there are a number of Mousillon peasants who are

Mousillon's swamps are even more treacherous. The firm Mutants but who live in what passes for normal society ground of a trail often sinks an inch or so beneath the level of because nobody has realised.

the water. This poses no problem for those in stout boots or Some people do come to Mousillon from outside. These are the on horseback, apart from the existence of sucking mud and most depraved and evil bandits, cultists of the Ruinous Powers, quicksand under the same water a yard or so to either side. To and Necromancers. They believe, rightly, that few people will make matters worse, Swamp Mat creates false trails. Swamp bother to pursue them once they enter the cursed dukedom.

Mat is a grassy plant that grows out from solid ground, over Many such immigrants find that the monsters waiting for them water, mud, and quicksand, forming a raft about six feet wide are more dangerous than any Bounty Hunter, but a few survive and up to hundreds of yards long. It traps mud in its leaves and to add to the peril for the next set of arrivals.

draws much of the water from it, so that the top of the Swamp Mat is hard to distinguish visually from the trails it links to. Mousillon villages look poor and rundown. The peasant hovels

A successful Challenging (~10%) Perception or Outdoor are on the verge of collapsing, streets are little more than

Survival Test reveals the trail isn't solid. Those stepping on sewers, and there are as many dead animals to be seen as living

it can easily tell the difference, however; Swamp Mat cannot ones. The inhabitants watch any visitors silently from their

support anything heavier than a small rodent. homes, cowering within and giving only occasional glimpses of their malformed bodies.

S MThe cursed dukedom is haunted by Undead, in far greater numbers than elsewhere in the kingdom. Indeed, the The castles of the nobility also appear to be decaying, but

here the appearance is somewhat illusory. Ruined portions are land positively encourages the Undead. Undead creatures not unusual, but the parts that are still inhabited are always

summoned by necromantic spells do not revert to normal corpses if they become uncontrolled. Instead, they continue well maintained but never beautiful. The decaying corpses

of gibbeted criminals hang outside most castles, fat ravens to obey their last order until destroyed in combat. Wandering feeding on the remnants. The

Undead can sense the borders of Mousillon and turn back. nobles all wear black armour with a helmet, and they never If forced across, they become ayings of ousillon reveal their faces. normal corpses unless they are still controlled. These energies seem to be appealing to other “He deserves to die”: He’s a remarkably good person. Some are actually Undead, Undead, as well; there are The point is that he deserves to die and stay dead, not Vampires, Wights, or many reports of Vampiric be reanimated to plague the living. Mummies, and the same lord nobility, though not on the “Life is a bed of roses”: Things are hard, with no has ruled for centuries. Others scale of Sylvania. respite. The roses in question are Mousillon Roses. are Mutants, or servants of the Ruinous Powers bearing the marks of their lords. A There are surprisingly “No point crying over spilt blood”: There’s nothing you few are simply Human and few reports of Beastmen. can do to make things better. need to hide that fact lest their Beastmen Zombies and neighbours think them weak. Skeletons are common near

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Adventurers do not need a reason to leave Mousillon. They Mousillon Peasant Deformities left because they were able to do so. Many lived near the borders in the first place and were lucky enough to be born Players creating characters from Mousillon need not roll on undeformed. A few were simply born with more courage and this table; not all Mousillon peasants suffer this way. However, drive than those around them, and for these adventurers, a player may choose to roll once, gaining an additional Fate leaving Mousillon is merely the first step. Almost all lie about Point for his character in return. their origins: Mousillon’s reputation for degenerate evil is not one most adventurers want to carry. Roll Deformity

- 1 Huge tumour on face. –10% to Fellowship
- The Duke of Mousillon Characteristic.
- 2 Shrunk head. –10% to Intelligence Characteristic.
- There is currently no recognised Duke of Mousillon. Duke 3 Constant shaking. –10% to Agility Characteristic.
- Maldred was deprived of his title after the affair of the False 4 Wasted, stick-like limbs. –10% to Strength
- Grail, and no one has been appointed to it since. However, Characteristic.
- there are stories of a mysterious knight raising an army in 5 One hand fused into a paddle. –20% penalty on
- Mousillon and claiming to be the Duke. The King has not yet Skill and Characteristic Tests that

rely on the use of

responded publicly, but it can only be a matter of time. two hands, cannot wield two-handed weapons. A

shield can be strapped to the arm, however.

Significant Places 6 Twisted leg. –1 to Movement Characteristic.

7 Warty growth of skin covering one eye. –20% to

Guerac Circle Ballistic Skill Characteristic, –20% penalty on all

Skill and Characteristic Tests reliant on sight.

Mousillon was not always a cursed land, though the blight 8 Twisted spine. –10% to Weapon Skill Characteristic.

does date back centuries. Guerac Circle is one of the few places 9 Constant hacking cough, which brings up blood.

remaining from before the horror. A stone circle sacred to –10% to Toughness Characteristic.

Taal and Rhya, it stands in the hills of northern Mousillon, 10 Roll twice, applying both deformities.

surrounded by an area of healthy vegetation and wholesome wildlife.

Maintaining this requires constant effort by the Priests of the nature Gods and their assistants. The Priests say the Gods provide for them, and certainly, the hunting in the area is very good. Nevertheless, the guardians are hard-pressed and readily welcome further aid.

The Circle is also renowned as the site of the Oak of Prophecy. This tree grows just outside the stone circle and bears acorns all year round. If you eat one of the acorns, you suffer terrible stomach cramps (treat as The Galloping Trots), but you also see a vision of the future. This vision is always easy to interpret in broad terms and reveals roughly what you must do to avert some disaster that would affect you personally. It doesn't give details. The guardians rely heavily on the Oak to warn them of attacks by the creatures of Mousillon.

Mousillon

The city of Mousillon stands near the mouth of the River Grismerie, surrounded by swamps. It seems to be slowly crumbling back into the swamp, but somehow it still survives. Few parts are actually maintained, the walls being one of the main exceptions. The repairs are not pretty, but they are effective—the residents of the city want to keep the inhabitants of the swamps out in the swamps.

The economy of the city is something of a mystery. There are taverns, brothels, drug dens, fighting pits, and places where even darker vices are indulged. There are shops selling forbidden books, the accoutrements of forbidden cults, and poisons and assassins' tools of every variety. There seem to be no basic food shops, or tailors, or any of the normal

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requirements of a city. Most of the residents seem to have Rachard some business outside the walls, and wagons and boats laden with basic necessities arrive every day. Most observers think Just across the border from Lyonesse stands Rachard, a castle that the Mousillonians barter among themselves for the from which the Lord Rachard rules over a handful of villages.

basics. These villages are remarkable for Mousillon. Most hovels have roofs that do not leak, and the inhabitants look Human, Eustace Undead having nothing more serious than a few warts or straggly hair to mark them out. A lot of people put this down to the fief's Race: Human location at the edge of the dukedom.

Career: Racketeer (ex-Thug) In fact, it is down to the deliberate planning of the lord. He has his men-at-arms scour surrounding villages, bring the least Main Profile deformed peasants to live in his villages. Anyone born with a serious deformity is taken to the castle and never seen again.

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel Dying peasants are also taken to the castle.

Under the castle, in an extensive series of caves, is Lord Rachard's 52% 45% 53% 41% 38% 23% 51% 33% secret. He is a Necromancer, and he has been building an army

of Undead for years. Within Mousillon, the foul creatures simply Secondary Profile wait for his commands, but he knows that he cannot use them outside the dukedom. He cannot control that many.

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP Lord Rachard's plan is to lure his neighbours in Lyonesse into attacking him, crush their armies with Undead, and then use 2 16 5 4 4 0 0 0 his Human men-at-arms to conquer their lands. He is almost ready to start his campaign of provocation.

Skills: Command, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia +10%), Consume Alcohol, Dodge Blow, Evaluate, Gamble, Gossip, Example Mousillonian Haggle, Intimidate, Perception, Secret Language (Thieves' Tongue), Speak Language (Breton) Eustace Undead

Talents: Coolheaded, Disarm, Lightning Reflexes, Menacing, Eustace is a Mousillonian expatriate, who claims he got his

Quick Draw, Resistance to Magic, Resistance to Poison, surname because his parents were both killed and reanimated

Street Fighting, Strike to Injure, Strike to Stun, Strong- when he was a baby, so that he was raised by Zombies. The

minded, Wrestling merchants and traders who share a city with him certainly feel that he is sufficiently unfeeling: Eustace runs a very effective

Special Rules: protection racket.

Eustace gets a +10% to all Common Knowledge (Bretonnia) Eustace is tall and solidly built, except that his head is hairless

Tests related to the dukedom of Mousillon. and the skin drawn so tight it almost looks like a skull. He

Eustace is immune to Fear or Terror caused by Skeletons never shouts, leaving many to suspect that a normal speaking and Zombies. He is affected by other Undead normally. voice is the loudest he can manage. His underlings have Maybe there's something to that story about his parents. seen him gouge a man's eyes out with his bare hands for disobedience. He doesn't have many problems keeping order.

Armour: Light Armour (Leather Jack) Back in Mousillon, Eustace was regarded as a kind-hearted soul,

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 1, Body 1, Legs 0 but his personality has not changed at all. He fled Mousillon

Weapons: Knuckledusters (SB-3 damage) because he could no longer stand the evil around him. Eustace's protection racket is honourable. If you pay his fees, not only will his goons not trash your shop, they will make sure no one else does, either. If people don't pay, he might burn their shop, or break their legs, or possibly have them tortured for an hour or two, but he doesn't kill them or target their families. Eustace still thinks of himself as kind and honourable and is sure that the people around him must be hiding truly vile crimes.

As a champion of virtue, Eustace would like to unmask those crimes. He knows most about the Undead, so he is looking out for evidence of Necromancy. If he finds it, he might need experienced help, the sort provided by adventurers. Even if those adventurers were initially hired by one of the victims in his protection racket.

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Adventure Hooks The bookshops of Mousillon are the only place they are likely to find an intact copy of the text, and without the text they are A Shopping Expedition helpless.

The adventurers are facing a clever opponent, well versed The Swamp is Coming! in Dark Arts. On their last adventure, they learned he was basically invulnerable. However, the Arts he uses are detailed A noble in southern Lyonesse asks the adventurers for help. The in the Librum Foetida, a banned text. It also describes his swampy land of Mousillon is expanding into his fief, bringing weaknesses. The adventurers know this because the copy they the curse of the dukedom with it. He has already had to fight stole from their enemy's lair has those pages ripped out. marauding Zombies twice, but he wants the adventurers to find out what is causing the expansion and stop it.

— Parravon —

In some ways, Parravon is reminiscent of Gisoreux: most of house on fertile land, however, so homes fixed to steep slopes the territory of the dukedom is covered by either mountains can be seen in all regions. or forest. However, the forest in Parravon is the north-eastern portion of the Forest of Loren, a very different place from the The castles of Parravon are noted for their high towers. In the Forest of Arden. forest, this allows lookouts to see over the trees, although they can't really see anything approaching through the forest itself. Most of the border between Parravon and the Elsewhere, it is an architectural preference more realm of the Fay runs along the River Grismerie. than anything else, though knights with Pegasus Where the river turns south, however, the border mounts do often stable them at the top of such turns north to meet the mountains. The border towers. Most Pegasus appreciate being high up. is marked by a line of trees, guided over centuries into an elaborate network of interlocking The People branches. Even the most city-bred Dwarf can tell that they are not natural. The Fay stay out of Parravon and expect the Parravonese to return the The forest folk of Parravon stand somewhat apart favour. Deliberate trespassers are dealt with harshly. from the rest of the population. Many ordinary Bretonnians think that they are part Fay (which is nonsense) and that they have some sort of extraordinary The Bretonnians are very reluctant to log extensively sense for the hazards of the world around them (which is within the Forest of Loren, even the part that the Fay have true). The forest folk move through the world as if they could permitted them to claim. There is a sense that the whole forest be punished with death for scraping against a tree. Even those is very closely connected to the Lady of the Lake and is therefore who leave try to disturb nothing, including piles of rubbish. sacred. Wood from the forest is often used in the construction of Many of those who leave do so because they are tired of feeling Grail Chapels but, even then, the use is sparing. Those villages that they are constantly watched by forces only too willing to within the forest live by herding pigs, gathering from the forest, punish infractions. and minimal farming. Many are built around the trees rather than clearing them, and most have platforms in the branches to serve as refuges from attacking Orcs. The rest of the Parravonese travel a lot. For centuries, it has been the custom for children to leave home at adolescence and be raised by relatives in a different village. After that, they travel S PMuch of the population of Parravon is found in Parravon Vale, to yet another village to be properly trained. When they marry, they are expected to settle in still another place. This scatters a fertile valley cradled in the mountains. The land around the families across the dukedom, but family members still gather for edge is pastoral, but the central portion, running down to the

Grismerie, is arable. Villages one of the annual holidays, here look much like typical almost always a summer Bretonnian settlements. one. Parravonese nobles The Grey Mountains become ayings of arravon have similar customs and so

less sharp and jagged as they “Duelling an avalanche”: Utterly futile activity. invariably grant permission to pass through Parravon, so the travel for these purposes. number of people who can “If you always look back, you never get home”: Most live and farm there increases. things cannot be done in the obvious way. Or, look On one hand, this means that Villages clinging to cliff faces to the future rather than the past. Parravonese know that there exist in the north, but south “He’s got holes in his ankles”: He can drink an is a world outside their village of the city of Parravon there enormous amount without showing any ill effects. and are confident about travel. is more flat and infertile People showing such ill effects sometimes decide to On the other, they tend to land, so most houses are built check for the holes. think they have seen everything on the level. No one in the already, and anything that is mountains would build a true all over Parravon is true

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all over the world. The combination of these attitudes and the willingness of Parravonese nobles to permit travel have led to very large numbers of adventurers coming from this dukedom. Whilst many head home after their first adventure when the world proves a bit too different, others persevere. The internal politics of the dukedom appear to be calm and harmonious. However, Duke Cassyon’s neglect of the diplomatic functions of his office has led to growing resentments under the surface. Two lords in the north of the dukedom, Sir Liutpol and Sir Fredergar, have been disputing over the right to gather a toll at a particular point on the Grismerie for years. There is no sign of a ducal resolution, and a feud between them would have a serious effect on river trade and thus on the whole dukedom. External relations are generally good, but that may not last. Sir Chloderic, in the extreme south, is eyeing the mountains to the south of his fief acquisitively. They are part of the Empire, but they do not seem to be firmly held, and he suspects that there may exploitable veins of metal. When he makes a move, he will technically be invading the Empire, and once the Empire notices, the repercussions will be profound.

Duke Cassyon of Parravon

Duke Cassyon is the youngest of the Dukes of Bretonnia, still in his early twenties. Nevertheless, he is a Grail Knight and rides a Royal Pegasus. His father died whilst Cassyon was questing for the Grail, and the young Duke knew nothing of his status until he returned to Parravon.

The Duke's counsellors find him very frustrating. He is an open and enthusiastic young man, bearing no malice towards anyone, which makes it almost impossible to dislike him. On the other hand, he believes he can fulfil his ducal duties simply by riding across the skies of the dukedom and striking down monsters. There is no doubt that he is good at that, but there are matters of taxation, justice, and administration that should also be seen to. Duke Cassyon's prowess has not escaped the notice of the Parravonese, and the story that he is Duke Agilgar reborn has recently started to spread.

Significant Places

The Glade of Children

Deep within the forests of Parravon is a glade of trees surrounding a deep, still pool of water. Dolls lie around the place in various stages of decay, and there are usually a handful of Bretonnian women here.

This is because the Fay sometimes return children in this glade. The Fay are not perfect, and sometimes they take a child with no magical talent. In such cases, they bring the child to this glade and, if there is a suitable woman present, leave the child with her as she sleeps. The woman then leaves the doll of her stolen child as a thank-offering.

The Fay only leave children if all the women in the glade are asleep. Sleeping in the middle of a forest with no guards is not

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particularly safe, and there are no villages close to the glade. This makes the trip here very dangerous. What is more, most women do not receive a child, and it is almost unheard of for a woman to receive her own child.

Almost. It does happen occasionally, and that is enough for some mothers.

Parravon

Parravon is a starkly impressive city, carved directly from the rock of the mountains. It is part of an outcrop at the edge of a spur of the Grey Mountains, and the River Grismerie runs along its base. Over the millennia, the people of Parravon have cut homes, businesses, walls, Grail Chapels, and palaces from the stone.

Brettonnia's sumptuary laws state only nobles can use stone in building. However, the Dukes of Parravon have never wanted wooden buildings messing up their glorious city, so they have long maintained that a peasant living in a carved stone building is no different from a peasant living in a cave. Indeed, given the quality of many peasant homes in Parravon, the difference really is minimal. The wealthy merchants of Parravon naturally push this allowance to the limit. corpses of the noble family living there, mixed with the Orcs they had slain. This is not too unusual, so another noble family Parravon is the only city in Brettonnia with a substantial was allowed to send a younger son to take over. Within ten population of Dwarfs. Most of them were originally Imperial years, his whole family was slaughtered in battle with Orcs. The expatriates, but some came directly from the Dwarfholds of the Vaults and World's Edge next lord was a knight with years of experience of fighting the Orcs of the mountains, but Mountains. There are now within fifteen years, he went some Dwarf families who have lived there for generations, "The Fay have entrusted this part of the forest to us. If the same way. At this point, though they still keep we betray that trust, the trees themselves will weep. And people decided the Orcs could themselves somewhat apart the Fay will come, disembowel us, and hang our entrails have the castle; it wasn't that from the Human citizens. from the branches." valuable.

Castle Parravon, seat of the — Old Euric, Village Elder Orcs did move in, but scouts Dukes, dominates the top of aiming to recover kidnap the outcrop with its soaring "We grant them that forest on sufferance. We watch victims found the castle towers. Like the rest of the them carefully, and if they become a threat to us or the full of dead Orcs, as if they city, it is carved from living forest, we will disembowel them and hang their entrails had died fighting amongst from the branches." themselves. That, again, was

rock, and thus has not been — Lessiantar, Elven warband leader not particularly unlikely, but it significantly altered since it happened again, and recently was first carved, two thousand "All the nobles ride Pegasus and so forget that the rest even the Orcs have abandoned years ago. The Dukes have of us need roads to get around. Double all travel time the place. It seems that there

needed more space, however, estimates if you want to be sure.” is a group of Orcs that really and have extended the castle — Eldegar of Busreq, Coachman does not want anyone to live down into an extensive series there; which raises the obvious of tunnels. question of “why?”

Underground rooms are quite common in Parravon, as they are Example Parravonese often less work to carve than an aboveground house. Tunnels linking those rooms are also common, and tunnels further back Estrebert into the mountain provide more storage. It is said that you can go from any point in the city to any other without taking more Estrebert is a Battle Pilgrim, and he followed his Grail Knight, than ten steps under the open sky. Parts of the tunnel network Sir Letour, for over twenty years. He bears the scars of that have been abandoned by Humans, and darker creatures now time, and his cropped hair is going grey, but he is still a solidly live there. built warrior. He is the unquestioned leader of the Grail Pilgrims around Sir Letour, as no one has more experience than Sanglac Castle he does. Still, Estrebert does not claim to lead, as he is just one more loyal follower of the Knight. Sanglac Castle is an abandoned castle in the heart of the Grey Mountains. A century ago, messengers found it full of the

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Estrebert personal theory: if he died saving the life of a Grail Knight, he would be reborn as a noble, and thus would be able to seek the Race: Human Grail. He believes this absolutely, even though his only reason Career: Champion (ex-Battle Pilgrim, ex-Grail Pilgrim, ex- for it is that he would very much like it to be true.

Estrebert came very close to fulfilling his dream a few years ago. Sir Veteran) Letour was beset by dozens of Beastmen, and despite his valour, he was being worn down. Estrebert leapt into the fray, killing Main Profile many of the creatures and taking many serious wounds. When the Pilgrim collapsed beside the knight and heard the sound of WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel breathing, he thought he had won and could die in peace. But he survived. Sir Letour had him nursed back to health, and 77% 54% 61% 62% 66% 38% 47% 42% as they were preparing to leave, the knight dropped his helmet at

Estrebert’s feet, leaving before the pilgrim had a chance to return Secondary Profile it. The helmet is now Estrebert’s most prized possession, and the experience has only hardened his resolve to die gloriously.

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

Adventure Hooks

3 21 6 6 5 0 0 0

Git Orf Moi Larnd!

Skills: Charm, Command, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia),

Consume Alcohol, Dodge Blow +20%, Evaluate, Gamble, A Dwarf living in Parravon has discovered solid evidence

Gossip, Haggle, Intimidate, Outdoor Survival, Perception, that the city, particularly the castle, were originally carved by

Secret Language (Battle Tongue), Speak Language (Breton) Dwarfs. This does not surprise the other Dwarfs in the slightest.

However, further investigation suggests the Dwarfhold was

Talents: Etiquette, Flee!, Fleet Footed, Hardy, Lightning Reflexes, sacked by the Bretonni, led by the ancestors of the Duke of

Mighty Shot, Public Speaking, Quick Draw, Seasoned Traveller, Parravon. Such an attack would demand vengeance.

Specialist Weapon Group (Crossbow, Two-handed), Stout- The adventurers have to stop the Dwarfs before they can carry

hearted, Strike Mighty Blow, Strike to Injure, Strike to Stun, out their vengeance. And maybe that evidence was planted by

Strong-minded, Sturdy, Very Resilient, Very Strong someone with an interest in instability.

Special Rules: Wherever You May Wander...

Estrebert gets a +10% bonus to all Common Knowledge

(Bretonnia) Tests concerned with Parravon. For the first time in over a decade, a Parravonese character

returns to the village where he was born. His family is pleased

Armour: Heavy Armour (Full Mail Armour, Helmet from a to see him, and the adventurers are just in time for a traditional

Grail Knight) festival. But now, with wider experience, the native realises

that there is something wrong about this festival, something

Armour Points: Head 5, Arms 3, Body 3, Legs 3 that suggests a link to the Ruinous Powers. Can he save his

Weapons: Best Craftsmanship Halberd, Best Craftsmanship birthplace without destroying it?

Crossbow and 20 Bolts

Estrebert was born in Parravon Vale and first saw a Grail

Knight in action against Beastmen when he was nine. This set

his course for life. At first, of course, he wanted to be a Grail

Knight, but he soon realised his peasant blood rendered him

unacceptable in the eyes of the Lady. He then formed a very

— Quenelles —

Quenelles is the largest of the dukedoms of Bretonnia, are relatively low, rounded, and eroded into networks of caves.

stretching over most of the middle of the land. In the These caves are inhabited by large numbers of Greenskins

east, it has a long border with the Forest of

Loren, and Quenellers have more direct dealings who mount frequent raids on the surrounding

with the Fay than the inhabitants of any other settlements. dukedom. To the south, the dukedom faces Few Humans choose to live in the Massif, but Carcassonne across the River Brienne, and then, the Dukes encourage a Human settlement in the working clockwise, borders Brionne, Aquitaine, hope of weakening the Orcs. Most villages are Bastonne, Montfort, and Parravon, divided from sacked within a few years, so ruined villages and the last two by the River Grismerie. castles are a common sight. However, a few have Broadly speaking, northern Quenelles is pastoral survived, and these are now very well fortified. whilst the south is arable. The north of the country The most notable is Viefin, which sits at the end is dominated by the Massif Orcal, a range of of the road through Axe Bite Pass. Viefin is a small mountains rising up in the middle of the land and the town, but the houses are dwarfed by the massive walls source of the River Gilleau. The mountains of the Massif and watchtowers. All inhabitants of Viefin are trained to fight, and all but the very youngest or newest immigrants

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have experience of fighting Dwarfs, seeking to drive attacking Orcs. the Greenskins from the Between the Massif Orcal and “The enemy is in the heart of our lands, like a cancer. Dwarfholds. We will not let it grow, and, Lady willing, we shall cut

the River Gilleau is a part of it out once and for all.” The politics of the dukedom

the Forest of Châlons. This — Duke Tancred II, raising another force to assault are dominated by the area seems almost completely the Massif Orcal succession question, as Duke free of monsters: one or two Tancred is not the only one small groups of Beastmen or “They’ve got so much land. It’s not like they’d really to have noticed that he is

Orcs are seen in a year. Small miss a bit.” getting old. If Einhard returns

groups of hunters, charcoal — Sir Renart, a noble of Montfort (see Duke Tancred II of burners, or woodsmen can Quenelles, below), he is the work in the forest unmolested. “I hear the Fay themselves walk the streets of Quenelles, clear heir, but most Questing All attempts to establish working wonders. That would be something to see!” Knights who are going to

villages have failed, ending — Ignorant and credulous L’Anguille tavern keeper, return have done so within in the complete destruction ten years. There are about half of the village. The village is talking to a Sea Elf Wizard. a dozen nobles with a realistic

replaced, overnight, by a bare claim to the dukedom, but depression in the soil, as if two stand out. something had scooped up the entire settlement and taken it away. The Quenellers suspect something similar happens to Earl Hincmar is the eldest son of the Duke's elder sister. He is large bands of Orcs or Beastmen. Nobody knows who or, more also lord of a large fief around the Massif Orcal and known for likely, what is responsible. his great courage in the face of Orc raids. He is feared even by his own vassals, as he is famous for the arbitrary cruelty of his The southwest of Quenelles was once, before the founding "justice." of Bretonnia, the land of Cuileux. The knights of Cuileux were wiped out by Goblinoids and their lands absorbed by Lord Therevault is the grandson of the Duke's younger brother, Quenelles. However, the courage of the last stand of the Cuilen and the next male in line if Einhard does not return. However, has made them legendary. A large area is known as the Grave he is not yet twenty and became a Knight of the Realm of Cuileux and is not farmed. Stories say that anyone who prematurely on his father's death in a hunting accident. The tries to do so is killed by the ghosts of the knights of Cuileux, accident was clearly genuine, but Therevault is not ready to who believe that only an Orc would disturb their rest. The rule. A number of wilier nobles are thus backing him, hoping occasional discovery of Orc and Human bones in the area to have a pliable puppet.

tends to suggest that this really is the site of the last ride of the The final decision rests with the King, but Duke Tancred is not Cuilen. the only noble who really hopes that Einhard can be found. Earl Hincmar would really like Einhard to be found dead. Lord The People Therevault does not know what he thinks.

The people of Quenelles are most renowned for their Duke Tancred II of Quenelles unrelenting hatred of the Greenskins that constantly raid their lands. This is a little strange: it is certainly true the inhabitants Duke Tancred II has been a fine lord of Quenelles. His finest of the Massif Orcal raid very frequently, but Greenskin raids moment was the defeat of the Necromancer Heinrich Kemmler have not had the same effect in other regions. Some people and the Chaos Champion Krell, who allied with the Skaven think that the dead of Cuileux have placed some sort of curse and attacked the abbey of La Maisontall. That was in 1513 on the inheritors of their (2491), and the Duke is now an old man, somewhat stooped land, compelling them to continue the fight. Certainly, and shrunken, but still showing his old vigour.

it is notable that every single Sayings of Quenelles The Duke himself, however,

Queneller festival involves now feels his mortality
 burning a Goblin or Orc, in "He'd invest in the Loren Logging Company": He really strongly and
 worries about the
 either effigy or a real one. is incredibly gullible.
 future of his dukedom. Duke
 Tancred had four sons. The
 A lot of Queneller adventurers "He's scented Orc blood": He thinks he has a chance to eldest
 died defeating a Wight
 left to take the fight to the do well at something. who had raised an army of
 Greenskins. Such folk often "Your mother was an Orc": An insult that can start Undead within
 Quenelles
 head into the Massif Orcal, generations-long blood feuds. itself. The second died as a
 but there are Goblins and "Your mother was a Snotling": Joking insult, used a lot Knight Errant in
 the battle
 Orcs in all mountain ranges, between friends. against Heinrich Kemmler.
 so others go further afield. The third was a dissipated
 They often ally with the wastrel who drowned in a cask

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of wine three years ago. The Duke's fourth son, Einhard, left on fourth could be a worthy
 successor. Either way, he wants to
 his Grail Quest some ten years ago and has not been heard of know, as he feels he must make
 definite arrangements for the
 since. future of the dukedom.
 Ten years is a long Grail Quest, but far from the longest on The Duke of Quenelles is the only
 Duke to use a lesser title
 record. Tancred fears all his sons are dead, but he hopes the with any frequency. He is also Earl
 of Cuileux, and out of

respect for the brave knights of that land, he issues
 charters and decisions affecting that region over
 that title.

Significant Places

The Barrows of Cuileux

The Barrows of Cuileux should not be confused
 with the Grave of Cuileux. The Grave is the site of
 the last battle between the Knights of Cuileux and
 the Greenskin horde. The Barrows of Cuileux are
 where the Cuilen buried their dead. The barrows
 are scattered over a wide area north of the Gilleau,
 some in the Forest of Châlons and some in the
 mountains of the Massif Orcal. A typical barrow

has about twenty burial chambers linked by tunnels, but some are far, far larger. Adventurers claim to have seen a barrow the size of a town within the forest but said that they were driven off by the Undead guarding it.

Most of the barrows in the lowlands are now merely empty shells, long looted of grave goods by Orcs and Bretonnians alike. There are a few with Undead guardians, and these still survive intact.

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The barrows in the mountains and forest are likely to still hold Sir Notker's ancient treasures and ancient monsters.

Race: Human

Quenelles Career: Grail Knight (ex-Knight Errant, ex-Knight of the

The city of Quenelles sits right on the border of the Forest Realm, ex-Questing Knight) of Loren. Indeed, the walls do not guard the eastern edge of the city: instead, they run up to the trees and stop. A broad Main Profile stone road runs along the border of the forest. This used to be the eastern wall, but it was cast down over a thousand WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel years ago at the command of the Fay. Pilgrims come from all over Bretonnia to stand on the road and gaze into the 67% 25% 60% 59% 50% 42% 55% 55% forest, hoping to catch a glimpse of the Fay. Some are lucky enough to do so, as the Fay keep a constant watch on the Secondary Profile city, but most see nothing that does not come from their own imagination. A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

As a result of the flux of pilgrims, the eastern end of the city is the entertainment district, with many inns, taverns, and houses 3 17 6 5 4 0 0 0 of ill repute. Castle Quenelles stands to the north, a surprisingly modest structure given the power of the dukedom. Rumour has Skills: Academic Knowledge (Genealogy/Heraldry, Religion,

it that the Fay have forbidden any major expansion. Strategy/Tactics), Animal Care, Animal Training, Charm,

Just to the west of the eastern border road stands a Grail Command, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia +10%, the

Chapel unique in Bretonnia. Called the Chapel of the Empire), Dodge Blow +20%, Gossip, Outdoor Survival,

Enchantress, its windows depict the Fay Enchantress rather Perception, Ride, Secret Language (Battle Tongue), Speak

than the Lady of the Lake. There are always at least two Grail Language (Breton, Reikspiel)

Knights keeping the place, though few do the job for more

than a year. Rumours speak of treasures under the chapel or Talents: Etiquette, Grail Virtue of the Penitent, Grudge-born

claim the Fay Enchantress herself visits at least once per year. Fury, Luck, Night Vision,

Resistance to Chaos, Seasoned

Traveller, Specialist Weapon Group (Cavalry, Two-handed),

Example Queneller Strike Mighty Blow, Strike to Injure, Sturdy, Very Resilient,

Very Strong, Virtue of Chivalry, Virtue of the Penitent,

Sir Notker Warrior Born

Sir Notker is a Grail Knight, still fresh from his vision of the Special Rules:

Lady of the Lake. He was born in the city of Quenelles where Sir Notker gets a +10% bonus on all Common Knowledge

his parents had a townhouse. Whilst his parents were both (Bretonnia) Tests concerned with the dukedom of

members of the nobility, their fief was small and most of the Quenelles.

family's money actually came from a set of taverns and bawdy

houses in the east of the city. When Notker learnt this, he was Armour: Heavy Armour (Full Plate Armour)

desperately ashamed and decided to become a Grail Knight to Armour Points: Head 5, Arms 5, Body 5, Legs 5

wipe the stain from his family's honour. Weapons: Lance, Great Weapon (two-handed sword)

As a Questing Knight, he crossed the whole of Bretonnia

and much of the Empire to fight the Greenskins. In the end, Adventure Hooks

however, the Lady appeared to him in Quenelles, on the east

road, within sight of the place that he was born. He took this The Heir of Cuileux

as a sign that he should remain in Quenelles and has moved

back into his parents' townhouse, though he spends most of A peasant from Cuileux is

circulating through the countryside,

his time at the various Grail Chapels in the city, praying for claiming to be the true heir of the last Duke of Cuileux. The

further guidance. His parents are terribly conflicted. On the nobility are treating him as a bandit and revolutionary, but he

one hand, they are inordinately proud of their son the Grail is acting more like a Faceless and winning the support of the

Knight. On the other hand, they are terribly ashamed of their peasantry. The adventurers have contacts in Quenelles and get

commercial transactions, and well aware they cannot survive caught up in the problem. The man may well be a fraud, and

without them. even if he is genuine, he might not have the best interests of

As Sir Notker still waits for a specific calling as a Grail Knight, the country at heart.

he could easily become embroiled in an adventure involving

the player characters. Respect for the Dead

Undead from one of the Barrows of Cuileux plague the

local communities. Knights have been sent to deal with the

situation, but there are too many to defeat and more seem to

arise all the time. Investigation reveals the Undead are taking

revenge because some particularly sacred grave goods were

stolen. Further investigation reveals they were taken by Orcs.

The adventurers need to bring them back.

Chapter VII: Characters and Careers

Characters Chapter and Careers VII

“Don’t argue with the Shepherdesses.”

- Tilean merchant’s advice to his son
before the latter left for Bretonnia.

Shepherds tend their flocks in the rocky expanse of war. Bretonnia is a very different land from the Empire, and Carcassonne. Knights of the Realm defend the borders of its natives differ from Imperial citizens and pursue different Couronne from the depredations of the foul greenskins. The careers. This chapter provides details on the starting skills and peasantry toil in the fields of their liege lords, exchanging their talents of Bretonnians, as well as details of several uniquely back-breaking labor for a humble hovel and protection in times Bretonnian careers.

— Bretonnian Racial Features —

The upbringing and life experience of the people of Racial Features by Bretonnia—whether noble or peasant—is notably Dukedom (Optional) quite different than that of a citizen of the Empire. Society functions in a very different manner, and this is reflected in the The dukedoms of Bretonnia differ substantially from one characteristics of Bretonnian characters. Human racial features another, as do their inhabitants. A character from the shadowy given on page 19 of WFRP are, obviously, appropriate only for recesses of the Forest of Arden has a significantly different citizens of the Empire. For a basic Bretonnian character, replace upbringing than one from the mountains of Carcassonne. those features with the following ones: Instead of using the basic Bretonnian features given above, you may choose to use the features appropriate to your dukedom, Bretonnian Racial Features as given below. The sample characters in Chapter VI use the dukedom racial features.
Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Gossip, Speak Language (Breton) L’Anguille

Talents: Two random talents (roll twice on Table 2-4: A L’Anguille gains the following skills and talents:
Random Talents on page 19 of WFRP to generate). Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Evaluate or Sail,

Optional Rule: If the campaign takes place primarily in the Gossip or Haggle, Speak Language (Breton)

Empire, you may replace one of your starting career Talents: one random talent skills with Speak Language (Reikspiel). You may buy the Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common

replaced skill through normal means with experience

points earned through play, and you must do so to Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native

complete your starting career. Imperial characters joining dukedom of L'Anguille.

a primarily Bretonnian campaign may use this rule to

acquire Speak Language (Breton).

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Aquitaine Bastonne

An Aquitainian gains the following skills and talents: A Bastonnian gains the following skills and talents:

Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Gossip, Speak Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Gossip, Speak

Language (Breton) Language (Breton)

Talents: Coolheaded, one random talent Talents: Stout-hearted, one random talent

Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common

Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native

dukedom of Aquitaine. dukedom of Bastonne.

Artois Bordeleaux

An Artoin gains the following skills and talents: A Bordelen gains the following skills and talents:

Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia) or Outdoor Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Consume Alcohol,

Survival, Gossip or Perception, Speak Language Gossip, Speak Language (Breton) (Breton) Talents: One random talent

Talents: Two random talents Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common

Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common

Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native

dukedom of Artois. If you do not start with the skill, dukedom of Bordeleaux.

this bonus applies once you gain it.

Note: If you choose not take Common Knowledge Brionne

(Bretonnia) at character creation, your character is considered to be from an isolated village in the Forest A Bretonnian gains the following skills and talents:

of Arden. Remember that Common Knowledge is an Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Gossip, Performer

Advanced Skill, so this means that, without it, your character does not even know the name of the King of (Musician) or Performer (Singer), Speak Language

Bretonnia, possibly not even that Bretonnia has a king. (Breton)

Indeed, it's an open question whether he has heard of Talents: One random talent

Bretonnia at all. Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common

Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native dukedom of Bordeleaux.

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Carcassonne Gisoreux

A Carcassonnian gains the following skills and talents: A Gisoren gains the following skills and talents:

Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Gossip, Speak Skills: Charm or Outdoor Survival, Common Knowledge

Language (Breton) (Bretonnia), Gossip, Speak Language (Breton)

Talents: Birth Sword (see page 66) (if male and noble) or Talents: One random talent

Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common

Warrior Born, one random talent.

Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native

dukedom of Gisoreux.

Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native

dukedom of Carcassonne. Lyonesse

Couronne A Lyonen gains the following skills and talents:

Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Gossip, Speak

A Couronnian gains the following skills and talents:

Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Gossip, Ride, Speak Language (Breton)

Talents: Schemer, one random talent

Language (Breton) Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common

Talents: Trick Riding

Trappings: Ordinary riding horse with saddle and tack. If your Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native

dukedom of Lyonesse.

career gives you a horse, use the better option. You do

not get two horses. Montfort

Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common

Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native A Montfortian gains the following skills and talents:

dukedom of Couronne. Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Gossip, Speak

<table> Language (Breton)

Talents: Hardy, one random talent

Table 7-1: Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common

Bretonnian Names

Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native

Roll Female Male dukedom of Montfort.

01-05 Armengild Aiden

06-10 Aigulf Mousillon

11-15 Bertha Bertelis

16-20 Chrodegard Carloman A Mousillonian gains the following skills and talents:

21-25 Chrodegang Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Gossip, Speak

26-30 Dhuoda Ferragus

31-35 Eleanor Hrodbert Language (Breton)

36-40 Hrotswitha Jacen Talents: Strong-minded, one random talent

41-45 Heloise Louis Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common

46-50 Isabel Merovech

51-55 Isolde Odo Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native

56-60 Lisseut Orderic dukedom of Mousillon.

61-65 Marie Panteleon

66-70 Mathilde Piers Parravon

71-75 Nimugild Redemund

76-80 Perlesault Roland A Parravonese gains the following skills and talents:

81-85 Rhadegund Suidbert Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Gossip, Speak

86-90 Rumengild Theudis

91-95 Sirisgard Waldon Language (Breton)

96-00 Sonengund Yonec Talents: Seasoned Traveller or Sixth Sense, one random talent

Vermengard Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common

Walswitha

Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native

dukedom of Parravon.

Quenelles

A Queneller gains the following skills and talents:

Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Gossip, Speak

Language (Breton)

Talents: Grudge-born Fury, one random talent

Special Rules: You gain a +10% bonus on Common

Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with your native

dukedom of Quenelles.

Chapter VII: Characters and Careers

— Bretonnian Careers —

Most careers from the WFRP rulebook are suitable for Trappings: Halberd, Bow and 20 Arrows, Medium Armour (Full

use in Bretonnia. The main exceptions are the Wizard Mail Armour)

careers, that is, any career with “Wizard” as part of its name. In

addition, some, such as Pistolier, are linked to specific Imperial Career Entries: Grail Pilgrim organisations with no Bretonnian equivalent.

Other careers may need some modifications. The most common Career Exits: Faceless, Sergeant, Vagabond, Veteran

is to replace Common Knowledge (the Empire) and Speak

Language (Reikspiel) with Common Knowledge (Bretonnia) and Note: Women may only become Battle Pilgrims if they are disguised

Speak Language (Breton), respectively. This simply represents the as men, nobles only if they are disguised as peasants.

Bretonnian version of the career. Others are best replaced with

the Bretonnian careers described below; these include Squire Carcassonne Shepherd

(replace with Knight Errant), Knight (replace with Knight of the

Realm), and Soldier (replace with Man at Arms). Description: The shepherds of Carcassonne are the dukedom's

The following careers are rarely pursued outside Bretonnia, and first line of defence against the Orc raiders who infest the

even then they are normally followed by Bretonnia expatriates. mountains. They often work alone, though a new recruit may be

paired with an older individual. Obviously, a single Human, no

Battle Pilgrim matter how well trained, cannot expect to take on an entire Orc

war-band, so the Shepherds are trained to gather information,

Description: Battle Pilgrims are Grail Pilgrims who have slow the band down, and report its location to the local nobility.

survived following their Grail Knight for some time. As a They also look after flocks

result, they have become competent fighters. In most cases, of sheep. A shepherd who

they have also become even more fervent admirers of their loses his sheep is mercilessly

Grail Knight and worshippers of the Lady of the Lake, having mocked by his fellows,

seen what the flower of Bretonnian chivalry is truly capable of. which leads many of them to take absurd risks to recover

Battle Pilgrims are the effective even a single lost lamb.

leaders of groups of Grail Male and female

Pilgrims, as the Grail Knight characters may

never condescends to give freely enter this

orders to peasant rabble. career. Bretonnian

Some Grail Pilgrims nobles would have

resent taking orders from to conceal their noble

someone no better than background to do so,

they, so Battle Pilgrims but that does happen.

often have to impose

order by force. Wiser Grail — Carcassone Shepherd Advance Scheme —
Pilgrims note that their

Main Profile

chances of survival are greatly
increased by doing as the Battle WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel
Pilgrims say.

+5% +10% — — +10% +5% — —

Secondary Profile

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

— Battle Pilgrim Advance Scheme — +1 +2 — — — — —

Main Profile Skills: Animal Care, Concealment, Dodge Blow, Perception, Scale
Sheer Surface, Secret Signs (Scout), Set Trap, Silent Move
WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

+20% +10% +10% +10% +15% +10% +10% +10% Talents: Flee!, Fleet-footed, Rover,
Sharpshooter

Secondary Profile Trappings: Bow with 10 Arrows, Light Armour (Leather Jerkin),
Shepherd's Crook (treat as Quarter staff), Herd of Sheep or
A W SB TB M Mag IP FP Cute Little Lamb

+1 +6 — — — — — Career Entries: Grail Pilgrim, Hunter, Outlaw, Outrider, Peasant,
Woodsman, Vagabond
Skills: Charm, Command, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Dodge
Blow, Haggle, Intimidate, Outdoor Survival, Perception Career Exits: Grail Pilgrim, Herrimault,
Outlaw, Scout, Vagabond,
Veteran
Talents: Flee!, Hardy, Public Speaking, Stout-hearted, Strike to
Stun, Strong-minded, Very Resilient, Very Strong Note: This is a Basic Career, so any character
can enter it at any time
by paying 200 xp.

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Faceless Grail Knight

Description: All bands of Herrimaults Description: Grail
have a leader; if a group gathers by Knights are the flower
chance, either a leader arises of Bretonnian chivalry,
or the group fragments the ideal to which all
once more. Successful bands other knights aspire, at
of Herrimaults are almost least in theory. The King

always led by a Faceless, an of Bretonnia is always individual highly experienced a Grail Knight, as in the pursuit of right and justice by are a number unconventional means. of the Dukes.

Faceless, unlike conventional There are also, Outlaw Chiefs, rarely have to however, many worry about being stabbed in Grail Knights of the back by their own followers. lesser rank, including Similarly, most encourage potential Faceless in the hermit knights who their band to develop and then establish their spend their lives tending own group. Ethics have their advantages. Grail Chapels.

On the other hand, they have to keep their band fed, find shelter, and right wrongs, all without stepping over the ethical Those who have drunk from lines that they set for themselves. Eventually, some find the the Grail are transformed. Their dedication to the ideals of pressure too great. chivalry becomes absolute, and most shine with a Fay light.

Most Faceless cultivate an air of mystery, wearing a deep hood This light fades over a few days after the knight drinks from to hide their features. Some are rumoured to be powerful the grail, but it may brighten once more when he is fighting nobles, even Grail Knights, righting wrongs they cannot particularly bravely for the Lady of the Lake.

publicly acknowledge.

It is not possible to enter this career unless the Lady of the Lake — Faceless Advance Scheme — has appeared to you and offered you a sip from the Grail. The Lady only appears to true sons of Bretonnia whom she judges Main Profile to be worthy, so foreigners, women, and peasants cannot enter this career.

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel — Grail Knight Advance Scheme —

+10% +30% +10% +20% +10% +10% +10% +35% Main Profile

Secondary Profile WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP +40% — +30% +30% +25% +10% +25% +25%

+2 +6 — — — — — Secondary Profile

Skills: Academic Knowledge (Strategy/Tactics), Charm, A W SB TB M Mag IP FP Command, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Concealment, Follow Trail, Gossip, Outdoor +2 +8 — — — — — Survival, Perception, Scale Sheer Surface, Secret Language (Battle Tongue), Secret Signs (Ranger Skills: Academic Knowledge (Genealogy/Heraldry) Academic Knowledge or Scout), Silent Move (Religion), Academic Knowledge (Strategy/Tactics), Charm, Command, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Dodge Blow, Talents: Mighty Shot, Public Speaking, Rapid Reload, Sure Shot, Perception, Ride, Secret

Language (Battle Tongue)

Unsettling

Talents: Grail Virtue (the one that matches the character's Virtue of

Trappings: Bow with 10 Arrows, Medium Armour (Sleeved Mail Knighthood), Luck, Public

Speaking, Resistance to Chaos,

Shirt and Leather Jack), Band of Herrimaults, Deep Hood or Sixth Sense, Specialist Weapon

Group (Two-handed), Stout-

Mask hearted, Strike Mighty Blow, Strike to Injure, Sturdy, Very

Resilient, Very Strong, Warrior Born

Career Entries: Battle Pilgrim, Crime Lord, Demagogue, Knight of Trappings: Heavy Armour (Full Plate Armour), Shield, Icon of the

the Realm, Noble Lord, Outlaw Chief, Politician, Questing Lady of the Lake, Destrier with Saddle and Harness, Sip from

Knight, Steward, Veteran the Grail

Career Exits: Crime Lord, Demagogue, Explorer, Highwayman, Career Entries: Questing Knight Outlaw Chief

Note: Women can only become Faceless if disguised as men. Career Exits: Captain, Courtier, Explorer, Faceless, Noble Lord, Politician

Note: Only male Bretonnian nobles can become Grail Knights. The Lady of the Lake is not fooled by disguises.

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Table 7-2: Bretonnian Starting Careers

Roll	Career	Roll	Career	Roll	Career	Roll	Career
01–02	Agitator	25	Ferryman	73–75	Servant		
46–47	Messenger						
03	Bailiff	26–27	Fisherman	76–77	Smuggler		
04	Barber-Surgeon	28	Grave Robber	48–49	Militiaman	78–79	Student
05–06	29 Grail Pilgrim	50–51	Miner	80–81			
07–08	Boatman	30	52–53 Noble	82–83	Thief		
09–10	Body Guard	Herrimault	54–55	Outlaw	84–85	Thug	
11–12	Bone Picker	31–32	Hunter	56–57	86–87	Toll Keeper	
13–14	Bounty Hunter	33–34	Initiate	58–61	Outrider	88–89	Tomb Robber
15–16	Jailer	Peasant	90–91	Tradesman			
17–18	Burgher	35	62 Pit Fighter	92–94	Vagabond		
19–20	Camp Follower	36–37	Knight Errant	63–64	Protagonist	95–96	Valet
21–22	Carcassonne Shepherd	38–39	Man-at-Arms	65–66	Rat Catcher	97–98	Watchman
23–24	Charcoal Burner	40–41	67–68	Rogue	99–00	Woodsman	
42–43	Marine	69–70	Scribe	Zealot			

Coachman 44–45 Mediator 71–72 Seaman
Entertainer Mercenary

Grail Pilgrim Skills: Charm, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Dodge Blow,
Intimidate, Outdoor Survival, Perception

Description: Grail Pilgrims are peasants devoted
to the Lady of the Lake, as represented by her Talents: Etiquette, Hardy or Very Resilient,
Specialist Weapon

Grail Knights. They believe that Grail Knights are Group (Two-handed), Stout-hearted or Strong-
minded

paragons of courage, justice, and courtesy,

and that the best way they, as lowly Trappings: Halberd, Light Armour (Leather Jack), Bits That
Fell

peasants, can serve the Lady is to Off the Back of A Grail Knight

serve a Grail Knight.

To this end, they choose a Grail Career Entries: Carcassonne Shepherd, Hunter, Herrimault,
Outlaw,

Knight and follow him around. Peasant, Tradesman, Vagabond

If the knight drops anything

(broken spoons, old buttons, Career Exits: Battle Pilgrim, Carcassonne Shepherd, Mercenary,
and so on), they seize them and Herrimault, Vagabond

treasure them as relics, a means

of contact with the holy. If the Note: This is a Basic Career, so any character can enter it at any
time

Grail Knight needs anything, by paying 200 xp. Women may only become Grail Pilgrims
they get it for him. And if the Grail if they are pretending to be men, nobles may only do so if
Knight is in danger, they try to fight they are pretending to be peasants.

for him. Most Grail Pilgrims do not

have long lives. Herrimault

If a Grail Knight dies whilst

questing, his Grail Pilgrims descend on the body, stripping it of Description: The harsh laws of
relics. Many then turn the corpse into a Grail Reliquae, which Bretonnia turn many Peasants into
they then carry around in place of the Knight himself. Outlaws. The acts that many nobles
commit with impunity turn many

— Grail Pilgrim Advance Scheme — Outlaws into avengers. The

Herrimaults hold themselves

Main Profile above both groups by keeping to

a strict code of morality. Whilst

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel they operate outside the laws of

+5% Bretonnia, they do so because

+10% +5% +5% +5% +5% — — the laws are unjust. A Herrimault

FP always acts rightly.

Secondary Profile —

Of course, most Bretonnian

A W SB TB M Mag IP nobles see no difference, and so

the Herrimaults are hunted as

— +2 — — — — enthusiastically as other Outlaws. A

Herrimault's ethical obligations do bring

popularity among the peasants, and the

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braver souls often seek to join up. Even a few nobles, shocked — Knight Errant Advance Scheme —

by abuses they are unable to legally prevent, have been known to take up the bow of the Herrimault. Main Profile

— Herrimault Advance Scheme — WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel
+5%

Main Profile +15% — +5% +5% +5% — +5%

FP

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel Secondary Profile —
+10%

+5% +10% — — +10% — — A W SB TB M Mag IP

FP

Secondary Profile — +1 +2 — — — —

A W SB TB M Mag IP Skills: Academic Knowledge (Genealogy/Heraldry), Animal Care,
Animal Training, Common Knowledge (any one), Dodge
+1 +2 — — — — Blow, Outdoor Survival, Ride, Speak Language (any one)

Skills: Animal Care or Charm, Concealment, Dodge Blow, Gossip or Talents: Etiquette,
Seasoned Traveller, Specialist Weapon Group
Secret Signs (Ranger), Outdoor Survival, Perception, Scale (Cavalry), Strike Mighty Blow, Virtue
of Chivalry
Sheer Surface, Silent Move
Trappings: Medium Armour (Mail Shirt, Mail Coif, Leather Jack,
Talents: Marksman or Specialist Weapon Group (Longbow), Rover, Helmet), Lance, Shield, Light
Warhorse with saddle and
Seasoned Traveller harness

Trappings: Bow with 10 Arrows (Longbow if you have Specialist Career Entries: Knight, Noble,
Squire

Weapon Group (Longbow), otherwise a Bow), Light Armour
(Leather Jerkin), Shield Career Exits: Knight of the Realm

Career Entries: Agitator, Carcassonne Shepherd, Charlatan, Note: This is a Basic Career, so any
character can enter it at any time by
Coachman, Grail Pilgrim, Hunter, Innkeeper, Knight Errant, paying 200xp. Characters who are not
male Bretonnian nobles
Man-at-Arms, Noble, Peasant, Rogue, Woodsman must pretend to be so in order to become
Knights Errant.

Career Exits: Demagogue, Grail Pilgrim, Scout, Thief, Vagabond, Knight of the Realm

Veteran

Description: Knights of the

Note: This is Basic Career, and thus any character may enter it at any Realm are the backbone of the

time by paying 200 xp. Women can only become Herrimaults Bretonnian army and the most if disguised as men. common members of its

ruling elite. They have

Knight Errant distinguished themselves

in errantry and received a fief

Description: Knights or a position in some other

of the Empire start their noble's household. They are

careers following after some expected to honor and defend

other knight, acting as nothing their lord, as well as the

more than a servant. What else Realm. The knights

would you expect from a nation described in Chapter

who has forgotten the true Eight are primarily Knights

meaning of chivalry, the true of the Realm.

meaning of honour, and the

true meaning of courage? — Knight of the Realm Advance Scheme —

In Bretonnia, knights

start off riding their Main Profile

own trail, as they set off

on their errantry tour. WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

Bretonnian knights learn

from the best school there +25% — +15% +15% +15% — +10% +15%

is: genuine experience.

At the start of their tour, Secondary Profile

they don't have any genuine

experience, but most make up A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

the deficit with their enthusiasm.

Knights Errant are expected to travel widely, often alone, +1 +4 — — — — —

seeking out perilous situations in which to prove their worth.

As a result, they can be found anywhere in the Old World, Skills: Academic Knowledge

(Genealogy/Heraldry or Religion),

sometimes to the regret of the natives. Academic Knowledge (Strategy/Tactics), Command,

Dodge

Blow, Perception, Ride, Secret Language (Battle Tongue),

Speak Language (any two)

Talents: Specialist Weapon Group (Cavalry), Specialist Weapon

Group (Two-handed), Strike Mighty Blow, Virtue of

Knighthood (any one)

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Trappings: Lance, Heavy Armour (Full Plate Armour), Shield, icon Mediator

of the Lady of the Lake, Destrier with Saddle and Harness,
Household Position with a Bretonnian Noble or Bretonnian Description: The peasants of
Fief Bretonnia try to live their lives
without noble interference.

Career Entries: Knight Errant When the nobility get
involved, people are beaten

Career Exits: Captain, Courtier, Explorer, Faceless, Noble Lord, or hanged and food is taken,
Politician, Questing Knight only making matters worse.

However, the peasantry are far

Note: Characters who are not male Bretonnian nobles must pretend to from living in a
cooperative

be so in order to become Knights of the Realm. idyll, and disputes do arise
between villages.

Man-at-Arms Mediators are the peasants
chosen to resolve those

Description: Whilst knights are the backbone of Bretonnian disputes. They live in one
armies, peasants form the bulk. Some receive no training at all village and deal with the
and are simply rounded up and pointed at the enemy. Men- representatives, normally
at-Arms are the lucky ones. When they were paraded before other Mediators, of villages
with which they have a

their lord, he decided they had the potential dispute. Mediators do not
to fight back and ordered that they be normally have the authority to make decisions, so they
must

trained. try for a solution they can sell to their neighbours.

Most Mediators are officially herders, as this gives them an

Still, the excuse to be in odd places if the nobility find them. Whilst the
training and overwhelming majority are men, a few female Mediators do
equipment exist.

that Men-at-

Arms receive are not very good, — Mediator Advance Scheme —
and whilst they do receive some

pay, it is far less than you might Main Profile

expect for risking your life. Most

important, they are given no WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

choice in the matter. As a result,

it is not uncommon for Men-at-Arms

to seize any chance to desert, and many

deserters take up a life of adventure.

— Man-at-Arms Advance Scheme — — — — — +10% +10% +10%

Main Profile Secondary Profile

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

—

+10% — +5% +10% +10% — — — +2 — — — — —

FP

Secondary Profile — Skills: Animal Care, Charm, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia),

Evaluate, Gossip, Haggle, Intimidate, Perception

A W SB TB M Mag IP

Talents: Dealmaker, Public Speaking, Seasoned Traveller, Suave

— +2 — — — — —

Trappings: A Wandering Lamb or a Wilful Pig

Skills: Consume Alcohol, Dodge Blow, Gamble, Gossip, Intimidate, Career Entries: Hunter, Man-at-Arms, Herrimault, Peasant, Rogue

Perception

Talents: Specialist Weapon Group (Two-handed), Street Fighting, Career Exits: Demagogue, Herrimault, Rogue, Village Elder

Strike Mighty Blow, Strike to Injure

Note: This is Basic Career, and thus any character may enter it at any

Trappings: Halberd, Light Armour (Leather Jack and Leather time by paying 200xp. Only peasants may enter this career.

Skullcap), Uniform bearing Lord's Heraldry

Questing Knight

Career Entries: Hunter, Peasant, Vagabond, Woodsman

Description: Questing Knights seek the Grail. Following in

Career Exits: Herrimault, Outlaw, Outrider, Veteran, Yeoman the footsteps of Louis the Rash, they cross Bretonnia and the

rest of the world, seeking the blessing of the Lady of the Lake.

Note: This is a Basic Career, so any character can enter it at any time Those knights who have succeeded in their quest have met

by paying 200xp. Women can only enter this career if they are the Lady in a variety of places, so the quest is not a search for

pretending to be men. a place. Rather, it is an effort to prove oneself worthy of the Grail.

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Chapter VII: Characters and Careers

Thus, Questing Knights strive to show themselves to be then hand out punishments. Often paragons of knighthood, seeking out dangerous situations in these involve paying reparations to the victim, normally in labour,

which to uphold the but sometimes the Village Elders honour of Bretonnia arrange "accidents" for the criminal.

and the Lady of the The quality of this justice

Lake. depends entirely on the quality

Questing of the Village Elder, as there

Knights are no checks on his decisions.

renounce A senile elder is still capable of

the use of handing down something less than

the lance justice. However, it is still almost

because it is invariably better than appealing

the weapon to the local lord.
of loyal service,
— Village Elder Advance Scheme —
and a Questing
Knight stands Main Profile
apart from the
feudal hierarchy WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

until his quest is
complete.

— — — — — +20% +20% +30%

— Questing Knight Advance Scheme — Secondary Profile

Main Profile A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel — +4 — — — — —

+35% — +20% +20% +25% +10% +25% +25% Skills: Charm, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia),
Evaluate, Gossip,
Haggle, Intimidate, Perception, Torture
Secondary Profile

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP Talents: Master Orator, Menacing, Public Speaking, Suave

+2 +6 — — — — — Trappings: Peasant Village

Skills: Academic Knowledge (Genealogy/Heraldry), Academic Career Entries: Faceless,
Mediator, Yeoman
Knowledge (Religion), Academic Knowledge (Strategy/
Tactics), Charm, Command, Common Knowledge (any Career Exits: Demagogue, Faceless,
Outlaw Chief, Politician,
two), Dodge Blow, Outdoor Survival, Perception, Ride, Steward
Secret Language (Battle Tongue), Speak Language (any two)
Note: Only peasants may become Village Elders. Women may only
Talents: Luck, Seasoned Traveller, Specialist Weapon Group (Two- become Village Elders if
disguised as men.
handed), Strike Mighty Blow, Strike to Injure, Sturdy, Very
Resilient, Very Strong, Virtue of the Quest, Warrior Born Wall Warden

Trappings: Heavy Armour (Full Plate Armour), Shield, Icon of the Description: Wall Wardens are
the
Lady of the Lake, Destrier with Saddle and Harness peasant craftsmen who care for and
design the fortifications of Bretonnian
Career Entries: Knight of the Realm nobles, the massive castles that
protect their power. They are
Career Exits: Captain, Courtier, Explorer, Grail Knight, Faceless, also responsible for the

Noble Lord, Politician construction and care of
siege engines. Most nobles

Note: Characters who are not male Bretonnian nobles must pretend to know nothing about
building

be so in order to become Questing Knights. or engineering and thus need
to place a great deal of trust in

Village Elder their Wall Wardens. As a result,
a peasant is only given such a post

Description: Bretonnian nobles are responsible for bringing after proving himself.

justice to the peasants. If they hear of a crime, they make sure As Wall Wardens often have
that someone is punished. As long as it's a peasant, they do not both the ear and the trust of
worry about which peasant. In some cases, the lord has hanged their lords, such a post is often
a

the victim. stepping stone to a more important

Most peasants would prefer to avoid such "justice." position in the lord's administration.

Instead, they turn to their Village Elders, respected residents of
the village. These old men listen to the details of the case and

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On the other hand, Wall Wardens are sometimes approached scouting missions that are
unsuited to

by outside forces to report on the state of the lord's defences. knights (too little glory,
The loyal ones naturally refuse. too much risk). Eventually,
some Yeomen grow tired

— Wall Warden Advance Scheme — of making things easy for
"social superiors" and strike

Main Profile out on their own.

Most lords allow their Yeomen

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel to retire honourably after a
few years of service or after

— +10% +10% +10% +25% +20% +10% +10% a spectacular act on the
battlefield. Others, however,

Secondary Profile simply desert, usually whilst on
a scouting mission so that their

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP lord assumes they were killed and
doesn't go after them.

— +4 — — — — — —

Skills: Academic Knowledge (Engineering), Academic Knowledge
(Strategy/Tactics), Common Knowledge (Bretonnia),
Evaluate, Gossip, Haggle, Perception, Trade (Carpenter),
Trade (Stoneworker)

Talents: Lightning Reflexes, Specialist Weapon Group (Engineer) — Yeoman Advance Scheme —

Trappings: Fortifications to look after, trade tools Main Profile

Career Entries: Man-at-Arms, Peasant, Tradesman WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

—

Career Exits: Spy, Steward, Yeoman +25% +10% +10% +10% +10% +10% +10%
FP

Note: Only peasants may become Wall Wardens. Women may only Secondary Profile —
become Wall Wardens if disguised as men.

A W SB TB M Mag IP

Yeoman +1 +6 — — — — —

Description: Yeomen are the elite peasant warriors of Skills: Animal Care, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Concealment, Bretonnia. Many knights are dismissive of their achievements, Consume Alcohol, Dodge Blow, Gamble, Gossip, Intimidate, arguing that “elite peasant warrior” has a similar meaning to Outdoor Survival, Perception, Ride, Secret Language (Battle “large mouse.” However, whilst it is true that the nobility are Tongue), Silent Move far better equipped, the Yeomen are as skilled as most Knights of the Realm, and they take justified pride in their martial Talents: Rover, Specialist Weapon Group (any one), Specialist abilities. Weapon Group (Two-handed), Strike to Stun, Very Resilient Indeed, the overwhelming majority of Yeomen are dedicated or Very Strong professionals because it is their dedication that has distinguished them from the mass of Men-at-Arms around Trappings: Halberd, any one weapon, Medium Armour (Full Mail them. Yeomen, in return, receive mounts and are used for Armour), Riding Horse with Tack and Harness.

Career Entries: Carcassonne Shepherd, Man-at-Arms, Mercenary, Wall Warden

Career Exits: Faceless, Mercenary, Outlaw Chief, Scout, Sergeant

Note: Women can only become Yeomen if disguised as men.

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Chapter VIII: Knighthood

Knighthood Chapter

For the Lady and the King! VIII
- Standard Bretonnian
battle-cry.

Ask anyone to talk about Bretonnia, and, while they may From the lowest Knight Errant to the

King himself, the
natter on about the beautiful countryside, wonderful food, knights of Bretonnia rule and defend
their country. Without
the wealth of the nobility and the stench of the peasantry, their staunch defense of the Realm,
Bretonnia would have
sooner or later, they'll mention the knights. succumbed to the forces that beset it long ago.

— Cultural Background —

Not just anybody can become a Bretonnian knight. First, In addition, knights, as the premier
warriors of the realm,
you must be male, or at least pretending to be so. As far as are expected to actually be the
premier warriors of the
the Bretonnians are concerned, chivalry is a male pursuit. No realm—better than peasants and
certainly better than women.

exceptions to this rule have ever been made. Bretonnian knights faced with extremely skilled
female

Second, you must be a Bretonnian noble. Three exceptions to mercenaries tend to try to prove
their superiority in various
this rule have been recorded in the last two thousand years. embarrassing ways.

Of course, absolutely everyone who meets those two Finally, knights must fight honourably,
which means hand-to-

requirements becomes a knight. The gap between what knights hand. Missile weapons are
cowardly, gunpowder weapons even

are supposed to be and what a particular knight actually is can more so. Bretonnian knights do
not regard the magic of the

be enormous. Some are barely competent with a sword, and Damsels of the Lady as
dishonourable, but any other magic

others have knowledge of riding that gets as far as the idea certainly is.

that you face the part of the horse that sticks up and neighs.

The “knights” who ignore the tenets of chivalry are beyond Loyalty

counting. Still, the ideal is there, and nobles who fall short

are looked down upon by their peers. So, what is the ideal? It Loyalty is slightly more complex
than obedience. A knight is

revolves around three ideas: Valour, Loyalty, and Courtesy. ultimately loyal to the King, so
disobeying the orders of his

immediate superior in the interests of the King is still loyal.

Valour The immediate superior in question, however, may choose to

demonstrate his disagreement with this ethical interpretation at

A valorous knight is one who fights bravely, skilfully, and length, from the other side of a
besieging army.

honourably. Bravery requires the knight to stand firm in the Worse, the Bretonnians love tragic
stories of knights who were

face of foes who are superior, even if to do so is clearly suicidal. caught between their loyalties
to two different lords, had no

Even Bretonnian knights have enough sense to ignore this way to act correctly, and thus died
tragically trying to do the

virtue at times, particularly if no one is watching. impossible. Some knights even manoeuvre
themselves into

Chapter VIII: Knighthood

starring roles in such stories. These knights sometimes turn The Knight's Progress to non-knightly help to extricate themselves from their self-imposed predicament. Imperial knights start their careers as squires to another knight. Bretonnian knights have a different path. Upon reaching Courtesy adulthood, an age that varies slightly from family to family but is always in the late teens, a male noble is dubbed a Knight. A true knight behaves properly at all times, even on the Errant and sent out into the world to prove himself. battlefield. This means showing respect to other knights by Knights Errant are supposed to travel the country, eagerly allowing your feudal superiors the honour of engaging the seeking out perilous situations in which to prove their mettle. most glorious foe. Indeed, the level of courtesy on display as Those who actually do it enter the Knight Errant career (see a group of Bretonnian Knights humbly yield the privilege of Chapter VII: Characters and Careers). Some nobles, however, fighting a Bloodletter of Khorne can truly bring tears to the have other interests and thus enter other careers. eyes. Greenskins, of course, merit no special treatment and are Social pressure to pursue the perils of errantry is very strong, simply slaughtered. and so most nobles at least make a show of it. As a result, at Outside battle, knights never insult one another. They may any time there are large numbers of young nobles travelling suggest that another knight has been bewitched as the only around the country, looking for trouble. Naturally, they find it. possible explanation for his opinion of a woman's beauty, but Often enough, it is of their own devising. a direct insult is out of place. This rule is generally observed, Travelling the roads of Bretonnia alone is perilous even for Grail and Bretonnian knights learn how to couch the deepest insult Knights; for young Knights Errant, it is almost suicidal. Some in terms of utmost politeness. Many knights are too stupid to knights travel alone for precisely that reason, hoping to meet realise that they have actually been insulted. with glorious adventure but often finding a cold and lonely Finally, knights are always polite to women. Women are death instead. Most knights, then, find travelling companions. expected to enter rooms first, sit down first, eat first, and so Other Knights Errant are the most popular choice, as they are on. They are also to be protected from all danger. Indeed, the of the same social class and truly understand your concerns. importance of protecting the women in his castle from the However, this is a case of the blind leading the blind, so wiser or

possibility of attack has prevented more than one bold knight luckier knights find themselves joining up with adventurers from from riding out against raiders. The women, of course, get a variety of backgrounds and social classes. Knights expect to be no say in this treatment: they will eat first and be honoured, the leaders of such groups, of course. whether they like it or not, and they most certainly will not be allowed to put themselves into danger.

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A knight cannot cease to be a Knight Errant until he receives in the normal way, enter that career by paying 100 experience a position from a Bretonnian noble. This can be a fief or a points at any point afterwards, even if he has entered another position as a household knight. Some lords give these positions career in the meantime. A lot of adventuring Knights Errant do out to their sons within a few weeks of the beginning of enter one or two other careers before becoming Knights of the errantry, allowing the knight to return from the perils of the Realm. road. Knights with such a position become Knights of the Not all nobles with the title of Knight of the Realm are in Realm. the Knight of the Realm career any more than all nobles in It is possible, and honourable, to refuse such a position on the the Empire are in the Noble career. However, it is normal to grounds that you have not yet sufficiently proved yourself. The offer a post to a Knight Errant at about the point where he only exception is that if the King personally offers you a post, has completed that career, and most knights do move into the refusal is not an option. Some Knights Errant travel, proving Knight of the Realm career. Thus, it is by far the most common themselves and waiting for the royal blessing. This only comes career for knights with that rank. if they can really distinguish themselves from the masses, Knights of the Realm have responsibilities and thus cannot however. simply ride off in search of adventure. However, household In game terms, it is only possible to enter the Knight of the knights are often sent to deal with threats or investigate Realm career if you have been granted a chivalric position. A rumours, and knights with their own fiefs find that plenty of character that has completed the Knight Errant career may, adventures come to them.

— Questing for the Grail —

Knights of the Realm may choose to go on a quest for the symbolise this, he lays aside the lance, normally fighting Grail, hoping to meet the Lady of the Lake in person and instead with great, two-handed

weapons. Household knights drink from the sacred chalice. Anyone may announce that he simply leave their lord's service. This is entirely honourable and is embarking on such a quest, but in order to have any chance indeed reflects well on the lord, so it is the best way to get out of success, he must enter the Questing Knight career, which of a commitment to a lord you do not like. Knights with their means that he must have completed the Knight of the Realm own fiefs appoint a steward to care for the fief in their absence. career. The Lady has certain standards for her knights, and in There are a number of Bretonnian folk tales of the abuses game terms, these standards are represented by the career path. perpetrated by such stewards and of the return of the new Grail A knight who takes the Questing Vow renounces his duties Knight that sets everything right once more. to mundane lords in favour of his duties to the Lady. To Questing Knights behave much like Knights Errant, except that they are looking for signs left by the Lady which might indicate their path. The Lady does take an interest in genuine Questing Knights, so the dangers they face build into a pattern. The final peril faced by a Questing Knight is the Green Knight, a servant of the Lady who challenges all such knights to prove their worth. Those who succeed here soon find themselves face-to-face with their Goddess.

Grail Knights

Grail Knights are the paragons of Bretonnian chivalry. They are rare, but as many tend to travel, most Bretonnians have seen one at least once. Many of the peasantry treat them as living saints, and the attitudes of most nobles are not far behind—Grail Knights are among the greatest warriors in the Old World. They are also, without exception, truly noble, upholding all the virtues of chivalry. Grail Knights sometimes re-enter the feudal hierarchy. However, no Grail Knight would swear fealty to a lord who was not himself a Grail Knight, and the only lord they would serve as a simple household knight is the King himself. Since the King of Bretonnia is always a Grail Knight, most Grail Knights swear fealty directly to the King, thus avoiding the possibility of an awkward situation if the heir to a Grail Knight is not a Grail Knight himself. Many Grail Knights, however, choose to live a little apart from normal society. Some base themselves at a Grail Chapel,

keeping the surrounding area safe. Others wander, much like Running the Quest like Knights Errant, righting wrongs wherever they find them. These are the Grail Knights most likely to attract Grail The Questing Knight's quest should be a defining feature Pilgrims. of the character's career. It must provide enough experience In the end, no Bretonnian questions the decisions a Grail to complete the Questing Knight career and enter the Grail Knight makes. If he decides to fraternise with peasants and Knight career, but little more, and the adventures should foreigners, there must be a good reason for it. Grail Knights have more significance than the defeat of isolated bands of can thus function as adventurers without restriction. Greenskins.

— Nobility — Significance

Most knights dream of becoming landed nobles. There are two types of significance which suit different styles Holding lands provides financial security, status, and of play. In the first, the Questing Knight unearths and defeats independence. It also, in theory, brings responsibilities for your a significant threat to the land of Bretonnia. This might be land and the people in it. Some knights are heirs to land, but a Chaos cult, an Orc warlord, or a Bestigor gathering a war most must work to fulfil their dream. Player characters may herd. In the second, the events of the quest force the Questing have the same dream. Knight to face his weaknesses or past mistakes. Thus, a knight Player characters should generally not be heirs, so that they who failed to defend a village against an Orc attack might find have to work for their land. Heroic deeds worthy of a knight himself placed to defend a different village from a horde of draw the attention of higher nobles and, happily, are just Beastmen. On the other hand, a knight with a tendency to lose the sorts of things that adventurers do. Some knights engage his temper might find himself forced to calmly negotiate peace in subtle politics for years in order to win a fief, but player between two nobles who hate each other and have nothing but characters in a grim world of perilous adventure are more likely contempt for the Questing Knight himself. to win one by spectacular acts of heroism. This takes a number of gaming sessions all focused on one If a player wants his character to become a landed noble, character. Whilst other player characters may be involved, they the game master should develop the campaign to make are essentially following the knight around on his quest. If the this possible. However, he should think about the way the Questing Knight is uncovering a major threat to the land, this campaign will go after the character gets his land. In some is not much of a problem: it's the sort of thing adventurers do cases, this will be the end of the campaign: a rich fief in a safe anyway. If he is facing his own

flaws, the other characters may
 area is a good device to provide an in-game explanation for feel a bit left out. The best thing to do
 here is talk to the players
 why the character stops adventuring. and see what they would be happiest doing.
 Otherwise, the character should be able to continue
 adventuring whilst looking after his fief. In addition, the other The Final Confrontation
 player characters should be able to keep adventuring with him.
 This generally means that a border fief under repeated attack The final part of the quest, the
 confrontation with the Green
 from dark forces is a good idea. Knight and the meeting with the Lady, is for the Questing
 Earlier adventures can be designed to lead up to this naturally. Knight alone. This is best played
 in an extra one-on-one
 If the player characters fight against the Orcs of a certain area session. The combat with the
 Green Knight may be purely
 of the Massif Orcal, it is natural for the knight to be granted a symbolic if the Questing Knight has
 saved Bretonnia from
 fief there, continuing the battle. On the other hand, a knight a major threat, or it could be a test of
 whether the knight
 who unmasks a lord in league with a Chaos cult might be has overcome his weaknesses. At this
 point, however, player
 granted his fief on condition that he roots out and destroy the characters should not fail.
 cult infesting it.
 Once a knight has a fief, the tone of the campaign should shift The Stuff of Legends
 to emphasise that he now has a home to defend. There are two
 techniques that achieve this without sacrificing the excitement Play the meeting with the Lady
 for as much drama as you
 of adventure. can manage. Lights shine from nowhere, the Lady, dazzlingly
 First, run short adventures, possibly even shorter than a beautiful, walks across water as
 smooth as mirrored glass, and
 single session, dealing with the mundane problems of ruling as the character drinks from the
 Grail he sees the whole world
 land in the Old World. These can range from accusations in its proper order.
 of witchcraft to deciding how to deal with a family with a This can be hard to pull off and it helps
 if you build
 Mutant child, or breaking up a major brawl over the issue expectations. The Questing Knight
 hears stories of the
 of who has the better turnips. Some will be comic relief, encounters between the greatest
 heroes, including the Grail
 others true tragedies, but all shed some light on the place the Companions, and the Green
 Knight and the Lady. His
 characters call home. encounter then includes elements from those stories, making it
 clear that he is part of the same tradition.

want to move on. The knight
fief, and the main threats should be threats to the fief and can simply declare himself on the
quest for the Grail, appoint
its inhabitants. This actually opens up some possibilities: the a steward, and return to a life of
travel and adventure. If the
characters cannot simply ignore a threat and must also deal knight is already a Grail Knight,
there is even less problem:
with the aftermath of their actions. For example, there are good he merely needs to decide that it
is time for him to wander in
reasons for them to deal with the Orcs who fled when their search of wrongs to right. Never
forget that this is a game, and
base was sacked, rather than simply moving on to the next the responsibilities of player
characters only apply as long as it
adventure. is fun for the players.

— The Knight's Steed —

Bretonnian knights are mounted warriors and very few
would deign to fight on foot. Thus, a knight's steed is very Bretonnian Warhorses
important to him. Many knights seem to care more about
their steeds than about their wives, a topic for many (highly Bretonnian warhorses are fine
destriers (see WFRP, page 232).
illegal) tavern songs in Bretonnia. There is good reason for They cover the full range of equine
colours, but all are tall at
this: a knight's life depends on his steed every time he fights, the shoulder and have naturally
long tails and manes. As lots
and a steed that hates or fears his master is worse than useless of loose hair gets in the way in
battle, most knights plait their
in battle. Thus, most knights make sure that their steed is fed, horse's hair, often winding ribbons
and charms in among it.
housed, and cared for before bothering about such details for Destriers serving a Bretonnian
knight may enter the Brute career.
themselves. Some have grooms or squires help with part of the
work, but all do a substantial part personally to increase the Pegasi
bond with the mount.

This bond allows the knight to push his mount to superior Pegasi are described in detail in the
Old World Bestiary, pages
deeds. This has two game effects. First, a knight may use 55 and 105. They are elegant and noble
creatures, favoured by
Fate or Fortune Points to benefit his mount rather than knights who prefer skill and strategy in
battle to wild slaughter.
himself. Second, a knight may spend experience points to buy They are prouder and more
intelligent than horses but still
advances for his mount. The allowable careers are noted in tolerant of Humans and each other.
Some lords have even
the descriptions of particular kinds of mounts given below. formed whole units of pegasus-riding
knights.
Obviously, common sense is still useful: horses can make little Most knights who want to ride a

pegasus raise it personally from use of a score in BS. a foal. It takes around a year before the pegasus is ready to accept a rider. However, it is not a full-time activity, as there is no problem with having other people help. Thus, a knight raising a pegasus can go on adventures. Most pegasus foals are bought at a cost of around 1,000 gc. A knight that wishes, however, can go on an adventure into the mountains to find his own.

Pegasi may enter the Chief career, and those pegasi with ten or more advances are referred to as Royal Pegasi. Those who do not ride the creatures often think that Royal Pegasi are a separate species, but this is not the case.

Hippogriffs

Hippogriffs are also described in the Old World Bestiary, pages 56 and 99. Hippogriffs are terrifying and violent creatures, ridden as mounts by very few knights, most notably King Louen Leoncoeur himself. They do not tolerate people, horses, other hippogriffs, or, indeed, anything they could possibly eat. As a result, there are no units of hippogriff-riding knights.

A hippogriff must be raised from a chick by the knight himself. He can accept no help, or the hippogriff will never accept him as a rider. Even a young hippogriff is capable of defending itself, which makes taking the beast along on adventures more practical. In addition, the rearing process gives rise to adventures itself. Once per month, the knight makes an Animal Training Test. On a failure, his dealings with the hippogriff lead to an adventure of some sort.

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Raising a hippogriff takes about a year and is possible for an to proceed, it does so. The knight must struggle to master his adventuring player character. The presence of the hippogriff mount, but this should be fun for the player. causes complications and occasional full-blown adventures, Fully trained Hippogriffs may enter the Chief career. but if it must fade into the background to allow an adventure

— Virtues of Knighthood —

The knights of Bretonnia aspire to a set of virtues, each Virtue of Duty exemplified by one of the original Companions of the Grail. In game terms, each Virtue is represented by a Talents. All Knights Thierulf of Lyonesse was the

most loyal of the Companions,

Errant take the same Talent: The Virtue of Chivalry. Knights of the always fighting at the side of his liege.

Realm must choose which of the fourteen Virtues they exemplify Description: You may pledge loyalty to up to three other

and select that Talent to complete the career. Questing Knights

take the Virtue of the Quest, but Grail Knights must take the Grail characters. When you fight alongside those characters,

Virtue corresponding to the Virtue they chose as Knights of the they each gain a +5% bonus to their Weapon Skill

Realm. characteristics. If any of them are not present in a

battle, you take a -10% penalty to your Weapon Skill

Virtue of Chivalry characteristic.

Description: You may call upon the Lady of the Lake and gain Virtue of Empathy

her blessings, as described in The Gifts of the Lady on

page 39. Only Bretonnian knights may take this talent, Martrud of Montfort always championed the peasants and was

which is only useful to characters with Fortune Points. loved by them in return.

Description: You gain +10% bonus to Fellowship Tests when

In order for a character to select other Virtues of Knighthood, he

must first take the Virtue of Chivalry Talent. dealing with Bretonnian peasants. Other knights do not

think less of you for talking with your social inferiors.

Virtue of Audacity (They may think less of you for choosing this path in the

first place, however.)

Agilgar of Parravon was a master of turning a foe's strength back

on him. Virtue of Heroism

Description: If an opponent's Strength Bonus is higher than Gilles of Bastonne was known as the slayer of monsters,

yours, use its value in place of your own for the purpose of renowned for killing creatures of great size.

dealing Damage. Description: You excel at hand-to-hand combat and your hits

Virtue of Confidence can prove deadly. Whenever you roll an unmodified

10 on your damage die, you may choose to forgo the

Carleond of Couronne would challenge any foe to single combat, additional damage to

automatically inflict a Critical

such was his confidence in his prowess. Hit instead, even if the target has not been reduced to

Description: Whilst engaged in combat, you may take a Full 0 Wounds. The Critical Value is equal to your Strength

Bonus. When using the Virtue of Heroism in conjunction

Action to issue a Challenge to a single opponent. Most with an Impact Weapon, the Impact

Quality does not

targets of the Challenge are not obligated to accept the apply as normal, but rather increases the Critical Value by

Challenge (though many do); Knights with the Virtue of +1. You may not use Virtue of Heroism

when wielding a

Chivalry Talent must accept. For the duration of the combat, magic weapon or a ranged weapon. you gain a +1 bonus on damage rolls in melee combat.

Whilst engaged in a Challenge, you may not Challenge a Virtue of the Ideal new opponent in that combat until the first is defeated or

has fled the battle. Landuin of Mousillon was the peerless knight, pure in heart, skilled in arm, and wise in mind. Alas, Mousillon has fallen far.

Virtue of Discipline Description: You gain a +1 bonus to your Attacks characteristic

Marcus of Bordeleaux took the field against any odds, ever when outnumbered in melee combat.

undaunted.

Description: It is no easier to attack you when you are Virtue of the Impetuous Knight

outnumbered. With this Talent, you negate any bonuses to Balduin of Brionne was always in the forefront of battle, first to

your opponents' Weapon Skill that are gained as a result of engage with his enemies.

superior numbers. (Ordinarily, multiple attackers against the Description: Charge Attack is only a half action for you. In

same target reduce the difficulty of the attack, as described

on Table 6–2: Combat Difficulty in WFRP.) This Talent addition to the normal +10% Weapon Skill bonus of this

does not negate any other circumstantial bonuses. action, you also gain a +1 bonus on the damage roll of your

attack. All normal conditions on a Charge Attack apply.

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Virtue of the Joust Description: You may not use magic items or ride steeds other than a horse. Any weapon you wield counts as magical, and the

Folgar of Artois was unmatched in his skill with the lance. Critical Value of any Critical Hit made against you is reduced

Description: You gain +10% to WS when using a lance. by one. A Critical Hit with a value of 0 has no effect.

Virtue of Knightly Temper Virtue of Purity

Beren of Gisoreux was ever swift to deal death to his foes, Rademund of Quenelles was the most virtuous champion of the

striking twice before they could respond. Lady, upholding her honour in every battle.

Description: If you successfully wound an opponent at the Description: You may invoke the Gifts of the Lady without taking

end of a Charge Attack, you may immediately make time to pray. In addition, you gain one bonus Fortune Point

another free attack against the same opponent. This every day.

attack costs no actions but is otherwise the same as a Standard Attack. You are not required to make this Virtue of Stoicism attack (for example, if the opponent is already dead).

The +10% bonus to Weapon Skill bonus from the Lambard of Carcassonne stood firm in the face of fear, and his

Charge does not apply to this additional attack. bravery steeled those around him.

Description: You may re-roll any failed Fear or Terror Test, or Virtue of Noble Disdain

any failed Test to resist Intimidation. If the re-roll succeeds,

Fredemund of Aquitaine never lost his contempt for those who ignore the first failure.

used cowardly weapons rather than fighting face-to-face.

Description: You gain a +10% bonus to your Weapon Skill Virtue of the Quest

when fighting characters who have used a missile This Talent has a number of effects, but they only apply whilst the

weapon against you or your allies. You take a permanent character is in the career of the Questing Knight. If he completes the

-10% penalty to your Ballistic Skill characteristic due career and moves on or abandons it to take up a different basic career,

to your loathing for such cowardly means. Modify your the effects of the Talent lapse. If the character completes the career

starting profile to reflect this penalty. and becomes a Grail Knight, the Talent is lost altogether, though

the experience points spent to buy it are not regained. If he simply

Virtue of the Penitent abandoned the career, he retains the Talent, and if he re-enters the Questing Knight career its effects apply once more.

Corduin of L'Anguille ever mourned the loss of his beloved to Description: You take a -50% penalty to your Weapon Skill

the curse of a hag, yet he fought bravely when summoned.

characteristic if you use a lance. Questing Knights renounce

the use of that weapon, and those with the Virtue of the

Quest find it hard to break that pledge.

You receive visions that direct your quest. These visions lead

you to the places where you should be, which normally

means that they lead you into danger.

At any time, you may call upon your strength of purpose to

give you succour. As a half action, you may spend a Fortune

Point to heal 1d10 of your own Wounds. This cannot take

you above your normal maximum.

The Grail Virtues

The Grail Virtues are only available to Grail Knights. They are noticeably stronger than the Virtues of Knighthood and are an important part of the reason why Grail Knights are so respected in Bretonnia. The effects of the Virtue of Knighthood still apply, and a Grail Knight can only take the Grail Virtue corresponding to his Virtue of Knighthood.

Grail Virtue of Audacity

Description: Whenever you are engaged in melee with one or more opponents, you increase your Toughness Bonus Characteristic by +4. The bonus applies to melee attacks made by opponents engaged with you. This bonus lasts until you successfully test Weapon Skill and inflict at least 1 Wound against any

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adjacent foe or if, at any time, you choose not to make a melee attack while so engaged. After the bonus is expended, you cannot use the Grail Virtue of Audacity for the duration of the encounter.

Grail Virtue of Confidence

Description: Whilst you are involved in a Challenge, all other opponents must succeed on Very Hard (–30%) Weapon Skill Tests to hit you. You take this penalty to any attacks you make against opponents other than the one you challenged, so long as that opponent still stands. Also, you gain a +10% bonus to your Toughness characteristic against any attack that hits you.

Grail Virtue of Discipline

Description: When you make a Swift Attack whilst outnumbered at least 2 to 1, your Attacks characteristic increases by +1.

Grail Virtue of Duty

Description: If you fight with those to whom you are pledged, they gain +1 bonus to their Attacks characteristics and +10% bonus to their Strength characteristics during the Battle. If any of those to whom you are pledged are absent, you take a –10% penalty to your Strength and Toughness characteristics.

Grail Virtue of Empathy wield a magical lance, its damage is increased by +1, and it loses the Tiring quality if it has it.

Description: When you lead Bretonnian peasants, you make any Fear or Terror tests first. If you succeed, the peasants do not need to Grail Virtue of Knightly Temper check. If you fail, the peasants must make their own tests, as normal. In addition, you may spend two Fortune Points when Description: When you make a Charge Attack, the attack at

seeking the Gifts of the Lady in order to extend the Gift to the the end is a Swift Attack, rather than a Standard Attack.

peasants under your command. You may command a number All attacks made in the Charge Attack benefit from the

of peasants equal to your Will Power characteristic. +10% bonus to Weapon Skill. The Virtue of Knightly

Temper applies to all of these attacks.

Grail Virtue of Heroism

Grail Virtue of Noble Disdain

Description: If you inflict damage on an opponent, you do an

additional number of Wounds equal to the opponent's Description: Double the Critical Value of any Critical Hit you

Armour Points on that location. That is, if the opponent's score against an opponent who has used missile weapons

Toughness Bonus and Armour are enough to reduce the against you or your allies.

damage you do to zero, you do no damage, but if you do any

damage at all, armour has no effect. Grail Virtue of the Penitent

Grail Virtue of the Ideal Description: You may reverse the dice of a Critical Hit made against you. Thus, if your opponent, with a Critical

Description: You gain a permanent +5% bonus to your Weapon Value of +5, rolls 58, giving a result of 8, a severe

Skill and Strength characteristics. Update your starting profile maiming, you may swap the dice to give 85, resulting in

to reflect these changes. a 6, which is less serious.

Grail Virtue of the Impetuous Knight Grail Virtue of Purity

Description: You may take two Charge Attack actions in a single Description: You do not need to spend Fortune Points

round. This over-rides the normal limit on only being able to to invoke the Gifts of the Lady and may do so

take a single attack action in one round. The normal limits on automatically before every combat.

Charge Attacks still apply.

Grail Virtue of Stoicism

Grail Virtue of the Joust

Description: You are immune to Fear and Terror and cannot

Description: In your hands, all lances count as magic weapons and be Intimidated. You gain +20% bonus to all Tests made

do SB+2 damage. They also lose the Tiring quality. If you to resist magic that affects your mind.

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Ill Chapter

Tidings

IX

“Why didn’t they just drown,
like normal people?”

- Sir Enguerrand

This adventure is designed to introduce players and The adventurers have come to L’Anguille, where their characters to Bretonnia. There are, therefore, two main discussions in a tavern are interrupted by the arrival of the types of adventuring group that might want to play through sea—inside the tavern! Such high tides are an occasional it. The first is a group of novice adventurers, primarily from nuisance in L’Anguille, and the characters are roped into Bretonnia. In this case, the introduction is more for the benefit getting things and people to safety. In the process, they find of the players. The second is a group of more experienced the body of a Mutant. Then they find four more. Investigations adventurers, probably from the Empire, who have just arrived lead to a hidden chapel of Nurgle, where half a dozen peasant in Bretonnia. In either case, L’Anguille is a sensible place to prisoners have survived. The peasants all come from the same start, being a major city and major port of entry for foreigners. village. Two sets of game statistics are provided: “Novice” and Pursuing one of several courses of action, the adventurers arrive “Veteran.” Novices are assumed to be at the start of their first in the village, discover that the lord is a tyrant opposed by a careers, whilst veterans are in their third careers. band of Herrimaults, and find the base of the Nurgle cult. In The structure of the adventure is the same for both types of group, the final battle, they overthrow the corrupt lord with the help but the threats they face are more deadly in one case than the other. of a truly noble Bretonnian knight.

— The Tide Comes In —

The player characters start the adventure at the Shattered Have everyone make a Perception Test. Those who succeed Compass, an inn near the waterfront in L’Anguille. In notice a change in the quality of the noise from outside, an most ways, it is an average tavern. However, Gaston d’Aberre, increased urgency. Those who fail notice nothing. Characters the innkeeper, is famous for his tolerance of people from who investigate must make an Intelligence Test. For characters anywhere in the Old World, making even Norscans and with a nautical career (anything from Boatman to Smuggler) Arabyans feel welcome. As a result, motley groups of arrivals this is Very Easy (+30%), whilst for landlubbers it is

get pointed here. Adventurers are almost invariably motley. Challenging (–10%). Those who succeed realise an unusually

They are all in the inn’s common room, though they may or high tide is coming in and that people are hurriedly moving

may not already know each other. If they do not, lack of space things to higher ground.

has meant they have been forced to share a table. If you are If the adventurers fail these tests, they can make an Easy

playing with new characters, this is a good opportunity for (+20%) Perception Test a few minutes later as water comes

players to introduce their characters. into the inn and starts lapping around their shoes.

Characters

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who fail that test don’t notice the rising tide until the inn’s Commands from on High

other patrons point it out to them (probably with some

derisive sarcasm), and the characters probably feel rather daft at As the characters splash

through the water, they are hailed in

that point. Breton from a balcony overlooking the street.

If the characters notice the tide at the first opportunity, they “You there! Pull that cart out of the alley! It’s blocking things!”

have time to make their own belongings secure before the The person shouting orders is dressed

in a short blue tunic, red

various emergencies start to happen. If they only notice when breeches, and a slashed white

cloak. He looks to be in his mid-

the water is in the inn, they must choose what they will take thirties and has the solid build of a

warrior. It is immediately

with them. obvious to anyone with Common Knowledge (Bretonnia) he

is a noble, as the sumptuary laws would not let any commoner

Varying the Difficulty dress like that.

Moving the cart requires a Strength Test, with a +10% bonus

For Novices, all the tests described in this section are Easy for every additional character

helping, up to a maximum of

(+20%). For Veterans, they are Challenging (–10%). You +30%. Moving it does allow people to

move goods out of the

should describe the situation in more challenging terms for alley more quickly, but the

characters notice the noble remains

veterans, as well. standing on the balcony, shouting orders to other people.

Flotsam and Jetsam That’s No Way to Build a City!

As the tide rises, it causes a variety of problems. These events Awkward players may wonder

why so much of L’Anguille

happen around the adventurers. The first two (Commands is vulnerable to flooding from the tide.

Tides this high only

from on High and Knight with Dirty Hands) are essential happen once every ten years or so, and

the flooded area is not to the scenario; the others are optional and should be used as terribly wealthy. The residents simply deal with the floods when appropriate for your group. they come. Most of the city is built high enough to remain Remember this is a rising tide, not a tidal wave. The water unaffected. generally moves fairly slowly, except when it breaks through a barrier and can pour into a lower area. Adults are at almost no risk of personal injury, but water can still do plenty of damage to property.

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At this point, the adventurers should spot some other crisis to The merchant is grateful, but has no particular relevance discourage them from trying to talk to the noble. to this adventure. Use Marperic d'Abenne (see page 46)

if the characters want to talk to him.

Knight with Dirty Hands

Something in the Water

This encounter is best used when the adventurers fail a test.

However, if they are being unhelpfully successful, have something Whilst the characters are helping with flood recovery, there is

happen next to them whilst their hands are full. For example, a a sudden rush of water past them as the tide finds an entrance

large barrel might come floating down the street towards them. to some low place. These happen occasionally as cellar doors

At the relevant point, a wet, mud-spattered, but smiling man and the like break. In the aftermath, objects such as apples or

splashes through the water to help. He succeeds in whatever stored cloth often float out. This time, a body floats past the

test he needs to make and makes sure that whatever it is, is safe. adventurers, face down in the water,

He then says something along the lines of "Right, plenty more They should be encouraged to stop it and turn it over to see

to do. Keep it up!" before heading off through the water. whether it is dead; if they don't, someone very close to them

A Perception Test reveals his tunic was originally white with red does. The body is a corpse. It is also a Mutant, with a third eye

and blue embroidery, and his breeches are deep blue. Again, this set in its forehead. This causes brief panic, but then a second

marks him as obviously a noble. Although he does not introduce corpse is spotted. This one has tentacles in place of legs. At this

himself at this point (there are more urgent matters at hand), this point, most people flee the area. The adventurers should not:

is Sir Laustic, and he is fully detailed on page 117. dead Mutants are not an immediate threat, but there may be

something that is.

Optional Encounters Characters who succeed at Intelligence Tests realise the

Mutants are likely to have come from wherever it was the water

At least some of these encounters should happen, though you was flowing to before and that following the flow back would

need not use them all. be a good idea. As they do so, they find three more Mutant

- A small child is standing on a barrel, crying for his bodies. One has a beak instead of a nose, another is covered

in green fur, and the last is obscenely obese and covered in

mother. The water is too deep for him to walk to safety, weeping sores. The last one is lodged in a small window

but picking him up and carrying him is quite easy. An leading to an underground cellar. The building in question is

Agility Test is needed not to slip and fall whilst carrying abandoned but on slightly higher ground; whilst the cellar is

him, as the ground is invisible under the water, and a obviously flooded, the ground floor is barely damp.

Gossip Test is needed to find his mother. Characters

who do not speak Breton take a –20% penalty to the The Foul Temple test.

- The water gets deep enough to lift a wagon off its The tide goes down in about an hour. An Average (+0%) Sail

wheels, and the impromptu boat begins floating down Test lets a character work this out for himself, and any native

the street. It is large enough to do a lot of damage if of L'Anguille knows this. It is basically impossible to investigate

it crashes into a poor house, like the one it is heading the cellar whilst the floodwaters are up, but characters that

towards. A Strength Test is needed to direct the wagon come up with a truly brilliant plan should be allowed to try.

and bring it safely to a halt. Modify the descriptions a bit to account for the fact that

- The proprietor of a bookshop is desperately trying to everywhere is full of water.

get his stock to safety on the upper floor. Success on

an Intelligence Test allows characters to work out an Above Ground

efficient method, giving a +30% bonus to Agility Tests

to move the books. The ground floor of the building is empty but looks like it was

- The water breaks through a barrier somewhere beyond occupied within the last month or so.

The first floor reinforces

the adventurers and suddenly starts flowing swiftly. that impression, and a couple of pieces of cheap furniture

Strength Tests are required to stay standing, and remain. If the characters ask the neighbours, a Routine

someone helpless (small child, cute puppy) is swept (+10%) Gossip Test reveals the house was rented out to a large

towards the characters. On a successful Weapon Skill family from Bastonne, but they fell ill and decided to go back

Test, the adventurers can catch whatever it is, otherwise home. The landlord is apparently looking for new tenants.

it gets swept to deeper water and a Swim Test is There is no obvious sign of an entrance to the cellar, and necessary to rescue her, him, or it. indeed, there is no entrance within the building. A Very Easy • A couple of robbers use the distraction caused by the (+30%) Search Test in the alley behind the house reveals water to go to work on a merchant. Use the statistics for a trapdoor in the ground. Normally, it would have been Footpads on page 234 of WFRP. For novices, there is concealed, but as the cellar filled, water forced it open and it only one, whilst veterans face three. The thieves try to is now quite obvious. If the characters do not Search until the flee once they realise that the characters are competent. tide has gone down, the Search Test is only Routine (+10%), as the trapdoor has settled back to some extent.

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Cleansed Temple

The temple to the Ruinous Powers is small and simple. A steep flight of stairs leads down from the trapdoor into a square room, which used to be the temple proper. A barred door to the left leads to the cell, whilst a simple wooden door to the right leads to the room where the Mutants lived.

1. The Temple

The first thing the characters notice on entering the temple is the cell because Odo immediately calls out to get their attention. See Location 2.

The temple itself is a mess, as one would expect. An altar still stands opposite the door, but the rest of the trappings are strewn about the floor. These items are foul and blasphemous, but characters with Academic Knowledge (Daemonology, History, Magic, Necromancy, or Theology) can automatically identify the symbols as those of Nurgle. Other characters may make a Very Hard (–30%) Intelligence Test to make the same connection. None of the items have any intrinsic value, and upstanding characters who do not want to be burned as heretics should destroy them as soon as possible.

2. The Cell

The cell holds five cold, frightened, and deeply traumatised peasants. Their clothes are soiled, and they are huddled together for warmth. The only one still coherent is Odo, a

middle-aged man. When the water started pouring into the room, Odo grabbed a brass tube that the cultists used in their rituals and poked it through the tiny breathing vent in the cell. He then made sure everyone in the cell got their turn at breathing through the tube.

As a result, they are all still alive, but it will be some time before they can forget being trapped in cold, dark water for over an hour, only able to breathe for a few seconds before it was someone else's turn.

The door of the cell is made of iron bars; Odo explains one of the cultists watched them with a loaded crossbow at all times, threatening to shoot if they made any noise. It is locked, but the key is among the junk of the temple and can be found without too much trouble.

Whilst all the peasants are grateful for the rescue, Odo is the only one coherent enough to talk to the player characters (see Odo's Story).

3. The Barracks

The door to this room has swollen and jammed shut.

Characters can break it down with weapons (such as axes), in which case it has Toughness 6 and opens after taking 20 Wounds. They can also attempt to force it open, which requires a Hard (-20%) Strength Test. The Strength Test can be retried, at the same difficulty, as many times as desired.

This room was still under construction, and the end furthest from the door has collapsed completely as a result of the flood.

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Who is Odo? The Mutants worshipped a Chaos deity who seemed to have something to do with diseases and decay. Odo tried not to listen. Odo is obviously more than a normal peasant. For a start, in to the services, particularly as the Mutants would sometimes game terms he spent a Fate Point after being captured, and the sacrifice a prisoner. Three were killed after Odo arrived and, from player characters are the rescue. In this adventure, he plays no talking to the other peasants, Odo thinks at least one was killed role beyond that of the prisoner, and within the span of this before that. He also thinks that the temple is quite new, as the adventure, he is too shaken to do anything else. Game masters Mutants were not all here when he arrived and the new arrivals may want to use him in future adventures, however. brought more blasphemous trappings with them.

Food and drink were brought to the Mutants by someone

(If the characters think to wonder about what is above it, the who never spoke and always wore a long cloak with a deep family living across the road from the abandoned house will be hood. The Mutants once mocked him (Odo is fairly sure the very grateful for the warning. Without it, their house collapses person was male), and he simply pointed at the prisoners. The in the night.) Mutants assured him they couldn't escape, but he wouldn't There are three bunk beds still largely intact and many personal budge. Wisely, as it turned out, possessions scattered around. These possessions can provide New prisoners arrived from Serrac about once a week to begin clues as to where to go next (see Tracing the Mutants). with, but there have been none for two weeks now. Odo doesn't know whether this is because they now had enough victims.

Odo's Story Odo has observed the Mutants carefully for several weeks, so can answer most questions. Unfortunately, nothing else of what Odo is willing to tell the characters everything he knows about he knows is directly relevant to the adventure.

the temple and the Mutants. Odo and the other prisoners are The peasants all want to go home, and Odo would be very all from Serrac, a small village a couple of days' travel west of grateful if the player characters would escort them. There L'Anguille. They were all kidnapped from their beds, knocked wouldn't be much in the way of monetary reward, but Odo also unconscious in their sleep (Odo thinks with drugs) and suggests Serrac would be the ideal place to continue investigating then brought here. They woke up in the cell, so they do not this cult if the player characters are interested in wiping it out.

know where they are. Odo is very relieved to find he is still in Bretonnia, especially if his rescuers are from the Empire. Note Tracing the Mutants that Odo speaks a language in common with the adventurers, probably Reikspiel if they are not Bretonnian. The characters may prefer to try tracing the Mutants directly, rather than relying on the peasants, or they may want to look for evidence to back Odo's story up. The material in the temple itself provides ample evidence that the Mutants were part of a Chaos cult but nothing more specific. The remains in the barracks are more informative.

First, a successful Evaluate Test reveals many of the normal items, such as blankets, clothes, and the like, are of Good Quality, but there are others that are distinctly Average. Players might suspect the good stuff belonged to the leader, but a little thought (automatic if they consider the possibility) shows the distribution is wrong; there are five almost identical Good cloaks, for example. The best hypothesis is that each Mutant owned a mix. A Common Knowledge (Bretonnia) Test reveals the higher quality items are all from the area west of the city of L'Anguille, the area containing the village of Serrac. Odo can also identify the source of the better goods, if asked.

Second, the three-eyed Mutant kept his Fay doll (see Religion and Custom, page 42), drawing a third eye on the forehead. The regional styles for these are distinctive, and a Hard (–20%) Common Knowledge (Bretonnia) Test reveals this style is characteristic of a group of four villages to the west, very close to Serrac. Again, Odo recognises it automatically if asked. Finally, a small chest contains over a dozen cheap tankards. Each tankard has the mark of an inn on it, and it looks like they were collected as souvenirs. Four are from inns in L'Anguille itself, and unless the characters are literally just off the boat, they recognise them. A fifth is from an inn on the

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road leading west from the city, about a day's travel away. (If We Ignore the Plot! the characters have travelled to L'Anguille, one stopped at the inn on the way. If this is impossible, they saw an advertisement Some players may decide the Mutants are uninteresting and for the inn in the Shattered Compass.) The others can only decline to investigate further. Often, simply saying this is the plot be identified with the help of a Very Hard (–30%) Common will get things back on track. Otherwise, you could point out the Knowledge Bretonnia Test, one for each tankard. One is from higher quality items suggest there is significant money behind the inn in Serrac (Odo can identify this automatically), another the cult, so there might be treasure involved. If the characters two from inns between Serrac and the city of Couronne, and are motivated neither by money nor by the prospect of fighting four more from inns in Couronne itself. These tankards were Chaos, they are going to have little to do in the Old World. collected by the three-eyed Mutant, who used to hide his third eye under a hat so he could move about in normal society. Searching the room also turns up 4 gc and 10 s in small change.

— Clues Tied Together —

The clues the characters have all point to the area west of When they arrive, they are noticed by another peasant, who L'Anguille, around the village of Serrac, as the origin of says “Good day, Odo,” and then takes another step before the Mutants. The characters have two main options over what spinning round to stare at him, incredulous, and shouts to do next. “Odo?!” The shout quickly brings other peasants out, and there are many happy reunions. Three families must mourn Escorting the Peasants the sacrificial victims, but on the whole, the mood is one of rejoicing that so many of the vanished villagers have returned.

The characters could agree to escort the peasants back to If the characters were escorting the villagers, they are the target
Serrac. The journey is not dangerous, but it does provide a of many effusive expressions of gratitude from smelly peasants.
good opportunity to describe the scenery of Bretonnia. Most In the middle of this celebration, the lord of the manor, Sir
of the peasants still say nothing, though Odo is willing to talk. Enguerrand, arrives. Silence falls. The lord is mounted on his
The peasants also have no money, and at least one overnight destrier and surrounded by half a dozen men-at-arms. He looks
stop is necessary. They are expecting to sleep under a hedge and at the scene.
will be incredibly grateful if the characters pay for space in the
common room of an inn. Paying for private rooms, even one Serrac
for all the peasants, will be met with some suspicion: why are
the characters spending so much? Serrac is a typical Bretonnian village. Its precise layout is
Once the characters reach Serrac, the events described below unimportant, so there is no
detailed map, but the general shape
can happen, but the peasants of Serrac start off well disposed to of the village does matter.
the adventurers, who rescued several of the friends and family. Serrac is home to about three
hundred peasants who live in a few
dozen hovels gathered around a rather muddy village green. The
Investigating Alone peasant houses are visibly in a bad way, having holes in the walls
and serious damage to roofs. The peasants themselves are dirty,
If the characters leave the peasants to make their own way poorly clothed, and underfed. The
characters should realise the
home, the main difference is they arrive in Serrac before the prisoners were treated almost as
well.
peasants do and they are not so well received. Whilst they did On a hill to the north of the village
stands Castle Serrac. This
rescue the villagers, they don't show any signs of having done is far more splendid than one
would expect from the size of
so deliberately, and leaving them to travel the dangerous roads the village, which might explain
the village's poverty. The castle
alone loses the adventurers a lot of credit. consists of a large triangular stone keep with a round
tower
The adventurers learn nothing useful at the inn between at each corner. A wooden palisade
surrounds the base of the
Serrac and L'Anguille. The innkeeper vehemently denies the hill and a lower courtyard, and a
large stone gatehouse guards
suggestion that Mutants have ever stayed at his inn and throws the only entrance. A short
section of wall to either side of the
the characters out if they persist. More subtle enquiries turn up gatehouse has also been rebuilt
in stone.
nothing; a lot of people pass through the inn, and the Mutant The village's fields are mainly to the
south, and to the east and west
did his best not to stand out. forest comes quite close. These woods are used as sources of fuel
and forage for pigs and are not particularly plagued by Beastmen,
Return of the Natives though a band of Herrimaults has recently taken up residence.

The adventurers should be in Serrac when the peasants arrive back. If the adventurers escorted them, that is no problem; otherwise, pick a suitable arrival time for the rescued captives.

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Men-at-Arms (6)

There are six men-at-arms, though their abilities depend on the player characters' experience.

Novices

Race: Human

Career: Man-at-Arms

Main Profile

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

34% 32% 31% 33% 30% 29% 28% 30%

Secondary Profile

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

1 10 3 3 4 0 0 0

Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Consume Alcohol, Dodge Blow, Evaluate, Gamble, Gossip +10%, Intimidate, Perception, Speak Language (Breton)

Talents: Specialist Weapon Group (Two-handed), Street Fighting, Strike Mighty Blow, Strike to Stun

Armour: Light Armour (Leather Jack and Leather Skullcap)

Armour Points: Head 1, Arms 1, Body 1, Legs 0

Weapon: Halberd

“So, the runaways have been caught. The penalty for runaway Veterans peasants is death by hanging.” He turns to the men-at-arms. “See to it.” Race: Human

The adventurers are likely to intervene at this point. If they do not, Sir Enguerrand notices them and says “And hang those bandits, too”. Career: Yeoman (ex-Man-at-Arms) Main Profile

A Very Easy (+30%) Common Knowledge (Bretonnia) Test reveals the lord is entirely within his legal rights. However, WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel a slightly longer trial would be more normal. Thus, the characters could try speaking out in defence of the victims. 54% 32% 41% 43% 40% 29% 38% 30%

Sir Enguerrand is the mastermind behind the Cult of the Pustulent Lord, and he wants the rescued peasants dead, lest Secondary Profile they reveal something that could unmask him. However, most of his men-at-arms are not part of the cult, and he is reluctant A W SB TB M Mag IP FP to raise too much suspicion in front of them. Thus, a good speech, backed up with a successful Charm Test, convinces 2 14 3 3 4 0 0 0 him he had better not hang the peasants out of hand. Instead, he decides, as they have returned voluntarily, they deserve Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Consume Alcohol, mercy, and he imposes a flogging. If the characters continue to Dodge Blow +10%, Evaluate, Gamble, Gossip +10%, speak, he orders them confined for contempt of court, saying Intimidate, Perception, Speak Language (Breton) he will deal with them the next day. Unless the characters fight, they are stripped of their weapons and guarded in one of the Talents: Specialist Weapon Group (Two-handed), Street peasant huts; the family is simply thrown out. Fighting, Strike Mighty Blow, Strike to Stun Alternatively, the adventurers might simply attack. Sir Enguerrand rides back to the castle for reinforcements, and Armour: Medium Armour (Full Mail Armour) the villagers are no help. Some even support the men-at-arms, Armour Points: Head 3, Arms 3, Body 3, Legs 3 as they do not want to be tarred with the brush of rebellion. Weapons: Halberd The fight is very likely to go against the characters (see Rescue!). Rescue!

The rescue finally comes when the characters need it most. If they are fighting Sir Enguerrand's men-at-arms, it comes then. If they allow themselves to be imprisoned by the knight, it comes during the night. Either way, the rescue quickly comes to involve combat.

Sir Enguerrand's cruelty has drawn the attention of a group of Herrimaults, who have been interfering with his activities for some weeks. They are led by a Faceless, but none of them

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know his true identity. He is Sir Laustic, a local nobleman But We Didn't Come and a knight whom the adventurers have already met in to Fight Chaos... L'Anguille.

The rescue needs to work, so you should not worry about If the adventurers do not agree to help the fight, the Faceless combat statistics. Enough Herrimaults arrive to overwhelm tries to persuade them, but ultimately he cannot force them. the guards or distract them enough for player characters to If they will not go along, he is regretful but says that they win in their current combat. The characters are then herded must stay in the camp whilst the rest of his men go, just in into the forest near the village, where they are taken to a case they are spies. council with the Faceless. The Herrimaults do not say much, In this case, Sir Enguerrand's troops are spotted after the preferring to leave that to the Faceless. They do welcome Faceless has left for the barrow. The guards left with the the characters' help in their struggle against Sir Enguerrand, characters insist that they come along when they leave to warn however, and do allow the characters to keep their weapons. the Faceless. This leaves the characters near the barrow when The characters should feel like rescued guests, not prisoners. the Herrimaults turn to deal with the troops, and they are The Herrimaults take the adventurers to a clearing where yet attacked by the Beastmen. more Herrimaults sit around a fire. Beyond the fire stands a figure in a deep hood, his face invisible in the shadows. This Sir Laustic is a true believer in the duties of knighthood is the Faceless. He welcomes the characters, has food and but also in the basic superiority of the nobility. He sees evil drink brought, and then speaks to them. nobles such as Sir Enguerrand as a blemish on Bretonnian knighthood rather than as a threat to the peasants. Whilst "Welcome to my humble lodgings. I am sorry that he is happy to work with peasants, he would never accept a you have seen the honour of Bretonnia so sullied by peasant as a leader. He should come across as proud, certain that cur Enguerrand. You seem to be bold folk—what that he is the leader in any situation, but willing to listen to has brought you to this place?" advice and change his plans. However, he always believes he gets to make the final decisions. The Faceless does not know about the Chaos temple in L'Anguille and will be shocked when he learns the truth, Sir Laustic partly because it fits with something his Herrimaults have found. A few hours' walk to the east there is an old barrow Race: Human which recently has been the site of some activity. A few of Career: Faceless (ex-Knight Errant, ex-Knight of the Realm) his men think they have seen Mutants and Beastmen in the area, but so far there has been no firm evidence. Now that it Main Profile seems there is a Chaos Cult active in the area, the Faceless is inclined to think the sightings are genuine. He suggests the WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel characters help him to deal with the site. Assuming the characters agree (see the sidebar for what 59% 57% 46% 48% 42% 29% 43% 57%

happens if they do not), he starts planning a major assault. However, before anyone can act, one of the scouts arrives to Secondary Profile report that Sir Enguerrand is leading his troops on a sweep of the forests. The Faceless sends the characters to deal with A W SB TB M Mag IP FP the barrow whilst he and his band distract and divert the lord's troops. He won't listen to suggestions that it be done 3 17 3 3 4 0 0 0 the other way around: his band knows the woods and the characters do not. He also does not think twice about issuing Skills: Academic Knowledge (Genealogy/Heraldry, Strategy/ orders to the player characters. Tactics +10%), Animal Care, Animal Training, Charm, Command +10%, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia +20%), Sir Laustic, The Faceless Dodge Blow +10%, Evaluate, Gossip, Outdoor Survival, Perception +10%, Ride +10%, Secret Language (Battle Sir Laustic has the same statistics whatever the level of the Tongue), Speak Language (Breton, Reikspiel—or another adventurers because he is not intended as an opponent. The language spoken by the adventurers) characters will have no chance to attack Sir Laustic at a point when he is not backed up by at least a dozen Herrimaults, Talents: Etiquette, Public Speaking, Seasoned Traveller, and no particular reason to attack him at any point. Specialist Weapon Group (Cavalry, Two-handed), Stout- The knight would prefer that the adventurers did not hearted, Strike Mighty Blow, Unsettling, Virtue of learn his identity, although he does recognise them from Chivalry, Virtue of Empathy L'Anguille. If the characters have a chance to see his face, they remember him on a successful Average Intelligence Test. Armour: Medium Armour (Full Mail Armour) Armour Points: Head 3, Arms 3, Body 3, Legs 3 Weapons: Hand Weapon (Axe), Shield, Bow with 12 Arrows Trappings: Band of men, Mysterious Hood. (Also the trappings of a Knight of the Realm with a fief, but he does not bring those along in his role as an outlaw.)

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— At the Barrow —

The barrow is now the site of a temple of Nurgle, the Novices location of some final clues pointing to Lord Enguerrand as the sponsor of the evil. Main Profile

1. Outside the Barrow WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

The barrow stands in a clearing in the woods, dominating the 30% 21% 31% 35% 30% 24% 24%

20%

open space. It rises over fifteen feet from the ground in the centre and is about 60 feet wide and 90 feet long. The plants Secondary Profile growing in the area are sickly and deformed.

The outside of the barrow is guarded by two Beastmen from a A W SB TB M Mag IP FP concealed guard post in the woods. Characters need to succeed at a Hard (-20%) Perception Test to spot it; if they do not, they 1 10 3 3 5 0 0 0 are surprised by the attack. The Beastmen first fire arrows, hoping to take advantage of surprise, then burst from concealment to Skills: Concealment, Follow Trail, Outdoor Survival, attack the characters. One charges straight in, but the other blows Perception, Shadowing, Silent Move, Speak Language (Dark a horn before closing. The horn is to alert the cultists inside the Tongue) barrow to come to help. The flaw in this plan is that people inside the barrow cannot actually hear the horn. Talents: Keen Senses, Rover The Beastmen notice the lack of reinforcements on the third Special Rules: round of combat, and one tries to break off to run inside. If the characters prevent this, the cultists are still ignorant of the Chaos Mutations: Animalistic Legs and Bestial adventurers' presence. If the sentry gets away, the cultists are Appearance. They do not have horns. warned and take up defensive positions, as described below. Silent as the Beasts of the Woods: +20% to Silent Move Tests and +10% to Concealment Tests.

Armour: None

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0, Body 0, Legs 0

Weapons: Shield, Spear, Bow with 12 Arrows

Veterans

The entrance to the barrow is obvious: a stone doorway in one Main Profile end of the mound.

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

Beastmen Guards (2)

40% 25% 35% 44% 35% 26% 25% 25%

Both Beastmen have numerous weeping sores and cough constantly during the battle. Whilst the adventurers may be Secondary Profile worried about infection, there is no risk.

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

1 12 3 4 5 0 0 0

Be Very Quiet

If the adventurers manage to enter the barrow without raising the alarm, they may want to try to keep it that way. The barrow is very solid, with thick walls, so sound does not travel easily within it. If the characters are in the main

chamber (Location 3), they must make Routine (+10%) Move Silently Tests to keep quiet enough not to be heard. In the side rooms, including the entrance passage (Location 2) and temple (Location 8), these tests are Very Easy (+30%). You should call for a test for every action the adventurers try, but no one investigates until the adventurers have failed three tests in different rounds. Combat is always noisy, but if it is over in under three rounds the characters who hear it decide that it was nothing important. If Cultists in the side chambers try to raise the alarm by shouting, they must spend two half actions doing so. These actions need not be in the same round but may be. Cultists in the main chamber can raise the alarm automatically without needing to spend an action. If the alarm is raised, the Cultists grab their weapons and go to investigate. There isn't much strategy involved, but the adventurers have to fight everyone at once.

Magic in the Barrow

The barrow has been saturated in Chaos energy for years now, and this affects magic use within. All spellcasters roll one extra die, and discard the lowest when calculating their casting total. However, all dice count for the Curse of Tzeentch or The Wrath of the Gods.

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Skills: Concealment, Follow Trail, Intimidate, Outdoor the remainder of their time in the barrow.

Resistance to Disease

Survival, Perception, Shadowing, Silent Move, Speak grants a +10% bonus to this test, as does a current or former

Language (Dark Tongue) career that involves working in sewers or with rotten bodies, such as Grave Robber or Rat Catcher.

Talents: Keen Senses, Menacing, Rover

Special Rules: 3. The Main Chamber

Chaos Mutations: Animalistic Legs, Bestial Appearance, The main chamber of the barrow is vaulted in stone and is

and Horns. six yards (three squares) wide by ten yards (five squares) long.

There are six archways leading off to the sides, three on each

Silent as the Beasts of the Woods: +20% to Silent Move side, whilst a seventh archway stands at the far end of the

Tests and +10% to Concealment Tests. room. The doors to each side chamber are described on the

following pages.

Armour: Light Armour (Leather Jack) There is a makeshift kitchen in the centre of the chamber,

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 1, Body 1, Legs 0 with a central fire and tables arranged around it.

Most of the

Weapons: Shield, Spear, Horns (SB-1), Bow with 12 Arrows smoke escapes through cracks in the roof, but the room is still

rather smoky. If there has been no alarm raised, a single cultist

2. The Entrance Passage is in this chamber, fixing himself something to eat. When

the characters enter, he is surprised for a round, and if the

This stone passage is 2 yards (1 square) wide and 6 yards (3 characters can dispose of him in that time, no one else notices.

squares) long, with a ceiling high enough for any character to The Cultist grabs a kitchen knife (treat as dagger) to defend

stand upright. There is no door at the outer end, but a simple himself.

wooden door blocks the inner. The inner door is not locked. If the Cultists were warned, two of them stand, wearing

If the Beastmen did not manage to raise the alarm, the leather jacks, armed, and ready for battle, at the far end of

passage is unguarded. Even if they did, it is probably empty. the chamber. They shout insults at the characters, trying to

Only if there are more than six adventurers is one of the goad them into attacking. If the adventurers do rush into the

Cultists posted here to guard the entrance whilst the others chamber, the other Cultists burst out of the side-chambers

devise a better plan. nearest the entrance to attack the characters from behind. It

As soon as the characters enter the barrow, their senses are isn't a great strategy, but it's the best they could come up with

assailed by a foul stench. The odour smell like a mixture of in the time they had.

warm sewage, rotten flesh, rotten vegetation, and the foul pus

that oozes from infected wounds. All characters must make a

Toughness Test or immediately spend two rounds vomiting.

Even after that, they are at -10% to all Tests due to nausea for

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Chaos Cultists (6) one holds one (the other resident is getting some food). The

rooms contain a bunk bed, table, chairs, and stinking bucket.

The Cultists of Nurgle have all suffered mutations that make Cultists who are surprised are not wearing armour and need a

them appear diseased. Indeed, they may all have some sort of full action to get hold of a Hand Weapon. Cultists given any

Chaos Disease. It is not, however, something that they can pass warning grab a Hand Weapon, and if warned by one of the

on to the player characters. sentries, they pull on a leather jack as well.

The doors to these rooms are wooden, heavy, and fit the frames

Novices well. They are not, however, locked in any way, and open easily.

Unless the adventurers have roused the Cultists' suspicions with

Main Profile earlier noise, the Cultists are surprised when the door opens.

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

3%

25% 25% 25% 25% 25% 25% 25% 5. The Wight Room

FP

Secondary Profile 0 The door to this room is ironbound wood with two heavy wooden bars and four iron bolts on the outside. There is no

A W SB TB M Mag IP window in the door, and characters may assume that it is a prison. Success on a Very Hard (–30%) Perception Test if

1 10 2 2 4 0 0 the characters do nothing particular (or Average if they state that they are examining the door) reveals the door hasn't been

Skills: Animal Care, Concealment, Outdoor Survival, Perception, opened for weeks. Any living prisoners would be long dead.

Silent Move, Speak Language (Breton, Dark Tongue) Unfortunately, the prisoner isn't living. This room holds the

Wight who haunts this barrow. Lord Enguerrand thought the

Talents: Flee! creature might prove useful, so he imprisoned it rather than

Special Rules: destroying it. The Wight is not happy.

If the characters open the door, the Wight rushes out immediately,

Chaos Mutations: Running Sores and Foul Stench. All ignoring the adventurers unless they try to stop it. The Undead

characters with a sense of smell take a –5% penalty to monster then hunts down the Chaos Cultists, killing all of them.

WS when within 2 yards. Penalties to Fellowship are It does not attack the adventurers if it has the chance to attack and

already included in the statistics above. kill the Cultists, even if the adventurers attack it.

Once the Cultists have been dealt with, it turns on the

Armour: None (if not warned) or Light Armour (Leather Jack) adventurers. It is most angry with those who have been defiling

(if warned) its tomb for years, but any intruders must be driven out.

Even if all the Cultists are dead when the characters open

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0 or 1, Body 0 or 1, Legs 0 the door, the Wight searches the barrow to make sure. If the

Weapons: Hand Weapon (swords or axes) characters leave whilst the Wight is searching, it does not pursue

them. Indeed, if the characters have killed all the Cultists, the

Veteran Wight realises what happened and goes to the entrance of the barrow to salute the characters, acknowledging their deeds. This

Main Profile should be very creepy, especially as the Wight is still Frightening.

It then returns to the darkness of the barrow.

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

8%

41% 38% 31% 31% 36% 31% 31%

FP

Secondary Profile 0

A W SB TB M Mag IP

1 15 3 3 4 0 0

Skills: Animal Care, Concealment, Dodge Blow, Outdoor The Wight Survival, Perception, Silent Move, Speak Language (Breton, Dark Tongue) The wound score in brackets is the number of Wounds the Wight has remaining after killing all the Chaos Cultists, if any Talents: Flee!, Strike to Injure are alive when it is released.

Special Rules:

Novices

Chaos Mutations: Running Sores and Foul Stench. All characters with a sense of smell take a -5% penalty to Main Profile WS when within 2 yards. Penalties to Fellowship are already included in the statistics above. WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

Armour: None (if not warned) or Light Armour (Leather Jack) (if warned)

Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0 or 1, Body 0 or 1, Legs 0

Weapons: Hand Weapon (swords or axes)

4. Living Quarters 40% 35% 45% 45% 30% 25% 35% 20%

Each of these three burial chambers has been converted into Secondary Profile living quarters for two Cultists. If there has been no warning, the two nearest the door each hold two Cultists, whilst the central A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

1 15(10) 4 4 4 0 0 0

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Skills: Perception, Speak Language (Classical) sacrifices, and it currently holds Yonec, an old Peasant who was

Talents: Frightening, Night Vision, Undead due to be offered up next time. Yonec is very hungry, but he

Special Rules: does not yet have any diseases; it would spoil the sacrifice were he infected in advance.

Wight Blade: The Wight wields a sword which counts as The characters can easily release Yonec, as he is not chained.

magical and inflicts SB+2 damage. In addition, when a If he sees the characters, and the Cultists are still around, he

Wight causes a Critical Hit, it makes two rolls on the tries to get their attention by waving through the window, and

table and inflicts the deadlier result. In the hands of if they come, he warns them to be quiet. He tells them how

anyone else, a Wight Blade counts as a hand weapon. many Cultists there are, and warns them that something very

dangerous is trapped in the Wight Room, though he does not

Armour: Medium Armour (Full Mail Armour) know exactly what (and thus does not call it the Wight Room).

Armour Points: Head 3, Arms 3, Body 3, Legs 3 He also warns them that entering the temple itself is extremely

Weapons: Wight Blade and Shield dangerous for those who do not worship the Plague Lord.

Yonec has a final piece of very valuable information. He was

Veterans already here when the last sacrifice happened, and he knows that

Lord Enguerrand came to oversee it. Yonec is extremely keen to

Main Profile tell the characters this, as he lives on one of Lord Enguerrand's manors and does not want a Chaos Cultist for a lord.

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

8. The Temple of Pestilence

60% 35% 51% 51% 30% 25% 35% 20%

This chamber, in the shape of an eight-pointed star, was

Secondary Profile excavated by the cultists, and the stonework is noticeably newer than that in the rest of the barrow. The double doors

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP are wooden, barred from the outside, and carved with a single, rotting rat on each leaf.

2 15 (12) 5 5 4 0 0 0 In the centre of the temple is a rotting heap of Human bodies, forming an obscene altar, and hovering over it in the air is a

Skills: Perception, Speak Language (Classical) constantly writhing shape that looks a lot like a torch flame

Talents: Frightening, Night Vision, Undead made of vomit. Maggots writhe in the altar, but all the corpses

Special Rules: are truly dead.

Wight Blade: The Wight wields a sword which counts as magical and inflicts SB+2 damage. In addition, when a Wight causes a Critical Hit, it makes two rolls on the table and inflicts the deadlier result. In the hands of anyone else, a Wight Blade counts as a hand weapon.

Armour: Medium Armour (Full Mail Armour)

Armour Points: Head 3, Arms 3, Body 3, Legs 3

Weapons: Wight Blade and Shield

6. Lord Enguerrand's Room

This is where Lord Enguerrand stays when he must remain at the barrow. The door is locked with an Average lock and can be broken down with a successful Challenging (–10%) Strength Test. If it takes more than one attempt to break the door down, however, all remaining Cultists are alerted to the characters' presence.

The room is comfortably, but repulsively, furnished. There is a single bed, an upholstered chair, and a table. All fabrics are in sickly greens and browns, as is the rug on the floor. A tapestry hanging over the table depicts people of all ranks of society

succumbing to foul diseases whilst a bloated, decaying creature looks on and laughs. Two gold candlesticks stand on the table, in the form of a naked man and woman with their flesh disfigured by sores, tumours, and other diseases. To the right purchaser, the tapestry is worth 200 gc, and each candlestick is worth 50 gc, or 150 gc for the pair. The “right purchaser,” however, is a worshipper of Nurgle. To the right witch hunter, the tapestry and candlesticks are both evidence of Chaos worship and worth a fiery death.

7. The Prison

The door to this room is bolted from the outside but contains a small barred window. The Cultists used it to house future

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Kill the Prisoners! make a Challenging (–10%) Toughness Test or contract The Green Pox. Anyone stupid enough to touch the vomit flame
Some player characters might decide to kill Yonect. He can't must make a Very Hard (–30%) Toughness Test or contract
stop them; he's too weak. If they do, they find he wrote, in Neiglish Rot.
the dirt of the floor of the cell, “The master of the Cultists is There is nothing of value in the temple, but adventurers are
Lord Enguerrand! If I cannot tell anyone, you must!”. If the likely to want to destroy it. By far the best way is by fire, and
adventurers are sensible and do not slaughter a helpless old there is a store of firewood in the main chamber, near the
man, Yonect is illiterate, like most peasants. kitchen. Furniture also burns. Throwing wood into the temple
from outside does not expose characters to disease, nor does
Anyone entering the temple must make a Toughness Test or lighting a torch or something and throwing that in. Once the
contract The Bloody Flux. Anyone touching the altar must fire has caught, however, it would be advisable to leave very
quickly.

— Ill-Met at Eventide —

The adventurers now have excellent reason to believe Lord have the Old World Bestiary, use statistics for a Plaguebearer

Enguerrand is behind the Chaos cult. All that is left is the of Nurgle. Otherwise, you can use the statistics for a Lesser

task of confronting the mastermind. The adventurers should Daemon as described in WFRP on page 229.

remember the Faceless was off distracting Lord Enguerrand's Most player characters, seeing a Chaos Cultist carrying out a

forces and thus should know where the lord is. If they forget, dark ritual, attack him to stop it.

This is the right thing to do.

the Herrimaults who were watching the clearing remind them. When Lord Enguerrand realises he is under attack, he breaks

At this point, the Herrimaults trust the adventurers and guide off from reading and turns to fight the adventurers.

them straight to the Faceless.

He listens and agrees the evidence is convincing. He knows Lord Enguerrand

Lord Enguerrand headed for the Grail Chapel just outside his

castle and suggests the adventurers pursue him there whilst he Lord Enguerrand is tall and solidly built, looking every inch

and his men keep the lord's men-at-arms occupied. Behind the knight. Any visible skin is disfigured by the marks of the

this is yet more calculation. The Faceless knows that Lord Green Pox, and some of the scars weep a stinking black fluid.

Enguerrand is a menace but would rather not have local people Lord Enguerrand's Virtue of Discipline means the characters

directly involved in killing a noble until the evidence of Chaos gain no bonus to attack rolls because they outnumber him.

worship is utterly undeniable. The adventurers are a useful tool.

Novices

The Chapel

Race: Human

With the guidance of a Herrimault, the characters quickly Career: Knight of the Realm (ex-Knight Errant)

make their way to the Grail Chapel. The Herrimault points

it out and the characters can see flickering light coming from Main Profile

inside, illuminating the twilight. There is no sign of any other

guards, and indeed Lord Enguerrand is alone. WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

The Grail Chapel is a rectangular stone building, 8 yards by

12 yards. It has a vaulted roof, a fleur-de-lis window of clear 58% 31% 44% 50% 38% 29% 39% 49%

glass over the door, and a stained glass window depicting the

Lady of the Lake bearing the grail in the far end. The windows Secondary Profile

along the side are not of stained glass. When the characters

enter, Lord Enguerrand is standing in front of the altar, reading A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

from a heavy book. There is something deeply wrong about his

words, and characters who know Arcane Language (Daemonic) 2 16 4 5 4 0 0 0

know he is speaking that foul tongue.

As the characters take in the situation, a weeping sore appears Skills: Academic Knowledge (Genealogy/Heraldry, Strategy/

on the face of the Lady of the Lake in the window. Tactics), Animal Care, Animal Training, Command,

If the characters let Lord Enguerrand continue chanting, the Common Knowledge (Bretonnia, the Empire), Dodge Blow,

image in the window continues to mutate and decay, becoming Evaluate, Gossip, Outdoor Survival, Perception, Ride, Secret

a Daemon of Chaos. When the transformation is complete, Language (Battle Tongue), Speak

Language (Breton, Dark
it steps from the window to attack the adventurers. If you Tongue)

Talents: Ambidextrous, Etiquette, Seasoned Traveller, Specialist
Weapon Group (Cavalry, Two-handed), Strike Mighty Blow,
Virtue of Chivalry, Virtue of Discipline

Armour: Medium Armour (Full Mail Armour)
Armour Points: Head 3, Arms 3, Body 3, Legs 3
Weapons: Great weapon (sword)

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Chapter IX: Ill Tidings

Veterans

Race: Human
Career: Captain (ex-Knight Errant, ex-Knight of the Realm)

Main Profile

WS BS S T Ag Int WP Fel

63% 31% 44% 50% 43% 29% 39% 49%

Secondary Profile

A W SB TB M Mag IP FP

3 19 4 5 4 0 0 0

Skills: Academic Knowledge (Genealogy/Heraldry, Strategy/
Tactics), Animal Care, Animal Training, Command,
Common Knowledge (Bretonnia, the Empire), Dodge
Blow +20%, Outdoor Survival, Perception, Ride, Evaluate,
Gossip, Secret Language (Battle Tongue), Speak Language
(Breton, Dark Tongue)

Talents: Ambidextrous, Etiquette, Lightning Parry, Seasoned inwards, and a young woman
mounted on a white horse leaps
Traveller, Specialist Weapon Group (Cavalry, Two-handed), through. She raises her hand, and a
bolt of lightning strikes the
Strike Mighty Blow, Virtue of Chivalry, Virtue of Discipline Chaos Monster down. The Prophetess
of the Lady regards the
adventurers gravely from horseback and then nods to them,
Armour: Heavy Armour (Full Plate Armour) before riding her horse through the Chapel and out of
the main

Armour Points: Head 5, Arms 5, Body 5, Legs 5 door. As she leaves, she passes the Faceless, who had come to see
Weapons: Great weapon (two-handed sword) what had happened.

When the adventurers finally cut Lord Enguerrand down, he coughs up blood and seems to be trying to laugh. "My master will still have you... You... are... hisssssss..." As he breathes his last, his body begins to jerk about, as if in a fit. His skin boils, and the characters have a round to back away. Maggots erupt from Lord Enguerrand's body, writhing up to form into a blasphemous form. At the same moment, the stained glass window explodes

— Aftermath —

The villagers are all very grateful to the characters and Whilst everyone accepts the adventurers defeated a servant of
offer them accommodation for the night. The remains Chaos, no one wants them to stay permanently: they are far
in the Chapel make it quite clear that Lord Enguerrand was too dangerous. Still, the characters have made a few useful
a servant of Chaos, and on the following day, Lord Laustic contacts in Bretonnia.
arrives from the neighbouring fief to render judgement. He
keeps up the pretence of knowing nothing and listens to the Experience Points
adventurers' story.
The PCs receive 125 exp. for surviving the adventure. You can
also hand out 5-30 exp. to each character for good roleplaying.

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Pregenerated Characters

- Jacen, Human Vagabond •

Career: Vagabond Special Rules: Jacen gains a +10% bonus on Common
Race: Human (Mousillon) Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with his native dukedom of Mousillon. Jacen also has a twisted leg,
WS BS Main Profile WP Fel reducing his Movement Characteristic by -1 (already
Starting S T Ag Int 40% reflected in his starting profile).
30% 31%
Advance 31% 32% 29% 29% 28% +5%3 Armour: None
+5% +10% Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0, Body 0, Legs 0
Current — — +10% +5%3 — 45% Weapons: Hand Weapon (Club), Dagger
30% 31% Trappings: Backpack, Blanket, Tent, Water Skin, 1 Week
31% 32% 29% 34% 28%
of Rations, Wooden Tankard, Wooden Cutlery Set,
AW Secondary Profile IP FP Common Clothing, Cloak, 11 gc
Starting SB TB M Mag 3
— Background

1 12 33300 3

Advance Jacen had the unfortunate luck to be born in Mousillon. The
——— seventh child of seven children, he was resigned to his fate as
— +2 a mud farmer, or if lucky, he might join the other hunters and
Current 33300 search the swamps for delicious snails and the sacred frogs. But,
it would not be, for a blight struck the swamp killing all the food
1 12 to be found. Not even painting glue on the stunted trees to snare
birds worked. It seemed the village was doomed. Jacen's mother,
Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia, Estalia), Gossip, a bent woman of 24 years bade her son
to go and seek his
Haggle, Navigation, Outdoor Survival, Perception, fortune in the world. And so, armed with a
backpack and a stout
Performer (Storyteller), Secret Language (Thieves' wooden club, he braved the treacherous lands
and finally slipped
Tongue), Silent Move, Speak Language (Breton) out of his cursed land and into the wonderful
world that was the
rest of Bretonnia. In the years since, Jacen has survived by telling
Talents: Marksman, Orientation, Rover, Seasoned Traveller, stories and wandering from village to
village, stealing what he
Strong-minded can to get by. He has a thing for the ladies, since all are beautiful
when compared to the hideous hags of his homeland, and he's
had much success in wooing Peasants all over the land.

• Suidebert, Human Rogue •

Career: Rogue Skills: Blather, Charm, Common Knowledge (Bretonnia),
Race: Human (Brionne) Evaluate, Gamble, Gossip, Haggle, Perception,
Performer (Actor), Performer (Singer), Search, Speak
Language (Breton, Reikspiel)
WS BS Main Profile Talents: Public Speaking, Savvy, Sixth Sense, Streetwise
Starting S T Ag Int WP Fel Special Rules: Suidbert gains a +10% bonus on Common

Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with his native
dukedom of Bordeleaux.
28% 29% 36% 28% 34% 41% 38% 28% Armour: None

A+d5v%an3ce+5% — — +10% +5% +5% 3 Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 0, Body 0, Legs 0
Weapons: Hand Weapon (Sword), Dagger
+10%

Current Trappings: Backpack, Blanket, Wooden Tankard, Wooden Cutlery

33% 29% 36% 28% 34% 41% 38% 33% Set, Common Clothes, Deck of Cards, Cloak, 16 gc

AW Secondary Profile IP FP Background
Starting SB TB M Mag 3

— Some people are just born lazy, and Suidbert of Brionne is one
1 11 32400 3 of them. Suidbert has never worked a day in his life, and he has

Advance no plans to start now. Ever the layabout, he gets by in life on
—— his natural talents, singing and performing on stage. He's also a
— +2 consummate gambler, knowing just how to play the odds...and
Current 32400 how far to push his luck. For now, he's content to stay with his
new companions, so long as it earns him money and he doesn't
1 11 have to break a sweat.

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Pregenerated Characters

• Redemund (Mathilde), Knight Errant •

Career: Knight Errant Talents: Etiquette, Luck, Schemer, Seasoned Traveller,
Race: Human (Lyonese) Specialist Weapon Group (Cavalry), Strike Mighty Blow,
Virtue of Chivalry
WS BS Main Profile WP Fel
Starting S T Ag Int 31% 30% Special Rules: Mathilde gains a +10% bonus on Common
30% 31% Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with her native
37% 37% 31% 32% +5%3 +5% dukedom of Lyonese.
A+1d5v%an3ce —
+5% +5% +5% — 36% 30% Armour: Medium Armour (Helmet, Mail Coif, Mail Shirt,
Current Leather Jack)
35% 31% 37% 37% 31% 32%
Armour Points: Head 4, Arms 1, Body 3, Legs 0
Weapons: Lance, Shield, Hand Weapon (Sword), Dagger
Trappings: Backpack, Blanket, Wooden Tankard, Wooden

Cutlery Set, Common Clothing, Cloak, Light Warhorse
with Saddle and Harness, 11 gc

AW Secondary Profile IP FP Background

Starting SB TB M Mag 2

— When Mathilde was a girl, she watch the Knights with
1 11 33400 2 fascination. She memorised every story, every tale, all in the
Advance hopes that one day she could join them. But as she grew older,
—— the sad truth about attitudes towards women was clear—
+1 +2 Knight were male. Despite the gender barriers, Mathilde
Current 33400 harboured her hopes, knowing somehow she would succeed.
And then the Storm of Chaos began. When the King called
1 11 for an Errantry War, she slipped out of her home, stole her
fathers armour and joined the host, proving she was as capable
Skills: Academic Knowledge (Genealogy/Heraldry), of a warrior as any other Bretonnian. She has
since returned,
Animal Care, Animal Training, Common Knowledge but knows she can't return home because of
her theft. So she's
(Bretonnia), Common Knowledge (the Empire), resolved to fight against the hated Greenskins
and anyone or

Dodge Blow, Gossip, Outdoor Survival, Ride, Speak anything else that threatens her land.
Language (Breton, Reikspiel)

• Theudis, Human Protagonist •

Career: Protagonist Skills: Common Knowledge (Bretonnia), Dodge Blow, Gossip,
Race: Human (Couronne) Haggle, Intimidate, Ride, Speak Language (Breton)

WS BS Main Profile WP Fel Talents: Disarm, Menacing, Street Fighting, Strike Mighty

S T Ag Int 34% 27% Blow, Strike to Injure, Strike to Stun, Trick Riding

Starting +10% —

35% 29% 31% 32% 36% 28% 34% 27% Special Rules: Theudis gains a +10% bonus on Common
Advance Knowledge (Bretonnia) Tests that deal with his native
+10% — +10% — dukedom of Couronne.

+10%3 —

31% 32% 36% 28% Armour: Medium Armour (Mail Shirt and Leather Jack)

Current Armour Points: Head 0, Arms 1, Body 3, Legs 0

40% 29% Weapons: Hand Weapon (Sword), Dagger, Shield

Trappings: Backpack, Blanket, Wooden Tankard, Wooden

Cutlery Set, Common Clothing, Cloak, Riding Horse
with Saddle and Harness, 11 gc

AW Secondary Profile IP FP Background

Starting SB TB M Mag 3 A bully and a thug, Theudis is quiet simply raw muscle for
— hire. Ever since he could stand on his own, he's always had a

1 3 11 33400 3 penchant for knocking skulls and beating up those who cross
him. And now that he's all grown up, he sees little reason to

Advance ———— change. Though a brute and a knave, he has a good sword

+1 +2 arm—even if his technique is a bit spotty—and is firm in a

33400 fight These are all traits that endear him to his companions,

Current despite his coarse and brutal nature.

2 11

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